shAnalysis Workflow & Theory Guide

GRACE / GRACE-FO spherical-harmonic processing in base MATLAB — theory, best practices, and step-by-step recipes

Toolbox version	shAnalysis v5.24.0
Edition	6 (adds: evaluation on the ellipsoid, GIA uncertainty, data-driven leakage correction, model grids, Earth-rotation excitation, bridging the mission gap, and the numerical lanes as class methods)
Scope	ICGEM I/O, spectral diagnostics, synthesis & analysis, destriping, Gaussian / DDK / tvANS filtering, VCE, basin averages & deconvolution, climatology & AR(1) significance, GIA, degree-1/C20 chain, Slepian localization, SINEX covariances, mascon comparison, load deformation, gradient tensor, multi-center combination, sea-level fingerprints, Love-number I/O incl. frame conversion, ICGEM series download, pole-tide conventions, pointwise synthesis at satellite altitude, the ellipsoidal surface, leakage correction, Kalman/VAR smoothing, Earth-rotation excitation, gap bridging, CF grids
Dependencies	base MATLAB only (no toolboxes); Java optionally for gz streaming
Validation	every numerical method independently validated in Python (numpy/scipy) before MATLAB implementation; runAllTests (five suites) is the acceptance gate on every pull request
License	MIT (see LICENSE; the DDK3 Wbd test fixture MIT from its upstream repository; ITSG/GFZ fixtures remain their providers' property)
Provenance	Developed by Matthias Weigelt with the help of Claude (Fable 5), 2026-08-07

How to read this guide. Part I develops the theory exactly as implemented (equation forms match the code, including storage conventions and numerically validated tolerances). Part II condenses the best practices the implementation enforces or enables. Part IV is the complete API reference — every public function and method with typed, dimensioned inputs/outputs, defaults and a real-data example, generated from the source arguments blocks at build time. Part III gives copy-paste step-by-step recipes for the standard products. The HTML reference (`doc shAnalysis`) documents every function signature; this guide explains why and in which order.

Installation and data

The toolbox itself needs nothing beyond base MATLAB. One call puts it on the path and, optionally, fetches the correction files the standard chain uses:

```
cd shAnalysis
setup_shAnalysis(Permanent = true, Download = "core")
% levels: "none" (path only) | "core" (TN-13/TN-14) | "filters" (+DDK)
%         | "starter" (+ a few ITSG months) | "all" (+ the complete ITSG
%         monthly archive, resumable);  DryRun = true shows the plan
shLowLevel.makeTutorials(Cases = "core");   % Live Scripts to open and run
```

Downloads land under a persistent data folder (`shLowLevel.dataFolder`), set once with `DataFolder=`. The fetchers throttle themselves and verify every file by parsing it before it replaces anything, so an interrupted download is resumable and never leaves a corrupt file in place.

Opt-in test data

Seven tests need data far too large to ship as fixtures, so each reads its location from an environment variable or a MATLAB preference and filters itself out when there is none. This is not tidiness: the fixture suite cannot see the class of failure that only appears on real data of real length — three such bugs were found the first time the toolbox was run against a full 24-year series, and the mascon reader's dimension order was only settled by a real product file.

Test	What it needs	Where it looks
testPublishedTrendOnARealSeries (testScience)	a folder of monthly GSM .gfc files, more than 24 epochs	SHX_SERIES_FOLDER, the environment only
testMasconReaderOnARealFile (testRobustness)	a real mascon product: CSR (no login), GSFC, or JPL PO.DAAC	SHX_MASCON_FILE
testReadGridOnTheGravISGrid (testRobustness)	the GravIS Level-3 TWS grid in the GravIS folder	SHX_GRAVIS_FOLDER or preference GravisFolder
testGravisChainsRealData (testContract)	the GravIS folder, a monthly series and the DDK binaries	SHX_GRAVIS_FOLDER, SHX_SERIES_FOLDER and SHX_DDK_FOLDER, or the preferences GravisFolder, SeriesFolder and DDKFolder
testExcitationAgainstESMGFZ (testScience)	the ESMGFZ angular momentum functions (ESMGFZ/HAM, ESMGFZ/SLAM) and a monthly series	SHX_EARTHROTATION_FOLDER or preference EarthRotationFolder, plus the series
testBridgeGapsAgainstGRACE (testScience)	an HLSST series such as HLSST_SLR_COMB2023s, and a monthly series	SHX_BRIDGE_FOLDER or preference BridgeFolder, plus the series
testUserSuppliedSINEXFiles (testRobustness)	SINEX files of your own (*.snx, *.snx.gz, up to ~30 MB)	the test-data folder: SHX_TESTDATA_FOLDER or preference TestDataFolder

```
% five locations through setup: setenv for this session AND setpref
setup_shAnalysis(SeriesFolder = "D:/grace/itsg", ...
                 MasconFile = "D:/grace/GRCTellus_JPL.nc", ...
                 GravisFolder = "D:/grace/gravis", DDKFolder = "D:/grace/DDK");
% the other two as preferences
setpref("shAnalysis", "EarthRotationFolder", "D:/grace/earthRotation");
setpref("shAnalysis", "BridgeFolder", "D:/grace/hlsst");
```

`SHX_SERIES_FOLDER` is the one location read from the environment only, and only by the trend regression: a routine acceptance run must never reach for a network or archive drive, so that test runs only in a session that asked for it (setup exports the variable for the session; a setenv line in startup.m keeps it). None of the seven is required: without their data the suite runs complete and each reports as filtered rather than passing silently.

Part I — Theory as implemented

0. What GRACE measures, for readers starting from zero

Mass attracts. Every redistribution of water on and in the Earth — a monsoon soaking a river basin, an ice sheet shedding meltwater, groundwater pumped from an aquifer — changes the gravity field by a minute amount. The GRACE mission (2002–2017) and its successor GRACE-FO (2018–) measure exactly this: two satellites chase each other about 220 km apart on a near-polar orbit, and a microwave (GRACE) or laser (GRACE-FO) link measures their separation to micrometers or better. Flying toward extra mass, the leading satellite accelerates first and the gap stretches; the gap history maps the gravity field, month after month. The magic number to remember: converted to water, GRACE resolves changes of roughly a centimeter of water spread over a few hundred kilometers — enough to weigh continents breathing.

The monthly product is not a map but a set of a few thousand numbers: **Stokes coefficients**, the spherical-harmonic spectrum of the field (Section 1 explains the mathematics; for now: degree l is inverse wavelength, about 20000/l km, so degree 60 means ~330 km features). Everything in this toolbox starts from such coefficient files. The product vocabulary, once and for all:

- GSM — the monthly gravity solution, with atmosphere and ocean dynamics already subtracted by background models. GSM over land = water storage; GSM over the ocean = nearly nothing, ON PURPOSE.
- GAA/GAB/GAC/GAD — monthly means of exactly those subtracted background models (atmosphere / ocean / both / ocean bottom pressure). To study ocean mass you must ADD the right one back (Section 23); shLowLevel.fetchGAX provisions them.
- Monthly SINEX — the full normal-equation matrix of a solution (ITSG only), i.e. its complete error description; the key to the VDK filter (Sections 21–22). One month is ~460 MB.
- Daily Kalman solutions — low-resolution (n40) daily fields from ITSG, the basis of near-real-time flood tracking (Section 26).
- Mascons — an alternative representation on mass tiles with built-in regularization; readMascon reads CSR and JPL products.

Two truths shape all processing. First, the raw monthly fields are STRIPED: the along-track sampling makes north–south errors much smaller than east–west ones, and unfiltered maps drown in meridional stripes — hence the whole filtering industry of Sections 7–9 and 21. Second, low degrees are special: the satellites cannot see degree 1 (geocenter) at all and measure C20 poorly, so both are completed from external series (Section 16). Skipping either correction silently biases every trend you compute afterwards.

1. Spherical harmonics, normalization, storage

The disturbing potential is expanded in fully (4π-)normalized real spherical harmonics:

$$V(r,\vartheta,\lambda)=\frac{GM}{R}\sum_{n=0}^{N}\left(\frac{R}{r}\right)^{n+1}\sum_{m=0}^{n}\left[\bar{C}_{nm}\cos m\lambda+\bar{S}_{nm}\sin m\lambda\right]\bar{P}_{nm}(\cos\vartheta)$$

with the normalization $\int|Y_{nm}|^2\,d\Omega = 4\pi$, the ICGEM convention. Throughout the toolbox coefficients live in lower-triangular matrices with 1-based indexing `C(n+1, m+1)`; vectorized orderings are always mediated by `shLowLevel.shIndex` (fields n, m, cs, P; Nmin defaults to 2 for GRACE work, 0 for analysis). GM and R ride with the data (read from the gfc header); the defaults (3.986004415e14, 6378136.3) are overridable, never baked-in physics. Load Love numbers k_n for water-storage kernels must be supplied explicitly — the toolbox refuses to guess them.

2. Legendre functions: scaled Holmes–Featherstone recursion

Fully normalized associated Legendre functions are computed by the standard order-diagonal seed plus degree recursion. The naive diagonal seed underflows near the poles at high degree; `shLowLevel.legendreALF` therefore implements the globally scaled Holmes–Featherstone variant (scale 10^{-280}, rescaling on the fly), verified stable to degree 2190: the sum rule and parity

$$\sum_{m=0}^{n}\bar{P}_{nm}^{2}(\cos\vartheta)=2n+1\quad(\sim 10^{-11}\ \text{at}\ n=2190),\qquad \bar{P}_{nm}(-\varphi)=(-1)^{n+m}\,\bar{P}_{nm}(\varphi)$$

hold across all latitudes; the parity relation halves the recursion cost on hemispherically symmetric grids (the parity trick).

3. Synthesis

Spatial synthesis evaluates, per latitude, the order sums

$$A_m(\varphi) = \sum_{n=m}^{N} f_n \, \bar{C}_{nm} \, \bar{P}_{nm}(\varphi), \qquad B_m(\varphi) \text{ analogously with } \bar{S}_{nm},$$

then the longitude sum

$$g(\varphi, \lambda) = \sum_{m=0}^{N} [A_m(\varphi) \cos m\lambda + B_m(\varphi) \sin m\lambda].$$

For uniform full-circle longitude grids this last sum is an inverse FFT after folding aliased orders into mod(m, n_{lon}) bins — exact, validated against the direct product to 3e-13 (`Method="auto"|"fft"|"direct"`).

Memory model (v2.2). The Legendre stack (n_{max}+1)² × n_{lat} × 8 bytes is the memory driver: 7 GB at n_{max} 2190 over 181 latitudes. Above the 'MaxMemGB' budget (default 4), synthesis streams latitude bands: compute the Legendre block, fold into A_m/B_m, discard. Chunked equals monolithic exactly (Python-validated, max deviation 0.0); the class-level Legendre cache is bypassed automatically when the stack would not fit.

Scattered points (v5.1.0). `shLowLevel.synthesisPoints` evaluates at arbitrary (latitude, longitude, radius), with the upward continuation a spherical grid cannot express. Method = "clenshaw" sums each order by Clenshaw's recursion on lumped coefficients and never forms the Legendre array; "direct" batches the Legendre functions and is bitwise the earlier path. In MATLAB clenshaw won at every point count measured (1 to 2000 points, nmax 60 to 360), so "auto" picks it everywhere (v5.3.0): 2000 points at nmax 60 take 0.022 s on the CI machine against 2.28 s for the per-point code it replaced.

4. Quantity kernels

A single degree factor f_n maps Stokes coefficients to the target quantity (`shLowLevel.kernelFactors`):

quantity	f_n	unit
geoid	R	m
potential	GM/R	m²/s²
gravity disturbance	$\frac{GM}{R^2}(n+1)$	m/s²
gravity anomaly	$\frac{GM}{R^2}(n-1)$	m/s²
EWH (water)	$R\,\frac{\rho_{ave}}{3\rho_w}\,\frac{2n+1}{1+k_n}$	m
surface density *	$R\,\frac{\rho_{ave}}{3}\,\frac{2n+1}{1+k'_n}$	kg/m²
bottom pressure *	$g_0 R\,\frac{\rho_{ave}}{3}\,\frac{2n+1}{1+k'_n}, \quad g_0 = \frac{GM}{R^2}$	Pa
vertical deformation *	$R\,\frac{h'_n}{1+k'_n}$	m
gravity gradient T_{rr} *	$\frac{GM}{R^3}(n+1)(n+2)$	1/s²

(* new in v2.3.) The 'Height' option continues potential-type kernels upward by $(R/r)^p$ (p = n+1 potential, n+2 anomaly/disturbance, n+3 T_{rr}; validated against -d/dr and d²/dr² of the continued potential) — evaluate directly at satellite altitude. Surface quantities reject Height by contract.

The EWH kernel divides by (1+k_n): the observed potential contains the solid-Earth loading response, which must be removed to recover surface mass. k_n is always user-supplied (e.g. Wahr et al. 1998 or your loading-theory set of choice).

5. Elastic load deformation (v2.3)

A surface load deforms the elastic Earth; the displacement at the surface, expressed through the load-induced (residual) Stokes coefficients, is (Wahr et al. 1998):

$$u_{\text{up}} = R\sum_{n,\,m} \frac{h'_n}{1+k'_n}\,\Delta\bar{C}_{nm}\,\bar{Y}_{nm}, \qquad u_{\text{north}} = R\sum_{n,\,m} \frac{l'_n}{1+k'_n}\,\Delta\bar{C}_{nm}\,\frac{\partial\bar{Y}_{nm}}{\partial\varphi}, \qquad u_{\text{east}} = R\sum_{n,\,m} \frac{l'_n}{1+k'_n}\,\Delta\bar{C}_{nm}\,\frac{1}{\cos\varphi}\,\frac{\partial\bar{Y}_{nm}}{\partial\lambda}$$

The vertical is a pure degree factor ('deformation_up'); the horizontals need the exact spherical-harmonic gradient. `shLowLevel.legendreALFDeriv` provides dPbar/dϕ through a frozen identity — the (n,m) coefficient pattern

(with √2 corrections at m=0 and m=1 from the normalization of $\bar{P}_{n0}$/$\bar{P}_{n1}$) was calibrated by least squares against numerical differentiation and then frozen; residuals sit at the finite-difference floor (~1e-9). `shLowLevel.shSynthesisDeformation` / `g.deformation` evaluate all three components on grids or GNSS station lists (Mode="points", LatType="geodetic"); north/east validated point-wise against brute-force gradients to ~5e-10. Degree 0 is excluded; degree 1 is opt-in and only meaningful with consistent geocenter (CF/CE frame) handling; all three Love-number sets must come from ONE loading model. East is NaN at the poles (undefined direction).

6. Analysis (the inverse problem)

`shLowLevel.shAnalysisGrid` / `shCoefficients.analysis` estimate coefficients from data. Two regimes:

- **Ring grids** (uniform full-circle longitudes, arbitrary latitude rings): an FFT along longitude decouples the normal equations per order; each order solves a small least-squares over latitude rings. Exact recovery of band-limited input to ~8.7e-15 when the sampling theorem is met ($n_{lat} \geq n_{max}+1$, $n_{lon} \geq 2n_{max}+1$).
- **Scattered points**: chunked accumulation of full normal equations. Under-determined or ill-conditioned samplings (polar gaps, regional patches) need Kaula regularization: a diagonal prior

$$\sigma^2_{\text{prior}}(n) = \left(\frac{K}{n^2}\right)^2$$

stabilizes the inversion at the cost of damping unconstrained coefficients toward zero. For regional data the mathematically cleaner route is Slepian localization (Section 12) — estimate only the ~N concentrated linear combinations the data can actually see.

7. Destriping and Gaussian smoothing

GRACE monthly solutions carry correlated north–south stripes: within one order and parity, coefficients of successive degrees correlate. The classic Swenson–Wahr destriper (`shLowLevel.shDestripe`) fits and removes a low-order polynomial across same-parity degree series per order (defaults: orders ≥ 8, polynomial order 2, window 5, all configurable). Gaussian smoothing (`shLowLevel.shGaussianFilter`) multiplies degree-wise by Jekeli weights from the recursion

$$b = \frac{\ln 2}{1-\cos(r/R)}, \qquad W_0 = 1, \qquad W_1 = \frac{1+e^{-2b}}{1-e^{-2b}} - \frac{1}{b}, \qquad W_{n+1} = -\frac{2n+1}{b}\,W_n + W_{n-1}$$

with the half-response radius r as the single tuning knob. Both are provided primarily as the baseline against which tvANS and DDK are judged.

8. DDK anisotropic decorrelation (v2.2)

The DDK filters (Kusche 2007; Kusche et al. 2009: DDK1–DDK8, ordered strong→weak) replace the scalar Gaussian weight by a full matrix per (order, C/S) block, derived from a GRACE error covariance and a signal prior — anisotropic, order-dependent smoothing that suppresses stripes with less signal attenuation than an equivalent Gaussian. `shLowLevel.readDDK` parses the released binary Wbd files natively (Rietbroek/Kusche BIN format; endian autodetect; verified to 4.4e-16 against the repository-documented DDK3 reference values; DDK1..8 = a_1d14p_4, 1d13, 1d12, 5d11, 1d11, 5d10, 1d10, 5d9; Nmax= truncates an Lmax-120 filter to n96 series), plus .mat containers and an ASCII exchange layout; `applyDDK` applies block-wise c → M·c, passing uncovered degrees through unchanged. Formal errors are invalidated by the filter (coefficients become correlated); propagate uncertainties with `shLowLevel.mcPropagate`.

Note. The real DDK3 file (Wbd_2-120.a_1d12p_4, MIT-licensed, from github.com/strawpants/GRACE-filter) is one of the test fixtures (shLowLevel.testDataDir finds it); the unit tests pin the parser to the repository-documented pack values. Degrees below the filter's Lmin (2) pass through unfiltered, as in the reference implementation.

9. The tvANS filter (time-variable anisotropic noise/signal Wiener filter)

The toolbox's flagship decorrelation filter. Model per month t: x = signal + noise with signal covariance S (estimated from the data themselves) and noise covariance $s_t N$ (a shape N, e.g. from a SINEX covariance or the built-in order/parity model, scaled monthly by VCE factors s_t). The Wiener estimate of the residual field is

$$\hat{x}_t = W_t\,x_t, \qquad W_t = S\,(S + s_t N)^{-1}$$

Implementation: one generalized symmetric eigendecomposition gives, for every month simultaneously,

$$SU = NU\Lambda \quad\Rightarrow\quad W_t = V\,\mathrm{diag}\!\left(\frac{\lambda_i}{\lambda_i + s_t}\right)U^{\mathsf{T}}, \qquad V = U^{-\mathsf{T}}$$

— O(P²) per month instead of a fresh P³ solve. The deterministic model (bias/trend/annual/semi-annual) is removed first and restored after filtering; VCE factors are estimated from high-degree residuals via a robust median χ^2 estimator (`shLowLevel.vceRescale`). With a block-diagonal N (order/parity blocks), the whole machinery runs per block (Blocks="auto"), tractable to Lmax ≈ 120. External noise models join the block path when they are block-diagonal in the (order, C/S, parity) partition (verified, not assumed — v2.2.2); dense covariances fall back to the full path (auto) or error loudly (on).

Per-order-band VCE (v2.2). One s_t per month is coarse: striping strength varies with order. VCEBands=[0 16 33 61] estimates independent monthly factors per order band (block path only — band-wise scaling breaks the single global eigendecomposition, which the code asserts). The per-block factors are honored consistently in the filter application, the posterior sigmas, and the basin deconvolution covariance (identity of the banded block filter with the directly constructed W validated to 5.6e-16).

Posterior uncertainty. The filtered-residual variance

$$\operatorname{diag}((I - W_t)\, S) = (V \circ V)\, \tfrac{s_t \lambda}{\lambda + s_t}$$

(validated 3.5e-16) is exposed as per-coefficient/month sigma stacks (`tsF.sigmaCs/Ss`). With hard constraints (v2.5) the EXACT diagonal of (W–I)S(W–I)' + s·WNW' is used (O(P²q) in the eig basis, validated 2e-15 against the brute-force covariance; the constrained-direction identity Ac'·Cov·Ac = s·Ac'NAc holds exactly). Honest correction: the earlier formula UNDERESTIMATED along constrained directions (ratios down to ~0.72) — the pre-v2.5 'upper bound' note had the direction wrong.

10. Basin averages and deconvolution

A basin kernel b (Section 11) gives the filtered basin series $a_t = b^{\mathsf{T}} x_t / (b^{\mathsf{T}} b)$. Because filtering attenuates and leaks, `shLowLevel.basinDeconvolve` solves the small linear system that undoes the filter's action on a set of basin kernels B:

$$c_t = A^{-1} B^{\mathsf{T}} \hat{x}_t, \quad A = B^{\mathsf{T}} W_t B \;\; (K \times K); \qquad \operatorname{cov}(c_t) = A^{-1} \left[G_v^{\mathsf{T}} \operatorname{diag}(s_{\mathrm{vec}}\, g^2)\, G_v \right] A^{-\mathsf{T}}$$

where g are the spectral gains and s_{vec} the (possibly band-wise) monthly noise factors — the v2.2 form is exactly the v2.1 formula when bands are off. Ill-conditioned kernel sets accept a relative ridge (λ = Ridge·||A||), with the covariance consistently using the regularized inverse. Since v2.5 the basin sigma also carries the OLS parameter uncertainty of the restored deterministic part (design leverage h_t × per-coefficient residual variance, carried on the operator; Monte-Carlo: emp/pred 1.18 without the term, 1.00 with it, 1.26 → 1.08 at seasonal leverage peaks), and with constraints the deconvolution noise covariance uses the exact constrained operator. The deterministic-part errors remain correlated across epochs through the shared fit (pointwise sigma; documented).

11. Basin kernels: buffering and tapering (v2.2)

`shLowLevel.basinKernel` builds $b = Y^{\mathsf{T}}(w \cdot \mathrm{mask})$ by exact Gauss–Legendre quadrature from a polygon, mask, or f(lat,lon) handle. Two leakage controls:

- **BufferKm**: grow/shrink the region by exact great-circle distance before quadrature (trade leakage-in against leakage-out; computed in latitude chunks, practical to Lmax ~ 96).
- **TaperKm**: multiply the kernel spectrally by Jekeli Gaussian weights — soft edges suppress the ringing of the truncated indicator. Rule of thumb: taper radius ≈ the coefficient filter's half-response radius.

The quadrature area fraction is returned; b(1) equals it exactly (Y_{00} = 1), which the tests pin down.

12. Slepian localization (v2.2)

For a region R, the concentration problem maximizes the energy ratio over band-limited g = Yx:

$$\lambda = \frac{\int_R g^2\, d\Omega}{\int_\Omega g^2\, d\Omega} \;\rightarrow\; \max, \qquad K = Y^{\mathsf{T}} \operatorname{diag}(w \cdot \mathrm{mask})\, Y, \qquad N_{\mathrm{Shannon}} = \sum_i \lambda_i = \tfrac{A_R}{4\pi} P$$

Eigenvectors (Slepian tapers) are orthonormal; eigenvalues are concentrations in [0,1]; the Shannon number (exact by the addition theorem — the trace identity the tests verify) counts the tapers the region supports. Regional analysis then estimates ~N Slepian coefficients $a = G^{\mathsf{T}} x$ instead of P Stokes coefficients — well-posed by construction, no Kaula prior needed. Validated on the 30° polar cap: λ bounds to 4e-16, orthonormality 3e-15.

`shLowLevel.slepianProject` projects a coefficient stack onto the tapers and rebuilds the part of the field they carry; `g.slepianProject` and `ts.slepianProject` (v5.13.0) do the same for one field or every epoch of a series.

13. Climatology, alias periods, AR(1) significance (v2.2)

`ts.climatology()` fits bias, trend, annual and semi-annual terms (plus optional extra periods) per coefficient. GRACE tidal aliasing puts S2 at 161 d, K2 at 3.66 yr, K1 at 7.48 yr: Periods=[161/365.25, 3.66, 7.48] keeps these out of trend and semi-annual estimates. Per-coefficient 1-sigma significance comes from the OLS covariance (weighted and robust variants available) and rides on every component accessor, enabling significance-masked maps.

AR(1) correction. GRACE residuals are temporally correlated; white-noise sigmas are optimistic. ARCorrect=true estimates the lag-1 residual autocorrelation r_1 per coefficient and inflates sigmas by

$$\sigma_{\mathrm{AR}(1)} = \sigma \sqrt{\frac{1+r_1}{1-r_1}}$$

— the standard first-order effective-sample-size correction, since v2.5 applied to the Kendall bias-corrected $r_1' = r_1 + (1+3r_1)/T$. Monte-Carlo validation: uncorrected sigmas underestimate the empirical trend scatter by 2.00× ($\phi = 0.6$, $T = 120$); with the raw-r_1 inflation the ratio is 1.065, with the bias-corrected r_1 1.028 (1.152 → 1.079 at T = 60). Still first-order and slightly conservative — the residual few percent stems from the regression absorbing low-frequency noise.

14. GIA correction (v2.2)

Secular Stokes trends mix present-day mass change with glacial isostatic adjustment. `ts.removeGIA(gia)` subtracts rate·(t - T_0) per epoch; `clim.removeGIA(gia)` corrects a fitted trend directly — both routes agree identically (tested to 1e-13). GIA models (ICE-6G_D, Caron et al., A/W13, ...) are user-supplied gfc rate files, never embedded. The model's own uncertainty, often the dominant regional trend error (Laurentia, Fennoscandia, Antarctica), propagates too since v5.2.0: `ts.removeGIA(gia, Sigma = s)` adds the rate sigma times $|t - T_0|$ in quadrature to every epoch's sigmas — correct MARGINAL sigmas — and returns the rate sigma itself in `info.rateSigmaC/S`. That second output is the one a trend needs: one rate error applies to every epoch, so the GIA term is perfectly correlated in time, and a trend fitted from per-epoch sigmas that assume independence understates it by about √T (measured 3.49× against √T = 3.46). Without a sigma field, differencing several models remains the spread estimate.

15. Geocentric vs. geodetic latitude (v2.2)

All SH mathematics here runs in geocentric latitude; maps, GIS products and mascon grids are geodetic:

$$\tan\varphi' = (1-f)^2 \tan\varphi$$

with the WGS84 flattening as overridable default. The difference peaks at 0.192° (~21 km) near 45° — large enough to visibly bias basin averages and point comparisons. Synthesis, analysis and shAnalysisGrid accept LatType="geodetic" and convert internally.

16. The degree-1 / C20 completion chain

GRACE does not observe geocenter motion (degree 1), and its C20 is weak: the standard product chain is GSM + TN-14 (C20/C30 from SLR) + TN-13 (degree-1). `shLowLevel.readTN14` and `shLowLevel.readTN13` parse the official technical notes (TN-13 verified against the real GFZ RL06 file: 256 paired months 2002-04 to 2026-04, including the 2017.4–2018.4 gap); `ts.addDegree1` and the C20/C30 replacement close the chain with epoch matching and provenance notes in the history.

A TN-13 table is one source of degree 1; the data themselves are the other. `shLowLevel.estimateDegree1` (v3.6.0) implements Swenson, Chambers & Wahr (2008): the degree-1 terms are whatever, added to the field, make its ocean part agree with an ocean model — a small least-squares problem per epoch over the ocean domain. Its output has the TN-13 layout, so `ts.addDegree1` takes either, and `ts.estimateDegree1` (v5.13.0) is the method form. Omitting the ocean model attributes real ocean signal to the geocentre, and a warning says so.

17. Normal field and (GM, R) conventions (v2.4)

Geoid maps need the DISTURBING field: subtract the ellipsoidal normal potential. `shLowLevel.normalFieldCS` computes the even zonals from the WGS84/GRS80 defining constants (GM, a, f, ω) via the Heiskanen–Moritz closed form (q_0 series → J_2 → J_{2n}) — no coefficient tables; validated against NIMA TR8350.2 to all published digits. Crucially, WGS84 GM (3.986004418e14) and a (6378137.0) DIFFER from the ICGEM conventions (3.986004415e14, 6378136.3): `g.subtractNormalField` rescales the ellipsoid field to the model's (GM, R) first via

$$\bar{C}'_{nm} = \bar{C}_{nm}\,\frac{GM_1}{GM_2}\left(\frac{R_1}{R_2}\right)^n$$

(`shLowLevel.rescaleGMR` / `g.toReference`; the physical field is invariant — verified by synthesizing the potential at a common radius from both representations). Skipping the rescaling costs millimetres. The arithmetic operators refuse GM/R-mismatched operands (shCoefficients:operands:constantsMismatch) instead of silently mixing conventions. Permanent tide: the ellipsoid is tide-free by construction; the model's C20 tide system (ICGEM header) is NOT converted silently — zero-tide vs tide-free differ by ~4.2e-9 in $\bar{C}_{20}$.

18. Multi-center combination (v2.4)

Several centers observe the same monthly field with different noise. One variance factor per (center, month) — the COST-G granularity — estimated by Foerstner iteration with PARTIAL redundancies:

$$\hat{x} = \left(\sum_c w_c N_c^{-1}\right)^{-1} \sum_c w_c N_c^{-1} x_c, \qquad s_c^2 = \frac{v_c^{\mathrm{T}} N_c^{-1} v_c}{r_c}, \qquad r_c = P - \mathrm{tr}\left(H\, w_c N_c^{-1}\right)$$

Without r_c the factors bias low (v_c is correlated with x■). Noise shapes N_c come from each center's own climatology residuals as (order, C/S, parity) blocks; the whole iteration runs block-wise. Robust=true replaces the global ratio by the median of per-block unbiased estimates q_b/r_b. The empirical shapes are trace-normalized, so the factors carry each center's absolute noise power and are directly comparable (weights invariant; v2.4.1). Two limits are structural: common-mode errors (shared K-band data, AOD1B, tides) are invisible to inter-center VCE — posterior sigmas are a LOWER bound — and inter-center correlations violate independence; info.interCenterCorr quantifies the optimism. Combine GSM before TN-14/TN-13, then apply the replacements once.

19. Elastic sea-level fingerprints (v2.4)

A melting ice mass does not raise the ocean uniformly: the ocean surface follows the perturbed geoid minus the deformed crust, under global mass conservation (Farrell & Clark 1976, elastic limit):

$$S = \mathcal{O}\,(N - U + \kappa), \qquad \int_{\mathrm{ocean}} \rho_w\, S\, dA = -\int_{\mathrm{land}} \sigma\, dA$$

`shLowLevel.seaLevelFingerprint` iterates this on the toolbox's exact Gauss–Legendre quadrature pair. Validation: mass conserved to machine precision, ~11 iterations, and the classic pattern — sea level FALLS near the melting mass (lost self-attraction plus rebound; validation run: near field -0.3 mm vs far field +0.8 mm about a +0.6 mm eustatic mean per unit load). Elastic only, no rotational feedback, fixed coastlines.

20. Gravity gradient tensor (v2.4)

`shLowLevel.shSynthesisGradientTensor` synthesizes all six NEU components at altitude; second Legendre derivatives come from the frozen first-derivative stencil applied twice (exact identity). Every call self-checks the Laplace invariant trace(G) = 0, validated at 7e-16 of max|G|; G_{uu} is bit-consistent with the 'gravity_gradient_rr' kernel route. 1 Eotvos = 1e-9 s^{-2}.

21. Time-variable decorrelation: the VDK/VADER filter (v3.13)

Sections 8–9 introduced the Wiener family: damp each coefficient by how much you trust it. The DDK filter fixes ONE synthetic error model for the whole mission; tvANS estimates one empirical structure from the series itself. Both assume the error STRUCTURE never changes — but it does: orbit height decays, ground tracks enter and leave short repeat cycles, instruments age. The VDK filter (Horvath et al. 2018; VADER in the paper) uses the actual monthly normal-equation matrix N from the ITSG SINEX:

$$x_\alpha = (N + \alpha M)^{-1} N x$$

with M the inverse signal variance (a Kaula rule $a l^b$ per calendar month, estimated by signalVarianceKaula with an exact log-chi-square bias correction) and α the strength knob. With $S = M^{-1}$ this is ALGEBRAICALLY the tvANS form $S(S+\alpha N^{-1})^{-1}$ — same family, different inputs, and the difference is worth 15% median error and an order of magnitude in bad months (paper Table 2). The price: the one-eigendecomposition trick of tvANS requires a stationary structure, so VDK pays one Cholesky factorization per month instead (seconds at n96). vdkApply never forms the filter matrix; tools/dev/run_vdk_series.m drives the archive-scale batch.

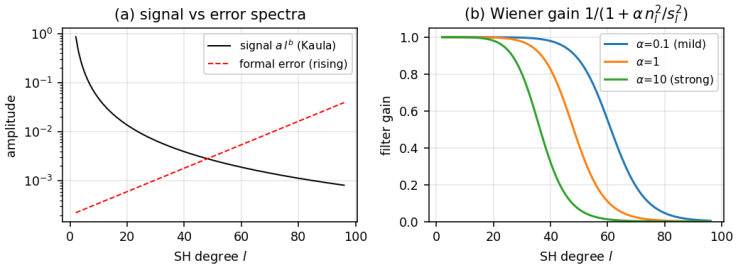


Figure T4 — the Wiener principle behind DDK, tvANS and VDK (computed illustration). (a) Signal follows a falling Kaula law while GRACE errors rise with degree; (b) the resulting gain damps degrees where noise wins. VDK recomputes the gain every month from the measured N.

```
idx = shLowLevel.shIndex(96, Nmin= 2);
f = shLowLevel.fetchITSGSINEX("2018-06", Nmax = 96);   % ~460 MB, deliberate
snx = shLowLevel.readSINEX(f(1), Index = idx);     % N + x in idx order
[ab, ~] = shLowLevel.signalVarianceKaula(ts.Cs, ts.Ss, ts.epochs);
xf = shLowLevel.vdkApply(snx.x, snx.M, idx.n, ab(6, :), Alpha = 1);
```

22. Normal equations and SINEX, demystified

A monthly solution is a least-squares estimate: the satellites provide millions of range observations, the unknowns are the ~9400 Stokes coefficients (n96, degrees 2–96), and the NORMAL-EQUATION MATRIX $N = A^T P A$ condenses the whole adjustment: its inverse is the error covariance, its structure encodes which coefficient combinations that month's orbit could or could not see. SINEX is simply the exchange format that ships x, N and metadata in labelled blocks; the ITSG monthly files carry SOLUTION/NORMAL_EQUATION_MATRIX as a packed triangle — hence 460 MB. readSINEX streams the blocks and reorders everything onto a shIndex layout, verified against exactly this product. COST-G distributes no per-month SINEX (their combination happens internally), so ITSG is the only public source.

23. Ocean mass: restoring GAX, barystatic sea level and OBP (v3.10–3.11)

Because GSM has ocean dynamics removed by construction, the honest recipe for ocean-mass questions is: restore what was subtracted, then average. oceanChain adds the monthly GAD field (ocean bottom pressure) back, subtracts GAA over the ocean to avoid double-counting atmosphere, filters, masks (|lat| ≤ 66° away from the crude coasts) and area-averages to the barystatic curve — the ocean-mass part of sea-level rise, +1.41±0.03 mm/yr in the shipped acceptance on COST-G (published range ~1.6–2.2; Section 24 explains the gap's main suspect). obpChain keeps the FIELDS instead (GravIS OBP recipe: GAD before the filter, reference period 2002/04–2020/03, land NaN). The pixel residuals still contain real ocean circulation; SeparateCirculation splits them by EOF with a Marchenko–Pastur significance limit — modes are only removed where they rise above what pure noise eigenvalues could produce.

```
[out, rep] = shLowLevel.oceanChain(ser, kn = kn, OceanMask = oc, ...
    GADFolder = gadF, GAAFolder = gaaF, SeparateCirculation = true);
[out.trend, out.nModes, out.sigMon]
```

24. Coastal leakage: buffers and support separation (v3.15)

A band-limited field has no sharp edges: truncate any coastline at degree 60–96 and it rings; filter it and land signal smears hundreds of kilometers into the ocean. Greenland alone biases the North Atlantic mean visibly. Two controls, both quantified before they were built. CoastBufferKm erodes the ocean mask by a great-circle distance (shLowLevel.erodeMask): for gauss445, 300 km removes 54% of a coastal point-source leak, 500 km 82%, at under 1% ocean-area loss. RemoveLandLeakage attacks the cause: separate the field into land-supported and ocean-supported band-limited components by two-sided alternating projections (Papoulis–Gerchberg style) and subtract the land part BEFORE filtering. The pre-validation taught a hard lesson worth stating in bold: a naive ONE-step subtraction makes the leak WORSE, because the reconstruction of the outside field rings INTO the mask. The two-sided iteration (LandLeakIter = 5) cuts an adjacent-source leak of 47% of the ocean mean by 94%.

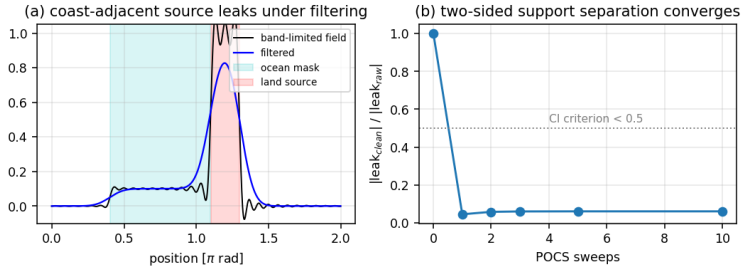


Figure T5 — the 1D reference experiment behind the v3.15 leakage controls (computed, identical mathematics to the sphere). (a) A band-limited land source adjacent to the ocean mask leaks under filtering; (b) two-sided support separation converges within a few sweeps to a small fraction of the raw leak — the CI test freezes the <0.5 criterion, the converged value is ~0.06.

25. Hydrological extremes: standardized indices (v3.14)

A TWS anomaly of –12 cm means nothing by itself: is that a dry month for THIS place and season, or business as usual? Standardized indices answer by comparing against the local seasonal climatology. The GRACE-DSI (Zhao et al. 2017) is the z-score per calendar month, binned into the 11 USDM-style classes D4 (exceptional drought, z ≤ –2) through W4; it agrees with USDM, PDSI, SPEI, NDVI and in-situ groundwater in the validation literature — while seeing the FULL storage column including groundwater, which no precipitation-based index does. Two policies are measured, not assumed: DETREND FIRST (a 0.5 cm/yr GIA or depletion trend weakens a planted exceptional-drought month from –2.41 to –1.44 — out of its class — and turns 45% of the late decade spuriously wet), and a robust sigma option (one corrupt month inflates the classical sigma sixfold; the 1.4826·MAD not at all). For floods, the causal Reager storage deficit $S_{def}(t)$ = max of the past minus the last state measures how much water the basin can still take; with a precipitation grid it becomes the full Flood Potential Index behind multi-month lead times (Reager et al. 2014).

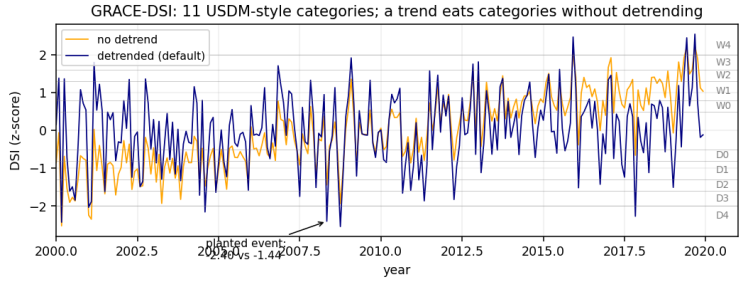


Figure T7 — the DSI construction on the pre-validation experiment (computed). The planted –2.5σ event keeps its D4 class only when the trend is removed first; the class edges are the USDM convention.

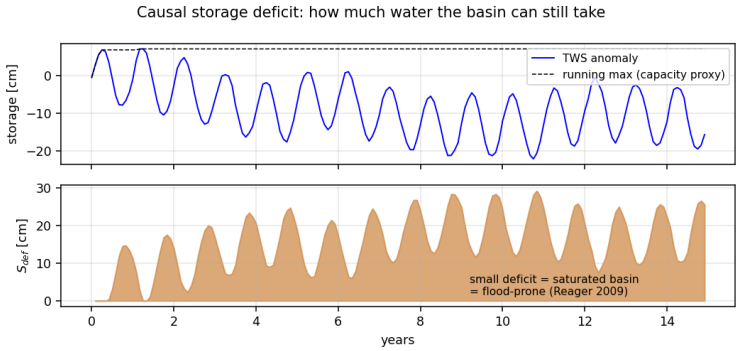


Figure T8 — the causal storage deficit (computed illustration): zero at a running maximum, growing as the basin dries; small deficit means flood-prone.

```
B = ts.toGrid(-89.5:89.5, 0.5:359.5, Quantity = "ewh", kn = kn);
[Z, ih] = shLowLevel.hydroExtremeIndex(B.Z, ts.epochs);
ih.categoryNames(ih.category(iLat, iLon, end) + 6)
```

26. Daily solutions and near-real-time monitoring (v3.14 stage 2)

Monthly fields cannot see a two-week flood wave. The ITSG daily Kalman solutions (n40, one gfc per day, fetchITSG Product = "daily") can — Gouweleeuw et al. (2018) tracked major Ganges–Brahmaputra floods this way. hydroExtremeIndex switches automatically to a day-of-year climatology on daily input: means per exact DOY, sigma from the RESIDUALS in a circular 31-day window that wraps December into January, with the sqrt(n/(n-1)) correction for the estimated mean. The construction is measured, not assumed: window sigma on RAW values leaks the seasonal cycle (1.99 instead of 1.5), the two-stage form does not; a planted +3σ January-2nd flood scores z = 2.9 straight across the year boundary.

27. Temporal smoothing: Kalman filtering with VAR process models (v3.21–3.26)

Every method so far treats months independently. But mass redistribution has memory: the field of one epoch predicts the next. Kurtenbach (2012) and Kvas (2019) built the ITSG daily solutions on exactly this idea — a vector-autoregressive (VAR) process model inside a Kalman filter — and the module implements their chain end to end: estimateVAR, kalmanFilter, rtsSmoother, buildCondFun, neqCombine, with kalmanChain as the single point of access.

The process and observation model

The reduced (climatology-removed) coefficient vector x_t follows a VAR(p); observations are either solutions with covariance (l = x + v) or normal equations (N x = b) consumed in information form. For p = 1 the Yule–Walker solution is Kurtenbach's closed form:

$$B = \Sigma(1)\,\Sigma(0)^{-1}, \qquad Q = \Sigma(0) - B\,\Sigma(0)\,B^{\mathsf{T}}$$

Higher orders embed into the companion form; the filter starts stationary (x■■ = 0, P■■ = Σ(0)), which makes the forward filter plus RTS smoother an EXACT solver of the joint block-tridiagonal least-squares adjustment over all epochs (Kvas Sec. 2.3) — pinned in the test suite to 1e-15 (Python) and 1e-9 (MATLAB) against the explicitly built batch system. Gap months become prediction-only and relax toward the prior at the rate the estimated dynamics dictate.

Choosing the process model: measured, not assumed

The first live VAR table (ITSG monthly n40, T = 257, 36-month holdout, one-step coefficient RMS, computed through the shipped estimator) settled the defaults:

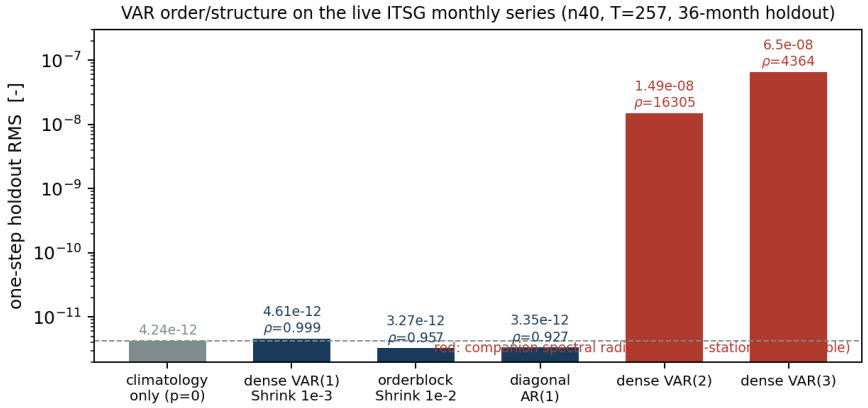


Figure: one-step holdout RMS per process model on the live monthly series. The dense VAR(1) at weak shrink is WORSE than no dynamics at all (overfit at T ≈ 0.13 P); the structured estimators beat climatology-only by 21–23%; p ≥ 2 explodes. Order = 1 confirmed.

Consequence in the API: estimateVAR Structure = "full" | "diagonal" | "orderblock". For MONTHLY series use "orderblock" (one block per order m and C/S — kalmanChain builds the partition itself) or "diagonal"; the dense default targets the DAILY regime, where Kurtenbach's production choice is dense plus spatial conditioning (buildCondFun: the Kvas EWH-domain land/ocean masks with the exp(–ψ/ψ■) taper, PSD by the Schur product theorem — it turns a singular empirical Σ(0) into a usable one, measured rcond 0 → 5.7e-2).

What the filter does to real data

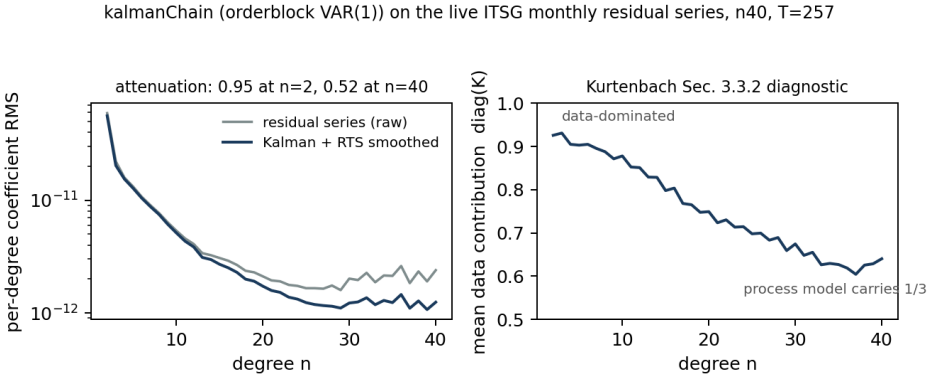


Figure: the live run on the monthly residual series (orderblock VAR(1), formal sigmas as R). Left: the smoother leaves the signal-dominated low degrees at 95% and halves the noise-dominated n = 40 band. Right: Kurtenbach's contribution diagnostic diag(K) — the share of each estimate coming from the DATA; the process model carries a third of the estimate at high degrees.

Honest scope note: an 11°-cap basin average of the same run changes by 2% RMS only (measured ratio 0.979) — basin averaging is itself a low-pass, so on monthly data the module's value sits at coefficient level, in the propagated sigmas, and in the machinery below. The DAILY regime it targets is different: there the process model is the difference between unusable and usable fields (Kurtenbach), and a live acceptance against the published ITSG daily series is on the roadmap, waiting on public daily normal equations.

Robustness machinery, each decided on measurement

- Innovation QC (Kvas Sec. 3.3, v3.21): per-epoch chi-square test T = d'S■¹d (solution form, dof = P) or u'(N P■ N + N)■ u (NEQ form, dof = rank(N)); identical when N = R■¹. QC = "reject" turns a failing epoch into prediction-only — essential in a RECURSIVE estimator, where one accepted blunder propagates into every later state (test: rejecting one 50-sigma epoch cuts downstream error by > 20%). Thresholds from the base-MATLAB Wilson–Hilferty quantile, accuracy measured against scipy.
- Joseph-stabilized update (v3.22): decided on a 50-digit-reference A/B, not textbook habit — with R small against a wide-spectrum prior (the strong-daily-data regime) the standard (I–K)P update loses six orders of covariance accuracy (1.3e-6 vs 1.9e-13). Exact-arithmetic identical otherwise.
- Multi-center (v3.23): a string array of SINEX folders is grouped by epoch and combined by neqCombine (per-epoch VCE or fixed weights) BEFORE the update; rep.sigma2 reports the factors.

• Bounded memory and latency (v3.19/v3.24): StoreCov = "matfile" keeps year-long full-covariance runs flat in RAM (bit-identical to in-memory); rtsSmoother Lag = L bounds the latency for near-real-time production (Lag = 0 is the filter, Lag ≥ T–1 the full smoother to rounding). With QC = "reject" this is the complete bounded-latency chain; the daily output feeds hydroExtremeIndex directly (chapter 26).

The one-call form

```
idx = shLowLevel.shIndex(40);
ts   = shSeries.fromFolder(folder, Truncate = 40);
[tsK, rep] = shLowLevel.kalmanChain(ts, ModelSeries = ts, ...
    Structure = "orderblock", Shrink = 1e-2, QC = "reject");
plot(rep.epochs, rep.qcStat); yline(shLowLevel.chi2Quantile(0.999, idx.P));
```

For SINEX normal equations replace the first argument by the folder (or a string array of folders, one per center); kalmanChain reads, epoch-groups, VCE-combines and filters in information form, and returns the smoothed shSeries with propagated sigmas plus the full report (model, contribution, QC record). For a series in solution mode, `ts.kalman(ModelSeries = tsm)` (v5.6.0) is the method form of the same call.

28. Evaluating on the ellipsoid (v5.5.0)

Every synthesis in Sections 3–5 evaluates on the sphere r = R. The Earth's surface is much closer to the WGS84 ellipsoid, whose geocentric radius at geocentric latitude ϕ is

$$r(\varphi) = a\sqrt{\frac{1-e^2}{1-e^2\cos^2\varphi}}, \qquad e^2 = f(2-f)$$

(`shLowLevel.ellipsoidRadius`, the one place the toolbox computes it). `Surface = "ellipsoid"` in shSynthesis and shSynthesisGradient, and in the class methods synthesis, gradient, toGrid and map, moves every point to r(ϕ) + Height and applies the radial law $(R/r)^p$ of Section 4 there. The difference is largest at the poles, where the ellipsoid lies 21.4 km inside the sphere: $(R/b)^{n+2}$ is 1.23 at n = 60, 1.39 at n = 96 and 1.84 at n = 180. Only quantities with a radial law accept the option — potential, gravity anomaly and disturbance, T_{rr}. The geoid is refused on purpose: on the ellipsoid it also needs the latitude-dependent normal gravity $\gamma(\phi)$, and moving the radius alone would be half a correction. The semi-major axis is WGS84's a = 6378137 m, not the coefficients' R: R belongs to the series, a to the surface. The sphere path is bitwise unchanged, and f = 0 with a = R reproduces it bitwise. Station lists go through synthesisPoints, which takes a radius per point; latitudes must be geocentric — a geodetic 45° taken as geocentric misplaces the radius by 71.8 m.

```
dg  = g.synthesis(-90:0.5:90, 0:0.5:359.5, ...
          Quantity = "gravity_disturbance", Surface = "ellipsoid");
r   = shLowLevel.ellipsoidRadius(latSta) + hSta;   % a radius per station
dgS = g.synthesisPoints(latSta, lonSta, r, Quantity = "disturbance");
```

29. Leakage correction without a model (v5.4.0, v5.9.0)

Guide G12 corrects leakage by forward modelling, which needs a mask, or by scaling factors, which need a hydrological model. The method of deviation (Vishwakarma et al. 2017) needs neither. Split the true field g into its part inside the catchment (catchment function R) and the rest. For any filter that leaves a constant alone — the Gaussian does — the filtered catchment average splits with no approximation:

$$\bar{g}_c = f_c + \Delta F_c + l_c \quad \Rightarrow \quad \hat{f}_c = \bar{g}_c - \Delta\hat{F}_c - \hat{l}_c$$

— the wanted mean f_c, the deviation integral ΔF_c (what the filter does to the catchment's own signal because it is not a uniform layer, weighted by the FILTERED catchment function) and the leakage l_c smeared in from outside. Both corrections need the unfiltered g; the method estimates them from the once- and twice-filtered fields and extrapolates one filtering step back. The leakage extrapolation corrects a PHASE as well as an amplitude (Hilbert regression, Phillips et al. 2012) — out-of-phase leakage is exactly what a scale factor cannot repair — while the deviation integral deliberately gets none: the thesis measured those phase differences and found no consistent relation. Both steps are regressions over time, so the function refuses fewer than 12 epochs and refuses NaN, and the method is designed for catchments of about 65000 km² and up.

The method of scale (Method = "scale", v5.9.0) removes the same leakage estimate and scales the rest:

$$\hat{f}_c = s\,(\bar{g}_c - \hat{l}_c), \qquad s = \frac{\int_R d\Omega}{\int_R \bar{R}\, d\Omega}$$

s depends on the catchment and the filter alone, and INFO.scale reports it whichever method ran. It is exact only for a uniform layer inside the catchment, and it grows as the catchment shrinks, amplifying errors. The closed loops favour it (75% of the filtering damage removed against 55% on the testCorrectness fixture), but both fixtures put a uniform layer inside the catchment — the one case it is exact for — so that ranks nothing, and the method of deviation stays the default.

```
% ewh: nLat x nLon x T fields that already saw a 300 km Gaussian
[fHat, info] = shLowLevel.leakageDataDriven(ewh, lat, lon, ...
    Mask = basin, Filter = "gauss300");
[info.phaseDeg, info.leakageRatio, info.scale]
fS = shLowLevel.leakageDataDriven(ewh, lat, lon, Mask = basin, ...
    Filter = "gauss300", Method = "scale");        % the method of scale
fT = ts.leakageDataDriven(lat, lon, Filter = "gauss300", kn = kn, ...
    Mask = basin);                                 % from a series (v5.6.0)
```

30. Model grids into coefficients (v5.8.0)

Hydrological models and the GravIS Level-3 products come as CF netCDF grids. `shLowLevel.readGrid`, the inverse of writeGrid, reads one: dimensions are found by name and returned as (lat, lon, time), longitudes come back in 0..360 ascending, fill values as NaN, and the time axis is decoded by the toolbox's one CF time decoder, the one readMascon uses. It changes no numbers: it neither regrids nor fills, and it does not assume the latitude type — INFO.latType reports what writeGrid recorded, and an empty string for a grid from elsewhere, whose latitudes are geographic, that is geodetic. A land-only grid comes back with NaN over the ocean, and `shCoefficients.analysis` refuses NaN until Fill = value says what the gaps mean (0 for no mass there): a NaN would otherwise reach every coefficient. Since v5.12.1 `shLowLevel.shAnalysisGrid` refuses NaN as well.

```
[tws, lat, lon, info] = shLowLevel.readGrid(gravisFile, Var = "tws");
info.units, info.latType                  % check both before going on
gT = shCoefficients.analysis(tws(:, :, 1), lat, lon, 96, ...
    Quantity = "ewh", kn = kn, Fill = 0, LatType = "geodetic");
```

31. Earth-rotation excitation (v5.10.0, v5.11.0)

Mass that moves on and in the Earth changes its inertia tensor and so its rotation, and the degree-2 Stokes coefficients are that tensor's time-variable part: C21 and S21 excite polar motion, C20 the length of day. Chen & Wilson (2003, eq. 1, after Eubanks 1993), solved for the excitation:

$$\chi_1 = -\frac{1.098\,R^2 M}{(1+k'_2)\sqrt{3/5}\,(C-A)}\,\Delta C_{21}, \qquad \chi_2 \text{ likewise with } \Delta S_{21}$$

$$\chi_3 = -\frac{0.753\,R^2 M 2\sqrt{5}}{(1+k'_2)\,3C}\,\Delta C_{20}, \qquad \Delta\mathrm{LOD} = \frac{2\pi}{\Omega}\,\chi_3$$

ΔLOD is the ESMGFZ convention (Dobslaw & Dill 2019, eq. 2.8, read as a time). `ts.excitation(kn = kn, TN14 = tn)` returns χ_1 and χ_2 in mas and, with a TN-14 table, χ_3 and ΔLOD in ms from the SLR C20 — GRACE's own C20 is the coefficient it determines worst. The Earth's constants default to the IERS Conventions (2010), Table 1.1: M = GM/G, C – A = $J_2 M a_E^2$, C = (C – A)/H, R = a_E, which agree with the ESMGFZ values of C and A to 0.03%; Earth = struct(...) takes your own. Three things the excitation is not. A GSM series has the atmosphere and the ocean removed, so it is the excitation of the rest — restore GAC first for the whole mass term. The motion term (winds, currents) is never in a gravity field. And χ_2 points to 90°E in the coefficients' frame, while the IERS pole y coordinate points to 90°W. C21/S21 also depend on the mean-pole convention of the pole-tide removal: convert with poleTideConvert before comparing series processed differently.

The factors 1.098 and 0.753 are options (PolarFactor, AxialFactor). ESMGFZ's prefactors give 1.101 for the polar terms, 0.3% apart, but 0.844 for the axial one, 12% more — close to the whole Earth's axial moment over the mantle's, which some authors put into the axial term. The opt-in testExcitationAgainstESMGFZ compares GRACE's excitation with the ESMGFZ hydrological and sea-level angular momentum functions.

```
tn = shLowLevel.readTN14(tn14File);
[tbl, info] = ts.excitation(kn = kn, TN14 = tn);   % t, chi1, chi2, chi3, dLOD
plot(tbl.t, tbl.dLOD); ylabel("dLOD [ms]")
info.earth                                         % the constants used
```

32. Bridging the mission gap (v5.12.0)

Between the last GRACE month and the first GRACE-FO month lie eleven months without a K-band solution (2017-07 to 2018-05), and GRACE lost scattered months to battery management before that. High-low satellite-to-satellite tracking of low orbiters such as Swarm, combined with SLR, covers them at lower resolution (Weigelt et al. 2024). `shLowLevel.bridgeGaps` and `ts.bridgeGaps` fill every month the reference series lacks within its span from such a series, calibrated on the months both have. Both are truncated to the lower nmax and smoothed with a Gaussian of RadiusKm (750 by default) — the whole output, so its resolution does not jump. Per coefficient, the means over the overlap give an offset, which also absorbs a difference in tide system or reference field; per degree, a scale regresses the reference's anomalies on the bridge's:

$$\tilde{c}_{nm}(t) = R_{0,\,nm} + s_n\big(B_{nm}(t) - B_{0,\,nm}\big), \qquad s_n = \frac{\sum \Delta B\,\Delta R}{\sum \Delta B^2}$$

The sigma of a filled month is the RMS over the overlap of the calibration residual — the fill's error as the reference itself sees it — because the formal sigmas of the HLSST series are too small at low degrees, by a factor 3 to 6 for the Kalman-filtered variant. Measured on COST-G RL02.1 against the Kalman-filtered QuantumFrontiers HLSST_SLR_COMB2023s at 750 km (208 overlap months), the fill's error over degrees 3–60 is 41% of the GRACE signal with the scale and 45% without; the unfiltered HLSST variant gives 62% and 92%. A filled month is named bridge: followed by its name in the bridge series, and INFO.bridged marks it, so the flag travels with the epochs through select, truncate and every other method. Apply TN-14 to the reference first: TN-14 has no C20 between the missions, and a filled month keeps the bridge series' own C20, which an HLSST + SLR combination determines from SLR as well.

```
tsG = shSeries.read("GSM-2_*.gfc").applyTN14(tnFile);   % TN-14 first
tsH = shSeries.read(fullfile(hlFolder, "*.gfc"));        % HLSST + SLR
[ts, info] = tsG.bridgeGaps(tsH, RadiusKm = 750);
ts.names(info.bridged)                                   % "bridge:..." months
[info.overlap, nnz(info.bridged)]
```

33. Regional bases for a selectable basin (v5.14.0)

The first step towards a regional Kalman filter after Kurtenbach (2012) whose state is a set of LOCAL basis functions. Every basis is a linear map to spherical-harmonic coefficients, x = T a with T of size P x K, so an SH solution or normal equation enters it as T'NT and T'b, a grid or point functional as A T, and a model series through a projector; on the SH basis itself (T = I) the regional filter is the global one, which is its oracle. `shLowLevel.readBasin` finds a GravIS basin by name or a unique part of it and returns a wrap-safe region: basins across lon 0 (Loire, Niger, Volta) and rings around a pole are inside where they should be. Since v5.21.0 the GravIS chains take their basin masks from it too, which closes Antarctic basin 302 through the pole (1.2 percent of the Antarctic area the old rule left out). `shLowLevel.regionalBasis` builds radial basis functions after Eicker (2008) and Woehnke et al. (2025), Slepian tapers, or the SH basis, for the region grown by BufferKm (600 km, Woehnke's computation area). A radial basis function centred on node x_k is the Legendre series

$$\Psi_k(x) = \sum_n \varphi_n\,(2n+1)\,P_n(\cos\psi_k), \qquad T_{nm,\,k} = \varphi_n\,\bar{Y}_{nm}(x_k), \qquad \varphi_n = \frac{\sigma_n}{\sqrt{2n+1}}$$

with the shape coefficients from the signal's degree amplitudes (Woehnke's eq. 7), Kaula's $1/n^2$ (the default) or one. Nodes are an icosahedral grid of $10(j+1)^2 + 2$ points or a Reuter grid, the default level the smallest whose global grid is as large as the SH basis (j = 30 at nmax 96); a node belongs to the basis when its nearest quadrature point lies in the buffered region. The projector is the least-squares fit over that region,

$$P = (T^{\mathsf{T}} K T)^{+} T^{\mathsf{T}} K, \qquad K = Y^{\mathsf{T}}\,\mathrm{diag}(w\,m)\,Y,$$

which for Slepian tapers is exactly G' (2.2e-15 in the oracle), so `regionalProject` generalises `slepianProject`. Only the grid points inside the buffered region are formed. Measured in tools/dev/validate_regional_basis.py: the radial basis function against scipy's Legendre series to 1.2e-14, the projector's normal equations to 2e-11, and the Elbe polygon's area, 140 031 km^2, against the mask quadrature (3.6% below it at nmax 60). The process model, the observation adapters and the filter on this state come next.

```
idx = shLowLevel.shIndex(60);
B = shLowLevel.regionalBasis(idx, "Elbe");          % RBF, Kaula kernel
S = shLowLevel.regionalBasis(idx, "Elbe", Type = "slepian", Threshold = 0.5);
[a, rec] = ts.regionalProject(ts.regionalBasis("Elbe"));   % K x T state
[B.K, B.nGlobal, S.K]
```

34. The process model in a regional basis (v5.15.0)

The second step towards the regional Kalman filter: Kurtenbach's (2012) stochastic process model, estimated in the coefficients of the basis of chapter 33. `shLowLevel.regionalProcessModel` and `ts.regionalProcessModel` remove the climatology of a geophysical model series (mean, trend, annual, semi-annual), project every epoch onto the basis, a = P x, and estimate the VAR model from the basis coefficients. The climatology is a fit along time with one design for every coefficient and the projection a map along the coefficients, so the two commute (6e-16 in the oracle). For order 1 the estimate is Kurtenbach's

$$B = \Sigma(1)\,\Sigma(0)^{-1}, \qquad Q = \Sigma(0) - B\,\Sigma(1)^{\mathsf{T}},$$

and on the SH basis it is, bit for bit, the model `kalmanChain` builds. His two adjustments are options. QScale multiplies Q alone (his eq. 4.8): with alpha = 10 the largest error RMS of his closed loop fell from 4.83 to 3.41 cm EWH and the mean from 1.12 to 1.01 cm, because an underestimated process variance suppresses signal while an overestimated one costs little. GroundNoise adds an isotropic, temporally uncorrelated variance to Sigma(0), his 2 cm EWH for the real data; it is read as the white EWH field band-limited to the index, sigma^2/(P f_n^2) per Stokes coefficient, whose pointwise variance is exactly sigma^2 by the addition theorem. It changes B as well as Q, and in his simulation it made results worse, so both default to off. info.representation reports the share of the model's regional signal energy the basis carries. Measured in tools/dev/validate_regional_process.py: a VAR(1) simulated in an RBF basis is recovered through the whole pipeline within the sampling error over 60 seeds.

```
B = tsModel.regionalBasis("Elbe", Type = "slepian", Threshold = 0.5);
[model, info] = tsModel.regionalProcessModel(B, QScale = 10);
[info.representation, model.specRadius, info.minEigQ]
```

35. Observations as normal equations in the basis (v5.16.0)

The third step: every level of gravity information becomes a normal equation in the basis coefficients, so that one regional state can be updated by all of them. `shLowLevel.regionalNEQ` reduces each kind to a design A in the basis and the covariance C of its data, and forms

$$N = A^{\mathsf{T}} C^{-1} A, \qquad b = A^{\mathsf{T}} C^{-1} y, \qquad l^{\mathsf{T}} P l = y^{\mathsf{T}} C^{-1} y$$

through the Cholesky factor of C (Woehnke et al. 2025, eq. A6). An SH solution with its covariance has A = T; an SH normal equation - a SINEX NEQ, or a GNSS loading equation built by another toolbox - enters as T'NT and T'b; point functionals in any quantity of kernelFactors have the design row $f_n\,(R/r)^{p_n}\,Y_{nm}$, and with a direction the row is the gradient along it - the gravity vector for the potential - from the north, east and up derivatives. A combination matrix forms differences, the shape of a line-of-sight gravity difference. The result is a neqCombine contribution with l'Pl and the observation count, so several kinds of one epoch combine with variance components before they update the filter. Measured in tools/dev/validate_regional_observations.py: the point design against the Legendre series of an RBF to 4e-15, the directional design against its analytic ECEF gradient to 4e-10 (the oracle's own finite-difference floor), and the Cholesky route against the explicit one to 5e-16.

```
r1 = g.regionalNEQ(B);                                  % a GRACE month
r2 = shLowLevel.regionalNEQ(B, "points", Values = dg, LatDeg = lat, ...
    LonDeg = lon, Height = 450e3, Quantity = "gravity_disturbance", Cov = 1e-16);
[a, out] = shLowLevel.neqCombine([r1, r2]);             % VCE of the two
```

36. The regional Kalman filter (v5.17.0)

The fourth step chains the three before it into one call. `shLowLevel.regionalKalman` and `ts.regionalKalman` estimate the process model in the basis from a model series (chapter 34), turn every observation epoch into a normal equation in the basis (chapter 35) and run the existing kalmanFilter in its normal-equation mode and the RTS smoother on the basis coefficients. With the stationary start of kalmanFilter the two passes are the joint least-squares adjustment over all epochs (Kvas 2019, Sec. 2.3); in an RBF basis the oracle solves that block-tridiagonal system densely and agrees to 2.6e-15, gaps included. The observations are a series with formal sigmas, whose climatology is removed first and restored in the basis afterwards, T(a + P c), or a struct array of basis normal equations with an epoch each. The smoothed coefficients leave the chain through linear functionals F a whose sigmas come from the full smoothed covariance,

$$\sigma_F = \sqrt{\operatorname{diag}\left(F P_s F^{\mathsf{T}}\right)},$$

with F = T for the output series, the EWH design at the region's quadrature points for out.grid, and their area-weighted mean over the unbuffered region for out.basin - the basin mean EWH and its sigma, which the

per-coefficient sigmas of the output series could not give back afterwards. The EWH outputs need the load Love numbers. On the SH basis the chain is kalmanChain: the same process model bit for bit and, through the information form instead of the gain form, the same estimates to 5.6e-15 and the same sigmas to 8.9e-16. In a closed loop with a known VAR(1) the basin-mean error is 1.07 predicted sigmas (RMS over 60 seeds), the predicted sigma honest to within the error of the estimated model. Measured in tools/dev/validate_regional_kalman.py.

```
B = tsGrace.regionalBasis("Elbe", Type = "slepian", Threshold = 0.5);
[tsK, out] = tsGrace.regionalKalman(B, ModelSeries = tsESM, kn = kn, QScale = 10);
errorbar(out.epochs, out.basin.mean, out.basin.sigma)   % basin mean EWH [m]
```

37. Regional consistency: remove-compute-restore (v5.18.0)

A regional basis sees the signal outside its region only through the observations, and what it cannot represent leaks into the coefficients it has. The option Background of regionalKalman removes a global background series b from the observations before they become normal equations in the basis, and restores it in every output:

$$x(t) = b(t) + T(a(t) + Pc(t)).$$

The grid and basin outputs carry b's EWH too. The background is taken as error-free, so no sigma changes. With the process model fixed the chain is linear in its data, so a background c z holding a fraction c of an outside signal z gives

$$x(\mathrm{obs};\, cz) = cz + x(\mathrm{obs}_{in}) + (1-c)(x(\mathrm{obs}_{in} + z) - x(\mathrm{obs}_{in})),$$

which is the test: exact to 5.6e-15. A basis built on an index with Nmin above 2 leaves the low degrees to the background entirely - remove-compute-restore of the low degrees. In record mode the records must already be reduced; the background is only restored. Neither Woehnke et al. (2025) nor Steffen et al. (2026) apply it; Steffen et al. name it as the treatment of long wavelengths, so it is checked here on its own terms. In a closed loop (nmax 30, a cap north of 60 N, a 30 cm seasonal neighbour and a degree-2..4 random walk, five seeds) the outside signal raises the grid RMS over the region by 28%; with an 80% background the error is within 3.6% of what the same data give without any outside signal. A background must be a good field: the observations' own unfiltered low degrees did worse than none (1.57 against 1.20 cm). The process model may come from the full model series (worst ratio 1.011). Woehnke's observation area, EWH on the region grown by 300 km, helps without a background (1.04 against 1.20 cm) and costs in every seed with one, so it is not a chain option. Measured in tools/dev/validate_regional_rcr.py.

```
[tsK, out] = tsGrace.regionalKalman(B, ModelSeries = tsESM, kn = kn, ...
    Background = tsHydrologyModel);             % removed, filtered, restored
```

The observation climatology the chains remove and restore is, by default, fitted to the noisy observations, so the noise of the fit returns unfiltered in every epoch. In the closed loop above it dominates: 14.5 cm grid RMS. Since v5.22.0 FitClimatology = "filtered" fits it instead to a first pass run without a climatology, removes that and filters the residual - twice the cost, 0.89 to 1.96 cm over three climatology strengths, and never more than 2% above leaving the climatology in the filter. The same option exists on kalmanChain; the default is unchanged. Measured in tools/dev/validate_climatology_restore.py.

```
[tsK, out] = tsGrace.regionalKalman(B, ModelSeries = tsESM, kn = kn, ...
    FitClimatology = "filtered");               % fit it to a first pass
```

38. Line-of-sight gravity differences (v5.19.0)

Kind lgd of regionalNEQ takes the line-of-sight gravity differences of a satellite pair in lgdToolbox's definition, the difference of the gravitational acceleration at the two satellites projected on the line of sight e = (rB - rA)/|rB - rA|:

$$\mathrm{LGD} = e \cdot (g_B - g_A), \qquad g = \nabla V.$$

The design is the potential's gradient design along e at B minus that at A, from the two orbits in the Earth-fixed frame of the coefficients; lgdToolbox works in an inertial frame, and the caller rotates both orbits. The along-track processing stays in lgdToolbox. Its band filter is passed as Operator and applied once to the block [y, A], data first, because lgd.spectralOperator fits its edge predictor on the first column and applies the fitted map to every column: filtered data against unfiltered partials would bias the inversion. So the values are the unfiltered LGD, Valid is the mask of the data's own filtered call, and Cov belongs to the filtered data; rows left non-finite or outside Valid are dropped with their part of Cov. Checked against lgdToolbox's own forward models in tools/dev/validate_regional_lgd.py: degrees 0 and 2 with C00 = 1 and C20 = -J2/sqrt(5) reproduce lgdReferenceJ2

to 1.7e-15 of |g| at the satellites, degree 0 its 50-digit Kepler pair to 5.3e-16 of |g|, and degrees 2..30 agree with Cartesian differences of the potential to the difference floor, 1.8e-8.

```
op = @(X) lgd.spectralOperator(t, X, Band = band);      % the data's operator
rec = shLowLevel.regionalNEQ(B, "lgd", Values = lgdUnfiltered, ...
    PositionA = rA, PositionB = rB, Operator = op, Valid = valid, Cov = C);
```

39. Process-noise scales from the data (v5.20.0)

Kurtenbach (2012, Sec. 4.3.5) scales the process noise by a hand-tuned factor and notes that for real data such a factor cannot be fixed beforehand. QBlocks labels blocks of the basis coefficients and QScale gives one factor per block,

$$Q(\alpha) = D\,Q\,D, \qquad D = \mathrm{diag}(\sqrt{\alpha_k}),$$

so the correlations of the estimated Q are kept; one block is Kurtenbach's alpha. EstimateQScale finds the factors as the maximum of the innovation likelihood. kalmanFilter returns its terms per epoch (Likelihood); in normal-equation form, with the predicted state m and covariance P,

$$-2\log L_t = \log|I + PN| + m^{\mathsf{T}}Nm - 2m^{\mathsf{T}}b - u^{\mathsf{T}}(P^{-1}+N)^{-1}u + c_t, \quad u = b - Nm,$$

where c_t = log|R| + l'R^-1 l is free of the model and is left out. Checked in tools/dev/validate_regional_adaptive.py: the sum equals the dense joint Gaussian likelihood to 3.9e-15, gaps included; for one block its maximum is the EM fixed point of Shumway and Stoffer (1982) to 1.3e-8; with true factors (4, 0.5) on two blocks the estimates average (3.95, 0.49) over 30 seeds and lower the state error against alpha = 1 in all of them. VAR(2) passes through the chain (with a VAR(2) truth Order 2 has the lower -2 log L in 10 of 10 seeds), and buildCondFun(..., Basis = B) turns Kvas' space-domain conditioner into one of basis covariances, Proj f(T S T') Proj'.

```
[tsK, out] = tsGrace.regionalKalman(B, ModelSeries = tsESM, EstimateQScale = true);
cf = shLowLevel.buildCondFun(B.idx, kn = kn, Psi0Km = 1100, Basis = B);
[tsK, out] = tsGrace.regionalKalman(B, ModelSeries = tsESM, CondFun = cf, Order = 2);
```

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Data providers to cite alongside the methods: ITSG (TU Graz), COST-G, GFZ/GravIS, CSR and JPL (mascons), ICGEM as the archive. The shipped acceptance numbers (–224.6 Gt/yr Greenland vs the published –231.1; +1.41 mm/yr barystatic) are reproduced against these products with the exact recipes of this guide.

Part II — Best practices

Processing chain order

The order below is not arbitrary; each step assumes the previous ones:

- **1.** Read GSM monthlies (shSeries.read, gz transparent, ICGEM 1.0/2.0 incl. gfct).
- **2.** Replace C20 (and C30 in the accelerometer-degraded years) from TN-14; add degree-1 from TN-13 (addDegree1). Do this BEFORE filtering — filters see the stripes, not the low-degree completions.
- **3.** Bridge the GRACE↔GRACE-FO gap explicitly: dropNaN / select, or fill it from an HLSST series with bridgeGaps (after TN-14, chapter 32); never fit a climatology across NaNs.
- **4.** Filter: tvANS (or DDK for benchmarking; Gaussian as baseline).
- **5.** Remove GIA (trend work only).
- **6.** Fit climatology with tidal alias periods and ARCorrect=true; or form basin series with deconvolution.
- **7.** Synthesize maps / averages; propagate sigmas (analytic where derived, mcPropagate everywhere else).

Choosing a filter

situation	recommendation
global EWH maps, standard use	tvANS (Blocks="auto"); Gaussian 300 km only as sanity baseline
cross-paper comparability	add DDK3-DDK6 variants via readDDK (binary Wbd, Nmax=96) + applyDDK
strong order-dependent striping	tvANS with VCEBands=[0 16 33 61] (v2.2)
small basins (< ~200,000 km²)	expect leakage; taper kernels, consider basinDeconvolve with several neighboring kernels
regional studies	Slepian basis instead of filtering a global field (Part III, G4)
a single catchment and no model you trust	filter as usual, then leakageDataDriven (chapter 29)

Uncertainty accounting — what is honest and what is approximate

- Formal per-coefficient sigmas (readers) → exact as published.
- tvANS posterior sigmas → exact for the unconstrained AND (v2.5) the constrained filter.
- Basin sigmas → noise part consistent with (banded) VCE and the exact (constrained) operator; deterministic-fit parameter uncertainty included since v2.5 (pointwise; epoch-correlated through the shared fit).
- Climatology sigmas → OLS/weighted/robust; AR(1) correction first-order with Kendall-corrected r_1 (v2.5; residual ~3% optimism from regression absorption).
- GIA → the model's rate sigma propagates with removeGIA(Sigma=) (v5.2.0); for a trend add info.rateSigmaC/S, which is fully correlated in time; without a sigma field use the model spread.
- Multi-center combination → posterior sigmas are a LOWER bound (common mode invisible; see info.interCenterCorr).
- DDK-filtered fields → no analytic sigmas; use mcPropagate.
- Anything else → mcPropagate: independent-sigma or full SINEX covariance sampling validates every analytic formula empirically (the toolbox's own tests do exactly this).

Validation habits the toolbox is built around

- Every numerical method was validated in Python (numpy/scipy) before the MATLAB implementation; the validation numbers are quoted in the help texts. Keep the habit for your own extensions.
- Ring-grid analysis↔synthesis roundtrips are exact to ~1e-14: use them as a self-test on your grids (Part III, G1 step 5).
- Real provider files beat synthetic fixtures: the test suite auto-discovers any *.snx(.gz) you drop into the test-data folder (shLowLevel.testDataDir) and sanity-checks it (files above ~30 MB are skipped with a message), and seven opt-in tests run on real data you point them at (see Opt-in test data).
- runAllTests is the gate: run it after every toolbox update; perf_log.csv accumulates machine-local timing history.

Common silent errors this toolbox guards against

error	guard
geodetic latitudes fed to SH math (~21 km bias)	LatType="geodetic" + conversion helpers (v2.2)
hardcoded Love numbers	kn is a required explicit input for EWH
climatology across the 2017-2018 gap NaNs	assertClean errors loudly; dropNaN/select
trend maps without GIA	removeGIA one-liner (v2.2)
optimistic trend sigmas	ARCorrect=true (v2.2)
tidal alias leakage into trends	Periods=[161/365.25, 3.66, 7.48]
zero-variance rows collapsing the noise floor	positive-diagonal floor + shLowLevel:buildNoiseCov:allZeroVariance
8-column ICGEM 1.0 acos/asin ambiguity	EIGEN-style period read; documented in README
sine sectorals S_{nn} blanked in difference triangles	fixed v2.4.2; rendered-CData regression test
NaN in a grid reaching every coefficient of an analysis	analysis refuses NaN until Fill= says what the gaps mean (v5.8.0); shAnalysisGrid refuses it too (v5.12.1)
a malformed filter spec ("gaussX", a negative radius)	one parser, shLowLevel.filterSpec, refuses it before any data is read (v5.7.0)

Part III — Step-by-step guides

G1. Monthly EWH anomaly maps from ITSG files

```
% 1. read the monthly GSM series (gz ok, ICGEM 1.0/2.0)
ts = shSeries.read("data/ITSG-Grace2018_n96_*.gfc");

% 2. low-degree completion BEFORE filtering
tn14 = shLowLevel.readTN14("TN-14_C30_C20_SLR_GSFC.txt");
ts   = ts.applyTN14(tn14);                  % C20 (+C30 where flagged)
tn13 = shLowLevel.readTN13("TN-13_GEOC_GFZ_RL06.txt");
ts   = ts.addDegree1(tn13);

% 3. bridge the mission gap explicitly
ts = ts.dropNaN();

% 4. anomalies w.r.t. a mean field, then filter
ts  = ts - ts.mean();                       % anomalies
tsF = ts.filter("tvANS", Blocks="auto");    % or .gaussian(300)

% 5. EWH synthesis (Love numbers user-supplied!)
kn  = readmatrix("loadLoveNumbers.txt");    % your set, degrees 0..nmax
lat = -89.5:1:89.5; lon = 0.5:1:359.5;
ewh = tsF.at(24).synthesis(lat, lon, Quantity="ewh", kn=kn);  % [m]

% self-test: analysis roundtrip on a ring grid should be ~1e-14
gChk = shCoefficients.analysis(ewh, lat, lon, tsF.nmax, ...
          Quantity='ewh', kn=kn);
```

Interpretation: values are equivalent water height anomalies relative to the removed mean, in meters. The FFT synthesis path engages automatically on this uniform grid; check `tsF.at(24).history` for the full provenance chain.

G2. Basin time series with uncertainties

```
idx = shLowLevel.shIndex(ts.nmax, Nmin=2);
% kernel from a polygon [lat lon], buffered + tapered (v2.2)
amazon = readmatrix("amazon_polygon.txt");
[b, info] = shLowLevel.basinKernel(idx, amazon, BufferKm=150, TaperKm=350);

% filtered series + filter operator
[tsF, op] = ts.filter("tvANS", Blocks="auto", VCEBands=[0 16 33 61]);

% deconvolved basin average with 1-sigma (banded-VCE-consistent, v2.2)
[avg, out] = shLowLevel.basinDeconvolve(b, op);
shLowLevel.plotBasinSeries(op.tYears, avg(1,:)', out.sigma(1,:)', Units="cm");
```

The deconvolution undoes the filter's attenuation of the kernel; the sigma comes from the posterior covariance with per-band noise factors. For several basins pass a kernel matrix B — the joint solve also redistributes mutual leakage. (Edition-2 erratum fixed: the signature is `basinDeconvolve(B, op)`, epochs live in `op.tYears`, averages in the first output.)

G3. Significance-masked trend maps (GIA- and AR(1)-honest)

```
gia = shCoefficients.read("ICE-6G_D_rates.gfc");       % rate [1/yr]
tsG = tsF.removeGIA(gia);
clim = tsG.climatology(Periods=[161/365.25, 3.66, 7.48], ...
                       ARCorrect=true);
tr   = clim.trend();                        % shCoefficients WITH sigmas
kn   = readmatrix("loadLoveNumbers.txt");
rate = tr.synthesis(lat, lon, Quantity="ewh", kn=kn);         % [m/yr]
mc   = shLowLevel.mcPropagate(@(g) g.synthesis(lat, lon, ...
          Quantity="ewh", kn=kn), tr, N=300, Seed=1);
sigma = mc.sigma;
mask = abs(rate) > 2 * sigma;               % 2-sigma significance
rate(~mask) = NaN; imagesc(lon, lat, rate);
```

Compare against a second GIA model (Caron) and show the difference as the model-spread contribution to the error budget — usually dominant over formal errors in formerly glaciated regions.

G4. Regional analysis with Slepian functions

```
idx = shLowLevel.shIndex(60, Nmin=0);
region = @(la,lo) double(la>-90 & la<-60);      % Antarctica-ish belt
[G, lam, infoS] = shLowLevel.slepianBasis(idx, region);
fprintf("Shannon %.1f -> keeping %d tapers\n", infoS.shannon, numel(lam));

x  = shLowLevel.vecFromCS(g.C, g.S, idx);             % one month, idx order
a  = G' * x;                                    % Slepian coefficients
xR = G * a;                                     % regional part of x
[Cr, Sr] = shLowLevel.csFromVec(xR, idx);
gR = shCoefficients(Cr, Sr, GM=g.GM, R=g.R);
```

Estimating a (dimension ≈ Shannon number) instead of all P Stokes coefficients is well-posed on regional data by construction; concentrations λ near 1 tell you which tapers the region genuinely constrains.

G5. Working with released covariances (SINEX)

```
idx = shLowLevel.shIndex(96, Nmin=2);
% full read (monthly solutions to ~30 MB): covariance in idx order
snx = shLowLevel.readSINEX("ITSG-..._n96_2008-04.snx.gz", ...
                    Output="covariance", Index=idx);
N   = snx.M;                                  % noise shape for tvANS
[tsF, op] = ts.filter("tvANS", NoiseCov=N, Blocks="off");

% multi-100-MB NEQ SINEX: stream just the estimates in seconds (v2.2)
est = shLowLevel.readSINEX("ITSG-..._operational_n96_2020-01.snx.gz", ...
                    Only="estimate");

% propagate the full covariance through ANY functional (v2.2)
out = shLowLevel.mcPropagate(@(gs) b' * shLowLevel.vecFromCS(gs.C,gs.S,idx), ...
                      g0, Cov=snx.M, Idx=idx, N=2000);
```

G6. Comparing against mascons

```
mas = shLowLevel.readMascon("GRCTellus.JPL...MSCNv03CRI.nc");
% mascon lats are GEODETIC -> one switch avoids the 21-km bias (v2.2)
kn = readmatrix("loadLoveNumbers.txt");
k  = find(abs(mas.epoch - 2010.29) < 0.05, 1);     % match an epoch
ewhSH = tsF.at(k).synthesis(mas.lat', mas.lon', ...
          Quantity="ewh", kn=kn, LatType="geodetic");  % [m]
d = 100*ewhSH - mas.ewh(:,:,k);                    % mascon units: cm
fprintf("RMS diff %.2f cm\n", sqrt(mean(d(:).^2, 'omitnan')));
```

Expect coastal and small-basin differences: mascons carry their own regularization. Compare basin-integrated series rather than pointwise fields for a fair statement; use the same GIA convention on both sides (JPL mascons ship GIA-corrected — remove GIA from the SH side too).

G7. GNSS loading comparison (v2.3)

```
% residual monthly series (mean removed), filtered
ts  = ts - ts.mean();                       % anomalies
tsF = ts.filter("tvANS", Blocks="auto");

% load Love numbers k', h', l' - ONE consistent model, user-supplied;
% v2.5 reader: layouts, sparse pchip interpolation, CF-frame conversion
LN = shLowLevel.readLoveNumbers("loadLoveNumbers_PREM.txt", ...
    Columns="n k h l", Nmax=tsF.nmax, Interp="pchip", ...
    InFrame="CE", OutFrame="CF");              % match TN-13 (CF)
kn = LN.kn; hn = LN.hn; ln = LN.ln;

% GNSS stations (geodetic coordinates!)
sta = readmatrix("stations.txt");              % [lat lon]
T = tsF.nEpochs;
up = zeros(size(sta,1), T); no = up; ea = up;
for k = 1:T
    [up(:,k), no(:,k), ea(:,k)] = tsF.at(k).deformation( ...
        sta(:,1)', sta(:,2)', kn=kn, hn=hn, ln=ln, ...
        Mode="points", LatType="geodetic");
end
% compare up(i,:) against the GNSS vertical of station i (same epochs);
% typical GRACE-elastic amplitudes: mm to ~1 cm vertical, ~1/3 horizontal
```

Degree 1 is excluded by default; include it only when both the GRACE side (TN-13 in the CF frame) and the Love numbers use the same frame convention. The elastic prediction excludes GIA and poroelastic effects — detrend both series or remove GIA explicitly before comparing trends.

G7b. Data management (v2.4.1, temporal catalogue v2.4.2)

```
shLowLevel.dataFolder("D:/geodata/shAnalysis");      % once; persists (getpref)
shLowLevel.fetchDDK(1:8);                      % all released DDK filters
W5 = shLowLevel.readDDK("DDK5");               % by name, from the data folder
T = shLowLevel.listICGEM();                    % 180+ static models as a table
f = shLowLevel.fetchICGEM("EGM2008");          % -> dataFolder/static/EGM2008.gfc
g = shCoefficients.read(f);
shLowLevel.fetchITSG(2010:2016);               % -> dataFolder/series/itsg/monthly
shLowLevel.fetchITSG("2008-04", Product="daily"); % Kalman daily n40 (v2.4.1)

% FULL temporal catalogue: all ~70+ series, all centers
Tt = shLowLevel.listICGEM(Type="temporal");
% fetch a WHOLE monthly series (v3.1.1) - one row of that catalogue
fs = shLowLevel.fetchICGEM(17, Type="temporal");
ts = shSeries.fromFolder(fileparts(fs(1)));   % straight into a series
```

The ICGEM static catalogue is parsed from icgem.gfz.de (fixture-tested offline). The temporal catalogue lists every series of every center — groups 01_GRACE, 02_COST-G, 03_other, 04_SLR — with columns group, center, series, path, url and zip. Since v3.1.1 a temporal row is not just browsable but fetchable: `fetchICGEM(idx, Type="temporal")` downloads the whole series into `<dataFolder>/series/<group>_<center>_<series>/`, which `shSeries.fromFolder` and `shLowLevel.standardChain` consume directly. For ITSG monthlies `shLowLevel.fetchITSG` remains the convenient route.

Mode: one request, not three hundred

The default `Mode="auto"` takes the server's whole-series ZIP in a SINGLE request and unpacks it. This is not an optimization but a courtesy requirement: icgem.gfz.de rate-limits, and fetching a 283-file series one file at a time earns HTTP 429 and a tarpit (field-observed as "too many connections"). If the archive is unavailable the fetcher falls back to per-file mode automatically — resumable, throttled with `Pause=` and `Retries=` exponential backoff, each file verified by parse before it replaces anything. `Mode="archive"|"files"` force either path; `info.mode` reports which one actually ran, so a script can tell a fresh download from a no-op. `Files=` filters the series, and `FileList=` injects a catalogue table for offline mirrors and subsets.

```
% forced per-file, filtered to a window, gentle on the server
fs = shLowLevel.fetchICGEM(17, Type = "temporal", Mode = "files", ...
        Files = "*2008*.gfc", Pause = 3, Retries = 3);
[ts, rep] = shLowLevel.standardChain(fileparts(fs(1)), Filter = "DDK3");
```

G8. Multi-center combination (v2.4)

```
shLowLevel.fetchITSG(2010:2016);              % download once (websave)
tsI = shSeries.fromFolder("ITSG/");    % GSM level, same nmax
tsC = shSeries.fromFolder("CSR/");
tsG = shSeries.fromFolder("GFZ/");
[tsComb, info] = shLowLevel.combineCenters({tsI, tsC, tsG}, Robust=true);

figure; plot(info.epochs, info.weights');     % weight time series
legend(info.centers); ylabel("relative weight");
figure; imagesc(info.interCenterCorr);        % honesty diagnostic
% THEN degree-1 / C20-C30 replacements, once:
tsComb = tsComb.applyTN14("TN-14.txt");
tsComb = tsComb.addDegree1("TN-13.txt");
```

Watch the weight series for regime changes (single-accelerometer era, GRACE-FO transition) and treat posterior sigmas as lower bounds — the common mode is invisible.

G9. Sea-level fingerprint (v2.4)

```
idx = shLowLevel.shIndex(96, Nmin=0);
LN = readmatrix("loadLoveNumbers.txt"); kn = LN(:,2); hn = LN(:,3);
greenland = @(la,lo) -280 * inGreenland(la, lo);   % kg/m^2/yr, say
oceanF = @(la,lo) oceanMaskFun(la, lo);            % 1 over ocean
[S, grid, info] = shLowLevel.seaLevelFingerprint(greenland, oceanF, idx, ...
    kn=kn, hn=hn);
imagesc(grid.lonDeg, grid.latDeg, info.S2D / info.eustatic);   % S / eustatic
axis xy; colorbar; title("Greenland fingerprint")
```

Plot S normalized by the eustatic mean: near-field values drop below zero, far-field plateaus around 1.1–1.3 — if not, check the ocean mask and that idx uses Nmin= 0.

G10. The standard chain in one call

```
% the whole post-processing chain, in the ONE correct order
gia = shCoefficients.read("ICE-6G_D_trend.gfc");   % a TREND field [1/yr]
[ts, rep] = shLowLevel.standardChain("D:/grace/monthly", ...
    TN14File = "TN-14_C30_C20_SLR_GSFC.txt", ...   % TN14 itself is a FLAG
    Degree1 = "CSR", ...                           % provider, not a path
    GIA = gia, Filter = "DDK3");
disp(rep.steps')          % what was applied, in order, with provenance
```

Order is not a matter of taste here. The SLR C20/C30 replacement and the degree-1 restoration must happen on the UNFILTERED coefficients — a filter mixes degrees, so replacing a coefficient afterwards inserts an unfiltered value into a filtered field and the low degrees no longer mean anything consistent. GIA is a trend in the same (corrected) coefficients, so it comes next; filtering is last. `standardChain` encodes exactly that order and returns REP, a provenance record naming every step, the files it used and the toolbox version that ran — the thing you paste into a paper's data section. Every stage is optional: leave `GIA=` out and the report says so, rather than silently skipping a step you assumed had happened.

Two contracts worth reading before the first call: `TN14` is a logical FLAG and the path goes in `TN14File`, while `Degree1` names the TN-13 provider ("GFZ" | "CSR" | "JPL" | "none") with the path in `Degree1File`; and `GIA` takes an `shCoefficients` TREND field in [1/yr], not a filename — it is applied as (t – GIAEpoch) × GIA. Left at their defaults the files come from the persistent data folder that `setup_shAnalysis` populates.

G11. Designing your own anisotropic filter

```
% a DDK-class filter built from YOUR error covariance
g  = shCoefficients.read("ITSG-Grace2018_n60_2008-04.gfc");
W  = shLowLevel.designFilter(g.sigmaC, g.sigmaS, Kaula = 1e-5);
[Cf, Sf] = shLowLevel.applyDDK(g.C, g.S, W);   % same block format as readDDK
```

The released DDK filters are built from a specific center's normal equations. If you have your own sigmas or a released covariance, `designFilter` builds the same kind of operator, $W = (N + a S^{-1})^{-1} N$, in the block format `readDDK` produces — so it drops into `applyDDK`, `g.applyDDK` and `standardChain(Filter=W)` unchanged. Note that `Noise=` expects a COVARIANCE, not sigmas: passing standard deviations where a variance is expected is the classic way to get a filter that looks plausible and smooths by the square root of what you intended.

G12. Correcting leakage

```
% forward modelling: only the FILTER has to be known
ewh = g.synthesis(-89:89, 0:359, Quantity= "ewh", kn = kn);
[m, info] = shLowLevel.leakageCorrect(ewh, -89:89, 0:359, ...
    Filter = "gauss300", Mask = basinMask, Gain = 2);

% or scaling factors, if you trust a model's spatial PATTERN
k = shLowLevel.gridScaling(modelEWH, -89:89, 0:359, Filter = "gauss300");
corrected = k .* ewh;                % NaN where the model is blind
```

A filter removes real signal and spreads the rest across basin boundaries; a 6° disc under a 500 km Gaussian keeps about half its peak. The two corrections differ in what you have to BELIEVE, which is how to choose between them. Forward modelling (`leakageCorrect`) needs only the filter and, usefully, a mask saying where mass can exist — it then has to explain the observation with mass inside that region, so leakage outside is removed rather than redistributed. Scaling factors (`gridScaling`) need a model series, and inherit the correctness of its spatial pattern: the factors are invariant to the model's amplitude but not to its shape.

Two behaviours worth knowing before you read the output. Convergence is judged on the change of the SOLUTION, not on the residual: with a mask the problem is inconsistent, so the residual settles at a floor while the solution is converged. And `gridScaling` returns NaN where the model carries no signal instead of a ratio of two numerical zeros — a model that does not reach your basin shows up as missing coverage rather than as noise multiplying your data. A third correction, the data-driven method of deviation (chapter 29), needs neither a mask nor a model — only the filter, the catchment and at least 12 epochs.

G13. What real provider files look like

Format specifications describe what files ought to contain. The reader is written against what they actually contain, and three separate field failures are worth knowing about, because they are silent — you get numbers, just not the right ones.

- **FORTRAN D-exponents.** Providers switch from `1.23E-10` to `1.23D-10` partway through large files (EIGEN-6C4 does it above degree ~370). MATLAB's `str2double` returns NaN for those, so a line-by-line parser quietly corrupts the high degrees of exactly the models where the high degrees are the point. The reader normalizes D/d to E/e before conversion.
- **ICGEM 2.0 column order.** The real-world layout of an `acos`/`asin` line is `... sigC sigS t0 t1 period` — period LAST, verified against CNES/GRGS files. A period-first assumption mis-parses every such file and produces a time-variable model whose seasonal terms are wrong without ever raising an error.
- **Ragged record groups.** EIGEN-5S and 5C carry a single `gfc` line with a trailing epoch among thousands of uniform ones. Bulk `sscanf(txt, '%f', [nc Inf])` does not complain about that — it silently re-flows the whole group by one column and asks for a coefficient matrix indexed by a date. The reader checks rows-out == lines-in per group, subgroups by numeric width when ragged, and keeps an n/m sanity net.

The practical rule: when a new provider or a new release enters your pipeline, read one file and check `g.C(3,1)` and the highest degrees against the provider's own published values before you trust a thousand of them. Bulk parsing is fast — EIGEN-6C4 at 177.7 MB and degree 2190 in about 5 s, a 73.6 MB GRGS mean field with 674k variable terms in about 7 s — but fast and correct are different properties.

G14. The lanes behind the classes (v5.6.0–v5.13.0)

Since v5.6.0 the numerical lanes that used to need C, S, GM and R unpacked by hand are methods of the classes. Each is a thin delegate: it fills in the object's coefficients, GM and R and forwards only the options you give, so every default lives in one place, and a test pins each method bitwise to the function it calls, with options and without. The two leakage methods REQUIRE Filter, although the functions default it: a series cannot know which filter its data saw, and the wrong one gives a plausible wrong answer. ts.write warns when a file name would not bring its epoch back, because a .gfc file carries no epoch of its own.

```
[tsK, rep]       = ts.kalman(ModelSeries = tsm, Order = 1);    % kalmanChain
[modes, pcs, ve] = ts.eof(NModes = 4);                         % eofAnalysis
[m, infoL]   = ts.leakageCorrect(lat, lon, Filter = "gauss300", kn = kn, ...
                  Mask = mask, NoiseLevel = sigTrend);
[dq, infoG]  = ts.gradient(lat, lon, Quantity = "ewh", kn = kn);
ts.write(outFolder);                                           % one .gfc per epoch
tsP          = ts.poleTideConvert(From = "IERS2010", To = "IERS2018");
[d1, infoD]  = ts.estimateDegree1(isOcean, kn = kn, OceanModel = obp);
[tsC, infoC] = ts.combineCenters({tsB, tsD});
[a, rec]     = ts.slepianProject(G, idx);
avg = g.basinAverage(B);
sig = g.errorMap(lat, lon);
val = g.synthesisPoints(latP, lonP, rP);
[T, infoT]   = g.gradientTensor(lat, lon, Height = 255e3);
```

Validation against GravIS

This chapter is a worked, reproducible comparison of the toolbox against a PUBLISHED product: the GravIS Greenland ice-mass basin averages (https://gravis.gfz.de/gis). It is written out in full because the numbers only mean something together with the choices behind them — and because two of those choices cost a factor that would otherwise have been mistaken for a bug in the toolbox.

V1. The reference

GravIS publishes seven Greenland drainage basins as ASCII time series in Gt. Summing them and fitting bias, trend, annual and semi-annual gives the reference trend. It must be recomputed over the SPAN YOU ACTUALLY USE: over the full record COST-G RL02 gives –220.8 Gt/yr, but over the shorter span for which the auxiliary correction tables were available it is –231.1 Gt/yr (that span: 2002-04..2023-02, n = 217 monthly solutions - QUOTE THE DATES with the number; an independent audit measured ~10 Gt/yr of reference drift over two years of end date). Comparing against the wrong span is a 5% error before any processing starts.

V2. Matching the GravIS processing

GravIS Level-3 basin averages come from Level-2B coefficients, which are Level-2 plus four corrections (https://gravis.gfz.de/corrections). Applying anything less makes the comparison meaningless. All four are read with `shLowLevel.readSHM` or as plain tables:

```
% (1) their low-degree replacement: C20, C30, C21, S21
% (2) their geocenter (Swenson approximation, NOT TN-13)
% (3) their mean field, 2002/04-2020/03
% (4) GIA: ICE-6G_D (VM5a), a GRDOTA rate model in 1/yr
Mn  = shLowLevel.readSHM("GRAVIS-2B_..._MEAN_2002095-2020091_NFIL.gz", Nmax = 90);
Gi  = shLowLevel.readSHM("GRAVIS-2B_..._GIA_ICE-6G_D_VM5a.gz", Nmax = 90);

ts = shSeries.fromFolder(costgFolder);
ts = ts.select(ts.epochs <= maxTableEpoch + 0.05);   % tables trail the data
% ... insert their C20/C30/C21/S21 and C10/C11/S11 per epoch ...
for k = 1:ts.nEpochs                    % mean field and GIA, per epoch
    Cs(:,:,k) = Cs(:,:,k) - Mn.C - (ts.epochs(k) - 2011) * Gi.C;
    Ss(:,:,k) = Ss(:,:,k) - Mn.S - (ts.epochs(k) - 2011) * Gi.S;
end
ts = ts.removeAlias();                  % (5) the S2 161-day alias
```

V3. The basin average

```
idx = shLowLevel.shIndex(ts.nmax, Nmin= 0);
[b, info] = shLowLevel.basinKernel(idx, gisPolygon);   % NaN-separated rings
area = info.areaFraction * 4*pi*6371^2;                % NOT b(1)
kf   = shLowLevel.kernelFactors("ewh", ts.nmax, GM, R, kn = kn);
avg  = (b .* kf(idx.n+1))' * X / (b'*b);               % EWH [m] per epoch
mass = avg(:) * area * 1e6 * 1000 / 1e12;              % -> Gt
```

V4. Results, and what each step is worth

Method	Gt/yr	vs published
naive kernel average	–196.4	–15%
naive grid integral	–170.3	–26%
forward modelling, **Greenland-only** mask	–259.8	+12%
forward modelling, **union** mask	–240.2	+4%
union mask + S2 alias removed	–240.0	+4%
GravIS COST-G RL02, matching span	**–231.1**	—

V4b. Describe the filter the FORWARD MODEL sees

The table above hides the single largest error I made. GravIS basin averages start from UNFILTERED Level-2B coefficients, so I passed `Filter="none"` to `leakageCorrect`. But Dahle et al. (2025), Sect. 2.2.1, list the basin-average steps: spectral masking, then **low-pass filtering with a Wiener optimal filter, approximately a Gaussian of 4° latitude spatial half-width**, then the conversion to surface mass, then the least-squares adjustment. The forward model is filtered IDENTICALLY to the observations — that is the whole point of the method — so the filter to declare is the Wiener one, not "none".

```
r = 4 * 111.195;                        % 4 deg latitude ~ 445 km
wG = shLowLevel.shGaussianWeights(nmax, r);
obs = shCoefficients(Ct .* wG(:), St .* wG(:)).synthesis( ...
        lat, lon, Quantity= "ewh", kn = kn, Nmin= 0);
m = shLowLevel.leakageCorrect(obs, lat, lon, Filter = "gauss445", ...
        Mask = unionMask, Gain = 2, MaxIter = 300);
```

Declared filter	Gt/yr	vs published
`"none"` (wrong)	–234.9	+1.6%
`"gauss445"` (Wiener equivalent)	–**227.4**	–**1.6%**
GravIS COST-G RL02, matching span	–**231.1**	—

Declaring the filter correctly turns a 1.6% overshoot into a 1.6% undershoot, and the iteration also drifts less with continued iteration (2.0 Gt/yr from 300 to 900 steps, against 2.5 unfiltered) because the filter regularises the inverse problem. At that point the agreement is as close as this reproduction can meaningfully be read: the remaining difference is smaller than the spread between GravIS product versions and smaller than the effect of the stopping point.

The paper also specifies the mask GravIS uses, which is NOT the bare drainage-basin outline: the spectral mask is 1 until 200 km outside the grounding line and tapers smoothly to 0 by 600 km. That is `basinKernel(..., BufferKm = 200, TaperKm = 400)`, not a hard boundary.

V4c. The regularised number, and the noise it needs

Every figure above was produced by stopping the iteration at a fixed count, which is not a criterion. Rerun with the discrepancy principle, two further things have to be right — and getting either wrong is worse than the leakage it was meant to fix.

- **The residual must be measured where the model is responsible.** With a Greenland mask the model describes one region while the data contains Antarctica, Alaska and global hydrology, so the GLOBAL residual never falls to the noise level: 0.0085 globally against 0.0008 near the mask, with a noise level of 0.0024. The principle silently never fires and the run stops at MaxIter. `ResidualRegion` (default: the mask) fixes this.
- **The noise level must match the quantity being inverted.** The open-ocean RMS of a TREND field is 0.0024 m/yr — but most of that is real barystatic sea-level rise, not error. Using it stops the iteration after 4 steps and gives –201.0 Gt/yr, 13% low. The trend's actual noise is the monthly noise propagated through the fit, sigma_monthly / sqrt(Sxx) = 0.0115 / sqrt(8353) = 0.000125 m/yr — nineteen times smaller.

```
% the concrete definitions this chapter previously left implicit
% (audit 2026-08: the recipe was not runnable as printed):
lat = (-89.5:89.5)';  lon = (0.5:359.5)';       % 1-degree grid
[LO, LA] = meshgrid(lon, lat);  lonW = mod(LO+180, 360) - 180;
box = @(a,b,c,d) LA>=a & LA<=b & lonW>=c & lonW<=d;
unionMask = gisMask ...                         % basin polygon pixels
    | box(60, 84, -128, -60) ...                % Canadian Arctic
    | box(63, 67,  -25, -13) ...                % Iceland
    | box(76, 81,   10,  34);                   % Svalbard
% Greenland mass rate from the corrected trend grid m [m/yr EWH]:
A  = (6371e3)^2 .* cosd(LA) * deg2rad(1)^2;     % cell areas [m^2]
Gt = sum(m(gisMask) .* A(gisMask), 'omitnan') * 1000 / 1e12;
```

```
% monthly noise from the residuals about the deterministic fit ...
sigMon = shLowLevel.oceanRMS(residGrid, lat, lon, openOcean);
% ... propagated to the TREND: sigma_trend = sigma_monthly / sqrt(Sxx)
sigTrend = sigMon / sqrt(sum((epochs - mean(epochs)).^2));
[m, info] = shLowLevel.leakageCorrect(trendGrid, lat, lon, ...
    Filter = "gauss445", Mask = unionMask, NoiseLevel = sigTrend);
info.stoppedBy      % "discrepancy", after 82 iterations
```

Stopping rule	Gt/yr	vs published
fixed 300 iterations (no criterion)	–227.4	–1.6%
discrepancy, trend-field oceanRMS (wrong noise)	–201.0	–13%
discrepancy, propagated trend noise	**–224.6**	**–2.8%**
GravIS COST-G RL02, matching span	**–231.1**	—

The regularised answer is 2.8% from the published one, slightly further than the 1.6% obtained by stopping at an arbitrary iteration count. That is the honest outcome: the closer number was a coincidence of where the iteration happened to be, and a result that depends on an arbitrary choice is not a result. This one follows from a stated criterion and a noise estimate that can be recomputed.

V5. The lessons

The mask must cover every region that can hold mass, not only the one you are measuring. A Greenland-only mask tells the inversion that mass exists nowhere else, so Canadian Arctic, Iceland and Svalbard signal is forced into Greenland: +12% instead of +4%. In the union solution the neighbours absorb –112 Gt/yr — mass the first mask had nowhere to put. The union mask also converges faster. This is a usage rule, not a bug: `Mask=` always accepted a union.

The filter you declare must be the filter the FORWARD MODEL sees, not the filter the input file carries. The inputs here are genuinely unfiltered, and declaring that was still wrong, because the method filters both sides. This cost more than the mask, the polygon resolution and the alias put together.

The S2 alias removal is worth 0.2 Gt/yr on a twenty-year trend — that is, nothing. A 161-day harmonic is very nearly orthogonal to a linear trend over two decades, so removing it barely moves the trend even though it is a real and necessary correction for the MONTHLY series. Reported here because it was expected to explain part of the residual and did not: a hypothesis removed is worth as much as one confirmed.

V6. What the remaining 4% is, honestly

- GravIS inverts SEVEN drainage basins jointly (Sasgen et al. 2012); this recipe constrains one region against coarse neighbour boxes.
- The basin outline used here is decimated to 97.4% of the published area, and the neighbour outlines are rectangles.
- The iteration has not converged: step 3.2e-4 against Tol 1e-4 after 900 iterations, and the estimate was still drifting (–240.2 at 300, –242.5 at 900). Call it ±5 Gt/yr.
- Nothing here was tuned to close the gap. A 4% agreement with an independently produced product, reached by matching its documented processing step for step, is the result; making it smaller by adjusting a mask until the number matched would not be.

V7. Antarctica: where the one-map inversion meets its limit

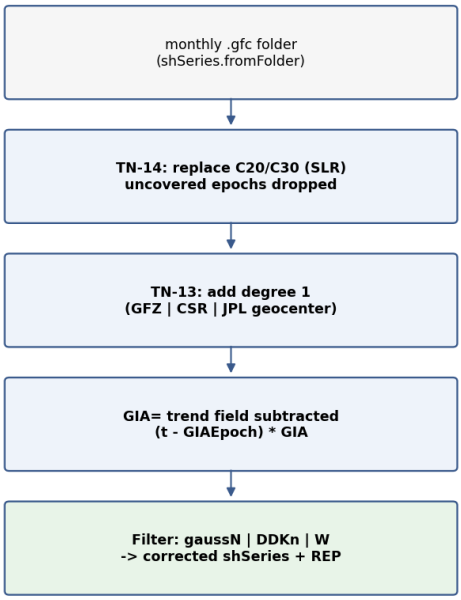
The same chain, run unchanged on the same corrected, GIA-reduced series with the 25 GravIS AIS basin polygons as the mask (span 2002-04..2023-02, n = 217), gives –125.7 Gt/yr against the official AWI basin-average product's –146.9 — a 14% attenuation, an order of magnitude worse than Greenland's 2.8%. Three controls say the chain itself is healthy: the GIA field alone carries +52.2 Gt/yr of apparent mass over the AIS and the uncorrected chain lands at –34.5 (the correction does exactly its advertised work); the wrong-noise control collapses to –108 in 8 iterations with the same signature as Greenland; and an 8-fold sweep of the noise level moves the answer by 2 Gt/yr — the stopping rule is NOT the problem.

The basin-by-basin comparison locates the gap: the inversion damps the EXTREMES of both signs (Amundsen and Getz come out 7–11 Gt/yr too weakly negative, the Dronning-Maud-sector accumulation basins 12–16 too weakly positive; 5.9 Gt/yr RMS per basin). The decisive cross-check is the SECOND official product: integrating the TU Dresden tailored-sensitivity-kernel GRID product (Groh & Horwath 2021) over the same basin polygons gives –112.8 Gt/yr with an 8.2 Gt/yr per-basin RMS and a 0.905 correlation to this chain's difference pattern. Every map-based estimator damps the same basins the same way; the Sasgen forward-modelling inversion (25 basins jointly, Sasgen et al. 2013) is a different method class, and the 14% is the distance between the classes, not a defect of the chain. A one-map inversion of a continent with a 113-pixel peninsula also reproduces every stopping pathology this guide warns about: the Peninsula alone never reaches the noise floor (maxIter), and the three sub-sheet inversions sum to –172, not –126 — V2's mask lesson, live.

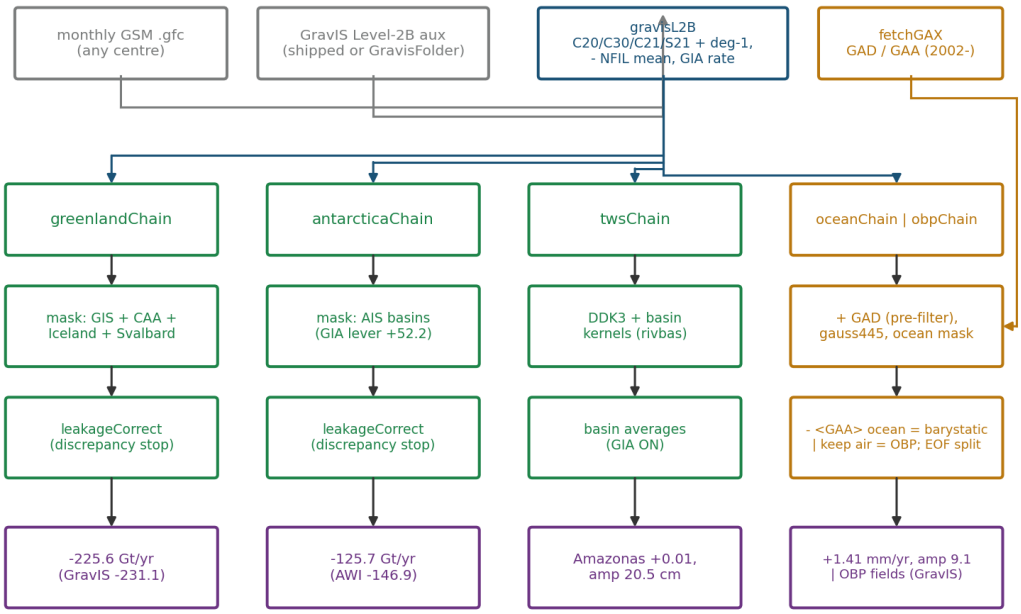
V8. Terrestrial water storage: 0.03 cm/yr against GravIS

The hydrology test inverts the roles: small signals, seasonal amplitudes, and a reference (the GravIS TWS portal series, COST-G) whose averaging convention was first pinned by reproducing the official gridded product's basin means to two decimals from the same polygons. The chain — corrections, minus the NFIL mean, DDK3 as the declared stand-in for GravIS' VDK3/VDK5 blend, cos-weighted 1° basin means over eleven major river basins, full 252-month span — reproduces the seasonal amplitudes at a median ratio of 1.001 (0.98..1.04). The trends came out at 0.225 cm/yr RMS with a pattern any geodesist will recognise: Mississippi −0.49 against +0.07, Ob/Yenisei/Lena all too positive — the Laurentide and Fennoscandian GIA signature. Subtracting the same ICE-6G_D rate model the ice products use drops the trend RMS to **0.032 cm/yr** (Mississippi +0.09 vs +0.07, Ganges −1.24 vs −1.22, Amazonas +0.01 vs +0.01). Two findings travel beyond this toolbox: the GravIS TWS Technical Note (2025-08-14) does not mention a GIA correction, but the product plainly carries one — a 7-fold RMS reduction is not a coincidence; and the residual Ganges difference is consistent with GravIS' empirical removal of the 2004 Sumatra earthquake steps, which this chain deliberately does not model. Declare the filter, declare the GIA, and a 90-degree spherical harmonic series reproduces an independently produced hydrology product to three hundredths of a centimetre per year.

V9. The chains: the validation as an API



The generic core: shLowLevel.standardChain applies the classic TN-14/TN-13 corrections in the only correct order, with the same drop-and-record policy for uncovered epochs. gravisL2B (below) is its GravIS-flavoured sibling: same shape, GravIS aux tables and NFIL mean instead of the TN files.



The chain family at v3.11.0: one shared gravisL2B core; the ocean lane forks after GAD into barystatic (oceanChain, with EOF circulation split) and bottom pressure (obpChain).

The chain family at v3.11.0. gravisL2B is the single shared correction core; the ice chains share one engine (gravisRegionChain), the TWS chain filters and averages in per-basin boxes, and the ocean lane forks after the GAD restoration: oceanChain removes the atmospheric ocean mean for the barystatic series (with an optional EOF split of residual circulation from noise), obpChain keeps the air column and delivers GravIS-style bottom-pressure fields. Defaults ARE the tested configuration; the shipped data/gravis folder makes the calls below run as written.

Every number in V1–V8 is reproducible in one call. The shipped `data/gravis` copies (frozen 2026-08-12) cover the aux tables, the NFIL mean, the ICE-6G_D GIA rate and the GravIS basin polygons (`shLowLevel.gravisDataFolder` returns the path); only the monthly series folder and the Love numbers are yours to supply. Greenland, with the guide-V4c ocean mask:

```
kn = readmatrix("loadLoveNumbers_Gegout97.txt", FileType = "text", ...
    NumHeaderLines = 2);
oc = @(la, lo) abs(la) <= 55 & ~(la < -60 | ...      % crude continents
    (la > -35 & la < 37 & mod(lo+180,360)-180 > -17 & mod(lo+180,360)-180 < 52));
[gt, rep] = shLowLevel.greenlandChain("E:/series/COSTG", ...
    kn = kn, OceanMask = oc);                        % -> -225.6 Gt/yr
disp(rep.steps')
```

Antarctica adds the 25-basin table, and `TrendGrid=` re-feeds a previous report so a sensitivity sweep costs seconds, not synthesis:

```
[gt, rep] = shLowLevel.antarcticaChain("E:/series/COSTG", ...
    kn = kn, OceanMask = oc);                        % -> -125.7 Gt/yr
disp(rep.basins)                                     % 301..325 [Gt/yr]
gt2 = shLowLevel.antarcticaChain("E:/series/COSTG", kn = kn, ...
    TrendGrid = rep, NoiseLevel = 2 * rep.sigTrend); % noise sweep, ~20 s
```

TWS runs full-span with GIA ON by default (the V8 finding); switching it off reproduces the 7× worse trend RMS:

```
[out, rep] = shLowLevel.twsChain("E:/series/COSTG", kn = kn, ...
    Basins = ["Amazonas", "Ganges", "Mississippi River"], ...
    DDKFolder = "E:/DDK");                           % amp 20.5/14.3/6.1 cm
plot(out.epochs, out.series); legend(out.name)
noGia = shLowLevel.twsChain("E:/series/COSTG", kn = kn, ...
    Basins = "Mississippi River", DDKFolder = "E:/DDK", GIAFile = "");
```

The two ice chains share one engine (`gravisRegionChain`); every input above is exchangeable, every deviation from the defaults is a declared sensitivity study, and REP records each step with the toolbox version. Data fetches behind these chains and all fetchers retry politely on 429/5xx: `httpFetch` honours the server's Retry-After header and `httpRetryDelay` supplies the capped, jittered backoff otherwise — the policy the GravIS portal's 503 bursts

demanded during the V7/V8 data collection. Spelling convention throughout: every option is an arguments-block Name=value option in the house casing (`OceanMask=`, `Quantity=`) — no inputParser option is left since v4.0.0 — MATLAB matches the names case-insensitively, and quantity strings are lowercase. `Quantity = "none"` is the dimensionless passthrough for synthesizing raw coefficient fields.

V10. Ocean and Slepian: closing the chain family

The ocean is the missing member: `oceanChain` runs the same gravisL2B core, applies the ICE-6G_D ocean-floor GIA rate (a measured +0.89 mm/yr lever on the barystatic trend) and gauss445, and returns the area-weighted ocean-mean series. Acceptance run on COST-G RL02.1 (252 months, |lat|≤66°, crude-continent mask): **+1.49 ± 0.02 mm/yr (+312 Gt/yr)**, annual amplitude 8.0 mm. The ocean MEAN is filter-invariant to 0.01 mm/yr while unfiltered pixel residuals are stripe-dominated (1.62 m measured) — sigMon = 0.0121 m after the trend+seasonal separation is the honest noise proxy the V6 finding demanded. GAD/GAA restoration is a declared limitation (`GADFolder=` adds GAD where available; AOD1B carries no secular trend by construction).

```
[out, rep] = shLowLevel.oceanChain("E:/series/COSTG", kn = kn, ...
    OceanMask = oc);                      % -> +1.49 mm/yr, +312 Gt/yr
plot(out.epochs, out.oceanMean)           % barystatic curve [cm]
noGia = shLowLevel.oceanChain("E:/series/COSTG", kn = kn, ...
    OceanMask = oc, GIAFile = "");        % the +0.89 mm/yr lever
```

Slepian analysis gets its application half: project any coefficient series onto the ~Shannon leading tapers of a region and analyze those few well-posed modes instead of all P coefficients. The localization kernel is cross-validated against an independent Python ring quadrature (30° cap, λ■ = 0.999981), and ICGEM `dot` secular lines now read as `trnd` synonyms.

Full ocean restoration (Chambers & Willis 2010) is one fetch away: `fetchGAX` downloads the AOD1B monthly means as ICGEM-converted .gfc from the GFZ series pages (163 GRACE-era + 88 GRACE-FO files per product, verified live; the AOD1B products are centre-independent, so they serve COST-G too). `GADFolder=` adds the model ocean signal back on the coefficient level, `GAAFolder=` subtracts the per-epoch ocean mean of the atmospheric product - the land-ocean air-mass term GRACE sees but that is not water. Epoch coverage is reported, never silent: REP carries nGadRestored and nGaaApplied. Accepted on the full COST-G RL02.1 series (252 months, 251 covered): the annual amplitude rises from 8.0 to 9.1 mm - the published manometric range - while the trend moves only 0.08 mm/yr (+1.41 ± 0.03), confirming that AOD1B is trend-free by construction; the residual RMS grows from 1.21 to 1.49 cm because GAD puts REAL sub-annual ocean variability back into the field.

Bottom pressure versus barystatic - one step apart. The GravIS Level-3 OBP product is GSM plus GAD with the standard corrections: bottom pressure is the weight of the FULL column (water plus air), so nothing is subtracted and the ocean mean contains the mean atmospheric mass. `obpChain` reproduces that recipe as gridded EWH anomalies against the GravIS reference window 2002/04-2020/03, with GAD added BEFORE the filter (the GravIS order - the filter note in both chain helps) and land set to NaN. `oceanChain` continues one step further and removes the ocean mean of GAA (Chambers & Willis 2010) to isolate water mass.

```
[obp, rep] = shLowLevel.obpChain(ser, kn = kn, OceanMask = oc, ...
    GADFolder = "E:/DATAPOOL/GravityField/GAX/GAD");
size(obp.grid)                % nLat x nLon x T, land NaN
rep.nRefEpochs                % epochs inside the GravIS window
```

Residual circulation, separated instead of ignored. After the trend + seasonal fit the ocean pixels still carry coherent interannual dynamics - real circulation, not error. `eofSeparate` splits the residual stack with an area-weighted EOF and the North et al. (1982) rule, keeping modes while their eigenvalue is separated by more than its sampling uncertainty. The physical limit is stated, not hidden: modes at or below the Marchenko-Pastur noise bulk (about sigma^2 (1+sqrt(Q/T))^2) are not separable by ANY eigenvalue criterion - the Python pre-validation demonstrated exactly that failure before the synthetic amplitudes were dimensioned above the bulk. Passing SeparateCirculation to oceanChain applies the split and turns sigMon into the de-circulated noise RMS.

```
[out, rep] = shLowLevel.oceanChain(ser, kn = kn, OceanMask = oc, ...
    GADFolder = gadF, GAAFolder = gaaF, SeparateCirculation = true);
[out.nModes, out.circulationRMS, out.sigMon]   % modes, circ, noise
```

The fetch family, one function per source and product. fetchITSG and fetchICGEM download solution series; fetchGAX the AOD1B GAA/GAB/GAC/GAD monthly means from the ICGEM/GFZ pages; fetchITSGSINEX the ITSG monthly normal-equation SINEX from TU Graz - the ONLY public per-month SINEX source, and heavy: one n96 month is about 460 MB gzipped (verified live), so months are a required argument and there is no convenience "all"; fetchITSGBackground the ITSG monthly background models (dealiasing, tides, and in the GRACE era also

atmosphere/ocean splits, c20, degree-1, GIA, hydrology). The ITSG background means are NOT the AOD1B GAX split - dealiasing is the closest GAC counterpart and no GAD substitute. All fetchers share one robust download loop: skip-if-present, MaxFiles/BudgetSec/MaxFailures caps, polite pauses, a single capped 429 retry, and a websave transport fallback.

```
f = shLowLevel.fetchITSGBackground(["2018-06", "2018-07"]);
s = shLowLevel.fetchITSGSINEX("2018-06", Nmax = 96);   % ~460 MB, deliberate
snx = shLowLevel.readSINEX(s(1), Only = "estimate");
```

VDK decorrelation - the reason the SINEX fetcher exists. With the monthly normal-equation matrices the VDK/VADER filter of Horvath et al. (2018) becomes buildable: $x_f = (N + \alpha M)^{-1} N x$ with the FORMAL monthly N (structure changes with orbit, repeat cycles and instrument state) and a cyclostationary Kaula signal model sigma_M(l) = a l^b estimated per calendar month from a pre-filtered series (signalVarianceKaula, with the exact log-chi-square bias correction - without it a biases 6% low). Algebraically this is the SAME family as the tvANS Wiener filter ($S = M^{-1}$, Python-verified to 1e-15); the difference is the input, and it is worth 15% median cumulative geoid error - an order of magnitude in short-repeat-cycle months (paper Table 2). tvANS remains the tool for series without released covariances. The full series is a deliberate batch (~460 MB SINEX per month): tools/dev/run_vdk_series.m is the resumable driver - downloads skip present files, months skip existing output, the signal model is cached, and the paper's closed-form identity runs as a built-in self-test.

```
idx = shLowLevel.shIndex(96, Nmin= 2);
snx = shLowLevel.readSINEX(f, Index = idx);        % N + x, idx order
[ab, ~] = shLowLevel.signalVarianceKaula(ts.Cs, ts.Ss, ts.epochs);
xf = shLowLevel.vdkApply(snx.x, snx.M, idx.n, ab(mo, :), Alpha = 1);
```

Flood and drought indices per cell or basin. hydroExtremeIndex turns any TWS stack - ts.toGrid grids or basinAverage series - into published extreme indices: the GRACE-DSI of Zhao et al. (2017), the standardized anomaly per calendar month with the 11-class USDM-style categories (validated in the literature against USDM, PDSI, SPEI, NDVI and in-situ groundwater); the WSDI deficit standardization; and the Reager & Famiglietti (2009) storage deficit - the CAUSAL flood predisposition (how much the store can still take), which with a precipitation grid becomes the full Flood Potential Index, the quantity behind multi-month flood lead times (Reager et al. 2014, Nature Geoscience). One policy is quantified rather than assumed: detrending. The pre-validation planted an exceptional-drought month under a 0.5 cm/yr trend - undetrended it weakens from -2.41 to -1.44, OUT of its class, while 45% of the late decade turns spuriously wet; Detrend = linear is therefore the DSI/WSDI default, while StorageDeficit keeps the physical Reager convention (none). A robust sigma option (1.4826 MAD) survives single corrupt months that inflate the classical sigma sixfold. STAGE 2 is live too: on the ITSG daily Kalman solutions (fetchITSG Product = daily, 365 files/yr, n40) the index switches to a day-of-year climatology - per-DOY means, sigma from the RESIDUALS in a circular 31-day window that wraps December into January, with the sqrt(n/(n-1)) estimated-mean correction. The construction matters and was measured: window sigma on RAW values leaks the seasonal cycle (1.99 instead of 1.5), the two-stage form does not (1.52). Daily solutions track short-lived floods that monthly fields miss (Gouweleeuw et al. 2018, Ganges-Brahmaputra) - a planted +3-sigma January-2nd flood scores z = 2.9 across the year wrap.

```
[tws, rep] = shLowLevel.twsChain(ser, kn = kn);
[Z, inf1] = shLowLevel.hydroExtremeIndex(tws.grid, tws.epochs);
inf1.categoryNames(inf1.category(iLat, iLon, end) + 6)   % cell class
[Sd, ~] = shLowLevel.hydroExtremeIndex(basinSeries, ep, ...
    Mode = "StorageDeficit");                % flood predisposition
```

Offline by design. No chain ever fetches: greenland/antarctica/tws/ocean/obp and every filter consume LOCAL paths only. The GravIS correction tables (C20/C30/C21/S21, degree 1, NFIL mean, GIA rate, ice basins) ship frozen inside the toolbox (data/gravis), so a fresh clone plus one local GSM series folder runs the ice and TWS chains completely offline; the ocean chains additionally need the GAD/GAA folders on disk - however they got there (fetchGAX, a browser, a copied drive: the chains cannot tell and do not care). The fetch* functions are one-time provisioners with skip-if-present semantics - re-running them against a populated folder is a no-op, and the VDK batch runs fully offline once its SINEX archive exists. Path resolution is three layers, explicit first: a passed argument always wins; below it the setup_shAnalysis preferences (SeriesFolder, MasconFile, GravisFolder, DDKFolder - setpref-persistent) and dataFolder() as the root for fetch targets; at the bottom the shipped freezes. The on-disk layout since v3.16 is uniform: temporal products under series/ (series/itsg/monthly|daily|sinex|background, series/<group>_ _<series> for an ICGEM series, series/GAX/<product>), static models under static/, auxiliaries under DDK/ and TN/; the fetchers warn once when they find data in a pre-v3.16 location instead of silently re-downloading. The single deliberate exception is gravisL2B with an explicit GravisFolder= requesting fresh tables - and even there the shipped freeze is the default, precisely so reproducibility never hangs on a server (the

ISDC 503 episode was the confirmation).

Coastal leakage, controlled twice. The crude ocean mask plus gauss445 lets land signal - Greenland above all - smear across the coast into the ocean mean. Two independent controls, both quantified before implementation: `CoastBufferKm` (the public helper `shLowLevel.erodeMask`) erodes the mask by a great-circle distance from every coast (the Python point-source experiment for gauss445: 300 km removes 54% of the leak, 500 km 82%, at under 1% ocean-area loss - 300 km is the Chambers-style standard), and `RemoveLandLeakage` separates the outside-mask sources by two-sided alternating support projections (Papoulis-Gerchberg style, LandLeakIter sweeps) and subtracts the converged land component before the filter. The pre-validation taught the hard lesson here: a naive ONE-step subtraction makes the leak WORSE, because the reconstruction of the outside field rings INTO the mask; the two-sided iteration cuts an adjacent-source leak of 47% of the ocean mean by 94% (1D reference, frozen in CI on the band-limited spherical experiment). Since v3.16.1 the 300 km buffer IS the default - the machine re-baseline moved the barystatic trend +1.407 to +1.557 mm/yr (500 km: +1.647), into the published ~1.6-2.2 band; CoastBufferKm = 0 reproduces the pre-v3.16.1 numbers. Changing a validated number happened here the only allowed way: measured first, then decided, then frozen.

```
[out, rep] = shLowLevel.oceanChain(ser, kn = kn, OceanMask = oc, ...
    GADFolder = gadF, GAAFolder = gaaF, ...
    CoastBufferKm = 300, RemoveLandLeakage = true);
```

```
f = shLowLevel.fetchGAX("E:/DATAPOOL/GravityField/GAX");
[out, rep] = shLowLevel.oceanChain(ser, kn = kn, OceanMask = oc, ...
    GADFolder = "E:/DATAPOOL/GravityField/GAX/GAD", ...
    GAAFolder = "E:/DATAPOOL/GravityField/GAX/GAA");
[rep.nGadRestored, rep.nGaaApplied]        % coverage, reported
```

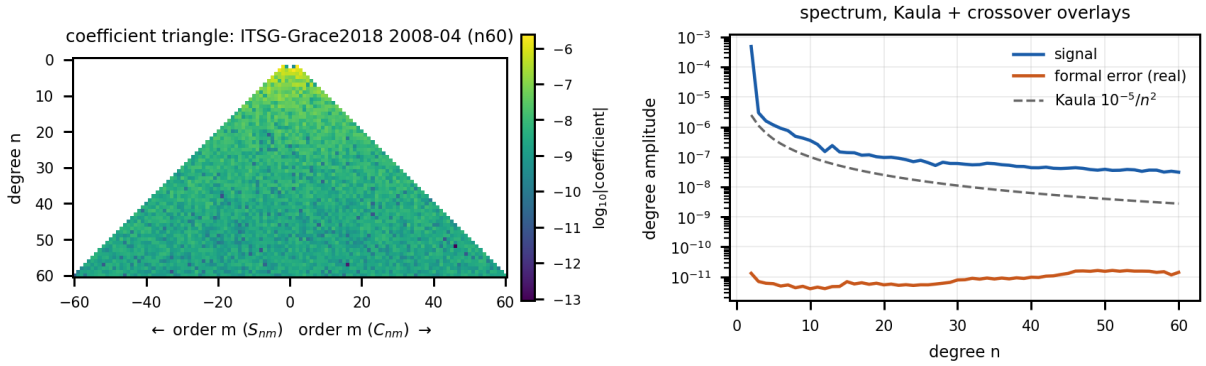
```
idx = shLowLevel.shIndex(30, Nmin= 0);
[G, lam, info] = shLowLevel.slepianBasis(idx, @(la, lo) double(la > 60));
K = round(info.shannon);                   % ~N useful modes
a = shLowLevel.slepianProject(ts.Cs, ts.Ss, G(:, 1:K), idx);
plot(ts.epochs, a')                        % regional modes vs time
```

Demo gallery

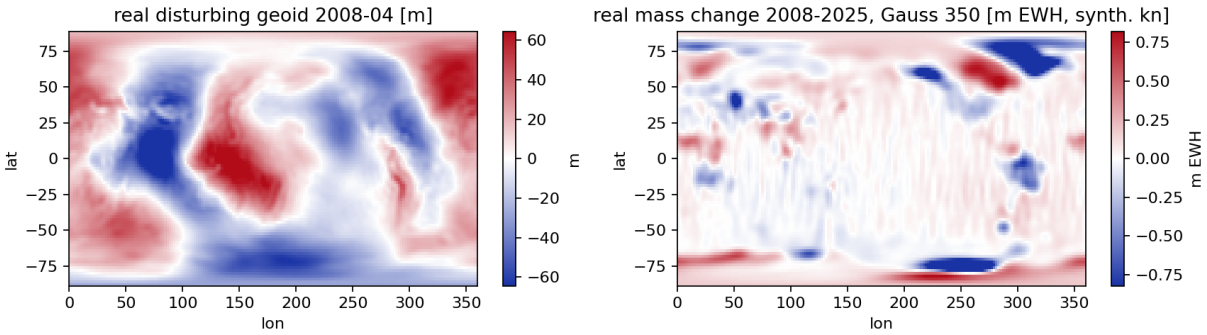
`demo_shAnalysis` is a case registry: `demo_shAnalysis("list")` prints the table below, `demo_shAnalysis("all")` runs everything, `demo_shAnalysis(["D04","D15"])` runs a selection, and Visible=false keeps figures hidden for smoke tests. Real files in the test-data folder (shLowLevel.testDataDir: ITSG months, the DDK3 Wbd) are used when present; every case falls back to synthetic data. Love numbers in the demos are SYNTHETIC — real work requires a real loading model.

ID	Case	Exercises
D01	Read & spectral diagnostics	shReadGFC, shDegreeRMS, triangle, spectrum
D02	Synthesis quantities & maps	shSynthesis, kernelFactors, toGrid, Height
D03	Normal field → geoid	normalFieldCS, subtractNormalField, toReference
D04	Filter comparison	gaussian, fan, destripe, DDK, triangle diff
D05	Climatology & basin series	climatology, basinKernel, plotBasinSeries
D06	tvANS pipeline	buildNoiseCov, tvANSFilter, basinDeconvolve
D07	Analysis (inverse)	shAnalysisGrid, Kaula
D08	Basin tools	basinKernel taper, deconvolve vs scaling
D09	Uncertainty	errorMap, mcPropagate, plotCovariance
D10	Load deformation	shSynthesisDeformation, Mode=points
D11	Gradient tensor	shSynthesisGradientTensor
D12	EOF analysis	eofAnalysis
D13	Trend breakpoints	trendBreaks, F-test
D14	Multi-center combination	combineCenters, VCE weights
D15	Sea-level fingerprint	seaLevelFingerprint, evalMask
D16	Export	writeGrid netCDF, writeAnimation MP4

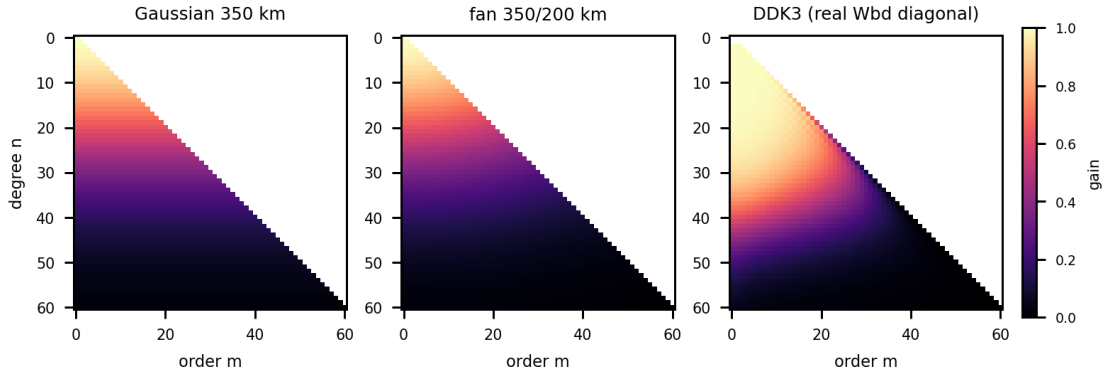
Note. Provenance of the figures below: rendered with the toolbox's Python validation port — the same algorithms that gate every MATLAB implementation, numerically equivalent by construction. D01/D02 use the REAL ITSG files among the test fixtures (and D04 the real DDK3 Wbd binary); the remaining figures use synthetic data with known ground truth, because recovery demonstrations (VCE factors, EOF modes, F-test calibration) require a truth to recover. `shLowLevel.fetchITSG(years)` extends the real-data demos to full monthly series. The MATLAB demo cases produce the interactive originals.



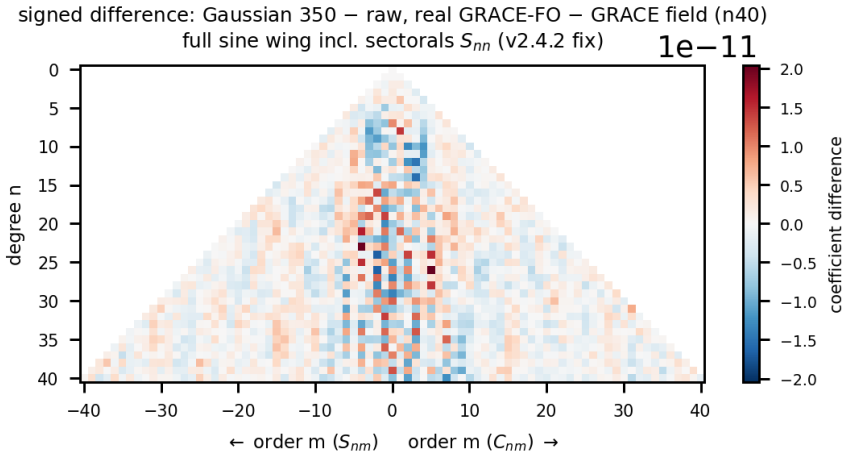
D01 — REAL DATA: the shipped ITSG-Grace2018 2008-04 month (rendered by the rebuilt Python port, v2.5). Coefficient triangle (apex up; C00/C20 removed for display) and the degree-amplitude spectrum with the REAL formal errors from the gfc file. At this n60 truncation the formal errors stay ~3 orders below the signal - the signal/error crossover (the resolution limit) lies beyond the truncation degree; Kaula decay as the yardstick.



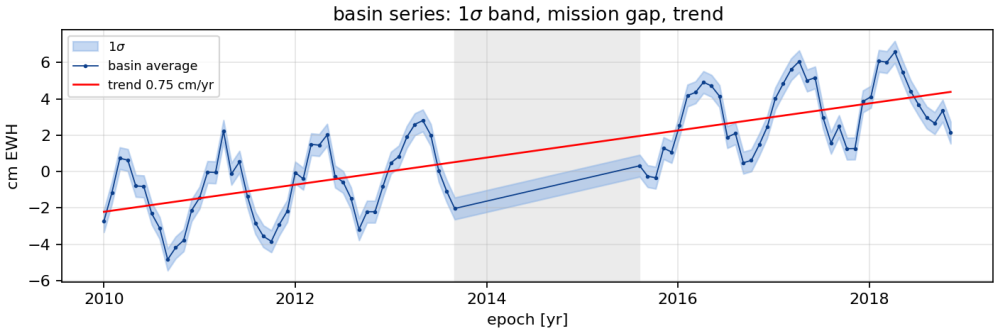
D02 — REAL DATA. Left: the disturbing geoid of 2008-04 after subtracting the WGS84 normal field computed from defining constants and rescaled to the ITSG (GM, R) — the classic ±100 m map (Indian Ocean low, New Guinea high). Right: the real 2008-2025 mass change (GRACE-FO minus GRACE, Gaussian 350 km, EWH): Greenland and West Antarctic mass loss stand out; residual meridional stripes at low latitudes are the real GRACE error structure. Honest caveats: synthetic Love numbers, no GIA correction, degree 1 absent — patterns are real, amplitudes approximate.



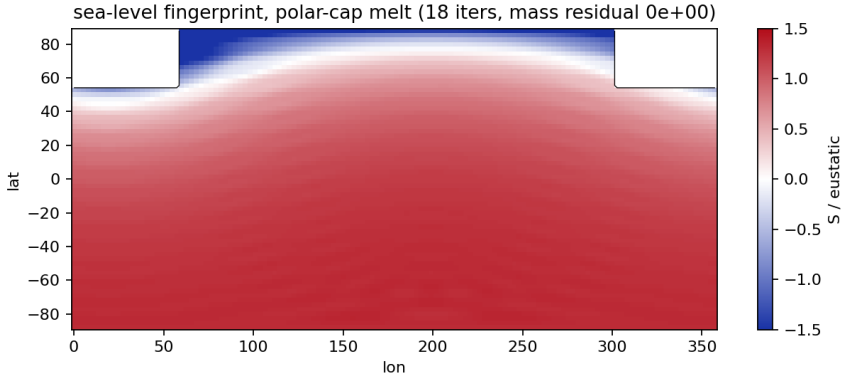
D04 — Filter gain over the (degree, order) triangle. Gaussian: isotropic in degree. Fan (Han): the order Gaussian additionally damps high orders — the striping direction. DDK3 (diagonal of the real Wbd blocks): anisotropic and order-dependent — near-zonal signal survives to n~35 while high orders are suppressed hard; exactly the structure a GRACE error covariance demands.



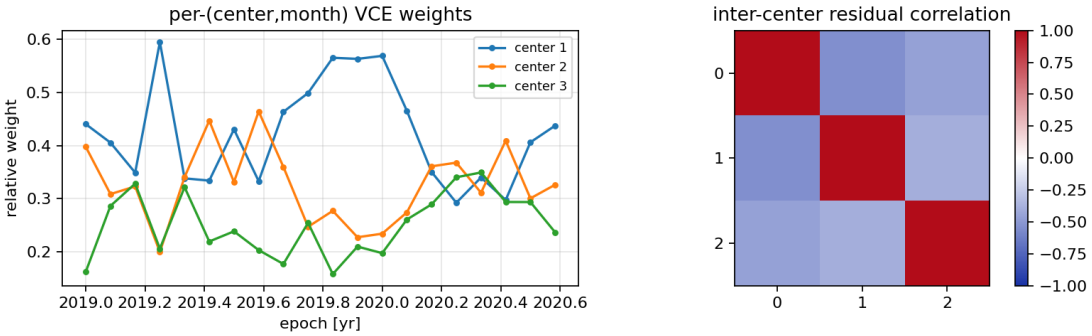
D04b — REAL DATA, v2.4.2 fix: the signed difference triangle (Gaussian 350 – raw) on the real GRACE-FO – GRACE field at n40 — the removed signal concentrates at the low orders where the real stripes and secular signal live. The sine wing now spans the full n ≥ m ≥ 1 support including the sectorals S_{nn}: before v2.4.2 the difference mode blanked the sectoral edge and every diff triangle rendered the left wing one column narrower than the right (regression-tested on the rendered CData since).



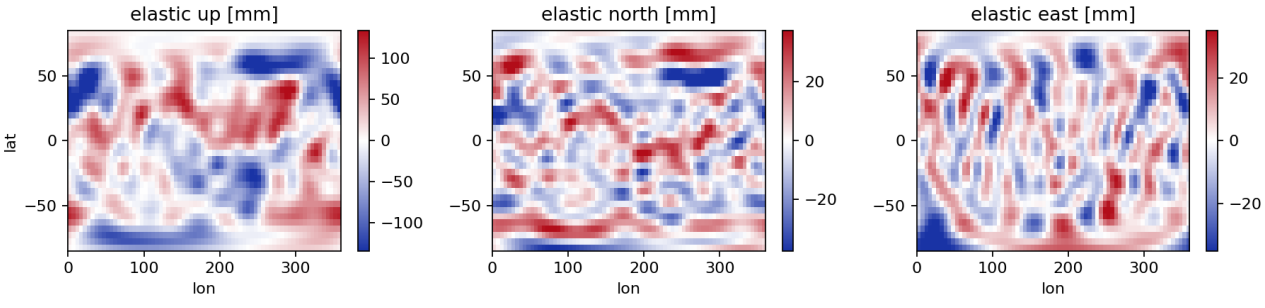
D05/D06 — The standard basin figure from plotBasinSeries: 1-sigma band, grey mission-gap patch, AR(1)-corrected trend annotation. With tvANS + basinDeconvolve the band comes from propagated posterior covariances instead of an empirical scatter.



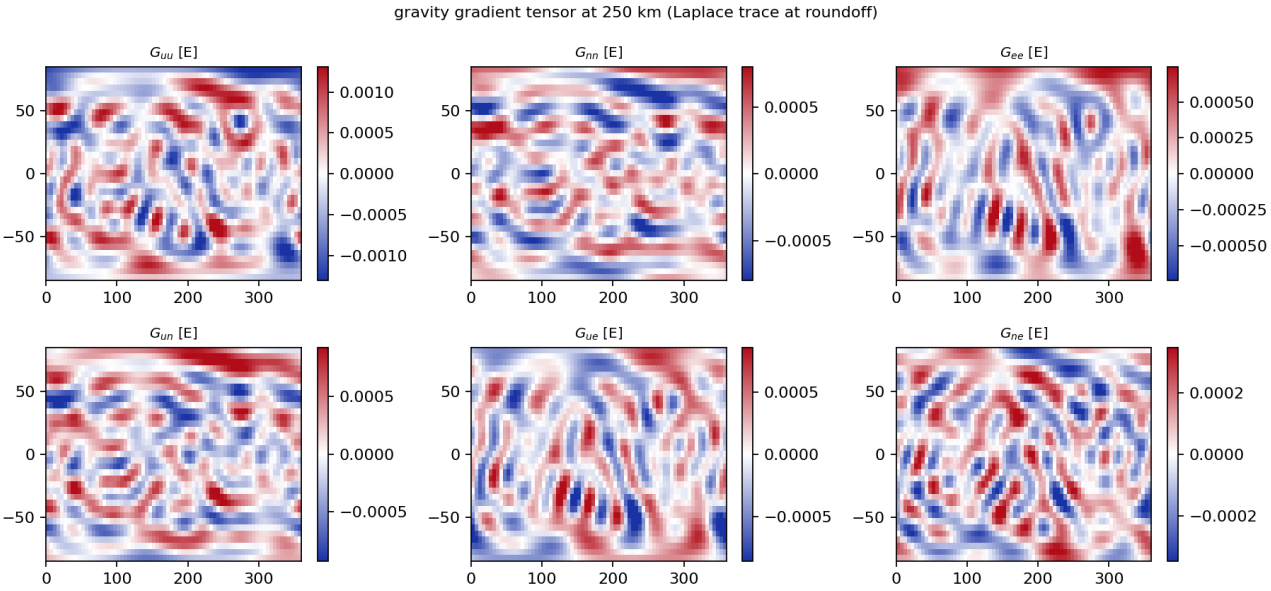
D15 — Sea-level fingerprint of a polar-cap melt, normalized by the eustatic mean: the near field FALLS (blue; lost self-attraction plus crustal rebound), the far field exceeds eustatic by ~20-30%. Mass conserved to machine precision — the printed residual is the built-in check.



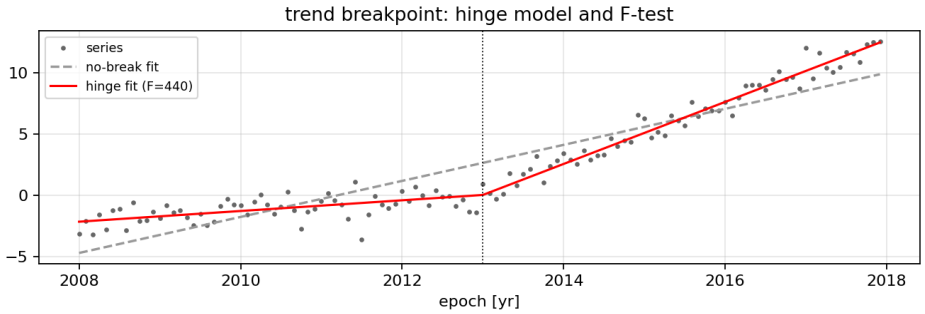
D14 — Multi-center VCE: per-(center, month) weights track the time-varying noise levels; the inter-center residual correlation matrix is the honesty diagnostic — VCE assumes independence, GRACE centers share data and background models.



D10 — Elastic load deformation: up, north, east from the same residual field. Horizontals are ~1/3 of the vertical (validation run: 0.38) and require the exact SH gradient (legendreALFDeriv); east is undefined at the poles.



D11 — All six gradient tensor components at 250 km in Eotvos. The Laplace invariant $G_{nn} + G_{ee} + G_{uu} = 0$ holds at roundoff (4e-15 of max|G| here) — a full-chain check of first and second Legendre derivatives, trig derivatives and frame terms at once.



D13 — Trend breakpoint: continuous piecewise-linear hinge model vs the no-break fit; the F-test (p via betainc, base MATLAB) quantifies the break. Null rejection is calibrated at the nominal level (5.1% at 5%).

Part IV — API reference

Generated from the source: the **arguments blocks are the ground truth** for input names, dimensions, classes and defaults (default 'required' = mandatory positional input); name-value options are passed as Name=Value. Conventions throughout: coefficient triangles are addressed C(n+1, m+1); vectors follow shLowLevel.shIndex ordering (Nmin= 2 unless stated); latitudes are geocentric degrees; filter radii in km, other lengths in m; epochs in decimal years. An entry whose help carries an example closes with it; every example is lint- and API-gated at build time.

shCoefficients class

Spherical harmonic (Stokes) coefficient set - single epoch. The single point of access for one gravity field: a GRACE/GRACE-FO monthly solution (GSM), a dealiasing product (GAA/GAB/GAC/GAD), a static model, or any derived field (difference, filtered, climatology component). Immutable value class: every operation returns a NEW object and appends to .history (full provenance).

property	size	type	default	notes
C	—	double	—	
S	—	double	—	
sigmaC	—	double	[]	
sigmaS	—	double	[]	
GM	1 x 1	double	3.986004415e14	
R	1 x 1	double	6378136.3	
epoch	1 x 1	double	NaN	
productType	1 x 1	string	"unknown"	
tideSystem	1 x 1	string	"unknown"	
name	1 x 1	string	""	
header	—	struct	struct()	
variableTerms	—	—	[]	
history	—	string	string.empty(0,1)	
nmax	—	—	—	

shCoefficients.shCoefficients

```
obj = g.shCoefficients(C, S, Name=Value)
```

Construct from coefficient matrices.

input	size	type	default	description
C	nmax+1 x nmax+1	double	0	double cosine coefficients, C(n+1, m+1) layout
S	nmax+1 x nmax+1	double	0	double sine coefficients, same layout (S(:,1) = 0)
SigmaC	n x m	double	[]	formal 1-sigma of the cosine coefficients, same layout as C ([]: none attached)
SigmaS	n x m	double	[]	formal 1-sigma of the sine coefficients
GM	1 x 1	double	3.986004415e14	gravitational constant times mass [m^3/s^2] the coefficients refer to (overridable default)
R	1 x 1	double	6378136.3	reference radius [m] the coefficients refer to
Epoch	1 x 1	double	NaN	decimal year of the solution; required by every epoch-matched operation (applyTN14, addDegree1, restore)

input	size	type	default	description
ProductType	1 x 1	string	"unknown"	provider product code, e.g. "GSM", "GAD", "GAA" - arithmetic uses it to catch mixing levels
TideSystem	1 x 1	string	"unknown"	"tide_free" | "zero_tide" | "mean_tide" | "unknown"; carried through and written back out, never converted silently
Name	1 x 1	string	""	model label used in displays and plot titles
Header	n x m	struct	struct()	) parsed gfc header fields, kept verbatim so writeGFC can round-trip them
VariableTerms	n x m	—	[]	ICGEM 2.0 gfct terms (trend/periodic per coefficient) evaluated by evalAt
History	1 x 1	string	string.empty(0, 1)	) initial processing history; every operation appends one line

output	description
obj	(1 x 1) shCoefficients immutable coefficient set with GM, R, epoch, sigmas, history

shCoefficients.plus

```
out = g.plus(a, b)
```

Coefficient addition (e.g. GSM + GAD background restore).

input	size	type	default	description
a	—	—	required	—
b	—	—	required	—

output	description
out	(1 x 1) shCoefficients sum; epochs must match; sigmas RSS when BOTH operands carry them, [] when either has none

shCoefficients.minus

```
out = g.minus(a, b)
```

Coefficient difference (e.g. monthly change gB - gA).

input	size	type	default	description
a	—	—	required	—
b	—	—	required	—

output	description
out	(1 x 1) shCoefficients difference; sigmas RSS when BOTH operands carry them, [] when either has none

shCoefficients.uminus

```
out = g.uminus(a)
```

Unary minus: negate all coefficients.

input	size	type	default	description
a	—	—	required	—

output	description
out	(1 x 1) shCoefficients negated coefficients (sigmas kept)

shCoefficients.mtimes

```
out = g.mtimes(a, b)
```

Scalar scaling.

input	size	type	default	description
a	—	—	required	—
b	—	—	required	—

output	description
out	(1 x 1) shCoefficients scalar-scaled; sigmas scale by |a|

shCoefficients.compare

```
[rep, h] = g.compare(other, varargin)
```

Full comparison against another solution (v2.6.0). REP = g.compare(G2, ...) delegates to shLowLevel.compareSolutions with OBJ as the first solution; all options pass through (Plot=true for the 4-panel figure).

input	size	type	default	description
other	—	—	required	—
varargin	—	—	required	—

output	description
rep	(1,1) struct as returned by shLowLevel.compareSolutions, which documents every field
h	(1 x 1) graphics handle figure (Plot = true)

shCoefficients.times

```
out = g.times(a, b)
```

Elementwise scaling .* (scalar or triangle matrix). W .* G scales every coefficient by the matching entry of the (nmax+1 x nmax+1) matrix W (per-coefficient weighting or tapering); a scalar factor delegates to mtimes. Sigmas scale by |factor| elementwise (v2.5.1).

input	size	type	default	description
a	—	—	required	—
b	—	—	required	—

output	description
out	(1 x 1) shCoefficients elementwise-scaled coefficients

shCoefficients.truncate

```
out = g.truncate(nmaxNew)
```

Reduce the maximum degree.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
nmaxNew	1 x 1	double	required	double new maximum degree (must not exceed the current nmax)

output	description
out	(1 x 1) shCoefficients truncated to the new nmax

shCoefficients.setCoefficient

```
out = g.setCoefficient(n, m, Cval, Sval, Name=Value)
```

Replace a single (n,m) coefficient pair.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
n	1 x 1	double	required	spherical harmonic degree
m	1 x 1	double	required	spherical harmonic order
Cval	1 x 1	double	required	double new C(n+1, m+1) value
Sval	1 x 1	double	NaN	double new S(n+1, m+1) value (NaN keeps the current one)
SigmaC	1 x 1	double	NaN	formal 1-sigma for the coefficient being set (NaN leaves the existing sigma untouched)
SigmaS	1 x 1	double	NaN	same for the sine coefficient

output	description
out	(1 x 1) shCoefficients copy with C/S(n+1, m+1) replaced

shCoefficients.applyTN14

```
out = g.applyTN14(tn, Name=Value)
```

Replace C20 (and C30 where provided) from a TN-14 table. OUT = obj.applyTN14(TN) with TN from shLowLevel.readTN14 (or a filename). Requires a finite obj.epoch; the nearest TN epoch within opts.Tolerance (default 0.05 yr) is used.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
tn	n x m	—	required	correction-table struct as returned by the matching reader
Tolerance	1 x 1	double	0.05	epoch matching tolerance [yr]
ReplaceC30	1 x 1	string ∈ ["auto","never","always"]	"auto"	"auto" replaces C30 when the table carries it, "always"/"never" force the choice; with obj.nmax < 3 the C30 step is skipped silently, whatever the choice opt...

output	description
out	(1 x 1) shCoefficients C20 (and C30 when available) replaced by the SLR values, sigmas updated

shCoefficients.addDegree1

```
out = g.addDegree1(tn, Name=Value)
```

Insert TN-13 geocenter (degree-1) coefficients. OUT = obj.addDegree1(TN) with TN from shLowLevel.readTN13 (or a filename) sets C10, C11, S11 (with their sigmas) from the TN-13 record nearest to obj.epoch (within opts.Tolerance, default 0.05 yr). Without degree 1, EWH/mass grids are systematically biased - this completes the standard GSM + TN-14 + TN-13 processing chain.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
tn	n x m	—	required	correction-table struct as returned by the matching reader
Tolerance	1 x 1	double	0.05	epoch matching tolerance [yr]

output	description
out	(1 x 1) shCoefficients degree-1 row set from the TN-13 record nearest to obj.epoch

shCoefficients.destripe

```
out = g.destripe(Name=Value)
```

Swenson & Wahr (2006) / P3M6 decorrelation. OUT = obj.destripe(MinOrder=6, PolyOrder=3, WindowLength=[]) Formal errors are passed through UNCHANGED (the destriping operator is data-dependent; rigorous error propagation is not defined for it - use the tvANS filter on an shSeries for a filter with proper covariance semantics).

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
MinOrder	1 x 1	double	6	lowest order the decorrelation touches
PolyOrder	1 x 1	double	3	order of the fitted/removed polynomial
WindowLength	n x m	double	[]	sliding-window length; [] fits one polynomial over the full degree range per order and parity (the original Swenson-Wahr form); a value selects the moving-wi...

output	description
out	(1 x 1) shCoefficients Swenson-Wahr decorrelated

shCoefficients.gaussian

```
out = g.gaussian(radiusKm)
```

Jekeli (1981) isotropic smoothing; sigmas scaled by Wn.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
radiusKm	1 x 1	double	required	double Gaussian filter half-response radius [km]

output	description
out	(1 x 1) shCoefficients Gaussian-smoothed; sigmas scaled by Wn

shCoefficients.degreeRMS

```
spec = g.degreeRMS(Name=Value)
```

Degree variance/RMS/amplitude spectrum (+ error spectrum).

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
Nmin	1 x 1	double	0	first degree included in the spectrum (renamed from N0 in v4.0.0)

output	description
spec	(1,1) struct the degree spectrum, including the formal-error curve, as returned by shLowLevel.shDegreeRMS

shCoefficients.crossover

```
[n0, nInterp] = g.crossover(Name=Value)
```

Signal-vs-formal-error crossover degree.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
Nmin	1 x 1	double	2	first degree searched for the signal/error crossover (renamed from N0 in v4.0.0)

output	description
nInterp	(1,1) double interpolated crossing degree

shCoefficients.spectrum

```
h = g.spectrum(varargin)
```

Plot the degree-amplitude spectrum. h = obj.spectrum(...)

input	size	type	default	description
varargin	—	—	required	—

output	description
h	(1 x 1) graphics handle spectrum plot

shCoefficients.triangle

```
h = g.triangle(varargin)
```

Plot the degree/order coefficient triangle. h = obj.triangle(...)

input	size	type	default	description
varargin	—	—	required	—

output	description
h	(1 x 1) graphics handle coefficient triangle plot

shCoefficients.synthesis

```
[grid, lat, lon] = g.synthesis(latVec, lonVec, Name=Value)
```

Spatial synthesis (geoid, gravity, potential, EWH). [GRID, LAT, LON] = obj.synthesis(LATVEC, LONVEC, Quantity=..., kn=..., Nmin=..., Nmax=..., UseCache=true). The Legendre functions are served from a verified process-wide cache (shLowLevel.legendreCached), so monthly time series on a fixed grid pay the recursion only once - no manual 'P' passing. EWH requires explicitly supplied load Love numbers kn (never hardcoded).

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
latVec	1 x :	double	required	geocentric latitude vector of the grid [deg]
lonVec	1 x :	double	required	longitude vector of the grid [deg], [0, 360)
Quantity	1 x 1	string	"geoid"	the quantity synthesized; the full list and units are in shLowLevel.kernelFactors
kn	n x m	double	[]	load Love numbers, degrees 0..nmax (user-supplied; required by the mass quantities such as "ewh")
hn	n x m	double	[]	vertical-deformation Love numbers, degrees 0..nmax (user-supplied)
Height	1 x 1	double	0	evaluation height [m] above the evaluation surface; applies the upward continuation (R/r)^p_n
Surface	1 x 1	string ∈ ["sphere","ellipsoid"]	"sphere"	"sphere" | "ellipsoid": evaluate on the sphere r = R or on the ellipsoid r(phi), see shLowLevel.shSynthesis. It is the SAME ellipsoid the Flattening option d...
SemiMajorAxis	1 x 1	double	6378137	ellipsoid semi-major axis [m], WGS84
Nmin	1 x 1	double	0	lowest degree synthesized
Nmax	1 x 1	double	NaN	highest degree synthesized; NaN uses obj.nmax
rho_ave	1 x 1	double	5517	mean Earth density [kg/m^3] in the EWH kernel
rho_water	1 x 1	double	1000	water density [kg/m^3] in the EWH kernel
UseCache	1 x 1	logical	true	serve the Legendre functions from shLowLevel.legendreCached

input	size	type	default	description
Method	1 x 1	string ∈ ["auto","direct","fft"]	"auto"	"auto" | "direct" | "fft": FFT along longitude applies to uniform full-circle longitude vectors and "auto" uses it whenever it is applicable; neither path is...
LatType	1 x 1	string ∈ ["geocentric", "geodetic"]	"geocentric"	"geocentric" | "geodetic": how the latitude inputs are interpreted; geodetic values are converted with Flattening before evaluation
Flattening	1 x 1	double	1/298.257223563	flattening of the reference ellipsoid for the geodetic/geocentric conversion and, with Surface = "ellipsoid", of the evaluation surface (WGS84; overridable, ...
MaxMemGB	1 x 1	double	4	memory budget [GB]; above it the synthesis streams in latitude bands instead of allocating the full design matrix (this is what makes nmax 2190 tractable)

output	description
grid	(nlat x nlon) double synthesized field
lat	(1 x nlat) double the latitudes AS GIVEN, in the convention named by LatType - not the internally converted ones (changed in v3.31.0)
lon	(1 x nlon) double longitudes

shCoefficients.toReference

```
out = g.toReference(Name=Value)
```

Convert to another (GM, R) reference (exact). OUT = g.toReference(GM=3.986004418e14, R=6378137.0) re-expresses the coefficients via shLowLevel.rescaleGMR; the physical field is invariant (Python-validated). Sigmas rescale identically; GM/R properties are updated.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
GM	1 x 1	double	NaN	target gravitational constant [m^3/s^2]; NaN keeps obj.GM
R	1 x 1	double	NaN	target reference radius [m]; NaN keeps obj.R

output	description
out	(1 x 1) shCoefficients rescaled to the given GM/R

shCoefficients.subtractNormalField

```
out = g.subtractNormalField(Name=Value)
```

Remove the ellipsoidal normal field. OUT = g.subtractNormalField() % WGS84 OUT = g.subtractNormalField(System="GRS80") Computes the even zonals from the DEFINING constants (shLowLevel.normalFieldCS, Heiskanen-Moritz closed form; validated against NIMA TR8350.2 to all published digits), rescales them from the ellipsoid's own (GM, a) to the object's (GM, R) - the WGS84 GM and a DIFFER from the ICGEM values, skipping this step costs millimetres - and subtracts them including the degree-0 GM ratio term. T...

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
System	1 x 1	string ∈ ["WGS84","GRS80"]	"WGS84"	"WGS84" | "GRS80": the defining constants
GM	1 x 1	double	NaN	GM of the normal field [m^3/s^2] (NaN: the System default)
a	1 x 1	double	NaN	semi-major axis [m] of the normal field (NaN: the System default)

input	size	type	default	description
f	1 x 1	double	NaN	flattening of the normal field (NaN: the System default; give GM, a, f and omega together to define your own)
omega	1 x 1	double	NaN	angular velocity [rad/s] of the normal field

output	description
out	(1 x 1) shCoefficients disturbing field (even zonals of the normal field removed)

shCoefficients.map

```
H = g.map(latDeg, lonDeg, Name=Value)
```

Synthesize and draw in one call, through geoMap. H = g.map(-89:89, 0:359, Quantity=..., kn=...) builds the handover struct with g.toGrid and hands it to geo.map. It draws NOTHING itself.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
latDeg	1 x :	double	required	double latitudes [deg]
lonDeg	1 x :	double	required	double longitudes [deg]
Quantity	1 x 1	string	"ewh"	any kernelFactors quantity
kn	n x m	double	[]	load Love numbers k'_n (mass quantities; never hardcoded)
hn	n x m	double	[]	load Love numbers h'_n (deformation_up only)
Nmin	1 x 1	double	0	degrees below nmin are zeroed
Nmax	1 x 1	double	NaN	truncation degree; NaN uses the object's nmax
Height	1 x 1	double	0	evaluation height [m] above the evaluation surface
rho_ave	1 x 1	double	5517	mean Earth density [kg/m^3]
rho_water	1 x 1	double	1000	water density [kg/m^3]
LatType	1 x 1	string ∈ ["geocentric", "geodetic"]	"geodetic"	"geodetic" | "geocentric"; coastlines are geodetic, so a map wants geodetic
Flattening	1 x 1	double	1/298.257223563	ellipsoid flattening (WGS84), for LatType and for Surface = "ellipsoid"
Surface	1 x 1	string ∈ ["sphere","ellipsoid"]	"sphere"	"sphere" | "ellipsoid": evaluate on the sphere r = R or on the ellipsoid r(phi), as g.synthesis
SemiMajorAxis	1 x 1	double	6378137	ellipsoid semi-major axis [m], WGS84
CRS	1 x 1	string	"equirectangular"	projection, forwarded to geo.map
Basemap	1 x 1	struct	struct()	) forwarded to geo.map's Basemap element; unless you set them yourself, CLim is inserted - the symmetric 98th percentile of |Z| for FieldKind "anomaly", [Zm...
GeoArgs	n x m	cell	{}	name-value pairs forwarded to geo.map verbatim

output	description
H	(1,1) struct the graphics handle struct, as returned by geoMap's map function - this toolbox draws no map of its own

Example

```
H = g.map(-89.5:89.5, 0.5:359.5, Quantity = "ewh", kn = kn, ...
        CRS = "robinson");
```

shCoefficients.fan

```
out = g.fan(rDegKm, rOrdKm)
```

Han fan filter (degree x order Gaussian) - shLowLevel.shFanFilter.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
rDegKm	1 x 1	double	required	double fan filter degree-direction radius [km]
rOrdKm	1 x 1	double	required	double fan filter order-direction radius [km]

output	description
out	(1 x 1) shCoefficients fan-filtered

shCoefficients.deformation

```
[up, north, east] = g.deformation(latDeg, lonDeg, Name=Value)
```

Elastic load deformation up/north/east [m]. [UP, NORTH, EAST] = g.deformation(LAT, LON, kn=, hn=, ln=, Mode="grid"|"points", Nmin=1, LatType="geocentric") from the object's (residual!) coefficients - remove a mean field first. Love numbers are always user-supplied; see shLowLevel.shSynthesisDeformation for formulas and validation.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
latDeg	1 x :	double	required	double latitudes [deg], in the convention LatType names
lonDeg	1 x :	double	required	double longitudes [deg]
kn	n x m	double	required	load Love numbers, (degree, kn) table or column vector - always user-supplied, no reference frame is assumed
hn	n x m	double	required	load Love numbers h_n, same layout as kn
ln	n x m	double	required	load Love numbers l_n (horizontal), same layout as kn
Nmin	1 x 1	double	1	lowest degree synthesized
Mode	1 x 1	string ∈ ["grid","points"]	"grid"	"grid" | "points": LAT x LON grid, or one station per (LAT(k), LON(k)) pair
LatType	1 x 1	string ∈ ["geocentric", "geodetic"]	"geocentric"	"geocentric" | "geodetic": how LAT is read; geodetic values are converted with Flattening
Flattening	1 x 1	double	1/298.257223563	ellipsoid flattening for the geodetic/geocentric conversion of the station latitudes

output	description
up	(nlat x nlon | npts) double vertical deformation [m]
north	same size north component [m]
east	same size east component [m]

shCoefficients.gradient

```
[dq, info] = g.gradient(latDeg, lonDeg, Name=Value)
```

North/east/up gradient of a synthesized quantity. [DQ, INFO] = g.gradient(LAT, LON, Quantity=..., Units=..., Mode=...) is the exact spatial derivative of what g.synthesis would return under the SAME options - the vector field to draw over a scalar map, or to advect tracers through. DQ.up is EMPTY for surface quantities (ewh, geoid, surface_density, bottom_pressure, deformation_up, none), which have no radial law; INFO.hasUp says so. See shLowLevel.shSynthesisGradient for the formulas, the validation, and why thi...

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on

input	size	type	default	description
latDeg	1 x :	double	required	double latitudes [deg]
lonDeg	1 x :	double	required	double longitudes [deg]
Quantity	1 x 1	string	"geoid"	any kernelFactors quantity
kn	n x m	double	[]	load Love numbers k'_n (mass quantities; never hardcoded)
hn	n x m	double	[]	load Love numbers h'_n (deformation_up only)
Nmin	1 x 1	double	0	degrees below nmin are zeroed
Nmax	1 x 1	double	NaN	truncation degree; NaN uses the object's nmax
Height	1 x 1	double	0	evaluation height [m] above the evaluation surface; surface quantities reject it
Surface	1 x 1	string ∈ ["sphere","ellipsoid"]	"sphere"	"sphere" | "ellipsoid", see shLowLevel.shSynthesisGradient; the components stay in the local spherical frame either way
SemiMajorAxis	1 x 1	double	6378137	ellipsoid semi-major axis [m], WGS84
rho_ave	1 x 1	double	5517	mean Earth density [kg/m^3]
rho_water	1 x 1	double	1000	water density [kg/m^3]
Mode	1 x 1	string ∈ ["grid","points"]	"grid"	"grid" | "points" (pairwise LAT/LON)
Units	1 x 1	string ∈ ["perMeter","perRadian"]	"perMeter"	"perMeter" | "perRadian" (= r x perMeter)
MaxMemGB	1 x 1	double	4	Legendre memory budget [GB]
LatType	1 x 1	string ∈ ["geocentric", "geodetic"]	"geocentric"	"geocentric" | "geodetic": how the latitude inputs are read. NOTE that only the evaluation POINT is converted - the components stay in the geocentric local f...
Flattening	1 x 1	double	1/298.257223563	ellipsoid flattening for that conversion and for Surface = "ellipsoid" (WGS84; overridable, never silently assumed)

output	description
dq	(1,1) struct as returned by shLowLevel.shSynthesisGradient: north, east and up, each (nlat x nlon) double or (npts x 1) for Mode="points"; up is [] for surface quantities
info	(1,1) struct as returned by shLowLevel.shSynthesisGradient (quantity, units, r, surface, nmin, nmax, hasUp, lat, lon, latType), except that lat and latType are overwritten here when geodetic input was given, so the convention travels with the numbers

Example

```
lat = -89:2:89; lon = 0:2:358;
[dq, info] = g.gradient(lat, lon, Quantity = "ewh", kn = kn);
info.hasUp        % false - EWH is a surface quantity
```

shCoefficients.toGrid

`b = g.toGrid(latDeg, lonDeg, Name=Value)`

Synthesized field plus the metadata a map needs to draw it. B = g.toGrid(LAT, LON, Quantity=..., kn=..., LatType=...) synthesizes exactly as g.synthesis does and returns the values TOGETHER WITH what they are: units, latitude convention, product type, epoch, provenance, and whether the field is a full field or an anomaly.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
latDeg	1 x :	double	required	double latitudes [deg], convention per LatType

input	size	type	default	description
lonDeg	1 x :	double	required	double longitudes [deg]
Quantity	1 x 1	string	"ewh"	any kernelFactors quantity; the default is the one a map of a GRACE field almost always wants
kn	n x m	double	[]	load Love numbers k'_n (mass quantities; never hardcoded)
hn	n x m	double	[]	load Love numbers h'_n (deformation_up only)
Nmin	1 x 1	double	0	degrees below nmin are zeroed
Nmax	1 x 1	double	NaN	truncation degree; NaN uses the object's nmax
Height	1 x 1	double	0	evaluation height [m] above the evaluation surface
rho_ave	1 x 1	double	5517	mean Earth density [kg/m^3]
rho_water	1 x 1	double	1000	water density [kg/m^3]
LatType	1 x 1	string ∈ ["geocentric", "geodetic"]	"geodetic"	"geodetic" | "geocentric"
Flattening	1 x 1	double	1/298.257223563	ellipsoid flattening (WGS84), for LatType and for Surface = "ellipsoid"
Surface	1 x 1	string ∈ ["sphere","ellipsoid"]	"sphere"	"sphere" | "ellipsoid", as g.synthesis
SemiMajorAxis	1 x 1	double	6378137	ellipsoid semi-major axis [m], WGS84
Method	1 x 1	string ∈ ["auto","direct","fft"]	"auto"	"auto" | "direct" | "fft"
MaxMemGB	1 x 1	double	4	synthesis memory budget [GB]

output	description
b	(1,1) struct the handover bundle, as built by shLowLevel.gridHandover, which documents every field: Z (nlat x nlon) double values; lat (nlat x 1) AS GIVEN; lon (1 x nlon); the string fields Units, LatType, Quantity, ProductType, Source, Name and FieldKind; the scalars Epoch, C00, Zmin, Zmax and Zmean; and History

Example

```
b = g.toGrid(-89.5:89.5, 0.5:359.5, Quantity = "ewh", kn = kn);
b.Units          % "m"
b.FieldKind      % "anomaly" for a residual field
```

shCoefficients.basinAverage

`avg = g.basinAverage(B)`

Basin averages of one field from basin kernels. AVG = g.basinAverage(B) is the naive basin average B'*x ./ diag(B'*B), one value per basin, with x the coefficient vector of G. It is the one-epoch case of shSeries.basinAverage and delegates to it, so the two cannot disagree. The exact deconvolution (Deconvolve = true) needs the stored operator of a filtered SERIES, so it stays on shSeries.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
B	P x K	double	required	double basin kernels in shLowLevel.shIndex ordering for this nmax, exactly as shSeries.basinAverage takes them (from a grid mask with shLowLevel.synthesisMa...

output	description
avg	(K x 1) double basin averages, one per kernel column

Example

```
    avg = g.basinAverage(B);   % B: P x K, as for ts.basinAverage
```

shCoefficients.errorMap

`[sig, latDeg, lonDeg] = g.errorMap(latDeg, lonDeg, Name=Value)`

Formal-error map of a synthesized quantity. SIG = g.errorMap(LAT, LON) is the pointwise 1-sigma of what g.synthesis returns on the grid LAT x LON, propagated from G's own formal sigmas (sigmaC, sigmaS) taken as a DIAGONAL covariance. SIG = g.errorMap(LAT, LON, Covariance = M, Index = IDX) propagates a full P x P covariance in IDX ordering instead, e.g. from shLowLevel.readSINEX(..., Output = "covariance"). Either way it is shLowLevel.errorMap with G's GM and R filled in. Quantity, kn, hn and Height go to shLowLe...

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
latDeg	1 x :	double	required	double geocentric latitudes [deg]
lonDeg	1 x :	double	required	double longitudes [deg]
Covariance	n x m	double	[]	(P x P) double covariance in Index ordering; [] builds diag(sigma.^2) from sigmaC and sigmaS
Index	n x m	—	[]	shLowLevel.shIndex struct Covariance is ordered by; [] uses shLowLevel.shIndex(nmax)
Quantity	lane default	—	required	the quantity whose error is mapped
kn	lane default	—	required	load Love numbers, for mass quantities
hn	lane default	—	required	vertical-deformation Love numbers
Height	lane default	—	required	evaluation height above R [m]

output	description
sig	(nlat x nlon) double 1-sigma of the field, in the unit of Quantity
latDeg	(1,nlat) double latitudes used [deg], as passed in
lonDeg	(1,nlon) double longitudes used [deg], as passed in

Example

```
    sig = g.errorMap(-89:2:89, 0:2:358, Quantity = "ewh", kn = kn);
```

shCoefficients.synthesisPoints

`val = g.synthesisPoints(latDeg, lonDeg, r, Name=Value)`

Field values at scattered 3-D points. VAL = g.synthesisPoints(LAT, LON, RGEO) evaluates G pointwise at equal-length vectors of geocentric latitude and longitude [deg] and geocentric radius [m] - stations, satellite positions, profiles - with the upward continuation (R/r)^n that a grid on the sphere cannot give. It is shLowLevel.synthesisPoints with G's coefficients, GM and R; that function documents the quantities, the two summations and why "auto" means "clenshaw". Its options go there only when given, so "(lan...

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
latDeg	: x 1	double	required	double geocentric latitudes [deg]
lonDeg	: x 1	double	required	double longitudes [deg]
r	: x 1	double	required	double geocentric radii [m]
Quantity	lane default	—	required	the quantity evaluated
Nmin	lane default	—	required	first degree included

input	size	type	default	description
Method	lane default	—	required	which summation
ClenshawFrom	lane default	—	required	point count where "auto" switches
MaxMemGB	lane default	—	required	memory budget of the direct path [GB]

output	description
val	(P,1) double the quantity at each point

Example

```
    r = shLowLevel.ellipsoidRadius(lat) + 450e3;
    dg = g.synthesisPoints(lat, lon, r, Quantity = "disturbance");
```

shCoefficients.gradientTensor

`[comps, info] = g.gradientTensor(latDeg, lonDeg, Name=Value)`

Full gravity gradient tensor in the local NEU frame. [COMPS, INFO] = g.gradientTensor(LAT, LON) synthesizes the six independent components of the disturbing gravity gradient tensor - uu, nn, ee, un, ue, ne - the GOCE-style diagnostic. It is shLowLevel.shSynthesisGradientTensor with G's coefficients, GM and R; that function documents the formulas, the Laplace self-check INFO carries, and the validation. Its options go there only when given, so "(lane default)" below is that function's - and its Height defaults to...

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
latDeg	1 x :	double	required	double geocentric latitudes [deg]
lonDeg	1 x :	double	required	double longitudes [deg]
Height	lane default	—	required	evaluation altitude above R [m]
Nmin	lane default	—	required	degrees below Nmin are zeroed

output	description
comps	(1,1) struct as returned by shLowLevel.shSynthesisGradientTensor, which documents every field: the six components, each (nlat x nlon)
info	(1,1) struct as returned by shLowLevel.shSynthesisGradientTensor, which documents every field

Example

```
    [G, info] = g.gradientTensor(-89:89, 0:359, Height = 255e3);
    info.maxTraceResidual     % the Laplace self-check
```

shCoefficients.vdkApply

`[out, info] = g.vdkApply(N, sigM, Name=Value)`

Apply the VDK decorrelation filter with a month's normals. [OUT, INFO] = g.vdkApply(N, SIGM) filters G with its own monthly normal-equation matrix N, xf = (N + alpha M) \ (N x) (Horvath et al. 2018), through shLowLevel.vdkApply, which documents the filter, its relation to tvANS and its cost. G's coefficients are taken in Index ordering - by default shLowLevel.shIndex(nmax, Nmin = 2), the ordering of shLowLevel.readSINEX(..., Index = idx) - filtered, and put back. Coefficients outside Index pass through unchanged...

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
N	P x P	double	required	double normal-equation matrix in Index ordering

input	size	type	default	description
sigM	n x m	double	required	double the signal sigma per parameter, or [a, b] for sigma = a * I^b, as shLowLevel.vdkApply takes it
Index	n x m	—	[]	shLowLevel.shIndex struct N is ordered by; [] uses shLowLevel.shIndex(nmax, Nmin = 2)
Alpha	lane default	—	required	filter strength

output	description
out	(1 x 1) shCoefficients the filtered field
info	(1,1) struct as returned by shLowLevel.vdkApply, which documents every field

Example

```
    idx = shLowLevel.shIndex(96, Nmin = 2);
    snx = shLowLevel.readSINEX(f, Index = idx);
    gf = g.vdkApply(snx.M, ab(mo, :), Index = idx, Alpha = 1);
```

shCoefficients.applyDDK

`out = g.applyDDK(W)`

Apply a DDK (order-block-diagonal) decorrelation filter. OUT = obj.applyDDK(W) with W anything shLowLevel.readDDK reads (a released binary Wbd filter file, a struct, a .mat file, or the documented ASCII exchange format). Degrees not covered by the filter pass through unchanged; sigmas are NOT propagated through the filter (set to NaN - use shLowLevel.mcPropagate for filtered uncertainties).

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
W	n x m	—	required	filter container from shLowLevel.readDDK / designFilter, or degree weights

output	description
out	(1 x 1) shCoefficients DDK-decorrelated

shCoefficients.evalAt

`out = g.evalAt(epoch)`

Evaluate gfct time-variable terms at an epoch.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
epoch	1 x 1	double	required	epoch [decimal years]

output	description
out	(1 x 1) shCoefficients gfct variable terms evaluated at the epoch; a static model (no variable terms) keeps its C, S, with warning shLowLevel:shEvalGFCT:staticModel; out.epoch is set to EPOCH in both cases

shCoefficients.write

`g.write(filename, Name=Value)`

Export to an ICGEM .gfc file (round-trip tested).

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
filename	n x m	—	required	char/string path of the file to read/write (gzipped .gz accepted where documented)

input	size	type	default	description
Comment	1 x 1	string	""	free-text comment written into the gfc header
Sidecar	1 x 1	logical	true	also write "<filename>.provenance.json". Set false when exporting into a folder that will be read back as a series: the sidecar is metadata, and a loose read...

shCoefficients.vec

```
x = g.vec(idx)
```

Pack into a coefficient vector in shLowLevel.shIndex ordering.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
idx	1 x 1	struct	required	index struct from shLowLevel.shIndex (fields n, m, cs, P, Lmax, minDegree, pos)

output	description
x	(P x 1) double coefficients in idx ordering

shCoefficients.poleTideConvert

```
out = g.poleTideConvert(Name=Value)
```

Move C21/S21 to another mean-pole convention. OUT = g.poleTideConvert(From = "IERS2010", To = "IERS2018") is shLowLevel.poleTideConvert(g, ...): it moves C21 and S21 from the mean-pole model the processing centre removed the pole tide with to another, at the field's own epoch. That function documents the two models and the adjustment.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
From	lane default	—	required	the convention of this field
To	lane default	—	required	the convention to move to
Mode	lane default	—	required	the solid tide, the ocean tide, or both
SolidCoef	lane default	—	required	the solid-tide coefficient
OceanCoef	lane default	—	required	the ocean-tide coefficient

output	description
out	(1,1) shCoefficients the converted field, history appended

Example

```
    g18 = g.poleTideConvert(From = "IERS2010", To = "IERS2018");
```

shCoefficients.slepianProject

```
[a, rec] = g.slepianProject(G, idx)
```

Project this field onto a Slepian basis, and back. [A, REC] = g.slepianProject(G, IDX) is shLowLevel.slepianProject(g.C, g.S, G, IDX), with the tapers G and the index IDX of shLowLevel.slepianBasis. A holds the Slepian coefficients, REC the field rebuilt from them.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on

input	size	type	default	description
G	P x K	—	required	double Slepian tapers, from shLowLevel.slepianBasis
idx	1 x 1	—	required	struct the coefficient index they are ordered by

output	description
a	(K,1) double the Slepian coefficients
rec	(1,1) struct as returned by shLowLevel.slepianProject, which documents every field

Example

```
    G = shLowLevel.slepianBasis(idx, @(la, lo) double(la > 60));
    a = g.slepianProject(G, idx);
```

shCoefficients.regionalBasis

```
B = g.regionalBasis(region, Name=Value)
```

A local basis for a region, at this field's degree. B = g.regionalBasis(REGION) is shLowLevel.regionalBasis(shLowLevel.shIndex(g.nmax), REGION): radial basis functions, Slepian tapers or the SH basis for a basin or region, built for the degree this field carries, so that g.regionalProject(B) cannot meet an index of another size. That function documents the bases and the projector.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
region	n x m	—	[]	basin name, handle, polygon or mask, as shLowLevel.regionalBasis takes it ([] for Type "sh")
Nmin	shIndex default	—	required	first degree of the index
Type	lane default	—	required	"rbf" | "slepian" | "sh"
BufferKm	lane default	—	required	growth of the region [km]
Grid	lane default	—	required	"icosahedral" | "reuter"
Level	lane default	—	required	rbf grid level
Kernel	lane default	—	required	"kaula" | "shannon" | "amplitude"
DegreeAmplitude	lane default	—	required	sigma_n for Kernel "amplitude"
Threshold	lane default	—	required	slepian concentration cut
NKeep	lane default	—	required	slepian taper count
EigTol	lane default	—	required	rbf projector eigenvalue cut
R	lane default	—	required	sphere radius [m]
OverSample	lane default	—	required	mask quadrature refinement
BasinFile	lane default	—	required	GeoJSON for a basin name

output	description
B	(1,1) struct the basis, as returned by shLowLevel.regionalBasis, which documents every field

Example

```
B = g.regionalBasis("Elbe", Type = "slepian");
a = g.regionalProject(B);
```

shCoefficients.regionalProject

`[a, rec] = g.regionalProject(B)`

This field in a regional basis, and back. [A, REC] = g.regionalProject(B) is shLowLevel.regionalProject(g.C, g.S, B): A holds the coefficients in the basis B of g.regionalBasis, REC the field rebuilt from them.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
B	1 x 1	struct	required	struct a basis from regionalBasis

output	description
a	(K,1) double basis coefficients
rec	(1,1) struct as returned by shLowLevel.regionalProject, which documents every field

Example

```
B = g.regionalBasis("Elbe");
[a, rec] = g.regionalProject(B);
```

shCoefficients.regionalNEQ

`[rec, info] = g.regionalNEQ(B, Name=Value)`

This field as an observation in a regional basis. [REC, INFO] = g.regionalNEQ(B) is shLowLevel.regionalNEQ(B, "solution", ...) with this field's coefficients in B.idx order as the data and their formal sigmas, squared, as the diagonal covariance: one GRACE solution as a normal equation in the basis B of g.regionalBasis, ready for shLowLevel.neqCombine and the regional Kalman filter. Cov replaces the formal sigmas, e.g. with the full covariance of a SINEX file.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
B	1 x 1	struct	required	struct a basis from regionalBasis
Cov	n x m	double	[]	(P,P) or (P,1) double covariance of the coefficients in B.idx order; [] takes the formal sigmas
Name	lane default	—	required	label of the contribution

output	description
rec	(1,1) struct as returned by shLowLevel.regionalNEQ, which documents every field
info	(1,1) struct as returned by shLowLevel.regionalNEQ, which documents every field

Example

```
B = g.regionalBasis("Elbe");
rec = g.regionalNEQ(B);
```

shCoefficients.basinKernel

`[b, info] = g.basinKernel(region, Name=Value)`

A basin kernel in the index basinAverage reads. [B, INFO] = g.basinKernel(REGION) is shLowLevel.basinKernel(shLowLevel.shIndex(g.nmax), REGION): the band-limited indicator of REGION in the ordering g.basinAverage and ts.basinAverage require, so a kernel built here cannot meet them in another. That function documents the quadrature, the buffer and the taper.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
region	n x m	—	required	handle f(latDeg, lonDeg), K x 2 polygon [lat lon] or mask, as shLowLevel.basinKernel takes it
BufferKm	lane default	—	required	growth (> 0) or shrinkage of the region [km]
TaperKm	lane default	—	required	Gaussian taper radius [km]
R	lane default	—	required	sphere radius for the km conversions [m]
OverSample	lane default	—	required	quadrature refinement factor

output	description
b	(P,1) double the kernel in shLowLevel.shIndex(g.nmax) ordering
info	(1,1) struct as returned by shLowLevel.basinKernel, which documents every field

Example

```
    b = g.basinKernel([-10 100; -10 140; 25 140; 25 100]);
    avg = g.basinAverage(b);
```

shCoefficients.sensitivityKernel

`[k, info] = g.sensitivityKernel(region, Name=Value)`

A tailored basin kernel in basinAverage's index. [K, INFO] = g.sensitivityKernel(REGION) is shLowLevel.sensitivityKernel(shLowLevel.shIndex(g.nmax), REGION): the Swenson-Wahr kernel that trades leakage against noise, in the ordering g.basinAverage and ts.basinAverage require. That function documents the trade-off, Alpha and INFO. Noise and FarField, when given, are in the same shLowLevel.shIndex(g.nmax) ordering.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
region	n x m	—	required	handle f(latDeg, lonDeg), K x 2 polygon [lat lon] or mask, as shLowLevel.sensitivityKernel takes it
Alpha	lane default	—	required	weight of the noise against the leakage
Noise	lane default	—	required	error covariance or sigmas, in index ordering
FarField	lane default	—	required	per-coefficient far-field weight
BufferKm	lane default	—	required	growth of the region [km]
TaperKm	lane default	—	required	Gaussian taper radius [km]
R	lane default	—	required	sphere radius for the km conversions [m]
OverSample	lane default	—	required	quadrature refinement factor

output	description
k	(P,1) double the kernel in shLowLevel.shIndex(g.nmax) ordering
info	(1,1) struct as returned by shLowLevel.sensitivityKernel, which documents every field

Example

```
    k = g.sensitivityKernel([-10 100; -10 140; 25 140; 25 100], ...
        Alpha = 1);
    avg = g.basinAverage(k);
```

shCoefficients.designFilter

`[W, info] = g.designFilter(Name=Value)`

A DDK-class filter built from this field's own errors. [W, INFO] = g.designFilter() is shLowLevel.designFilter(g.sigmaC, g.sigmaS): the Wiener-type decorrelation filter from G's formal sigmas, in the block format g.applyDDK takes. With Noise (and Idx) a full covariance is used instead and the sigmas are not read. That function documents the construction. A field without formal sigmas passes NaN, which the lane refuses unless Noise is given.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
Alpha	lane default	—	required	regularisation weight
Kaula	lane default	—	required	signal RMS of the Kaula rule
DegVar	lane default	—	required	per-degree signal variance
Noise	lane default	—	required	full noise covariance in Idx ordering
Signal	lane default	—	required	full signal covariance in Idx ordering
Idx	lane default	—	required	shLowLevel.shIndex struct of Noise/Signal
Nmin	lane default	—	required	first filtered degree
Name	lane default	—	required	label stored in W.name

output	description
W	(1,1) struct the filter, as returned by shLowLevel.designFilter, which documents every field
info	(1,1) struct as returned by shLowLevel.designFilter

Example

```
    W = g.designFilter(Alpha = 1);
    gF = g.applyDDK(W);
```

shCoefficients.mcPropagate

`out = g.mcPropagate(fun, Name=Value)`

Monte-Carlo uncertainty of any functional of this field. OUT = g.mcPropagate(FUN) is shLowLevel.mcPropagate(FUN, g): it draws samples of G consistent with its formal sigmas (or with Cov in Idx ordering), pushes each through FUN and returns the sample mean and sigma. That function documents the sampling models.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
fun	1 x 1	function_handle	required	function handle y = fun(gs), gs an shCoefficients sample, y numeric of a fixed size
N	lane default	—	required	number of samples
Cov	lane default	—	required	full covariance in Idx ordering

input	size	type	default	description
Idx	lane default	—	required	shLowLevel.shIndex struct of Cov
Seed	lane default	—	required	rng seed
KeepSamples	lane default	—	required	also return the samples

output	description
out	(1,1) struct as returned by shLowLevel.mcPropagate, which documents every field

Example

```
b = g.basinKernel([-10 100; -10 140; 25 140; 25 100]);
out = g.mcPropagate(@(gs) gs.basinAverage(b), N = 500, Seed = 1);
```

shCoefficients.disp

`g.disp()`

Compact display: size, epoch, GM/R, processing history. disp(G) prints one header line with the model name, one contract line (nmax, epoch, product type, tide system, GM, R), whether formal sigmas are attached and how many gfct variable terms are carried, followed by the processing history. Called automatically when an shCoefficients object is shown without a semicolon.

Example

```
g = shCoefficients.read("ITSG-Grace2018_n60_2008-04.gfc");
disp(g)                          % degree, epoch, history
```

shCoefficients.read (static)

`obj = shCoefficients.read(filename, Name=Value)`

Read an ICGEM .gfc/.gfct/.gfc.gz file into an shCoefficients. G = shCoefficients.read(FILE) parses product type and mid-epoch from standard GRACE L2 filenames (GSM/GAA/GAB/GAC/GAD-2_...); override with Epoch=..., ProductType=... when needed.

input	size	type	default	description
filename	n x m	—	required	char/string path of the file to read/write (gzipped .gz accepted where documented)
Epoch	1 x 1	double	NaN	decimal year; NaN takes it from the file name
ProductType	1 x 1	string	""	product code; "" takes it from the file name ("static" for a file without epoch or time terms)

output	description
obj	(1 x 1) shCoefficients parsed gfc/gfct(.gz) with GM, R, sigmas, variable terms, Epoch= as given

shCoefficients.fromVec (static)

`obj = shCoefficients.fromVec(x, idx, like)`

Unpack a shLowLevel.shIndex-ordered vector into an shCoefficients. G = shCoefficients.fromVec(X, IDX, LIKE) copies GM/R and other metadata from the template LIKE (an shCoefficients).

input	size	type	default	description
x	: x 1	double	required	coefficient stack, (P x T) in index ordering
idx	1 x 1	struct	required	index struct from shLowLevel.shIndex (fields n, m, cs, P, Lmax, minDegree, pos)
like	1 x 1	shCoefficients	required	template shCoefficients supplying GM, R and metadata

output	description
obj	(1 x 1) shCoefficients rebuilt from x; the size comes from IDX; GM, R, epoch, productType, tideSystem, name (+ "_fromVec") and history come from LIKE; its sigmas, header and variableTerms are NOT copied

shCoefficients.analysis (static)

```
[obj, info] = shCoefficients.analysis(grid, latVec, lonVec, nmax, Name=Value)
```

Spherical harmonic analysis: gridded/scattered data -> Stokes coefficients (the inverse of synthesis).

input	size	type	default	description
grid	n x m	double	required	field values on the (lat, lon) grid
latVec	n x m	double	required	geocentric latitude vector of the grid [deg]
lonVec	n x m	double	required	longitude vector of the grid [deg], [0, 360)
nmax	1 x 1	double	required	maximum spherical harmonic degree
Quantity	1 x 1	string	"geoid"	physical quantity of the grid values; its kernel is divided out, see shLowLevel.kernelFactors
Method	1 x 1	string	"auto"	"auto" | "rings" | "ls", see shAnalysisGrid
Weights	1 x 1	string	"none"	("none" | "coslat") latitude weighting
Kaula	1 x 1	double	0	(1 x 1) Kaula regularization for "ls"
kn	n x m	double	[]	load Love numbers, degrees 0..nmax, required for Quantity="ewh" (user-supplied, never hardcoded)
hn	n x m	double	[]	vertical-deformation Love numbers, degrees 0..nmax
rho_ave	1 x 1	double	5517	mean Earth density [kg/m^3] in the EWH kernel
rho_water	1 x 1	double	1000	water density [kg/m^3] in the EWH kernel
GM	1 x 1	double	3.986004415e14	, R (6378136.3), Epoch (NaN) stored on the returned object
R	1 x 1	double	6378136.3	reference radius [m] (default 6378136.3, overridable)
Epoch	1 x 1	double	NaN	epoch [decimal years]
Name	1 x 1	string	"analysis"	(1 x 1) string stored as the object name
LatType	1 x 1	string ∈ ["geocentric", "geodetic"]	"geocentric"	"geocentric" | "geodetic": how latVec is interpreted; geodetic values are converted with Flattening before evaluation
Flattening	1 x 1	double	1/298.257223563	flattening of the reference ellipsoid for that conversion (WGS84; overridable, never silently assumed)
Fill	1 x 1	double	NaN	the value that replaces NaN in GRID - e.g. 0 where a land-only grid has no ocean value. NaN, the default, refuses a grid that holds NaN: what the gaps mean i...

output	description
obj	(1 x 1) shCoefficients Stokes coefficients estimated from the grid (exact on ring grids; Kaula for scattered points)
info	(1,1) struct the estimation diagnostics, as returned by shLowLevel.shAnalysisGrid

shSeries class

Time series of spherical harmonic coefficient sets. Wraps a stack of shCoefficients over epochs and provides everything with a time dimension: the mean field, the climatology (bias / trend / annual / semi-annual), GAX background restoration, the classic destripe+Gaussian chain applied per epoch, and the tvANS time-variable anisotropic Wiener filter with exact basin deconvolution. Immutable value class with provenance in .history.

property	size	type	default	notes
Cs	—	double	—	
Ss	—	double	—	
sigmaCs	—	double	[]	
sigmaSs	—	double	[]	
epochs	: x 1	double	—	
GM	1 x 1	double	3.986004415e14	
R	1 x 1	double	6378136.3	
productType	1 x 1	string	"unknown"	
names	: x 1	string	string.empty(0,1)	
history	—	string	string.empty(0,1)	
nmax	—	—	—	
nEpochs	—	—	—	

shSeries.shSeries

```
obj = ts.shSeries(in, Name=Value)
```

Construct from an shCoefficients array or raw stacks. ts = shSeries(objArray) ts = shSeries(Cs, Epochs=..., Ss=...) (raw-stack form via opts)

input	size	type	default	description
in	nmax+1 x nmax+1 x T	—	required	double or (1,T) shCoefficients coefficient stacks or object array
Ss	n x m	double	[]	sine stack of the raw-stack form, same size as Cs
Epochs	: x 1	double	[]	(T x 1) decimal years of the raw-stack form, one per layer
GM	1 x 1	double	3.986004415e14	gravitational constant times mass [m^3/s^2] of the series (overridable default)
R	1 x 1	double	6378136.3	reference radius [m] of the series
ProductType	1 x 1	string	"unknown"	provider product code shared by all epochs, e.g. "GSM"
Names	: x 1	string	string.empty(0, 1)	) display labels, one per solution/series
SigmaCs	n x m	double	[]	formal 1-sigma stack for Cs, same size
SigmaSs	n x m	double	[]	formal 1-sigma stack for Ss, same size
History	1 x 1	string	string.empty(0, 1)	) initial processing history; every operation appends one line

output	description
obj	(1 x 1) shSeries epoch-sorted monthly stack with sigmas and history

shSeries.at

```
g = ts.at(k)
```

Extract epoch k as an shCoefficients.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
k	1 x 1	double	required	positive integer epoch index, 1-based

output	description
g	(1 x 1) shCoefficients month k with epoch and sigmas

shSeries.mean

```
[g, info] = ts.mean(Name=Value)
```

Mean field, over the whole series or a user-given window. G = ts.mean() averages every epoch and returns an shCoefficients whose sigmas are the standard error of the temporal scatter, divided by the number of VALID epochs per coefficient (before v3.29.0 it divided by nEpochs, which understated the sigmas of any series holding NaN months).

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
Range	n x m	—	[]	(1 x 2) double decimal years [t1 t2], or a 1 x 2 datetime; [] uses the full series
Estimator	1 x 1	string ∈ ["arithmetic", "model"]	"arithmetic"	(1 x 1) string, "arithmetic" (equal weights) or "model" (fit and integrate, see above)
Periods	1 x :	double	double.empty(1,0)	) (1 x K) double extra harmonic periods [yr] for Estimator = "model", beyond the built-in annual and semi-annual - e.g. 161/365.25 for the S2 alias
Omitnan	1 x 1	logical	true	(1 x 1) logical, ignore NaN coefficients ("arithmetic") or drop NaN epochs ("model"); false makes a NaN month poison the result / raise shSeries:stack:nanInS...
MinEpochs	1 x 1	double	1	(1 x 1) double, minimum number of epochs inside the window; below it the call errors

output	description
g	(1 x 1) shCoefficients mean field over the window, with sigmas (scatter-based for "arithmetic", propagated through the fit for "model")
info	(1,1) struct fields estimator (1,1) string which estimator ran range (1,2) double the window requested nUsed (1,1) double epochs that contributed nTotal (1,1) double epochs in the series nDropped (1,1) double epochs dropped as empty span (1,2) double first and last epoch used coverage (1,1) double used*dt / window length, capped at 1; NaN below two epochs maxGapYears (1,1) double largest gap between two used epochs; NaN below two epochs centroidOffset (1,1) double mean(used) minus the window centre - how lopsided the sample is epoch (1,1) double the epoch stamped on the returned field attenuation (K+2 x 2) double [period factor]; Estimator="model" only

Example

```
gBase = ts.mean(Range = [2004 2010]);
[gGap, info] = ts.mean(Range = [2015 2021], Estimator = "model");
```

shSeries.climatology

```
[clim, resid] = ts.climatology(Name=Value)
```

Bias/trend/annual/semi-annual (+extra periods) fit. [CLIM, RESID] = ts.climatology(Robust=false, T0=mean(epochs), Periods=[], Weights=[]) CLIM is an shClimatology; RESID the residual shSeries. Periods: extra periodic terms [years] - e.g. the GRACE tidal alias periods [161/365.25, 3.66, 7.48] (S2, K2, K1); without them, trend and semi-annual estimates absorb tidal aliasing. Weights: T x 1 per-epoch weights (e.g. 1./info.vce from the tvANS filter). CLIM carries per-coefficient 1-sigma significance (OLS formula, Mo...

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
Robust	1 x 1	logical	false	(1 x 1) logical Huber re-weighting
T0	1 x 1	double	NaN	(1 x 1) reference epoch; NaN uses the mean
Periods	1 x :	double	double.empty(1,0)	) (1 x K) extra harmonic periods [yr] beyond the built-in annual + semiannual

input	size	type	default	description
Weights	: x 1	double	[]	(T x 1) epoch weights
ARCorrect	1 x 1	logical	false	(1 x 1) AR(1) correction of the sigmas

output	description
clim	(1 x 1) shClimatology fitted bias/trend/annual/semiannual (+Periods=) with coefficient sigmas
resid	(1 x 1) shSeries residual series about the fit

shSeries.trendBreaks

```
out = ts.trendBreaks(Name=Value)
```

Piecewise-linear trends with break significance. OUT = ts.trendBreaks(Breaks=[2016.0], Periods=[], T0=, ARCorrect=false) fits the standard climatology design PLUS hinge terms max(0, t - tb) per break epoch (continuous piecewise-linear trend) to every coefficient, and tests the break's significance with an F-test against the no-break model (p-values via betainc - base MATLAB, no toolbox). Python-validated: 5.1% null rejection at the 5% level; F = 23 for a 0.02/yr break in 0.05-sigma noise (T = 120).

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
Breaks	1 x :	double	required	(1 x B) trend break epochs [decimal years]; omitting it is MATLAB's own missing-argument error, an empty one raises noBreaks
Periods	1 x :	double	double.empty(1,0)	) (1 x K) extra harmonic periods [yr]
T0	1 x 1	double	NaN	(1 x 1) reference epoch; NaN uses the mean
ARCorrect	1 x 1	logical	false	(1 x 1) AR(1) correction of the sigmas

output	description
out	(1,1) struct NOT an shCoefficients - the coefficient matrices are plain (n1 x n1) doubles - fields breaks (1 x B) double the break epochs, as given [decimal years] t0 (1,1) double reference epoch used trend1C, trend1S (n1 x n1) double pre-break rate [units/yr], cosine and sine sigmaTrend1C, sigmaTrend1S (n1 x n1) double their 1-sigma hingeC, hingeS (n1 x n1 x B) double rate CHANGE at each break; the post-break rate is trend1 + cumsum over the hinges sigmaHingeC, sigmaHingeS (n1 x n1 x B) double 1-sigma of the rate changes trendNoBreakC (n1 x n1) double rate of the no-break model, the F-test's null sigmaTrendNoBreakC (n1 x n1) double its 1-sigma F, pValue (n1 x n1) double F statistic and p-value per cosine coefficient FS, pValueS (n1 x n1) double the same for the sine coefficients

shSeries.fan

```
out = ts.fan(rDegKm, rOrdKm)
```

Han fan filter on every epoch (degree x order Gaussian). OUT = ts.fan(RDEG, RORD) - see shLowLevel.shFanFilter.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
rDegKm	1 x 1	double	required	double fan filter degree-direction radius [km]
rOrdKm	1 x 1	double	required	double fan filter order-direction radius [km]

output	description
out	(1 x 1) shSeries fan-filtered per month

shSeries.applyTN14

```
out = ts.applyTN14(tn, Name=Value)
```

Replace C20 (and flagged C30) per month from TN-14. OUT = ts.applyTN14("TN-14.txt") - series-level convenience around shCoefficients.applyTN14 (v2.4.1; the per-month epoch selects the TN entry). All options pass through.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
tn	n x m	—	required	correction-table struct as returned by the matching reader
Tolerance	1 x 1	double	0.05	maximum |epoch difference| [yr] accepted when matching a table entry to this epoch
ReplaceC30	1 x 1	string	"auto"	"auto" (replace when the table has a non-NaN C30 for that month) | "never" | "always"

output	description
out	(1 x 1) shSeries C20/C30 replaced epoch-matched

shSeries.addDegree1

```
out = ts.addDegree1(tn, Name=Value)
```

Insert TN-13 geocenter degree-1 per month. OUT = ts.addDegree1("TN-13.txt") - series-level convenience around shCoefficients.addDegree1 (v2.4.1).

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
tn	n x m	—	required	correction-table struct as returned by the matching reader
Tolerance	1 x 1	double	0.05	maximum |epoch difference| [yr] accepted when matching a table entry to this epoch

output	description
out	(1 x 1) shSeries degree 1 completed epoch-matched

shSeries.removeAlias

```
out = ts.removeAlias(Name=Value)
```

Remove a tidal alias harmonic from every epoch. TS2 = ts.removeAlias() fits, per coefficient, a harmonic at the S2 tidal alias period (161 days) TOGETHER WITH bias, trend, annual and semi-annual, and subtracts only that harmonic. This is the correction GravIS applies to its Level-2B products (https://gravis.gfz.de/corrections): errors in the ocean-tide background model alias into the monthly fields at this period, and leaving them in puts a spurious ~161-day signal into every derived series.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
Period	1 x 1	double	161/365.25	alias period [years]. The default is the S2 alias; the K2 and K1 aliases (3.66 and 7.48 years) are longer than most records and are better handled as climato...
PhaseOffset	1 x 1	double	100	phase offset [degrees] applied to epochs at or after SplitEpoch
SplitEpoch	1 x 1	double	2018.0	mission boundary [decimal year]; the GRACE-FO record starts mid-2018
T0	1 x 1	double	NaN	reference epoch of the fit (NaN: the mean epoch)

output	description
out	(1,1) shSeries copy with the alias harmonic removed from every epoch; the operation is appended to the history

Example

```
    ts = ts.removeAlias();                  % S2, 100 deg offset
    ts = ts.removeAlias(SplitEpoch = 2018.4);
```

shSeries.removeGIA

`[out, info] = ts.removeGIA(gia, Name=Value)`

Subtract a glacial isostatic adjustment model. OUT = ts.removeGIA(GIA, T0=mean(epochs)) subtracts the linear GIA signal giaRate * (t - T0) from every epoch. GIA is an shCoefficients object holding RATE coefficients [1/yr] - read your model (ICE-6G_D, Caron et al., ...) from its gfc file with shCoefficients.read; models are ALWAYS user-supplied, never embedded. Trends computed after this are GIA-corrected. The GIA model is truncated to the series nmax; a model with smaller nmax is zero-padded with a note in his...

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
gia	1 x 1	shCoefficients	required	shCoefficients GIA rate field [1/yr], subtracted as rate times (t - T0); its own epoch is not used
T0	1 x 1	double	NaN	reference epoch of the linear model; the series mean epoch when not given
Sigma	n x m	—	[]	shCoefficients of per-coefficient 1-sigma RATE uncertainties [1/yr]; defaults to gia's own sigmaC/sigmaS

output	description
out	(1 x 1) shSeries GIA trend removed about T0 (the series mean epoch unless T0 is given)
info	(1 x 1) struct what was propagated, fields t0 (1,1) double reference epoch used rateSigmaC (n1 x n1) double rate 1-sigma, cosine rateSigmaS (n1 x n1) double rate 1-sigma, sine propagated (1,1) logical false when no sigma was available and none was added sigmaWasEmpty (1,1) logical the series carried no sigmas, so the stacks hold the GIA term alone correlated (1,1) logical always true - the GIA term is fully correlated across epochs; see the note above

shSeries.applyDDK

`out = ts.applyDDK(W)`

Apply a DDK decorrelation filter to every epoch. OUT = ts.applyDDK(W), W from shLowLevel.readDDK. Sigma stacks are invalidated (NaN) - the filter correlates coefficients.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
W	n x m	—	required	filter container from shLowLevel.readDDK / designFilter, or degree weights

output	description
out	(1 x 1) shSeries DDK-decorrelated per month

shSeries.compare

`[rep, h] = ts.compare(others, varargin)`

Temporal comparison against other series (v2.6.0). REP = ts.compare(TS2) or ts.compare({TS2, TS3, ...}) delegates to shLowLevel.compareSeries with OBJ as the reference; all options pass through (Basin=, Names=, Plot=, ...).

input	size	type	default	description
others	—	—	required	—
varargin	—	—	required	—

output	description
rep	(1,1) struct as returned by shLowLevel.compareSeries, which documents every field

output	description
h	(1 x 1) graphics handle figure (Plot = true)

shSeries.restore

```
out = ts.restore(gax, Name=Value)
```

Add a background (GAA/GAB/GAC/GAD) series, epoch-matched. OUT = ts.restore(GAXSERIES, Tolerance=0.05, AllowMissing=false) Each epoch of OBJ is matched to the nearest GAX epoch within Tolerance [yr]. Missing matches error (or, with AllowMissing=true, leave those epochs unchanged with a note).

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
gax	1 x 1	shSeries	required	shSeries GAX product to add back, epoch-matched; read a folder or file list with shSeries.read first
Tolerance	1 x 1	double	0.05	epoch matching tolerance [yr]
AllowMissing	1 x 1	logical	false	tolerate epochs absent from some centres

output	description
out	(1 x 1) shSeries background model added back epoch-matched (e.g. GSM + GAD)

shSeries.minus

```
out = ts.minus(a, b)
```

Subtract a field (shCoefficients) or an epoch-matched series.

input	size	type	default	description
a	—	—	required	—
b	—	—	required	—

output	description
out	(1 x 1) shSeries per-month difference (series or single field)

shSeries.destripe

```
out = ts.destripe(Name=Value)
```

Swenson & Wahr / P3M6, applied per epoch.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
MinOrder	1 x 1	double	6	lowest order to destripe; coefficients at m < minOrder pass through unchanged (below it the signal is real, not stripes)
PolyOrder	1 x 1	double	3	order of the polynomial fitted and removed per order/parity sequence
WindowLength	n x m	double	[]	[] fits ONE polynomial over the whole sequence; a number L uses a centered moving window of 2*floor(L/2)+1 degrees instead (so 6 and 7 both span 7), widened ...

output	description
out	(1 x 1) shSeries destriped per month

shSeries.gaussian

```
out = ts.gaussian(radiusKm)
```

Jekeli smoothing per epoch (vectorized over the stack).

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
radiusKm	1 x 1	double	required	double Gaussian filter half-response radius [km]

output	description
out	(1 x 1) shSeries Gaussian-smoothed per month

shSeries.truncate

```
out = ts.truncate(nmaxNew)
```

Reduce the maximum degree of the whole series.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
nmaxNew	1 x 1	double	required	double new maximum degree (must not exceed the current nmax)

output	description
out	(1 x 1) shSeries truncated per month

shSeries.dropNaN

```
out = ts.dropNaN()
```

Remove epochs containing any non-finite coefficient. OUT = ts.dropNaN() drops every epoch whose C or S stack has a NaN/Inf anywhere - typically placeholder months across the GRACE / GRACE-FO gap (2017.5-2018.5) or corrupt reads. The remaining series is irregularly sampled, which climatology and the tvANS filter handle natively (least-squares fit on the actual epochs; per-month VCE).

output	description
out	(1 x 1) shSeries gap months removed

shSeries.select

```
out = ts.select(which, Name=Value)
```

Subset the series by index, mask, or time range. OUT = ts.select(WHICH) with WHICH one of logical (1,T) keep masked epochs indices keep listed epochs (in the given order) [tMin tMax] keep epochs with tMin <= t <= tMax

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
which	n x 1	—	[]	logical | double mask, index list, or [tMin tMax]; omit it when passing Range
Range	n x m	—	[]	(1 x 2) double decimal years, or a 1 x 2 datetime; mutually exclusive with WHICH

output	description
out	(1 x 1) shSeries the selected epochs, in the order given; the operation is appended to the history (immutable value-class pattern)

Example

```
    tsFO = ts.select(ts.epochs > 2018.5);
    tsB  = ts.select(Range = [2004 2010]);
```

shSeries.filter

```
[out, op, info] = ts.filter(method, Name=Value)
```

Optimal time-variable filtering of the series. [TSF, OP, INFO] = ts.filter("tvANS", Constraints=..., NoiseCov=..., SignalMode="isotropic"|"inhomogeneous", NIterSignal=3, Robust=false, Nmin=2) runs the tvANS chain (see

shLowLevel.tvANSFilter): deterministic-model separation, empirical or supplied noise covariance, monthly VCE scaling, data-driven signal covariance, per-month anisotropic Wiener filter, optional hard constraints. OP is the stored linear operator - required for basinAverage(..., Deconvolve=true) and...

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
method	1 x 1	string	required	string filter chain to run; currently "tvANS" (the simple filters are their own methods: gaussian / fan / destripe / applyDDK)
NoiseCov	n x m	double	[]	(P x P) double full noise covariance (e.g. a released one); [] uses the empirical per-order/parity covariance
Constraints	n x 1	double	[]	(P x q) double hard linear constraint kernels, one column per constraint; [] none
SignalMode	1 x 1	string	"isotropic"	"isotropic" | "inhomogeneous" signal covariance model (see shLowLevel.buildSignalCov)
NIterSignal	1 x 1	double	3	(1 x 1) signal-covariance re-estimation iterations
Robust	1 x 1	logical	false	(1 x 1) logical, Huber re-weighting of epoch residuals
Nmin	1 x 1	double	2	(1 x 1) lowest degree entering the filter
Blocks	1 x 1	string ∈ ["auto","on","off"]	"auto"	("auto" | "on" | "off") order-block usage in the normal matrix
Shrinkage	1 x 1	double	[]	(1 x 1) shrinkage of the empirical NOISE covariance; [] keeps the tvANSFilter default, 0.1
VCEMinDegree	1 x 1	double	[]	(1 x 1) first degree entering the VCE; [] keeps the tvANSFilter default, round(2/3*Lmax)
VCEBands	1 x :	double	[]	(1 x B) order-band edges for per-band monthly VCE factors (block path only); [] no banding

output	description
out	(1 x 1) shSeries tvANS-filtered series with sigmaCs/Ss posterior stacks (exact incl. constraints, v2.5)
op	(1,1) struct the stored linear operator, as returned by shLowLevel.tvANSFilter, for shLowLevel.basinDeconvolve and shLowLevel.resolutionMap
info	(1,1) struct the noise, signal and VCE diagnostics, as returned by shLowLevel.tvANSFilter

shSeries.basinAverage

```
[avg, out] = ts.basinAverage(B, Name=Value)
```

Basin averages, naive or exactly deconvolved. AVG = ts.basinAverage(B) - naive averages B'*x ./ diag(B'*B), K x T, with B (P x K) basin kernels in shLowLevel.shIndex ordering (build from a grid mask via shLowLevel.synthesisMatrix: b = Y' * (w .* mask)). [AVG, OUT] = ts.basinAverage(B, Deconvolve=true, Op=op) removes filter attenuation and inter-basin leakage exactly using the stored operator from ts.filter (see shLowLevel.basinDeconvolve). OUT.sigma (K x T) is the 1-sigma noise uncertainty of AVG propagated thro...

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
B	n x m	double	required	basin-kernel coefficient vector from basinKernel
Deconvolve	1 x 1	logical	false	apply shLowLevel.basinDeconvolve to the basin series (undo kernel attenuation)
Op	n x m	struct	struct()	) the filter operator from ts.filter("tvANS", ...), required by Deconvolve = true
Ridge	1 x 1	double	0	Tikhonov ridge added to the deconvolution normal matrix; raise it when the kernel matrix is ill-conditioned (out.condA reports the condition number)

output	description
avg	(K x T) double basin averages (deconvolved when Deconvolve=true)
out	(1,1) struct on the deconvolution path, as returned by shLowLevel.basinDeconvolve (sigma, c, attn, condA, avgNaive); otherwise struct(), a 1 x 1 struct with no fields

shSeries.toGrid

```
b = ts.toGrid(latDeg, lonDeg, Name=Value)
```

Synthesize every epoch into one stack, with its metadata. B = ts.toGrid(LAT, LON, Quantity=..., kn=..., LatType=...) is shCoefficients.toGrid over a whole series: B.Z is (nlat x nlon x nEpochs) and B.Epoch carries the decimal years, so an animation can label its own frames from the data rather than from a filename.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
latDeg	1 x :	double	required	double latitudes [deg], convention per LatType
lonDeg	1 x :	double	required	double longitudes [deg]
Quantity	1 x 1	string	"ewh"	any kernelFactors quantity
kn	n x m	double	[]	load Love numbers k'_n (mass quantities; never hardcoded)
hn	n x m	double	[]	load Love numbers h'_n (deformation_up only)
Nmin	1 x 1	double	0	degrees below nmin are zeroed
Nmax	1 x 1	double	NaN	truncation degree; NaN uses the series nmax
Height	1 x 1	double	0	evaluation height [m] above the evaluation surface
rho_ave	1 x 1	double	5517	mean Earth density [kg/m^3]
rho_water	1 x 1	double	1000	water density [kg/m^3]
LatType	1 x 1	string ∈ ["geocentric", "geodetic"]	"geodetic"	"geodetic" | "geocentric"
Flattening	1 x 1	double	1/298.257223563	ellipsoid flattening (WGS84), for LatType and for Surface = "ellipsoid"
Surface	1 x 1	string ∈ ["sphere","ellipsoid"]	"sphere"	"sphere" | "ellipsoid", as g.synthesis
SemiMajorAxis	1 x 1	double	6378137	ellipsoid semi-major axis [m], WGS84
MaxMemGB	1 x 1	double	4	budget for the STACK itself; exceeding it is an error naming the size, not a silent swap-thrash

output	description
b	(1,1) struct as built by shLowLevel.gridHandover, the same bundle shCoefficients.toGrid returns, with Z (nlat x nlon x nEpochs) double, Epoch and C00 (nEpochs x 1) double, and FieldKind "mixed" when the epochs disagree

Example

```
    b = ts.toGrid(-89.5:89.5, 0.5:359.5, Quantity = "ewh", kn = kn);
    size(b.Z)        % [180 360 nEpochs]
```

shSeries.kalman

```
[out, rep] = ts.kalman(Name=Value)
```

Kalman-smoothed series (Kurtenbach/Kvas), solution mode. [TSK, REP] = ts.kalman(ModelSeries = TSM) runs shLowLevel.kalmanChain with TS as the observations: the VAR process model is estimated from TSM, every epoch of TS is one observation weighted by its formal sigmas (or NoiseCov), and a forward Kalman filter plus an RTS smoother return the smoothed series. shLowLevel.kalmanChain documents the chain, its references and its memory cost.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
ModelSeries	required	—	required	(1 x 1) shSeries process realization at this series' nmax, e.g. GAX/AOD1B or a hydrology model
Order	lane default	—	required	VAR order p
Structure	lane default	—	required	coupling structure of the VAR model
Shrink	lane default	—	required	diagonal loading of the VAR estimate
CondFun	lane default	—	required	covariance conditioning
Epochs	lane default	—	required	target epoch grid [decimal years]
Tolerance	lane default	—	required	epoch matching tolerance [yr]
NoiseCov	lane default	—	required	observation noise covariance
Climatology	lane default	—	required	reduce the series by its own climatology around the filter, and restore it after
FitClimatology	lane default	—	required	"observations" | "filtered": fit that climatology to the series or to a first filter pass (A34)
Smoother	lane default	—	required	run the RTS pass
QC	lane default	—	required	innovation-based quality control
QCAlpha	lane default	—	required	false-alarm level of that test
StoreCov	lane default	—	required	where the smoother's covariances live

output	description
out	(1 x 1) shSeries smoothed series on the epoch grid, with formal 1-sigma stacks
rep	(1,1) struct as returned by shLowLevel.kalmanChain, which documents every field

Example

```
    [tsk, rep] = ts.kalman(ModelSeries = tsm, Order = 1);
```

shSeries.eof

`[modes, pcs, varExplained, info] = ts.eof(Name=Value)`

Empirical orthogonal functions of the series. [MODES, PCS, VE, INFO] = ts.eof() decomposes the series into spatial modes and unit-variance principal components by an SVD of the time-centred coefficient stack - shLowLevel.eofAnalysis, which documents the scaling: MODES{k} times PCS(:,k) reconstructs mode k's contribution exactly. It is usually run on a residual, after ts.climatology. The options go to shLowLevel.eofAnalysis only when given; "(lane default)" is that function's.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
NModes	lane default	—	required	number of modes returned
Center	lane default	—	required	remove the temporal mean first

output	description
modes	(1 x K) cell shCoefficients, the spatial patterns
pcs	(T x K) double principal components, unit variance
varExplained	(K x 1) double fraction of the variance per mode
info	(1,1) struct as returned by shLowLevel.eofAnalysis, which documents every field

Example

```
    [~, resid] = ts.climatology();
    [modes, pcs, ve] = resid.eof(NModes = 3);
```

shSeries.write

`ts.write(folder, Name=Value)`

Export every epoch to its own ICGEM .gfc file. ts.write(FOLDER) writes epoch k with g.write, through ts.at(k), so each file is what g.write writes for that epoch. The files are named after the series' names: NAMES(k) + ".gfc", unless FileNames says otherwise.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
folder	1 x 1	string	required	string existing folder to write into
FileNames	: x 1	string	string.empty(0, 1)	) (T x 1) string one file name per epoch, relative to FOLDER; empty uses NAMES + ".gfc"
Comment	1 x 1	string	""	forwarded to g.write
Sidecar	1 x 1	logical	false	forwarded to g.write. Deliberately false here, where g.write defaults to true: a folder of epochs is meant to be read back as a series, and the default read ...

Example

```
    ts.write(outFolder, FileNames = "GSM-2_" + spans + "_mine.gfc");
```

shSeries.gradient

`[dq, info] = ts.gradient(latDeg, lonDeg, Name=Value)`

North/east/up gradient of every epoch, stacked. [DQ, INFO] = ts.gradient(LAT, LON, ...) is g.gradient of each epoch g = ts.at(k), with DQ.north, DQ.east and DQ.up stacked along the THIRD dimension, page k for epoch k, as ts.toGrid stacks its fields: (nlat x nlon x T) on a grid and (npts x 1 x T) for Mode = "points". DQ.up stays [] for the surface quantities, which have no radial law. INFO is the first epoch's; it depends only on the options, which every epoch shares. The options go to g.gradient only when given,...

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
latDeg	1 x :	double	required	double latitudes [deg]
lonDeg	1 x :	double	required	double longitudes [deg]
Quantity	method default	—	required	any kernelFactors quantity
kn	method default	—	required	load Love numbers k'_n
hn	method default	—	required	load Love numbers h'_n
Nmin	method default	—	required	degrees below Nmin are zeroed
Nmax	method default	—	required	truncation degree

input	size	type	default	description
Height	method default	—	required	evaluation height [m]
Surface	method default	—	required	"sphere" or "ellipsoid"
SemiMajorAxis	method default	—	required	ellipsoid semi-major axis [m]
rho_ave	method default	—	required	mean Earth density [kg/m^3]
rho_water	method default	—	required	water density [kg/m^3]
Mode	method default	—	required	a grid, or pairwise points
Units	method default	—	required	per metre or per radian
MaxMemGB	method default	—	required	Legendre memory budget [GB]
LatType	method default	—	required	how the latitudes are read
Flattening	method default	—	required	ellipsoid flattening

output	description
dq	(1,1) struct as returned by shCoefficients.gradient, which documents every field, each component stacked along the third dimension
info	(1,1) struct as returned by shCoefficients.gradient for the first epoch, which documents every field

Example

```
[dq, info] = ts.gradient(-89:2:89, 0:2:358, Quantity = "ewh", kn = kn);
size(dq.north)        % 90 x 180 x T
```

shSeries.leakageCorrect

`[mCorr, info] = ts.leakageCorrect(latDeg, lonDeg, Name=Value)`

Forward-model leakage correction of every epoch. [M, INFO] = ts.leakageCorrect(LAT, LON, Filter = F, kn = KN) synthesizes each epoch on the grid (g.synthesis, geocentric, Quantity "ewh" unless told otherwise) and runs shLowLevel.leakageCorrect on it with the series' GM and R: the iterative forward model that finds the field which, pushed through the chain the data saw, reproduces the filtered field. M is the corrected stack, page k for epoch k. shLowLevel.leakageCorrect documents the method, its stopping rule, a...

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
latDeg	1 x :	double	required	double geocentric latitudes [deg]
lonDeg	1 x :	double	required	double longitudes [deg]
Filter	required	—	required	the filter the DATA saw: a string such as "gauss300" or "DDK3", or a W struct
Quantity	1 x 1	string	"ewh"	the synthesized quantity; its unit is M's
kn	n x m	double	[]	load Love numbers for the mass quantities (never hardcoded)
Mask	lane default	—	required	pixels allowed to hold mass
Nmax	lane default	—	required	degree of the intermediate analysis

input	size	type	default	description
Gain	lane default	—	required	relaxation factor
NoiseLevel	lane default	—	required	noise RMS of the field
ResidualRegion	lane default	—	required	where the residual is measured
Tau	lane default	—	required	discrepancy-principle safety factor
MaxIter	lane default	—	required	iteration cap
Tol	lane default	—	required	fallback step criterion
Quiet	lane default	—	required	suppress the per-epoch summary

output	description
mCorr	(nLat x nLon x T) double corrected fields, in the unit of Quantity
info	(1 x T) struct one per epoch, as returned by shLowLevel.leakageCorrect, which documents every field

Example

```
    [m, info] = ts.leakageCorrect(-89:89, 0:359, Filter = "gauss300", ...
        kn = kn, Mask = unionMask, Quiet = true);
```

shSeries.leakageDataDriven

`[fHat, info] = ts.leakageDataDriven(latDeg, lonDeg, Name=Value)`

Model-free leakage correction of a catchment mean. [FHAT, INFO] = ts.leakageDataDriven(LAT, LON, Mask = R, Filter = F, kn = KN) synthesizes every epoch on the grid (g.synthesis, geocentric, Quantity "ewh" unless told otherwise) and runs shLowLevel.leakageDataDriven on the stack with the series' GM and R - Vishwakarma's method of deviation, or with Method = "scale" the method of scale; both repair the catchment average from the filtered fields alone. FHAT is the corrected catchment mean, one value per epoch. shLo...

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
latDeg	1 x :	double	required	double geocentric latitudes [deg]
lonDeg	1 x :	double	required	double longitudes [deg]
Filter	required	—	required	the filter the DATA saw: a string such as "gauss300" or "DDK3", or a W struct
Quantity	1 x 1	string	"ewh"	the synthesized quantity; its unit is FHAT's
kn	n x m	double	[]	load Love numbers for the mass quantities (never hardcoded)
Mask	lane default	—	required	the catchment function, 1 inside and 0 outside; required in practice
Nmax	lane default	—	required	degree of the analysis/synthesis chain
Method	lane default	—	required	the method of deviation, or of scale

output	description
fHat	(T x 1) double corrected catchment average, in the unit of Quantity
info	(1,1) struct as returned by shLowLevel.leakageDataDriven, which documents every field

Example

```
    [f, info] = ts.leakageDataDriven(lat, lon, Mask = basin, ...
        Filter = "gauss300", kn = kn);
```

shSeries.poleTideConvert

`out = ts.poleTideConvert(Name=Value)`

Move every epoch's C21/S21 to another mean pole. OUT = ts.poleTideConvert(From = "IERS2010", To = "IERS2018") applies shLowLevel.poleTideConvert to each epoch at its own epoch, in the raw (C, S, EPOCH) form, so the series keeps its names, its sigmas and its history. That function documents the two models and the adjustment.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
From	lane default	—	required	the convention of this series
To	lane default	—	required	the convention to move to
Mode	lane default	—	required	the solid tide, the ocean tide, or both
SolidCoef	lane default	—	required	the solid-tide coefficient
OceanCoef	lane default	—	required	the ocean-tide coefficient

output	description
out	(1,1) shSeries the converted series, history appended

Example

```
    ts18 = ts.poleTideConvert(From = "IERS2010", To = "IERS2018");
```

shSeries.estimateDegree1

`[d1, info] = ts.estimateDegree1(ocean, Name=Value)`

Geocentre coefficients of every epoch, from the series. [D1, INFO] = ts.estimateDegree1(OCEAN, kn = KN) is shLowLevel.estimateDegree1(ts, OCEAN, ...): C10, C11 and S11 for every epoch by the method of Swenson, Chambers & Wahr (2008). That function documents the method, its grid and its outputs; D1 drops straight into ts.addDegree1.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
ocean	n x m	—	required	logical the ocean mask on the LatDeg x LonDeg grid
kn	lane default	—	required	load Love numbers, which the method needs
OceanModel	lane default	—	required	an ocean-bottom-pressure model grid
LatDeg	lane default	—	required	latitudes of the working grid
LonDeg	lane default	—	required	longitudes of the working grid
Nmax	lane default	—	required	degree of the analysis

output	description
d1	(1,1) struct as returned by shLowLevel.estimateDegree1, which documents every field

output	description
info	(1,1) struct as returned by shLowLevel.estimateDegree1, which documents every field

Example

```
    d1 = ts.estimateDegree1(ocean, kn = kn);
    ts = ts.addDegree1(d1);
```

shSeries.combineCenters

`[tsComb, info] = ts.combineCenters(others, Name=Value)`

Combine this series with other centres' by VCE. [TSCOMB, INFO] = ts.combineCenters({TSB, TSC}) is shLowLevel.combineCenters({ts, TSB, TSC}): one variance factor per centre and month, by variance-component estimation, on the epochs of this series. That function documents the method and what its posterior sigmas can and cannot claim.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
others	1 x :	cell	required	cell the other centres' series, same nmax
Tolerance	lane default	—	required	epoch matching [yr]
AllowMissing	lane default	—	required	combine months some centres lack
Robust	lane default	—	required	the median variance factor per month
MaxIter	lane default	—	required	the most VCE iterations
Tol	lane default	—	required	the VCE convergence tolerance

output	description
tsComb	(1,1) shSeries the combined series
info	(1,1) struct as returned by shLowLevel.combineCenters, which documents every field

Example

```
    [ts, info] = tsITSG.combineCenters({tsCSR, tsGFZ});
```

shSeries.slepianProject

`[a, rec] = ts.slepianProject(G, idx)`

Project every epoch onto a Slepian basis, and back. [A, REC] = ts.slepianProject(G, IDX) is shLowLevel.slepianProject(ts.Cs, ts.Ss, G, IDX), with the tapers G and the index IDX of shLowLevel.slepianBasis: A holds one column of Slepian coefficients per epoch, the regional modes in time, and REC the series rebuilt from them.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
G	P x K	—	required	double Slepian tapers, from shLowLevel.slepianBasis
idx	1 x 1	—	required	struct the coefficient index they are ordered by

output	description
a	(K,T) double the Slepian coefficients per epoch
rec	(1,1) struct as returned by shLowLevel.slepianProject, which documents every field

Example

```
G = shLowLevel.slepianBasis(idx, @(la, lo) double(la > 60));
a = ts.slepianProject(G, idx);
```

shSeries.regionalBasis

`B = ts.regionalBasis(region, Name=Value)`

A local basis for a region, at this series's degree. B = ts.regionalBasis(REGION) is shLowLevel.regionalBasis(shLowLevel.shIndex(ts.nmax), REGION): radial basis functions, Slepian tapers or the SH basis for a basin or region, built for the degree this series carries, so that ts.regionalProject(B) cannot meet an index of another size. That function documents the bases and the projector.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
region	n x m	—	[]	basin name, handle, polygon or mask, as shLowLevel.regionalBasis takes it ([] for Type "sh")
Nmin	shIndex default	—	required	first degree of the index
Type	lane default	—	required	"rbf" | "slepian" | "sh"
BufferKm	lane default	—	required	growth of the region [km]
Grid	lane default	—	required	"icosahedral" | "reuter"
Level	lane default	—	required	rbf grid level
Kernel	lane default	—	required	"kaula" | "shannon" | "amplitude"
DegreeAmplitude	lane default	—	required	sigma_n for Kernel "amplitude"
Threshold	lane default	—	required	slepian concentration cut
NKeep	lane default	—	required	slepian taper count
EigTol	lane default	—	required	rbf projector eigenvalue cut
R	lane default	—	required	sphere radius [m]
OverSample	lane default	—	required	mask quadrature refinement
BasinFile	lane default	—	required	GeoJSON for a basin name

output	description
B	(1,1) struct the basis, as returned by shLowLevel.regionalBasis, which documents every field

Example

```
B = ts.regionalBasis("Elbe", Type = "slepian");
a = ts.regionalProject(B);
```

shSeries.regionalProject

`[a, rec] = ts.regionalProject(B)`

Every epoch in a regional basis, and back. [A, REC] = ts.regionalProject(B) is shLowLevel.regionalProject(ts.Cs, ts.Ss, B): A holds the coefficients in the basis B of ts.regionalBasis per epoch, REC the series rebuilt from them.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
B	1 x 1	struct	required	struct a basis from regionalBasis

output	description
a	(K,T) double basis coefficients
rec	(1,1) struct as returned by shLowLevel.regionalProject, which documents every field

Example

```
    B = ts.regionalBasis("Elbe");
    [a, rec] = ts.regionalProject(B);
```

shSeries.regionalProcessModel

`[model, info] = ts.regionalProcessModel(B, Name=Value)`

Kurtenbach's process model of this series in a basis. [MODEL, INFO] = ts.regionalProcessModel(B) is shLowLevel.regionalProcessModel(ts, B): the climatology of this model series is removed, every epoch projected onto the basis B of ts.regionalBasis, and the VAR process model of Kurtenbach (2012) estimated from the basis coefficients. That function documents the method and its two adjustments (QScale, the alpha of his eq. 4.8, and GroundNoise).

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
B	1 x 1	struct	required	struct a basis from regionalBasis
Order	lane default	—	required	VAR order
Shrink	lane default	—	required	diagonal loading
Structure	lane default	—	required	"full" | "diagonal"
CondFun	lane default	—	required	covariance conditioning
Climatology	lane default	—	required	remove the climatology first
QScale	lane default	—	required	Kurtenbach's alpha
GroundNoise	lane default	—	required	isotropic ground noise [m EWH]
kn	lane default	—	required	load Love numbers, for GroundNoise

output	description
model	(1,1) struct as returned by shLowLevel.regionalProcessModel, which documents every field
info	(1,1) struct as returned by shLowLevel.regionalProcessModel, which documents every field

Example

```
    B = tsModel.regionalBasis("Elbe");
    [model, info] = tsModel.regionalProcessModel(B, QScale = 10);
```

shSeries.regionalKalman

`[tsK, out] = ts.regionalKalman(B, Name=Value)`

The regional Kalman filter on this series, in a basis. [TSK, OUT] = ts.regionalKalman(B, ModelSeries = TSM) is shLowLevel.regionalKalman(ts, B, ModelSeries = TSM): this series' coefficients and sigmas are the observations,

the process model is estimated from TSM in the basis B of ts.regionalBasis, and the filter and RTS smoother run on the basis coefficients. TSK is the smoothed series T a with sigmas through T; OUT carries the basis coefficients and, with kn, the EWH grid of the region and its basin mean with s...

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
B	1 x 1	struct	required	struct a basis from regionalBasis
ModelSeries	required	—	required	the model series of the process
Order	lane default	—	required	VAR order
Shrink	lane default	—	required	diagonal loading
Structure	lane default	—	required	"full" | "diagonal"
CondFun	lane default	—	required	covariance conditioning
QScale	lane default	—	required	Kurtenbach's alpha, one per block
QBlocks	lane default	—	required	block label of every basis coefficient
EstimateQScale	lane default	—	required	estimate the alphas by maximum likelihood of the innovations
GroundNoise	lane default	—	required	isotropic ground noise [m EWH]
kn	lane default	—	required	load Love numbers, for the EWH outputs
Epochs	lane default	—	required	target epoch grid
Tolerance	lane default	—	required	epoch matching tolerance [yr]
NoiseCov	lane default	—	required	noise covariance of the series
Climatology	lane default	—	required	remove and restore it
FitClimatology	lane default	—	required	"observations" | "filtered": fit it to the series or to a first filter pass (A34)
Lag	lane default	—	required	smoothing lag in epochs
QC	lane default	—	required	innovation quality control
QCAlpha	lane default	—	required	its false-alarm level
StoreCov	lane default	—	required	"full" | "matfile"
Background	lane default	—	required	global background series, removed from the observations and restored (remove-compute-restore)

output	description
tsK	(1,1) shSeries the smoothed series T a
out	(1,1) struct as returned by shLowLevel.regionalKalman, which documents every field

Example

```
B = ts.regionalBasis("Elbe", Type = "slepian", Threshold = 0.5);
[tsK, out] = ts.regionalKalman(B, ModelSeries = tsm, kn = kn);
[tsK, out] = ts.regionalKalman(B, ModelSeries = tsm, kn = kn, ...
    Background = tsHydrologyModel);
[tsK, out] = ts.regionalKalman(B, ModelSeries = tsm, ...
    EstimateQScale = true);          % alpha from the data
```

shSeries.basinKernel

`[b, info] = ts.basinKernel(region, Name=Value)`

A basin kernel in the index basinAverage reads. [B, INFO] = ts.basinKernel(REGION) is shLowLevel.basinKernel(shLowLevel.shIndex(ts.nmax), REGION): the band-limited indicator of REGION in the ordering ts.basinAverage and g.basinAverage require, so a kernel built here cannot meet them in another. That function documents the quadrature, the buffer and the taper.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
region	n x m	—	required	handle f(latDeg, lonDeg), K x 2 polygon [lat lon] or mask, as shLowLevel.basinKernel takes it
BufferKm	lane default	—	required	growth (> 0) or shrinkage of the region [km]
TaperKm	lane default	—	required	Gaussian taper radius [km]
R	lane default	—	required	sphere radius for the km conversions [m]
OverSample	lane default	—	required	quadrature refinement factor

output	description
b	(P,1) double the kernel in shLowLevel.shIndex(ts.nmax) ordering
info	(1,1) struct as returned by shLowLevel.basinKernel, which documents every field

Example

```
b = ts.basinKernel([-10 100; -10 140; 25 140; 25 100]);
avg = ts.basinAverage(b);
```

shSeries.sensitivityKernel

`[k, info] = ts.sensitivityKernel(region, Name=Value)`

A tailored basin kernel in basinAverage's index. [K, INFO] = ts.sensitivityKernel(REGION) is shLowLevel.sensitivityKernel(shLowLevel.shIndex(ts.nmax), REGION): the Swenson-Wahr kernel that trades leakage against noise, in the ordering ts.basinAverage and g.basinAverage require. That function documents the trade-off, Alpha and INFO. Noise and FarField, when given, are in the same shLowLevel.shIndex(ts.nmax) ordering.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
region	n x m	—	required	handle f(latDeg, lonDeg), K x 2 polygon [lat lon] or mask, as shLowLevel.sensitivityKernel takes it
Alpha	lane default	—	required	weight of the noise against the leakage
Noise	lane default	—	required	error covariance or sigmas, in index ordering
FarField	lane default	—	required	per-coefficient far-field weight
BufferKm	lane default	—	required	growth of the region [km]

input	size	type	default	description
TaperKm	lane default	—	required	Gaussian taper radius [km]
R	lane default	—	required	sphere radius for the km conversions [m]
OverSample	lane default	—	required	quadrature refinement factor

output	description
k	(P,1) double the kernel in shLowLevel.shIndex(ts.nmax) ordering
info	(1,1) struct as returned by shLowLevel.sensitivityKernel, which documents every field

Example

```
k = ts.sensitivityKernel([-10 100; -10 140; 25 140; 25 100], ...
    Alpha = 1);
avg = ts.basinAverage(k);
```

shSeries.signalVarianceKaula

`[ab, info] = ts.signalVarianceKaula(Name=Value)`

The VDK signal model of this series. [AB, INFO] = ts.signalVarianceKaula() is shLowLevel.signalVarianceKaula(ts.Cs, ts.Ss, ts.epochs): the Kaula-type signal sigma a * l^b per calendar month, the input g.vdkApply takes as SIGM. Feed a pre-filtered series; that function documents why, and the bias correction.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
LRange	lane default	—	required	(1 x 2) degree range of the fit

output	description
ab	(12 x 2) double [a, b] per calendar month, January first
info	(1,1) struct as returned by shLowLevel.signalVarianceKaula, which documents every field

Example

```
ab = ts.applyDDK(W4).signalVarianceKaula();
gf = ts.at(k).vdkApply(N, ab(mo, :), Index = idx);
```

shSeries.basinScaling

`[k, info] = ts.basinScaling(op, b, Name=Value)`

Basin scaling factor, with this series as the model. [K, INFO] = tsModel.basinScaling(OP, B) is shLowLevel.basinScaling(OP, B, tsModel): the series is pushed through the operator OP that filtered the data, and the true basin average is regressed on the filtered one. That function documents the operator forms, the epoch matching and INFO.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
op	n x m	—	required	tvANS struct, (P x P) matrix in Idx ordering or handle @(x, t), as shLowLevel.basinScaling takes it
b	P x 1	—	required	double basin kernel in the operator's ordering
Idx	lane default	—	required	shLowLevel.shIndex struct of a matrix or handle operator

input	size	type	default	description
TYears	lane default	—	required	data epochs of a matrix or handle operator
PerMonth	lane default	—	required	also return monthly factors

output	description
k	(1,1) double the scaling factor
info	(1,1) struct as returned by shLowLevel.basinScaling, which documents every field

Example

```
    [k, info] = tsModel.basinScaling(W, b, Idx = idx, TYears = ep);
```

shSeries.buildCondFun

`[f, info] = ts.buildCondFun(Name=Value)`

The CondFun conditioner for this series' index. [F, INFO] = tsModel.buildCondFun(kn = KN) is shLowLevel.buildCondFun(shLowLevel.shIndex(tsModel.nmax), kn = KN, GM = tsModel.GM, R = tsModel.R): Kvas' covariance conditioning in the EWH domain, in the index ts.kalman and ts.regionalKalman build their process model on. Call it on the MODEL series and pass F as CondFun. That function documents the conditioner and INFO.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
kn	required by the lane	—	required	load Love numbers, degrees 0..nmax
Psi0Km	lane default	—	required	correlation length of the taper [km]
Regions	lane default	—	required	region assignment for the block mask
NLat	lane default	—	required	Gauss-Legendre rings of the grid
NLon	lane default	—	required	longitudes of the grid
Basis	lane default	—	required	a regional basis, for basis covariances

output	description
f	function handle the conditioner, C -> conditioned C
info	(1,1) struct as returned by shLowLevel.buildCondFun, which documents every field

Example

```
    cf = tsModel.buildCondFun(kn = kn, Psi0Km = 2000);
    tsK = tsObs.kalman(ModelSeries = tsModel, CondFun = cf);
```

shSeries.bridgeGaps

`[out, info] = ts.bridgeGaps(bridge, Name=Value)`

Fill the months this series lacks from a second series. [OUT, INFO] = ts.bridgeGaps(TSB) is shLowLevel.bridgeGaps(ts, TSB): it fills every month ts lacks within its span from the series TSB, calibrated on the months both have - an offset, a per-degree scale and a per-degree sigma - and names each filled month "bridge:" plus its name in TSB. Both series are truncated to the lower nmax and smoothed with a 750 km Gaussian unless told otherwise; shLowLevel.bridgeGaps documents the method, what it was measured to do ...

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
bridge	1 x 1	—	required	shSeries the series that fills the gaps
RadiusKm	lane default	—	required	Gaussian radius [km]; 0 for none
Tolerance	lane default	—	required	month matching [yr]
MinOverlap	lane default	—	required	the fewest matched months accepted

output	description
out	(1,1) shSeries this series' months and the filled ones
info	(1,1) struct as returned by shLowLevel.bridgeGaps, which documents every field

Example

```
    ts = ts.applyTN14(tnFile);
    [tsF, info] = ts.bridgeGaps(hlsst);
```

shSeries.excitation

`[tbl, info] = ts.excitation(Name=Value)`

Earth-rotation excitation of the series' degree-2 terms. [TBL, INFO] = ts.excitation(Earth = E, kn = KN) runs shLowLevel.rotationExcitation on the series' C21 and S21 - Chen & Wilson (2003) eq. (1) solved for the excitation - and returns one row per epoch: t [yr], chi1 and chi2 [mas]. shLowLevel.rotationExcitation documents the equation, the frame of chi2 (towards 90 E, not the IERS pole's 90 W) and the Earth's constants (IERS 2010 unless given).

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
Earth	lane default	—	required	"IERS2010", or a struct with the Earth's M, R, C and A; see shLowLevel.rotationExcitation
kn	required	—	required	load Love numbers; kn(3) is k2'
TN14	n x m	—	[]	a TN-14 file name or a shLowLevel.readTN14 struct; gives chi3
Tolerance	applyTN14 default	—	required	epoch matching for TN14 [yr]
Reference	lane default	—	required	remove the series mean, or not
PolarFactor	lane default	—	required	the 1.098 of eq. (1)
AxialFactor	lane default	—	required	the 0.753 of eq. (1)
Omega	lane default	—	required	the Earth's mean angular velocity

output	description
tbl	table one row per epoch: t [yr], chi1 and chi2 [mas], and chi3 (dimensionless) and dLOD [ms] when TN14 is given
info	(1,1) struct as returned by shLowLevel.rotationExcitation, which documents every field

Example

```
    tbl = ts.excitation(kn = kn, TN14 = tnFile);
```

shSeries.disp

`ts.disp()`

Compact display: product, epochs, nmax, span, history. disp(TS) prints the product type, the number of epochs, the maximum degree and the covered epoch range, followed by the processing history. Called automatically when an shSeries object is shown without a semicolon.

Example

```
    ts = shSeries.read("ITSG-Grace2018_n60_*.gfc");
    disp(ts)
```

shSeries.read (static)

`obj = shSeries.read(files, Name=Value)`

Read a series of gfc files (pattern or list), sorted by epoch. TS = shSeries.read("GSM-2_*.gfc") or shSeries.read(fileList).

input	size	type	default	description
files	n x m	—	required	glob pattern (containing * or ?) or string array of .gfc file paths; for a folder use shSeries.fromFolder
Truncate	1 x 1	double	NaN	truncate every field to this nmax while reading (NaN: keep the file resolution)

output	description
obj	(1 x 1) shSeries wildcard-read, epoch-sorted stack

shSeries.fromFolder (static)

`obj = shSeries.fromFolder(folder, Name=Value)`

Read every matching gfc file in a folder as a series. TS = shSeries.fromFolder(FOLDER) TS = shSeries.fromFolder(dest, Pattern="*n96*.gfc*", Truncate=60) Convenience wrapper around shSeries.read (sorted by epoch); pairs with shLowLevel.fetchITSG, which downloads ITSG monthly solutions into <dataFolder>/series/itsg/monthly on demand.

input	size	type	default	description
folder	1 x 1	string	required	folder path
Pattern	1 x 1	string	"*.gfc*"	file pattern inside FOLDER
Truncate	1 x 1	double	NaN	truncate every field to this degree; NaN keeps the files' degree

output	description
obj	(1 x 1) shSeries all gfc(.gz) files of a folder, epoch-sorted

shClimatology class

Deterministic climatology of an SH series. Bias + trend + annual + semi-annual model per Stokes coefficient, as fitted by shSeries.climatology (least squares or Huber-robust): x(t) = bias + trend*(t-t0) + cosA*cos(2*pi*(t-t0)) + sinA*sin(...) + cosSA*cos(4*pi*(t-t0)) + sinSA*sin(4*pi*(t-t0)) + sum_k extra cos/sin terms of period p_k (v2.1) All phases and the bias refer to the reference epoch t0. Extra periods (Periods= option) typically hold the GRACE tidal alias terms S2 (161 d), K2 (3.66 yr), K1 (7.48 yr); access them via periodic(k). Per-coefficient 1-sigma significance from the fit is sto

property	size	type	default	notes
t0	1 x 1	double	NaN	
GM	1 x 1	double	3.986004415e14	
R	1 x 1	double	6378136.3	
biasC	—	double	—	

property	size	type	default	notes
biasS	—	double	—	
trendC	—	double	—	
trendS	—	double	—	
cosAnnC	—	double	—	
cosAnnS	—	double	—	
sinAnnC	—	double	—	
sinAnnS	—	double	—	
cosSemiC	—	double	—	
cosSemiS	—	double	—	
sinSemiC	—	double	—	
sinSemiS	—	double	—	
periods	1 x :	double	double.empty(1,0)	extra periods [yr] (v2.1)
extraCosC	—	double	[]	n1 x n1 x K stacks for the extra periods
extraCosS	—	double	[]	
extraSinC	—	double	[]	
extraSinS	—	double	[]	
coefSigma	—	double	[]	(6+2K) x 2*Nc per-coefficient 1-sigma (v2.1)
history	—	string	string.empty(0,1)	
nmax	—	—	—	

shClimatology.withNote

```
obj = clim.withNote(txt)
```

Append a provenance note to the history (v2.2). OBJ = clim.withNote(TXT) - the only supported way to annotate from outside the class (history is SetAccess=private).

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
txt	n x m	—	required	free-text provenance note appended to the history

output	description
obj	(1 x 1) shClimatology copy with the note appended to its history

shClimatology.removeGIA

```
out = clim.removeGIA(gia)
```

Subtract a GIA rate model from the fitted trend. OUT = clim.removeGIA(GIA): GIA is an shCoefficients holding RATE coefficients [1/yr] (user-supplied model file via shCoefficients.read). Only trendC/trendS change; trend sigmas are kept - the model is treated as exact here. To carry a GIA model's own sigma, correct the series before the fit with ts.removeGIA(GIA, Sigma = SIG) (v5.2.0), or add its rate sigma to the trend sigma. GIA model spread often dominates regional trend error budgets - compare several models.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
gia	1 x 1	shCoefficients	required	shCoefficients GIA rate field [1/yr] removed from the trend component (read a model file with shCoefficients.read first)

output	description
out	(1,1) shClimatology copy with the GIA trend removed from the trend component; history appended

shClimatology.eval

```
g = clim.eval(epoch)
```

Evaluate the full climatology at an epoch -> shCoefficients.

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
epoch	1 x 1	double	required	epoch [decimal years]

output	description
g	(1 x 1) shCoefficients model field evaluated at the epoch

shClimatology.bias

```
g = clim.bias()
```

Field at the reference epoch t0.

output	description
g	(1 x 1) shCoefficients bias component with sigmas

shClimatology.trend

```
g = clim.trend()
```

Linear trend field, units of the coefficients per year.

output	description
g	(1 x 1) shCoefficients trend component [units/yr] with sigmas

shClimatology.cosAnnual

```
g = clim.cosAnnual()
```

Cosine annual component (sigmas attached).

output	description
g	(1 x 1) shCoefficients cosine annual component

shClimatology.sinAnnual

```
g = clim.sinAnnual()
```

Sine annual component (sigmas attached).

output	description
g	(1 x 1) shCoefficients sine annual component

shClimatology.cosSemiannual

```
g = clim.cosSemiannual()
```

Cosine semiannual component (sigmas attached).

output	description
g	(1 x 1) shCoefficients cosine semiannual component

shClimatology.sinSemiannual

```
g = clim.sinSemiannual()
```

Sine semiannual component (sigmas attached).

output	description
g	(1 x 1) shCoefficients sine semiannual component

shClimatology.periodic

```
[gc, gs] = clim.periodic(k)
```

Cos/sin components of the k-th extra period (v2.1). [GC, GS] = clim.periodic(K) returns shCoefficients for the cos and sin terms of period obj.periods(K) [yr] - e.g. the S2/K2/K1 tidal alias terms when fitted via ts.climatology(Periods=[161/365.25, 3.66, 7.48]).

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
k	1 x 1	double	required	index into obj.periods, the EXTRA periods only (1 = the

output	description
gc	(1 x 1) shCoefficients cosine component of the k-th extra period
gs	(1 x 1) shCoefficients sine component

shClimatology.amplitudeMap

```
[A, lat, lon, phase] = clim.amplitudeMap(which, latVec, lonVec, Name=Value)
```

Pointwise seasonal amplitude (and phase) map. [A, LAT, LON, PHASE] = clim.amplitudeMap(WHICH, ... with WHICH "annual" | "semiannual" | k (index into clim.periods, v2.1), LATVEC, LONVEC, Quantity=..., kn=...) synthesizes the cos and sin component fields and combines them pointwise: A = sqrt(fc.^2 + fs.^2) PHASE = atan2(fs, fc) [rad, relative to t0] (amplitude of a harmonic is NOT a linear functional of the coefficients, so it must be formed in the space domain).

input	size	type	default	description
obj	n x m	—	required	the object the method is called on
which	1 x 1	—	required	selection of items to act on
latVec	1 x :	double	required	geocentric latitude vector of the grid [deg]
lonVec	1 x :	double	required	longitude vector of the grid [deg], [0, 360)
Quantity	1 x 1	string	"geoid"	the quantity synthesized, as in shCoefficients.synthesis
kn	n x m	double	[]	load Love numbers (user-supplied; required by the mass quantities)

output	description
A	(nlat x nlon) double amplitude of the harmonic in the requested quantity
lat	(1 x nlat) double latitudes
lon	(1 x nlon) double longitudes
phase	(nlat x nlon) double phase [rad] of the harmonic

shClimatology.disp

```
clim.disp()
```

Compact display: fitted components, reference epoch, note. disp(CLIM) prints the maximum degree and the reference epoch t0, the list of fitted components (bias, trend, annual and semi-annual cosine/sine - a fixed line; extra Periods are not listed, read obj.periods for them) and the processing history including the GIA note. Called automatically when an shClimatology object is shown without a semicolon.

Example

```
    clim = ts.climatology();
    disp(clim)
```

shClimatology.fromCoef (static)

```
obj = shClimatology.fromCoef(coef, t0, series, Name=Value)
```

Build from shLowLevel.fitDeterministicModel output (internal). OBJ = shClimatology.fromCoef(COEF, T0, SERIES, Periods=[], CoefSigma=[]) with COEF (6+2K) x (2*Nc) over the flattened [C(:); S(:)] stack of SERIES; rows 7:end are the cos/sin pairs of the K extra Periods [yr].

input	size	type	default	description
coef	n x m	double	required	x 2*Nc) fitted component coefficients over the flattened [C(:); S(:)] stack, Nc = (nmax+1)^2
t0	1 x 1	double	required	reference epoch of the fit [decimal years]
series	1 x 1	shSeries	required	shSeries the fit came from (history carrier)
Periods	1 x :	double	double.empty(1,0)	) (1 x K2) extra harmonic periods [yr]
CoefSigma	n x m	double	[]	1-sigma uncertainties of coef, same layout

output	description
obj	(1 x 1) shClimatology rebuilt from a coefficient table with the series' layout

Package +shLowLevel

Readers, writers & data management

shLowLevel.shReadGFC

```
model = shLowLevel.shReadGFC(filename)
```

Read an ICGEM ASCII .gfc gravity field model file. MODEL = SHREADGFC(FILENAME) parses header key:value pairs and the gfc/gfct data block of a standard ICGEM-format file (GRACE/GRACE-FO monthly solutions, static models, GOCE, EGM2008, etc.). Gzip- compressed files (.gfc.gz) are transparently decompressed.

input	size	type	default	description
filename	—	—	required	—

output	description
model	(1,1) struct fields C, S, sigmaC, sigmaS (nmax+1 x nmax+1) double coefficients and their formal errors GM, R (1,1) double the file's reference constants; without them in the header, silently 3.986004415e14 and 6378136.3 nmax (1,1) double maximum degree read modelname the header's modelname as parsed (char, or a number when the value is numeric); '' when absent header (1,1) struct the parsed file header, verbatim - this is where the TIDE SYSTEM lives, as header.tide_system when the file declares one. There is no model.tide field; shCoefficients.read lifts it out of the header variableTerms (1,:) struct array trend/annual/semiannual terms; empty when the file carries none

shLowLevel.shEvalGFCT

```
[Ct, St] = shLowLevel.shEvalGFCT(model, epoch)
```

Evaluate time-variable Stokes coefficients at a given epoch. [CT, ST] = SHEVALGFCT(MODEL, EPOCH) reconstructs C(t) = C0 + trnd*(t-t0) + sum_k [acos_k*cos(2*pi*(t-t0)/p_k) ... + asin_k*sin(2*pi*(t-t0)/p_k)] (and analogously for S) from MODEL.C / MODEL.S (constant part) and MODEL.variableTerms (from SHREADGFC), at EPOCH (same units/convention as the t0 values in the file -- typically decimal years).

input	size	type	default	description
model	—	—	required	—
epoch	—	—	required	—

output	description
Ct	(nmax+1 x nmax+1) double cosine coefficients at the epoch
St	(nmax+1 x nmax+1) double sine coefficients at the epoch

shLowLevel.readTN13

```
tn = shLowLevel.readTN13(filename)
```

Read a GRACE/GRACE-FO TN-13 geocenter (degree-1) file. TN = shLowLevel.readTN13(FILENAME) parses the official TN-13 product (JPL/CSR/GFZ, e.g. TN-13_GEOC_CSR_RL06.txt): data lines GRCOF2 n m Clm Slm Clm_sig Slm_sig begin end with n=1, m=0/1 and begin/end epochs yyyymmdd.hhmm. Line pairs (m=0, m=1) sharing the same interval are combined into one monthly record with the interval mid-point as epoch.

input	size	type	default	description
filename	n x m	—	required	char/string path (.txt, or .gz which is gunzipped)

output	description
tn	(1,1) struct fields epoch (K,1) double interval mid-points [decimal years] C10, C11, S11 (K,1) double degree-1 Stokes coefficients sigC10, sigC11, sigS11 (K,1) double 1-sigma t0, t1 (K,1) double interval bounds [decimal years]

shLowLevel.readTN14

```
tn = shLowLevel.readTN14(filename)
```

Parse a TN-14 style SLR C20/C30 replacement table. TN = shLowLevel.readTN14(FILENAME) reads the CSR/GFZ "TN-14" technical-note text format: an arbitrary text header followed by data lines with 10 whitespace-separated numeric columns MJD_begin yearfrac_begin C20 C20-mean*1e10 sigC20*1e10 ... C30 C30-mean*1e10 sigC30*1e10 MJD_end yearfrac_end C30 columns contain 'NaN' for months where no SLR C30 is provided (pre GRACE-FO accelerometer degradation).

input	size	type	default	description
filename	n x m	—	required	char/string

output	description
tn	(1,1) struct one row per table line (T rows), fields epochStart, epochStop (T x 1 double) span bounds [decimal years] epoch (T x 1 double) span mid-point [decimal years] C20, C30 (T x 1 double) SLR replacement coefficients; C30 is NaN for months the file leaves blank sigmaC20, sigmaC30 (T x 1 double) 1-sigma, scaled out of the file's 1e-10 units

shLowLevel.readSINEX

```
snx = shLowLevel.readSINEX(filename, Name=Value)
```

Read gravity-field SINEX files (solutions, covariances, NEQs). SNX = shLowLevel.readSINEX(FILENAME) parses the SINEX blocks used by gravity-field solution providers (ITSG, COST-G, ...): +SOLUTION/ESTIMATE parameter list: type CN/SN, degree, order, value, std +SOLUTION/MATRIX_ESTIMATE L|U COVA covariance (lower/upper, up to 3 values per line) +SOLUTION/NORMAL_EQUATION_MATRIX L|U normal-equation matrix .gz files are gunzipped transparently.

input	size	type	default	description
filename	n x m	—	required	output/input file path
Index	n x m	struct	struct([])	) shLowLevel.shIndex struct for reordering
Output	1 x 1	string ∈ ["raw","covariance"]	"raw"	raw returns the parsed blocks; covariance assembles it from a NEQ solution
Only	1 x 1	string ∈ ["all","estimate"]	"all"	estimate streams only the SOLUTION/ESTIMATE block of large files

output	description
snx	(1,1) struct the parsed solution, fields n, m, cs (Q x 1) double the parameter list; cs is 0 for C, 1 for S, in file order or in IDX order when Index was given x, sig (Q x 1) double estimates and formal sigmas: the last two numeric fields of each estimate line M (Q x Q) double covariance or normal-equation matrix, per Output=; [] when absent kind (1,:) char 'COVA' | 'NEQ' | '' ('estimate' on the Only="estimate" path) epoch (1,1) double the solution's reference epoch stats (1,1) struct the parsed +SOLUTION/STATISTICS block (v3.20): keys and values verbatim, plus nobs, nunk, dof, wsos (l'Pl, also matched from "SQUARE SUM OF RESIDUALS") and vfactor where present. struct([]) when the block is absent, and ALWAYS struct([]) on the streaming Only="estimate" path, which stops before it - shLowLevel.neqCombine's VCE feeds on nobs and wsos, so that path cannot supply it

shLowLevel.readDDK

```
W = shLowLevel.readDDK(source, Name=Value)
```

Load a DDK (Kusche) anisotropic decorrelation filter. W = shLowLevel.readDDK(SOURCE) loads a DDK filter into the toolbox's order-block container, ready for shLowLevel.applyDDK / g.applyDDK / ts.applyDDK. The DDK filters (Kusche 2007; Kusche et al. 2009, DDK1..DDK8) are the standard published anisotropic alternative to Gaussian smoothing and the usual benchmark against tvANS.

input	size	type	default	description
source	n x m	—	required	a DDK name ("DDK3"), a filter file (binary, .mat or ASCII) or a W struct; a folder is not accepted
Nmax	n x m	double	[]	truncate the filter to degrees <= Nmax (leading submatrix per block - identical to the reference filterSH behavior for inputs with nmax below the filter's Lm...

output	description
W	(1,1) struct fields nmax (1,1) double maximum degree the filter covers name (1,1) string the path of the file read (for a name form, the file it resolved to); a W struct keeps its own blocks (1 x K) struct array one per (order, cs) block (241 for the Lmax-120 binary files), each with m (1,1 double), cs (1,1 double, 0 for C and 1 for S), n (1,B double, the degrees) and M (B x B double, the square block matrix)

shLowLevel.readMascon

```
mas = shLowLevel.readMascon(filename)
```

Read a GRACE/GRACE-FO mascon netCDF (JPL / CSR / GSFC style). MAS = shLowLevel.readMascon(FILENAME) reads gridded mascon solutions for comparison against the SH chain (base MATLAB: ncread/ncinfo, no toolboxes). Variable names are auto-detected among the layouts used by JPL RL06 ('lwe_thickness'), CSR RL06 ('lwe_thickness'), and generic 'lwe'/'water_thickness'; CF time units "<days | hours | minutes | seconds> since Y-M-D[h:m[:s]]" (one- or two-digit month, day and clock fields) are converted to decimal years.

input	size	type	default	description
filename	n x m	—	required	char/string .nc path

output	description
mas	(1 x 1) struct fields lat (nlat,1) double [deg] as stored - typically GEODETIC; convert with shLowLevel.geodetic2geocentric before synthesizing SH fields on this grid! lon (nlon,1) double [deg, 0..360) epoch (T,1) double decimal years ewh (nlat,nlon,T) double [cm or m AS STORED - check mas.units] units, name (1,1) string

shLowLevel.readSHM

```
out = shLowLevel.readSHM(filename, Name=Value)
```

Read a GRAVIS/GRACE SHM file (GRCOF2 fields, GRDOTA rates). OUT = shLowLevel.readSHM(FILENAME) reads the spherical-harmonic format used by the GRAVIS Level-2B products and by GRACE/GRACE-FO Level-2 files that are not in ICGEM layout:

input	size	type	default	description
filename	1 x 1	—	required	string | char path to the file; .gz is read transparently
Nmax	1 x 1	double	NaN	truncate while reading (NaN: the file's own maximum degree). A GIA model at degree 256 against a solution at 96 wastes memory and time

output	description
out	(1,1) struct fields: kind (1,1) string "GRCOF2" (field) | "GRDOTA" (rate) C, S (nmax+1 x nmax+1) double coefficients in the C(n+1, m+1) house layout; for GRDOTA these are rates per year sigmaC, sigmaS (nmax+1 x nmax+1) double, or [] when the file carries none (GRDOTA never does) GM (1,1) double [m^3/s^2] from the header R (1,1) double [m] from the header nmax (1,1) double Nmax when given (a Nmax above the file's degree zero-pads C and S), else the file's maximum degree header (1,1) string the raw YAML header, kept so provenance is not lost on the way in

Example

```
    gia = shLowLevel.readSHM("GRAVIS-2B_..._GIA_ICE-6G_D_VM5a_0001.gz", ...
        Nmax = 96);
    g = shCoefficients(gia.C, gia.S, GM = gia.GM, R = gia.R);
    ts = shLowLevel.standardChain(folder, GIA = g);   % rates in 1/yr

  See also shLowLevel.shReadGFC, shLowLevel.standardChain.
```

shLowLevel.readGrid

`[grid, latDeg, lonDeg, info] = shLowLevel.readGrid(filename, Name=Value)`

Read a gridded field or stack from a CF netCDF file. [GRID, LAT, LON, INFO] = shLowLevel.readGrid(FILE) reads the one latitude-longitude field in FILE - a 2-D grid, or a 3-D stack with a time axis - and returns it in the toolbox's layout: GRID is (nlat x nlon) or (nlat x nlon x T), LAT and LON are column vectors [deg], and INFO.epochs holds the epochs as decimal years. It is the inverse of shLowLevel.writeGrid, and it reads CF grids from elsewhere too - hydrological models, GravIS Level-3 grids - so that they ca...

input	size	type	default	description
filename	n x m	—	required	char/string path of the .nc file
Var	1 x 1	string	""	the variable to read; "" reads the only variable on the latitude-longitude grid, and refuses when there are several

output	description
grid	(nlat x nlon) or (nlat x nlon x T) double the field, NaN where the file has no value
latDeg	(nlat,1) double latitudes [deg], in the file's order
lonDeg	(nlon,1) double longitudes [deg], 0..360, ascending
info	(1,1) struct fields var (1,1) string the variable read units (1,1) string its units attribute ("" if none) longName (1,1) string its long_name attribute ("" if none) latType (1,1) string the lat_type attribute writeGrid stores; "" when the file does not say epochs (T,1) double epochs [decimal years]; [] for a 2-D grid timeUnits (1,1) string the time axis' units; "" for 2-D calendar (1,1) string its calendar attribute ("" if none) conventions (1,1) string the global Conventions attribute title (1,1) string the global title attribute file (1,1) string the file read

Example

```
    f = fullfile(getpref('shAnalysis', 'GravisFolder'), ...
        'GRAVIS-3_GFZOP_0600_TWS_GRID_GFZ_0006.nc');
    [tws, lat, lon, info] = shLowLevel.readGrid(f, Var = "tws");  % cm
    g = shCoefficients.analysis(tws(:, :, 1) / 100, lat, lon, 60, ...
        Quantity = "ewh", kn = kn, LatType = "geodetic", Fill = 0);

  See also shLowLevel.writeGrid, shLowLevel.readMascon,
  shCoefficients.analysis.
```

shLowLevel.readLoveNumbers

`[LN, info] = shLowLevel.readLoveNumbers(filename, Name=Value)`

Read load Love numbers from a user-supplied table file. LN = shLowLevel.readLoveNumbers(FILE) parses a plain-text load-Love-number table (comment lines starting with %, #, ! or // are skipped; an optional header line naming the columns is recognized). The toolbox never hardcodes Love numbers - this reader turns YOUR loading-model table (PREM, Gutenberg-Bullen, ak135, ...) into the kn/hn/ln vectors the synthesis and deformation routines expect.

input	size	type	default	description
filename	n x m	—	required	char/string path of the plain-text table to read
Columns	1 x 1	string	"auto"	explicit column meaning, tokens from {n,k,h,l}, e.g. "n k h l" (overrides header detection)
Nmax	1 x 1	double	[]	verify coverage of degrees 0..Nmax and truncate; with sparse tables combine with Interp ("none")
Interp	1 x 1	string ∈ ["none", "pchip"]	"none"	"none" | "pchip": fill degree gaps by shape-preserving pchip in log(1+n) - Farrell-style sparse tables (n = ...,32,56,100,...) become dense. Python-validate...
InFrame	1 x 1	string ∈ ["", "CE", "CF", "CM"]	""	degree-1 reference frame of the FILE, and
OutFrame	1 x 1	string ∈ ["", "CE", "CF", "CM"]	""	requested output frame: "CE" | "CF" | "CM". Both or neither. Only degree 1 changes (Blewitt 2003 isomorphic frames): all of h1,l1,k1 shift by the same consta...

output	description
LN	(1,1) struct fields n (D x 1) degrees, ascending kn (D x 1) potential load Love numbers k'_n hn (D x 1) vertical (NaN if absent from file) ln (D x 1) horizontal (NaN if absent from file)
info	(1,1) struct fields source (1,1) string the file it was read from columns (1,:) char the columns actually used, space-separated frame (1,1) string "as-in-file", or the conversion applied, e.g. "CE>CF (degree-1 shift ...)" interpolated (D x 1) logical which degrees were filled in rather than read

Example

```
LN = shLowLevel.readLoveNumbers("prem_load.txt", Columns="n h l k", ...
         Nmax=96, Interp="pchip", InFrame="CE", OutFrame="CF");
[up, no, ea] = g.deformation(latPts, lonPts, kn=LN.kn, hn=LN.hn, ...
         ln=LN.ln, Mode="points");
```

shLowLevel.listICGEM

`[T, info] = shLowLevel.listICGEM(Name=Value)`

List gravity field models available at ICGEM (GFZ). T = shLowLevel.listICGEM() returns a table of the STATIC global models from https://icgem.gfz.de/tom_longtime (name, year, max degree, data sources, direct .gfc download URL) - feed a row's name into shLowLevel.fetchICGEM to download.

input	size	type	default	description
Type	1 x 1	string ∈ ["static","temporal"]	"static"	"static" | "temporal"
Series	1 x 1	string	""	temporal only: catalogue path of one series to list its individual files (see above)
Source	1 x 1	string	""	local HTML file instead of the live page (offline/testing; the parsers are fixture-tested)
Timeout	1 x 1	double	60	per-request timeout [s]

output	description
T	table: static: idx, name, year, degree, data, url temporal: idx, group, center, series, path, url, zip temporal+Series: idx, name, url (idx is the row number, 1..height(T))

output	description
info	(1,1) struct fields source (1,1) string where the catalogue came from retrieved (1,1) datetime when it was read note (1,1) string what the listing covers

shLowLevel.listITSG

```
[T, info] = shLowLevel.listITSG(Name=Value)
```

Catalogue of ITSG gravity field series on the TU Graz server. T = shLowLevel.listITSG() enumerates the available ITSG releases and product folders (releases ITSG-Grace2014/2016/2018 and the continuously extended ITSG-Grace_operational; products monthly at n60/n96/n120 and daily Kalman solutions) by parsing the server directory indices - so mixing files from different releases, the trap of guessing folder names, becomes impossible. The catalogue row number is the selection handle for shLowLevel.fetchITSG(Catalog=...

input	size	type	default	description
BaseURL	1 x 1	string	"https://ftp.tugraz.at/pub/ITSG/GRACE"	("https://ftp.tugraz.at/pub/ITSG/GRACE") server base, or a LOCAL MIRROR FOLDER (offline/testing: directory tree is walked instead of scraped)
Timeout	1 x 1	double	30	per-request timeout [s]

output	description
T	(K x 5) table columns: idx (1,1) double selection number for fetchITSG release (1,1) string e.g. "ITSG-Grace2018" product (1,1) string "monthly" | "daily" | "static" nmax (1,1) double 60/96/120 (NaN for daily/static) url (1,1) string folder URL or mirror path
info	(1,1) struct fields source (1,1) string where the catalogue came from nReleases (1,1) double releases found

Example

```
    T = shLowLevel.listITSG();
    disp(T)     % pick rows, then fetch via Catalog= in fetchITSG
```

shLowLevel.fetchITSG

```
[files, info] = shLowLevel.fetchITSG(months, Name=Value)
```

Download ITSG monthly OR daily solutions from TU Graz. The fetch family, one function per source and product: fetchITSG and fetchICGEM for solution series, fetchGAX for the AOD1B GAA/GAB/GAC/GAD monthly means (ICGEM/GFZ pages), fetchITSGSINEX for the ITSG monthly normal-equation SINEX, fetchITSGBackground for the ITSG monthly background models, plus fetchTN, fetchDDK, fetchLoveNumbers for auxiliaries.

input	size	type	default	description
months	n x m	—	""	numeric years (each expands to 12 months) OR string array "YYYY-MM" OR "all": every monthly .gfc the server folder of each release (or of Release, when given...
Dest	1 x 1	string	""	(fullfile(shLowLevel.dataFolder(), "series", "itsg", "monthly")) target folder (set a shared location once via shLowLevel.dataFolder(path))
Nmax	1 x 1	double	NaN	monthly: 60 | 96 | 120 (server folder monthly_nXX; NaN resolves to 96). Daily solutions are n40 only and NaN resolves to 40; any other value errors
Product	1 x 1	string ∈ ["monthly", "daily"]	"monthly"	"monthly" | "daily": the ITSG solution kind
Timeout	1 x 1	double	60	[s] per file
Proxy	1 x 1	string	""	per-call proxy URL, e.g. "http://proxy:8080" (empty: MATLAB Web Preferences)
Update	1 x 1	logical	false	re-download files that are already present
Quiet	1 x 1	logical	false	suppress per-file progress

input	size	type	default	description
Release	1 x 1	string	""	"" routes each month by the rule below; a release name ("ITSG-Grace2018" | "ITSG-Grace_operational") pins every file to that release folder
BaseURL	1 x 1	string	"https://ftp.tugraz.at/pub/ITSG/GRACE"	("https://ftp.tugraz.at/pub/ITSG/GRACE") server base URL, or a local mirror folder for offline use
Catalog	1 x :	double	[]	row numbers of the shLowLevel.listITSG catalogue to fetch completely; a static or daily row is skipped with a warning (staticSkipped, dailySkipped)

output	description
files	(1,:) string paths of all present files (new + existing)
info	(1,1) struct fields fetched (1,:) string paths downloaded now updated (1,:) string paths replaced by a newer copy skipped (1,:) string paths already present missing (1,:) string months (daily: days) the server did not offer dest (1,1) string target folder base (1,1) string server base URL product (1,1) string the ITSG product actually requested

shLowLevel.fetchICGEM

```
[file, info] = shLowLevel.fetchICGEM(model, Name=Value)
```

Download a static gravity field model from ICGEM. FILE = shLowLevel.fetchICGEM("EGM2008") resolves the model name against shLowLevel.listICGEM (case-insensitive exact match, else unique prefix; a temporal catalogue matches the series name exactly, else by unique substring) and downloads the .gfc into <dataFolder>/static. Existing files are skipped. Load with shCoefficients.read(FILE).

input	size	type	default	description
model	n x m	—	required	ICGEM model name as listed by shLowLevel.listICGEM
Dest	1 x 1	string	""	"" = the v3.16 layout: static models under dataFolder/static, series under dataFolder/series/<group_center_series>
Timeout	1 x 1	double	300	,
List	n x m	table	table()	) ([]) pass a pre-fetched listICGEM table (avoids re-listing in loops / enables the offline fixture in tests)
Proxy	1 x 1	string	""	per-call proxy URL, e.g. "http://proxy:8080" (empty: MATLAB Web Preferences)
Update	1 x 1	logical	false	refresh existing files (safe swap: verified before replacing)
Quiet	1 x 1	logical	false	suppress progress output ([k/K] counter, per-file timing, failure summary)
Pause	1 x 1	double	3	seconds between models in bulk mode - the ICGEM server RATE-LIMITS rapid requests (HTTP 429), which looks like a stall
Retries	1 x 1	double	3	retry attempts on 429/timeout, with 30/60/120 second backoff - the rate-limit loop AROUND each download; MaxTries and BaseDelay are the transport retries INS...
Type	1 x 1	string ∈ ["static", "temporal"]	"static"	"static" | "temporal": which catalogue numeric selections and names resolve against (mirrors shLowLevel.listICGEM)
Files	1 x 1	string	"*.gfc*"	filename filter in series mode

input	size	type	default	description
Mode	1 x 1	string ∈ ["auto", "archive", "files"]	"auto"	series download strategy: "auto" fetches the server's whole-series ZIP in ONE request (the rate limiter punishes hundreds of per-file requests) and falls bac...
FileList	n x m	table	table()	) series mode: use this file table (from listICGEM(Series=...)) instead of querying - for subsetting or offline mirrors
MaxTries	1 x 1	double	required	(1,1) double attempts httpFetch makes per download on a transient failure (429, 5xx, a network error), with exponential backoff between them; not forwarded ...
BaseDelay	1 x 1	double	required	(1,1) double [s] first backoff wait; after failed attempt k (k < MaxTries) httpFetch waits BaseDelay 2^(k-1) plus up to 25% jitter, and none after the last....

output	description
file	string local path(s): one per model, or every file of the series in temporal mode (bulk selections are concatenated)
info	(1,1) struct fields (a 1 x K struct array, one per selection, in bulk mode) url (1,:) string the URL(s) used skipped (1,1) logical the file was already present updated (1,1) logical an existing file was replaced by a newer copy failed (1,1) logical the download did not complete mode (1,1) string which path actually ran: "model" (single static model) | "archive" (whole series as one ZIP) | "files" (per-file fallback) | "present" (nothing to do). A script tells a fresh download from a no-op by this field

shLowLevel.fetchDDK

```
[files, info] = shLowLevel.fetchDDK(which, Name=Value)
```

Download DDK filter matrices (Wbd binaries) on demand. FILES = shLowLevel.fetchDDK(1:8) fetches the released anisotropic DDK decorrelation filters DDK1..DDK8 (Kusche 2007; Kusche et al. 2009; ~9.8 MB each) from the MIT-licensed strawpants/GRACE-filter repository into <dataFolder>/DDK. Existing files are skipped unless Update=true, which re-downloads them with a safe swap (the fresh file is parse-verified by shLowLevel.readDDK before replacing the old one). No Wbd file is tracked in the repository: CI checks a DD...

input	size	type	default	description
which	1 x :	double	required	double subset of 1..8
Dest	1 x 1	string	""	(fullfile(shLowLevel.dataFolder(), "DDK")), Timeout (120), Quiet (false)
Timeout	1 x 1	double	120	per-request timeout [s]
Proxy	1 x 1	string	""	per-call proxy URL, e.g. "http://proxy:8080" (empty: MATLAB Web Preferences)
Update	1 x 1	logical	false	re-download files that are already present
Quiet	1 x 1	logical	false	suppress progress output

output	description
files	(1,:) string present file paths (new + existing)
info	(1,1) struct fields fetched (1,:) string paths downloaded now updated (1,:) string paths replaced by a newer copy skipped (1,:) string paths already present (or kept after a failed refresh) names (K,1) string the Wbd file names of the requested DDK levels, one per unique entry of which url (1,1) string server base URL used dest (1,1) string folder the files were resolved against

shLowLevel.fetchTN

```
[files, info] = shLowLevel.fetchTN(Name=Value)
```

Download the TN-13/TN-14 low-degree completion files on demand. FILES = shLowLevel.fetchTN() fetches the GRACE/GRACE-FO technical notes that complete the standard processing chain into <dataFolder>/TN: TN-14

GSFC SLR C20/C30 replacement (shLowLevel.readTN14/applyTN14) TN-13 geocenter (degree 1) per provider (shLowLevel.readTN13/addDegree1) Source: the GFZ ISDC open document server (URLs verified 2026-08-07). No TN file is tracked in the repository: CI checks the test copies out of the fixtures tag into ...

input	size	type	default	description
Providers	1 x :	string ∈ ["GFZ", "CSR", "JPL"]	["GFZ", "CSR", "JPL"]	TN-13 providers to fetch
TN14	1 x 1	logical	true	also fetch the GSFC TN-14 file
Release	1 x 1	string	"RL06.3"	TN-13 release tag in the filename
Update	1 x 1	logical	false	refresh existing files (safe swap)
Dest	1 x 1	string	""	(fullfile(shLowLevel.dataFolder(), "TN"))
BaseURL	1 x 1	string	""	override source: an https base or a LOCAL MIRROR FOLDER (institute mirrors, offline tests)
Proxy	1 x 1	string	""	per-call proxy, e.g. "http://proxy.uni.de:8080" (websave otherwise honours MATLAB Web Preferences)
Timeout	1 x 1	double	60	, Quiet (false)
Quiet	1 x 1	logical	false	suppress progress output
MaxTries	1 x 1	double	required	(1,1) double attempts httpFetch makes per download on a transient failure (429, 5xx, a network error), with exponential backoff between them; not forwarded ...
BaseDelay	1 x 1	double	required	(1,1) double [s] first backoff wait; after failed attempt k (k < MaxTries) httpFetch waits BaseDelay 2^(k-1) plus up to 25% jitter, and none after the last....

output	description
files	(1,:) string verified present file paths (new + updated + kept existing)
info	(1,1) struct fields fetched (1,:) string file NAMES (not paths) downloaded now updated (1,:) string file names replaced by a newer copy skipped (1,:) string file names already present (or kept after a failed refresh) failed (1,:) string "name (message)" per file that did not arrive or did not parse urls (1,:) string the URLs used, in the same order dest (1,1) string target folder

Example

```
shLowLevel.fetchTN(Update = true);            % monthly refresh, safe swap
tn13 = shLowLevel.readTN13(fullfile(shLowLevel.dataFolder(), "TN", ...
          "TN-13_GEOC_CSR_RL06.3.txt"));
g1 = g.applyTN14(tn14).addDegree1(tn13);
```

shLowLevel.fetchGAX

`[files, info] = shLowLevel.fetchGAX(dest, Name=Value)`

Download AOD1B GAX monthly means (GAA/GAB/GAC/GAD) from ICGEM. FILES = shLowLevel.fetchGAX(DEST) downloads the monthly-mean dealiasing products needed for full ocean-mass restoration (Chambers & Willis 2010) as ICGEM-converted .gfc files into DEST/<PRODUCT>/. The AOD1B products are identical across processing centres, so the GFZ series pages (which carry all four products from 2002 on) serve every GSM series including COST-G. Listing and download go through the toolbox's Retry-After-aware fetch layer; files alre...

input	size	type	default	description
dest	1 x 1	string	""	string destination folder ("" = the v3.16 default dataFolder/series/GAX); product subfolders are created as needed

input	size	type	default	description
Products	1 x :	string	["GAD", "GAA"]	(1 x k string) any of GAA/GAB/GAC/GAD; GAD restores the model ocean signal, the ocean mean of GAA removes the atmospheric land-ocean mass term
Series	1 x :	string	["01_GRACE/GFZ/GFZ Release 06", "01_GRACE/GFZ/GFZ Release 06.3 (GFO)"]	(["01_GRACE/GFZ/GFZ Release 06", "01_GRACE/GFZ/GFZ Release 06.3 (GFO)"]) (1 x s string) ICGEM catalogue paths "group/center/series" fed to shLowLevel.listICGEM
Update	1 x 1	logical	false	(1 x 1) re-download files that already exist
MaxFiles	1 x 1	double	Inf	(1 x 1) stop after this many downloads per product - bounded acceptance runs, not a user knob
Downloader	1 x 1	string ∈ ["websave", "httpFetch"]	"websave"	(1 x 1) "websave" (webread network stack, matches listICGEM) or "httpFetch" (matlab.net.http with Retry-After support); the stacks differ in proxy/TLS behavi...
BudgetSec	1 x 1	double	Inf	(1 x 1) wall-clock budget; on expiry the fetch stops CLEANLY, keeps what it has, and reports the remainder (info.nRemaining) - never a hung call
MaxFailures	1 x 1	double	5	(1 x 1) consecutive-failure cap per product; on hitting it the product loop stops with a warning instead of failing every remaining file one by one
PauseSec	1 x 1	double	1.5	(1 x 1) polite pause between downloads [s] - the ICGEM server rate-limits bursts (HTTP 429; observed live)
RetryAfterCap	1 x 1	double	30	(1 x 1) on a 429 the download is retried ONCE after this wait [s]; a second 429 counts as a failure (websave does not expose the Retry-After header, so a fix...
Quiet	1 x 1	logical	false	(1 x 1) suppress progress output

output	description
info	(1,1) struct fields products (1 x nProducts) struct array, one per product, with nListed, nDownloaded, nSkipped, nFailed and nRemaining (what the budget cut off) series (1,:) string the series actually used

Example

```
    f = shLowLevel.fetchGAX("E:/DATAPOOL/GravityField/GAX");
    [out, rep] = shLowLevel.oceanChain(ser, kn = kn, OceanMask = oc, ...
        GADFolder = "E:/DATAPOOL/GravityField/GAX/GAD", ...
        GAAFolder = "E:/DATAPOOL/GravityField/GAX/GAA");

  See fetchITSGSINEX and fetchITSGBackground for the ITSG-side products;
  the ITSG background models are per-release means, NOT the AOD1B
  GAX split.
```

shLowLevel.fetchITSGSINEX

`[files, info] = shLowLevel.fetchITSGSINEX(months, Name=Value)`

Download ITSG monthly normal-equation SINEX from TU Graz. FILES = shLowLevel.fetchITSGSINEX("2018-06") downloads the monthly normal-equation/solution SINEX of the ITSG series - the only public per-month SINEX source (COST-G combines on the normal-equation level internally but does NOT distribute per-month SINEX or covariances). Release routing follows fetchITSG: months before 2017-07 come from ITSG-Grace2018, months from 2018-06 on from ITSG-Grace_operational. Feed the files to shLowLevel.readSINEX (verified aga...

input	size	type	default	description
months	n x 1	—	required	(1 x k string | numeric years) "YYYY-MM" strings or year vectors, as in fetchITSG

input	size	type	default	description
Dest	1 x 1	string	""	destination folder; "" = dataFolder/series/itsg/sinex (v3.16 layout)
Nmax	1 x 1	double	96	(1 x 1) 96 or 120 - the two server variants
Release	1 x 1	string	""	"" routes by month (fetchITSG rule); "ITSG-Grace2018" or "ITSG-Grace_operational" pin one release
Update	1 x 1	logical	false	re-download files that already exist
MaxFiles	1 x 1	double	Inf	downloads cap - bounded acceptance runs
BudgetSec	1 x 1	double	Inf	wall-clock cap with clean partial stop
MaxFailures	1 x 1	double	5	failure cap (failures are counted in total, not reset by a success); stops with a warning
PauseSec	1 x 1	double	1.5	polite pause between downloads [s]
RetryAfterCap	1 x 1	double	30	single capped retry wait on HTTP 429 [s]
Downloader	1 x 1	string ∈ ["websave", "httpFetch"]	"websave"	"websave" | "httpFetch" (Retry-After-aware, with its own websave transport fallback)
BaseURL	1 x 1	string	"https://ftp.tugraz.at/pub/ITSG/GRACE"	("https://ftp.tugraz.at/pub/ITSG/GRACE") server base
Quiet	1 x 1	logical	false	suppress progress output

output	description
info	(1,1) struct fields nListed, nDownloaded, nSkipped, nFailed, nRemaining (1,1) double the download tally; nRemaining is what the MaxFiles/BudgetSec/MaxFailures caps cut off missing (k,1) string requested months with no local file after the run: absent on the server, failed, OR cut by MaxFiles/BudgetSec/MaxFailures (so with MaxFiles = 0 every month not already present) releases (r,1) string releases actually used

Example

```
f = shLowLevel.fetchITSGSINEX(["2018-06", "2018-07"], Nmax = 96);
snx = shLowLevel.readSINEX(f(1), Only = "estimate");
```

shLowLevel.fetchITSGBackground

`[files, info] = shLowLevel.fetchITSGBackground(months, Name=Value)`

Download ITSG monthly-mean background models. FILES = shLowLevel.fetchITSGBackground("2018-06") downloads the monthly means of the background models the ITSG processing reduced from the observations, as .gfc (about 1 MB each): "dealiasing" (atmosphere + ocean - the ITSG counterpart of restoring AOD), "oceanTide", "earthTide", "poleTide" and "oceanPoleTide". Release routing follows fetchITSG: months before 2017-07 from ITSG-Grace2018, from 2018-06 on from ITSG-Grace_operational.

input	size	type	default	description
months	n x 1	—	required	(1 x k string | numeric years) "YYYY-MM" strings or year vectors, as in fetchITSG
Products	1 x :	string	"dealiasing"	(1 x k string) product selection, one subfolder per product. Availability is release-dependent (verified live 2026-08-12): BOTH eras carry dealiasing, earthT...
Dest	1 x 1	string	""	destination folder; "" = dataFolder/series/itsg/background (v3.16)
Release	1 x 1	string	""	"" routes by month; a release name pins it
Update	1 x 1	logical	false	re-download files that already exist
MaxFiles	1 x 1	double	Inf	downloads cap per product
BudgetSec	1 x 1	double	Inf	wall-clock cap with clean partial stop

input	size	type	default	description
MaxFailures	1 x 1	double	5	failure cap per product (failures are counted in total, not reset by a success); stops that product with a warning
PauseSec	1 x 1	double	1.5	polite pause between downloads [s]
RetryAfterCap	1 x 1	double	30	single capped retry wait on HTTP 429 [s]
Downloader	1 x 1	string ∈ ["websave", "httpFetch"]	"websave"	"websave" | "httpFetch"
BaseURL	1 x 1	string	"https://ftp.tugraz.at/pub/ITSG/GRACE"	("https://ftp.tugraz.at/pub/ITSG/GRACE") server base
Quiet	1 x 1	logical	false	suppress progress output

output	description
info	(1,1) struct fields products (1 x nProducts) struct array, one per product, with product, nListed, nDownloaded, nSkipped, nFailed, nRemaining, and missing ((k,1) string, the months that product has no file for) missing (k,1) string months for which at least one selected product has no file - absent on the server, failed, or cut by MaxFiles/BudgetSec/ MaxFailures; products(i).missing says which (until v5.23.4 a month was listed only when every product lacked it) releases (r,1) string releases actually used

Example

```
f = shLowLevel.fetchITSGBackground(["2018-06", "2018-07"]);
g = shCoefficients.read(f(1));   % plain gfc, C(n+1, m+1)
```

shLowLevel.fetchLoveNumbers

`[files, info] = shLowLevel.fetchLoveNumbers(names, Name=Value)`

Download load/deformation Love number files (GROOPS set). FILES = shLowLevel.fetchLoveNumbers() downloads the standard load Love number file (Gegout97, kn for degrees 0..1024) from the GROOPS data collection hosted by TU Graz into <dataFolder>/loveNumbers, with the usual safe-swap semantics. The toolbox deliberately never hardcodes Love numbers - this fetcher automates obtaining a PUBLISHED set, which you then pass explicitly (kn = ...) where required.

input	size	type	default	description
names	1 x 1	string	"loadLoveNumbers_Gegout97.txt"	display names, one per series/solution
Dest	1 x 1	string	""	target folder; default <dataFolder>/loveNumbers
BaseURL	1 x 1	string	"https://ftp.tugraz.at/pub/ITSG/groops/data/loading"	("https://ftp.tugraz.at/pub/ITSG/groops/data/loading") (GROOPS/TU Graz loading folder) or a local mirror folder
Timeout	1 x 1	double	30	, Proxy (""), Update (false), Quiet (false)
Proxy	1 x 1	string	""	proxy server URL (" = direct)
Update	1 x 1	logical	false	re-download/overwrite files that already exist
Quiet	1 x 1	logical	false	suppress progress output

output	description
files	(1,K) string local paths
info	(1,1) struct fields fetched, updated, skipped (1,:) string local PATHS per outcome (skipped includes a present file kept after a failed refresh) failed (1,:) string "name: message" per file that did not arrive or did not parse parsed (1,:) struct one per loadLoveNumbers_* file, with name, n (N x 1) and kn (N x 1); deformation files are omitted

Example

```
    [f, inf] = shLowLevel.fetchLoveNumbers();
    kn = inf.parsed(1).kn(1:61);        % degrees 0..60 for an n60 field
```

shLowLevel.dataFolder

`folder = shLowLevel.dataFolder(newFolder)`

Get or set the persistent user data folder of the toolbox. F = shLowLevel.dataFolder() returns the current data folder (created on demand). Default: <toolbox root>/data. F = shLowLevel.dataFolder(PATH) sets and persists a user folder (MATLAB preference, survives sessions: setpref('shAnalysis','dataFolder')). F = shLowLevel.dataFolder("reset") back to the default.

input	size	type	default	description
newFolder	1 x 1	string	""	char/string new persistent data folder (omit to query the current one)

output	description
folder	(1 x 1) string current data folder (created on demand)

shLowLevel.gravisDataFolder

`p = shLowLevel.gravisDataFolder()`

Path of the shipped GravIS auxiliary data. P = shLowLevel.gravisDataFolder() returns the absolute path of the data/gravis folder shipped with the toolbox: frozen (2026-08-12) copies of the GravIS COST-G Level-2B auxiliary files and the GravIS basin polygons that gravisL2B, greenlandChain, antarcticaChain and twsChain use when no gravisFolder is given. The correction tables trail the monthly solutions - for epochs after the freeze fetch fresh copies (see data/gravis/README.md) and pass gravisFolder=.

output	description
p	(1,1) string absolute folder path

Example

```
    dir(shLowLevel.gravisDataFolder())
```

shLowLevel.testDataDir

`d = shLowLevel.testDataDir()`

Resolve the sample/fixture data folder (relocatable). D = shLowLevel.testDataDir() returns, in order of precedence: 1. getenv('SHX_TESTDATA_FOLDER') if set and a folder 2. getpref('shAnalysis','TestDataFolder') if set and a folder 3. <toolbox>/tests/test_data the fallback location; it is NOT tracked in the repository - CI checks the fixtures out of the fixtures tag into it, and a plain clone has none Same contract as tests/shxTestDataDir (which the test suites use); this packaged twin exist...

output	description
d	(1 x :) char folder path (existence NOT enforced for the fallback - callers keep their own diagnostics)

Example

```
    W = shLowLevel.readDDK("DDK3");   % /DDK, then here
    f = fullfile(shLowLevel.testDataDir(), 'test_static.gfc');
```

shLowLevel.ddkNames

`names = shLowLevel.ddkNames()`

Released Wbd filenames for DDK1..DDK8 (strong -> weak). NAMES = shLowLevel.ddkNames() - single source of truth for the mapping (verified against the strawpants/GRACE-filter repository listing). Claude (Fable 5), 2026-08-07 (v2.4.1).

output	description
names	(8 x 1) string Wbd file names for DDK1..DDK8

shLowLevel.parseGraceFilename

```
meta = shLowLevel.parseGraceFilename(filename)
```

Product type and mid-epoch from a GRACE L2 filename. META = shLowLevel.parseGraceFilename(FILENAME) parses the standard GRACE / GRACE-FO Level-2 naming convention PPP-2_YYYYDDD-YYYYDDD_*.gfc[.gz] e.g. GSM-2_2024032-2024060_GRFO_UTCSR_BA01_0600.gfc, where PPP is one of GSM, GAA, GAB, GAC, GAD and YYYYDDD are year + day-of-year of the coverage span. Best-effort: fields are NaN/"unknown" when the pattern does not match (static models, renamed files); callers can always override via explicit options. Monthly and dai...

input	size	type	default	description
filename	n x m	—	required	char/string path or bare filename

output	description
meta	(1,1) struct fields productType (1,1) string "GSM"|"GAA"|"GAB"|"GAC"|"GAD", or "unknown" when no prefix matches epochStart, epochStop (1,1) double coverage span [decimal years], NaN when no date pattern matches epoch (1,1) double span mid-point [decimal years], NaN with the span

shLowLevel.icgemDate2Year

```
y = shLowLevel.icgemDate2Year(d)
```

Convert ICGEM/GRACE yyyymmdd(.hhmm) epochs to decimal years. Y = shLowLevel.icgemDate2Year(D) converts date codes of the form yyyymmdd or yyyymmdd.hhmm (as used in ICGEM gfct files, TN-13/TN-14) to decimal years, using day-of-year / (days in year) with proper leap years. Values that do not look like date codes (< 1.8e7, e.g. already-decimal years in legacy synthetic files) are returned UNCHANGED - this rule keeps pre-v2.1 files evaluating identically.

input	size	type	default	description
d	n x m	double	required	double array dates as yyyymmdd(.hhmm) numbers or decimal years (passed through)

output	description
y	(same size as input) double decimal years

shLowLevel.writeGFC

```
shLowLevel.writeGFC(filename, C, S, GM, R, Name=Value)
```

Write Stokes coefficients to an ICGEM ASCII .gfc file. shLowLevel.writeGFC(FILENAME, C, S, GM, R) writes a static ICGEM-format gravity field file readable by shLowLevel.shReadGFC (round-trip tested). Coefficients are written with %22.14e, 15 significant digits - one or two short of full double precision - and sigmas with %12.4e, 5 significant digits.

input	size	type	default	description
filename	n x m	—	required	char/string C, S (nmax+1)x(nmax+1) double fully normalized coefficients
C	n x m	double	required	cosine Stokes coefficients, C(n+1, m+1) indexing
S	n x m	double	required	sine Stokes coefficients, S(n+1, m+1) indexing
GM	1 x 1	double	required	double [m^3/s^2]
R	1 x 1	double	required	double [m] opts.SigmaC, opts.SigmaS same layout, formal errors ([] -> zeros, errors flag written as 'no')
SigmaC	n x m	double	[]	1-sigma uncertainties of C, same indexing
SigmaS	n x m	double	[]	1-sigma uncertainties of S, same indexing
ModelName	n x m	—	"shAnalysis_export"	string default "shAnalysis_export"
TideSystem	n x m	—	"unknown"	string default "unknown"
Comment	n x m	—	""	string extra header comment lines ("" = none)

input	size	type	default	description
Sidecar	1 x 1	logical	true	logical write <file>.provenance.json beside it Outputs: none (file on disk; plus <file>.provenance.json sidecar

shLowLevel.writeGrid

`shLowLevel.writeGrid(filename, grid, latDeg, lonDeg, Name=Value)`

Export gridded fields to CF-style netCDF (base MATLAB). shLowLevel.writeGrid('ewh.nc', GRID, LAT, LON, Name="lwe_thickness", Units="m") writes a 2-D field or a 3-D stack (nlat x nlon x T with Epochs=) using nccreate/ncwrite - a stack is directly readable back by shLowLevel.readMascon (roundtrip-tested), by GMT, panoply, xarray, etc. Time is stored as "days since 2002-01-01" like the mascon products. A 2-D field gets a time axis of length 1 when one epoch is given (Epochs = 2010.29), and none without (before v5.2...

input	size	type	default	description
filename	n x m	—	required	char/string .nc target (existing file is replaced; missing parent folders are created, v2.4.1)
grid	nlat x nlon	double	required	or (nlat,nlon,T) double
latDeg	: x 1	double	required	double [deg] (document your latitude type - geocentric unless you converted; attribute 'lat_type')
lonDeg	: x 1	double	required	double [deg, 0..360)
Name	1 x 1	string	"field"	, Units (""),
Units	1 x 1	string	""	unit label used for annotation
Epochs	: x 1	double	[]	(T,1) decimal years, one per layer (required when T > 1; optional, and then written, when T = 1),
LatType	1 x 1	string	"geocentric"	, Description ("")
Description	1 x 1	string	""	free-text description written to the sidecar
Sidecar	1 x 1	logical	true	write <file>.provenance.json alongside the output

shLowLevel.writeAnimation

`shLowLevel.writeAnimation(ts, filename, Name=Value)`

Export a series as a map animation, drawn by geoMap. shLowLevel.writeAnimation(TS, 'ewh.avi', Quantity=..., kn=...) synthesizes every epoch of TS onto one grid, draws each frame with geo.map, and writes them to a video container with a provenance sidecar.

input	size	type	default	description
ts	1 x 1	shSeries	required	shSeries the series to animate
filename	1 x 1	string	required	string .mp4 (Windows/macOS) or .avi (portable)
Quantity	1 x 1	string	"ewh"	any kernelFactors quantity
kn	n x m	double	[]	load Love numbers k'_n (mass quantities; never hardcoded)
hn	n x m	double	[]	load Love numbers h'_n (deformation_up only)
lat	1 x :	double	-89:2:89	latitude grid [deg]
lon	1 x :	double	0:2:358	longitude grid [deg]
LatType	1 x 1	string ∈ ["geocentric", "geodetic"]	"geodetic"	"geodetic" | "geocentric"; a map wants geodetic
FrameRate	1 x 1	double	4	frames per second
Sidecar	1 x 1	logical	true	write <file>.provenance.json alongside the output

input	size	type	default	description
Size	1 x 2	double	[900 470]	STARTING figure size in pixels, [width height]. geo.map fits the figure to the map from there, so the frames are usually taller than this; they are identical...
CRS	1 x 1	string	"equirectangular"	forwarded to geo.map as its projection
Basemap	1 x 1	struct	struct()	) forwarded to geo.map's Basemap element. The stack-wide CLim and the Divergent flag are inserted into it unless you set them yourself, so overriding is del...
GeoArgs	n x m	cell	{}	cell of name-value pairs forwarded to geo.map verbatim

Example

```
    shLowLevel.writeAnimation(ts, fullfile(tempdir, 'ewh.avi'), ...
        Quantity = "ewh", kn = kn, FrameRate = 6);

  See also shSeries.toGrid, shLowLevel.writeFrames, shLowLevel.requireGeoMap.
```

shLowLevel.writeFrames

`shLowLevel.writeFrames(frames, filename, Name=Value)`

Write ready-made RGB frames to a video container. shLowLevel.writeFrames(FRAMES, 'out.avi', FrameRate=..., ...) writes an (H x W x 3 x T) uint8 stack to an MPEG-4 or Motion-JPEG AVI file and, by default, a provenance sidecar beside it.

input	size	type	default	description
frames	H x W x 3 x T	uint8	required	uint8 RGB frames, e.g. from getframe().cdata
filename	1 x 1	string	required	string .mp4 or .avi target path
FrameRate	1 x 1	double	4	frames per second
Sidecar	1 x 1	logical	true	write <file>.provenance.json alongside the output (nFrames, frameRate and frameSize are always recorded)
SidecarExtra	1 x 1	struct	struct()	) extra fields merged into the sidecar

Example

```
    F = uint8(zeros(120, 240, 3, 5));
    shLowLevel.writeFrames(F, fullfile(tempdir, 'demo.avi'), FrameRate = 2);

  See also shLowLevel.writeAnimation, shSeries.toGrid.
```

shLowLevel.gridHandover

`b = shLowLevel.gridHandover(Z, lat, lon, units, latType, quantity, productType, name, epoch, c00, history, nmax, nmin)`

Assemble the metadata that travels with a synthesized grid. B = shLowLevel.gridHandover(Z, LAT, LON, UNITS, LATTYPE, QUANTITY, PRODUCTTYPE, NAME, EPOCH, C00, HISTORY, NMAX, NMIN) packs a synthesized field together with what it is, for handover to a cartographic toolbox. Called by shCoefficients.toGrid and shSeries.toGrid; it exists so the two bridges cannot describe the same field differently, which is the failure they were built to prevent in the first place.

input	size	type	default	description
Z	n x m	double	required	double synthesized values
lat	1 x :	double	required	double [deg] as given by the caller
lon	1 x :	double	required	double [deg]

input	size	type	default	description
units	1 x 1	string	required	string from shLowLevel.kernelFactors
latType	1 x 1	string	required	string "geodetic" | "geocentric"
quantity	1 x 1	string	required	string
productType	1 x 1	string	required	string e.g. "GSM", "GAD", "unknown"
name	1 x 1	string	required	string model label, may be ""
epoch	: x 1	double	required	double decimal year(s), NaN if unset
c00	: x 1	double	required	double degree-0 coefficient per epoch
history	n x 1	string	required	string processing history nmax, nmin (1,1) double degree range actually used
nmax	1 x 1	double	required	maximum spherical harmonic degree
nmin	1 x 1	double	required	minimum spherical harmonic degree

output	description
b	(1,1) struct Z, lat (nlat x 1) double, lon (1 x nlon) double, Units, LatType, Quantity, ProductType, Name, Source, FieldKind (1,1) string, Epoch (: x 1) double, C00 (: x 1) double, Zmin, Zmax, Zmean (1,1) double, Nmax, Nmin (1,1) double, History (: x 1) string

Example

```
    b = shLowLevel.gridHandover(Z, lat, lon, "m", "geodetic", "ewh", ...
            "GSM", "ITSG-Grace2018", 2008.29, 0, string.empty(0,1), 60, 0);
    b.FieldKind        % "anomaly"

  See also shCoefficients.toGrid, shSeries.toGrid, shLowLevel.kernelFactors.
```

shLowLevel.requireGeoMap

`loc = shLowLevel.requireGeoMap()`

Assert that geoMap is on the path; say where it is. LOC = shLowLevel.requireGeoMap() returns the path of geo.map, or raises shLowLevel:requireGeoMap:geoMapRequired with a message that says what to do instead of reporting an undefined function three frames deeper.

output	description
loc	(1,:) char full path of geo.map, for provenance records

Example

```
    loc = shLowLevel.requireGeoMap();   % errors if geoMap is absent

  See also shCoefficients.map, shCoefficients.toGrid, shLowLevel.writeAnimation.
```

Legendre, spectral tools & indexing

shLowLevel.legendreALF

`P = shLowLevel.legendreALF(nmax, lat)`

Fully normalized (4-pi) associated Legendre functions Pbar_nm. P = LEGENDREALF(NMAX, LAT) computes fully normalized associated Legendre functions up to degree/order NMAX for each latitude in LAT (radians, geocentric, scalar or vector), using the scaled forward column recursion of Holmes & Featherstone (2002): the u^m factor of each column is carried separately with a 1e-280 scale factor, which keeps the recursion overflow/underflow-free up to at least degree 2190 (EGM2008/XGM2019e) at all latitudes including nea...

input	size	type	default	description
nmax	—	—	required	—
lat	—	—	required	—

output	description
P	(NMAX+1)x(NMAX+1)xnumel(LAT) double P(n+1,m+1,k) = Pbar_{n,m}(sin(lat(k))), upper triangle 0

shLowLevel.legendreALFDeriv

```
[P, D, D2] = shLowLevel.legendreALFDeriv(nmax, latRad)
```

Fully normalized ALFs and their latitude derivatives. [P, D] = shLowLevel.legendreALFDeriv(NMAX, LATRAD) returns the 4pi-fully- normalized associated Legendre functions P (via shLowLevel.legendreALF, scaled Holmes-Featherstone, stable to degree 2190) and their exact first derivatives with respect to LATITUDE phi,

input	size	type	default	description
nmax	1 x 1	double	required	double maximum degree
latRad	1 x :	double	required	double [rad] geocentric latitudes

output	description
P	(nmax+1, nmax+1, nlat) double Pbar_nm(sin lat)
D	(nmax+1, nmax+1, nlat) double dPbar_nm/dphi [1/rad] D2 (nmax+1, nmax+1, nlat) double d2Pbar_nm/dphi2 [1/rad^2]: the SAME column stencil applied to D - exact, because the first-derivative identity holds degree-wise as a function of phi and differentiates term by term (Python-validated vs numerical second differences, rel ~2e-7 = FD floor; v2.4)

shLowLevel.legendreCached

```
P = shLowLevel.legendreCached(nmax, latRad)
```

Cached fully normalized Legendre functions. P = shLowLevel.legendreCached(NMAX, LATRAD) returns shLowLevel.legendreALF(NMAX, LATRAD), serving repeated requests for the same (NMAX, LATRAD) from a process-wide cache. Cache hits are verified with an EXACT isequal comparison of the stored latitude vector -- a mismatched latVec can never silently return the wrong P (this removes the documented footgun of shSynthesis' raw 'P' passthrough).

input	size	type	default	description
nmax	—	—	required	—
latRad	—	—	required	—

output	description
P	(nmax+1)x(nmax+1)xnumel(latRad) double

shLowLevel.ylm

```
Y = shLowLevel.ylm(latRad, lonRad, idx)
```

4-pi normalized SH basis vectors at arbitrary points. Y = shLowLevel.ylm(LATRAD, LONRAD, IDX) evaluates the basis at nPts points (geocentric latitude/longitude in radians, equal-length vectors), so that f(points) = Y * x for a coefficient vector x in IDX ordering. Vectorized over points via one shLowLevel.legendreALF call.

input	size	type	default	description
latRad	: x 1	double	required	double geocentric latitudes [rad]
lonRad	: x 1	double	required	double longitudes [rad]
idx	1 x 1	struct	required	struct from shLowLevel.shIndex

output	description
Y	(nPts x idx.P) double

shLowLevel.shIndex

```
idx = shLowLevel.shIndex(Lmax, Name=Value)
```

Canonical order-major index for SH coefficient vectors. idx = shLowLevel.shIndex(Lmax) builds the index table used by all shLowLevel functions: order-major ordering, C before S per (n,m), degrees n = Nmin..Lmax (default Nmin = 2;

degree 0/1 and the SLR-C20 replacement are assumed to be handled upstream).

input	size	type	default	description
Lmax	1 x 1	double	required	maximum spherical-harmonic degree of the index
Nmin	1 x 1	double	2	(1,1) double first degree included (non-negative integer)

output	description
idx	(1,1) struct the canonical vector ordering of the toolbox, fields n, m, cs (P x 1) double degree, order and 0=cosine/1=sine of every element, in vector order P (1,1) double number of elements Lmax (1,1) double maximum degree (the LMAX argument) minDegree (1,1) double first degree included (the Nmin option; the FIELD keeps the older spelling) pos (Lmax+1 x Lmax+1 x 2) double reverse map, the vector position of (n, m, cs) or 0 when absent

shLowLevel.vecFromCS

```
x = shLowLevel.vecFromCS(cnm, snm, idx)
```

Pack lower-triangular Cnm/Snm matrices into a shLowLevel vector. x = shLowLevel.vecFromCS(cnm, snm, idx) with cnm, snm of size (Lmax+1)x(Lmax+1), cnm(n+1,m+1) = Cnm, snm(n+1,m+1) = Snm.

input	size	type	default	description
cnm	n x m	double	required	cosine coefficient matrix, C(n+1, m+1) indexing
snm	n x m	double	required	sine coefficient matrix, same indexing
idx	1 x 1	struct	required	index struct from shLowLevel.shIndex (fields n, m, cs, P, Lmax, minDegree, pos)

output	description
x	(P x 1) double coefficients gathered in idx ordering

shLowLevel.csFromVec

```
[cnm, snm] = shLowLevel.csFromVec(x, idx)
```

Unpack a shLowLevel vector into lower-triangular Cnm/Snm matrices. [cnm, snm] = shLowLevel.csFromVec(x, idx). Coefficients outside the index range (n < Nmin) are zero.

input	size	type	default	description
x	: x 1	double	required	coefficient stack, (P x T) in index ordering
idx	1 x 1	struct	required	index struct from shLowLevel.shIndex (fields n, m, cs, P, Lmax, minDegree, pos)

output	description
cnm	(nmax+1 x nmax+1) double cosine coefficients, C(n+1, m+1)
snm	(nmax+1 x nmax+1) double sine coefficients, S(:, 1) = 0

shLowLevel.shDegreeRMS

```
spec = shLowLevel.shDegreeRMS(C, S, Name=Value)
```

Spectral (degree-domain) analysis of spherical harmonic coefficients. SPEC = SHDEGREERMS(C, S) computes, per degree n = 0..nmax: .degVariance(n+1) = sum_m (Cnm^2 + Snm^2) .degRMS(n+1) = sqrt(degVariance) .degAmplitude(n+1) = R * degRMS [geoid-height-equivalent, m] .cumAmplitude(n+1) = R * sqrt(cumsum(degVariance)) [cumulative, m]

input	size	type	default	description
C	n x m	double	required	cosine Stokes coefficients, C(n+1, m+1) indexing
S	n x m	double	required	sine Stokes coefficients, S(n+1, m+1) indexing
R	1 x 1	double	6378136.3	(1,1) double reference radius [m]

input	size	type	default	description
Nmin	1 x 1	double	0	(1,1) double lowest degree to include; coefficients below it are zeroed before summation (Nmin=2 drops degree 0 and 1). Renamed from n0 in v4.0.0.
SigmaC	n x m	double	[]	formal 1-sigma of C, same layout
SigmaS	n x m	double	[]	formal 1-sigma of S, same layout

output	description
spec	(1,1) struct fields degree (nmax+1 x 1) double the degree axis degVariance, degRMS, degAmplitude (nmax+1 x 1) double per-degree signal measures cumVariance, cumRMS, cumAmplitude (nmax+1 x 1) double their cumulative counterparts R (1,1) double the radius the amplitudes use domain (1,:) char 'degree' (consumed by plotSHSpectrum) errVariance, errRMS, errAmplitude (nmax+1 x 1) double the same for the formal errors; present only when sigmas were supplied

shLowLevel.shOrderRMS

```
spec = shLowLevel.shOrderRMS(C, S, Name=Value)
```

Order-domain spectral diagnostics (striping direction). SPEC = shLowLevel.shOrderRMS(C, S) sums coefficient power per ORDER m - the complementary view to shLowLevel.shDegreeRMS and the natural axis for GRACE striping (correlated errors live at high orders):

input	size	type	default	description
C	n x m	double	required	cosine Stokes coefficients, C(n+1, m+1) indexing
S	n x m	double	required	sine Stokes coefficients, S(n+1, m+1) indexing
R	1 x 1	double	6378136.3	[m], Nmin (0) zero degrees below it first, SigmaC, SigmaS ([]) formal errors
Nmin	1 x 1	double	0	minimum spherical harmonic degree
SigmaC	n x m	double	[]	1-sigma uncertainties of C, same indexing
SigmaS	n x m	double	[]	1-sigma uncertainties of S, same indexing

output	description
spec	(1,1) struct fields order (nmax+1 x 1) double the order axis ordVariance, ordRMS, ordAmplitude (nmax+1 x 1) double per-order signal measures cumVariance, cumRMS, cumAmplitude (nmax+1 x 1) double their cumulative counterparts R (1,1) double the radius the amplitudes use domain (1,:) char 'order' (consumed by plotSHSpectrum) errVariance, errRMS, errAmplitude (nmax+1 x 1) double the same for the formal errors; present only when sigmas were supplied

shLowLevel.shSpectralCrossover

```
[nCrossover, degreeInterp] = shLowLevel.shSpectralCrossover(spec)
```

Degree at which the error spectrum first exceeds the signal (degree-amplitude) spectrum -- a standard guide for choosing a truncation degree or Gaussian filter radius.

input	size	type	default	description
spec	—	—	required	—

output	description
nCrossover	(1,1) double first degree with err > signal (NaN if none, or if it is the first degree)
degreeInterp	(1,1) double linearly interpolated crossing degree

shLowLevel.gaussLegendre

```
[x, w] = shLowLevel.gaussLegendre(n)
```

Gauss-Legendre nodes and weights on [-1, 1]. [X, W] = shLowLevel.gaussLegendre(N) via Golub-Welsch (symmetric eigenvalue problem of the Jacobi matrix). Exact for polynomials up to degree 2N-1: integral f(t) dt = sum(W .* f(X)).

input	size	type	default	description
n	1 x 1	double	required	double number of nodes

output	description
x	(n,1) double nodes, ascending
w	(n,1) double weights, sum(w) = 2

Synthesis & analysis

shLowLevel.shSynthesis

```
[grid, lat, lon, P] = shLowLevel.shSynthesis(C, S, GM, R, latVec, lonVec, Name=Value)
```

Spherical harmonic synthesis of a global/regional grid. [GRID, LAT, LON] = SHSYNTHESIS(C, S, GM, R, LATVEC, LONVEC) synthesizes the disturbing-potential-derived quantity (default: geoid height) on the grid LATVEC x LONVEC (degrees) from fully normalized (ICGEM) Stokes coefficients C, S at the reference sphere r = R - or, with Surface = "ellipsoid", on the reference ellipsoid (v5.5.0).

input	size	type	default	description
C	n x m	double	required	cosine Stokes coefficients, C(n+1, m+1) indexing
S	n x m	double	required	sine Stokes coefficients, S(n+1, m+1) indexing
GM	n x m	double	required	gravitational constant times Earth mass [m^3/s^2] (default 3.986004415e14, overridable)
R	n x m	double	required	reference radius [m] (default 6378136.3, overridable)
latVec	n x m	double	required	geocentric latitude vector of the grid [deg]
lonVec	n x m	double	required	longitude vector of the grid [deg], [0, 360)
Quantity	n x m	—	'geoid'	one of ('none' = dimensionless passthrough, kernel 1, no GM/R/kn enter - the clean way to synthesize raw coefficient fields such as kernels or masks): 'geoid...
Nmin	0	—	0	, Nmax (size(C,1)-1) degree range to include. Renamed from nmin/nmax in v4.0.0.
Nmax	n x m	—	size(C,1)-1	maximum spherical harmonic degree
kn	n x 1	—	[]	load Love number vector k_n (index 1 = degree 0), required for "ewh"; NOT supplied by default -- see note below.
rho_ave	5517	—	5517	average Earth density [kg/m^3] (used for "ewh")
rho_water	1000	—	1000	water density [kg/m^3] (used for "ewh")
P	n x m	—	[]	precomputed Legendre array from a prior call/LEGENDREALF, for the identical latVec and nmax -- skips recomputing the recursion. Only the size is checked (bad...
Method	n x m	—	'auto'	"auto" / "direct" / "fft": FFT-along-longitude synthesis for uniform full-circle longitude grids; 'auto' picks it whenever applicable. The two differ only in...
MaxMemGB	4	—	4	Legendre-block memory budget before banding
hn	n x m	—	[]	load Love numbers h'_n, for deformation quantities
Height	0	—	0	evaluation height [m] above the evaluation surface: above R on the sphere, above r(phi) on the ellipsoid

input	size	type	default	description
Surface	1 x 1	string ∈ ["sphere", "ellipsoid"]	"sphere"	"sphere" | "ellipsoid". "sphere" evaluates at r = R + Height, bitwise as before v5.5.0. "ellipsoid" evaluates at r(phi) + Height, r(phi) the geocentric radiu...
SemiMajorAxis	1 x 1	double	6378137	semi-major axis of the ellipsoid [m], WGS84; used only with Surface = "ellipsoid"
Flattening	1 x 1	double	1/298.257223563	flattening of the ellipsoid, WGS84; used only with Surface = "ellipsoid"

output	description
grid	(nlat x nlon) double synthesized field in the units of the requested quantity
lat	(1 x nlat) double geocentric latitude grid used [deg]
lon	(1 x nlon) double longitude grid used [deg]
P	(nmax+1 x nmax+1 x nlat) double Legendre array as returned by LEGENDREALF; pass it back via 'P' to skip the recursion. EMPTY in latitude-banded mode (MaxMemGB exceeded): the blocks are streamed and discarded, so request the 4th output only with a memory budget that fits the full array.

shLowLevel.synthesisMatrix

```
[Y, w, grid] = shLowLevel.synthesisMatrix(idx, Name=Value)
```

Dense SH synthesis matrix on a Gauss-Legendre grid. [Y, W, GRID] = shLowLevel.synthesisMatrix(IDX) returns Y (Ngrid x P) with f = Y*x for coefficient vectors x in IDX ordering (shLowLevel.shIndex), and quadrature weights W (Ngrid x 1), normalized such that the discrete analysis A = Y' * diag(W) is EXACT for band-limited fields: A*Y = eye(P) to machine precision (asserted in the test suite).

input	size	type	default	description
idx	1 x 1	struct	required	struct from shLowLevel.shIndex
NLat	1 x 1	double	idx.Lmax + 1	number of latitude rings [default Lmax+1]
NLon	1 x 1	double	2*idx.Lmax + 2	number of longitudes [default 2*idx.Lmax + 2]
GridOnly	1 x 1	logical	false	return Y = [] and only the weights and the grid. The matrix is NLat*NLon x P doubles - 0.9 GB at Lmax 60 and OverSample 2, 5.6 GB at Lmax 96 - and a caller t...

output	description
Y	(NLat*NLon x idx.P) double synthesis matrix ([] with GridOnly)
w	(NLat*NLon x 1) double quadrature weights, sum(w) = 1
grid	(1,1) struct fields theta (NLat x 1) double co-latitude of each ring [rad] lambda (NLon x 1) double longitude of each column [rad] latDeg (NLat x 1) double the same latitudes [deg] lonDeg (NLon x 1) double the same longitudes [deg]

shLowLevel.synthesisPoints

```
val = shLowLevel.synthesisPoints(C, S, GM, R, latDeg, lonDeg, r, Name=Value)
```

Gravity field quantities at arbitrary 3-D points. VAL = shLowLevel.synthesisPoints(C, S, GM, R, LATDEG, LONDEG, RGEO) evaluates the spherical harmonic expansion POINTWISE at positions given by equal-length vectors of geocentric latitude [deg], longitude [deg] and geocentric radius [m] - satellite altitudes, scattered stations, profiles - including the upward continuation (R/r)^n that grid synthesis on the sphere cannot provide: potential T = GM/r sum_n (R/r)^n sum_m Pnm (C cos + S sin) disturbance ...

input	size	type	default	description
C	n x m	double	required	cosine Stokes coefficients, C(n+1, m+1) indexing
S	n x m	double	required	sine Stokes coefficients, S(n+1, m+1) indexing

input	size	type	default	description
GM	1 x 1	double	required	gravitational constant times Earth mass [m^3/s^2] (default 3.986004415e14, overridable)
R	1 x 1	double	required	reference radius [m] (default 6378136.3, overridable)
latDeg	: x 1	double	required	geocentric latitudes [deg]
lonDeg	: x 1	double	required	longitudes [deg], lon in [0, 360)
r	: x 1	double	required	reference radius [m] (default 6378136.3, overridable)
Quantity	1 x 1	string ∈ ["potential", "disturbance", "anomaly"]	"potential"	"potential" [m^2/s^2] | "disturbance" | "anomaly" (both [m/s^2]; multiply by 1e5 for mGal)
Nmin	1 x 1	double	2	first degree included (0 evaluates the full field including the central term)
Method	1 x 1	string ∈ ["auto", "direct", "clenshaw"]	"auto"	"auto" | "direct" | "clenshaw" - which summation to use; "auto" chooses "clenshaw" once the point count reaches ClenshawFrom
ClenshawFrom	1 x 1	double	1	point count at or above which "auto" switches to "clenshaw". The default is 1 because MATLAB has NO crossover: benchPointsCrossover timed both paths at the s...
MaxMemGB	1 x 1	double	4	memory budget for the "direct" path's Legendre block; the chunk size follows from it and from nmax. Ignored by "clenshaw", which never allocates one

output	description
val	(P,1) double quantity at each point

Example

```
dg = shLowLevel.synthesisPoints(g.C, g.S, g.GM, g.R, ...
    [10; 12], [100; 101], (g.R + 450e3) * [1; 1], ...
    Quantity = "disturbance") * 1e5;   % mGal at 450 km
```

shLowLevel.shSynthesisGradient

`[dq, info] = shLowLevel.shSynthesisGradient(C, S, GM, R, latDeg, lonDeg, Name=Value)`

North/east/up gradient of any synthesized quantity. [DQ, INFO] = shLowLevel.shSynthesisGradient(C, S, GM, R, LAT, LON, Quantity=..., Units=..., Mode=...) returns the spatial gradient of the field that shLowLevel.shSynthesis would produce from the SAME coefficients and the SAME options, resolved in the local north-east-up frame:

input	size	type	default	description
C	n x m	double	required	cosine Stokes coefficients, C(n+1, m+1) indexing
S	n x m	double	required	sine Stokes coefficients, S(n+1, m+1) indexing
GM	1 x 1	double	required	double [m^3/s^2]
R	1 x 1	double	required	double [m] reference radius
latDeg	1 x :	double	required	double [deg] GEOCENTRIC latitude
lonDeg	1 x :	double	required	double [deg] longitude
Quantity	1 x 1	string	"geoid"	any quantity of shLowLevel.kernelFactors: "none", "geoid", "potential", "gravity_anomaly", "gravity_disturbance", "gravity_gradient_rr", "ewh", "surface_dens...
kn	n x m	double	[]	load Love numbers k'_n, degrees 0..nmax; REQUIRED by the mass quantities, never hardcoded

input	size	type	default	description
hn	n x m	double	[]	load Love numbers h'_n (deformation_up only)
Nmin	1 x 1	double	0	degrees below nmin are zeroed. Degree 0 and 1 have no horizontal gradient beyond the degree-1 tilt, but they DO contribute to G.up - so this is not a free ch...
Nmax	1 x 1	double	NaN	truncation degree; NaN uses all supplied degrees
Height	1 x 1	double	0	evaluation height [m] above the evaluation surface; r enters both the kernel attenuation and the metric factors. Rejected for surface quantities, by kernelFa...
Surface	1 x 1	string ∈ ["sphere", "ellipsoid"]	"sphere"	"sphere" | "ellipsoid", as in shLowLevel.shSynthesis: "ellipsoid" evaluates at r(phi) + Height with r(phi) from shLowLevel.ellipsoidRadius, and needs a quant...
SemiMajorAxis	1 x 1	double	6378137	ellipsoid semi-major axis [m], WGS84; used only with Surface = "ellipsoid"
Flattening	1 x 1	double	1/298.257223563	ellipsoid flattening, WGS84; used only with Surface = "ellipsoid"
rho_ave	1 x 1	double	5517	mean Earth density [kg/m^3] (mass kernels)
rho_water	1 x 1	double	1000	water density [kg/m^3] (ewh kernel)
Mode	1 x 1	string ∈ ["grid", "points"]	"grid"	"grid" evaluates the nlat x nlon outer product; "points" takes equal-length LAT/LON and evaluates pairwise - the mode a particle advection needs when it step...
Units	1 x 1	string ∈ ["perMeter", "perRadian"]	"perMeter"	"perMeter" is the true gradient [Q]/m. "perRadian" multiplies every component by r, giving dQ/dphi, (1/cos phi) dQ/dlambda and dQ/d(ln r) - the form a lat/lo...
MaxMemGB	1 x 1	double	4	memory budget [GB] for the Legendre stack; latitudes are processed in bands so nmax is not limited by it

output	description
dq	(1,1) struct each field is (nlat x nlon) double for Mode="grid" or (npts x 1) double for "points". Fields north the north component of the gradient east the east component. NaN where |lat| = 90 - the east direction does not exist at a pole, and the cos(phi) division there returns a finite, meaningless number if it is not caught up the radial component; [] for surface quantities (see above)
info	(1,1) struct fields quantity (1,1) string what was differentiated units (1,1) string the units of dq r (1,nr) double evaluation radius [m]: nr = 1 on the sphere; on the ellipsoid one radius per latitude (Mode="grid") or per point (Mode="points") surface (1,1) string "sphere" | "ellipsoid", as used nmin, nmax (1,1) double the degree range used hasUp (1,1) logical whether dq.up is filled lat (1 x nlat) double latitudes actually used lon (1 x nlon) double longitudes actually used latType (1,1) string always "geocentric" here: the latitudes this function takes are geocentric, and Surface moves the radius, not the latitude. shCoefficients.gradient overwrites lat and latType when it was handed geodetic input, so the convention travels with the numbers instead of being remembered by the caller

Example

```
  % a zonal degree-2 pattern: the east gradient must vanish exactly
  C = zeros(3); S = zeros(3); C(3,1) = 1;              % C_20
  lat = -80:10:80; lon = 0:20:340;
  dq = shLowLevel.shSynthesisGradient(C, S, 3.986004415e14, ...
         6378136.3, lat, lon, Quantity = "none", Units = "perRadian");
  max(abs(dq.east(:)))            % 0
  quiver(lon, lat, dq.east, dq.north)

References
  Wahr, Molenaar & Bryan (1998), JGR 103(B12) - the degree factors.
  Holmes & Featherstone (2002), J Geod 76 - the Legendre recursion
  whose exact latitude derivative shLowLevel.legendreALFDeriv carries.

Python-validated before implementation (tools/dev/validate_gradient.py):
all three components against 5-point finite differences of an
independent scalar synthesis at 1e-12 (the difference floor), the
radial identities d(potential)/dr = -gravity_disturbance and
d(gravity_disturbance)/dr = -gravity_gradient_rr at 4e-16, and
single-coefficient closed forms at 2e-16.

See also shLowLevel.shSynthesis, shLowLevel.shSynthesisDeformation,
shLowLevel.shSynthesisGradientTensor, shLowLevel.kernelFactors,
shLowLevel.legendreALFDeriv.
```

shLowLevel.shSynthesisDeformation

`[up, north, east] = shLowLevel.shSynthesisDeformation(C, S, R, latDeg, lonDeg, Name=Value)`

Elastic load deformation: up / north / east. [UP, NORTH, EAST] = shLowLevel.shSynthesisDeformation(C, S, R, LAT, LON, kn=..., hn=..., ln=...) synthesizes the three components of the elastic surface deformation caused by the load expressed in the (residual) Stokes coefficients C, S (Wahr et al. 1998; Kusche & Schrama 2005 - the GRACE <-> GNSS loading comparison):

input	size	type	default	description
C	n x m	double	required	cosine Stokes coefficients, C(n+1, m+1) indexing
S	n x m	double	required	sine Stokes coefficients, S(n+1, m+1) indexing
R	1 x 1	double	required	double [m]
latDeg	1 x :	double	required	double [deg] geocentric latitude
lonDeg	1 x :	double	required	double [deg]
kn	n x m	double	required	double load Love numbers k'_n (REQUIRED)
hn	n x m	double	required	double load Love numbers h'_n (REQUIRED)
ln	n x m	double	required	double load Love numbers l'_n (REQUIRED)
Nmin	1 x 1	double	1	double = 1 degrees below nmin are zeroed (degree 0 carries no deformation; include degree 1 ONLY if your coefficients carry geocenter motion in the CF fra...
Mode	1 x 1	string ∈ ["grid","points"]	"grid"	"grid"|"points" = "grid" grid: nlat x nlon outer product; points: equal-length LAT/LON vectors evaluated pairwise (GNSS stations)

output	description
up, north, east	(nlat,nlon) double for Mode="grid", (np,1) for Mode="points"; vertical, north and east elastic deformation [m]. EAST is NaN at |lat| = 90, where the direction is undefined.

shLowLevel.shSynthesisGradientTensor

`[comps, info] = shLowLevel.shSynthesisGradientTensor(C, S, GM, R, latDeg, lonDeg, Name=Value)`

Full gravity gradient tensor in the local NEU frame. [COMPS, INFO] = shLowLevel.shSynthesisGradientTensor(C, S, GM, R, LAT, LON, Height=250e3) synthesizes all six independent components of the disturbing gravity gradient tensor (GOCE-style diagnostics) in the local north-east-up frame at radius r = R + Height:

input	size	type	default	description
C	n x m	double	required	cosine Stokes coefficients, C(n+1, m+1) indexing
S	n x m	double	required	sine Stokes coefficients, S(n+1, m+1) indexing
GM	1 x 1	double	required	gravitational constant times Earth mass [m^3/s^2] (default 3.986004415e14, overridable)
R	1 x 1	double	required	reference radius [m] (default 6378136.3, overridable)
latDeg	1 x :	double	required	, lonDeg (1,nlon) double [deg], geocentric
lonDeg	1 x :	double	required	longitudes [deg], lon in [0, 360)
Height	1 x 1	double	250e3	[m] evaluation altitude above R
Nmin	1 x 1	double	2	zero degrees below nmin

output	description
comps	(1,1) struct the six independent components of the symmetric tensor, each (nlat,nlon) double [1/s^2]; 1 Eotvos = 1e-9 1/s^2. Fields uu, nn, ee the diagonal (up, north, east) un, ue, ne the off-diagonal terms. Every component involving east is NaN at |lat| = 90
info	(1,1) struct fields maxTraceResidual (1,1) double max |trace| / max|G| over the grid, poles excluded - the built-in Laplace self-check r (1,1) double evaluation radius [m] Height (1,1) double the altitude r was formed from, echoed back [m]

shLowLevel.shAnalysisGrid

```
[C, S, info] = shLowLevel.shAnalysisGrid(grid, latVec, lonVec, nmax, Name=Value)
```

Spherical harmonic analysis: estimate Stokes coefficients from gridded or scattered data (the inverse of shLowLevel.shSynthesis).

input	size	type	default	description
grid	n x m	double	required	field values on the (lat, lon) grid
latVec	n x m	double	required	geocentric latitude vector of the grid [deg]
lonVec	n x m	double	required	longitude vector of the grid [deg], [0, 360)
nmax	1 x 1	double	required	maximum spherical harmonic degree
Method	1 x 1	string ∈ ["auto","rings","ls"]	"auto"	"auto" (default) | "rings" | "ls"
Quantity	n x m	—	'geoid'	'geoid' (default) | 'potential' | 'gravity_anomaly' | 'gravity_disturbance' | 'ewh' - the grid's physical Quantity; the degree-dependent kernel (shLowLevel....
GM	1 x 1	double	3.986004415e14	gravitational constant times Earth mass [m^3/s^2] (default 3.986004415e14, overridable)
R	1 x 1	double	6378136.3	reference radius [m] (default 6378136.3, overridable)
kn	n x m	double	[]	load Love numbers, required for Quantity='ewh' rho_ave, rho_water EWH densities (5517, 1000)
hn	n x m	double	[]	vertical-deformation Love numbers, degrees 0..nmax (user-supplied; only reached through kernelFactors)
rho_ave	1 x 1	double	5517	mean Earth density [kg/m^3] (default 5517, overridable)
rho_water	1 x 1	double	1000	water density [kg/m^3] (default 1000, overridable)
Weights	1 x 1	string ∈ ["none","coslat"]	"none"	"none" (default) | "coslat" - area weighting of rings/ points (recommended for equiangular ring grids: rows are scaled by sqrt(cos lat), a diagonal approxima...

input	size	type	default	description
Kaula	1 x 1	double	0	0 (default: off). If > 0, Tikhonov regularization toward 0 with per-degree standard deviation Kaula*1e-5/n^2 (Kaula's rule; Kaula=1 is the classic value). RE...
ChunkSize	1 x 1	double	2000	points per accumulation chunk for "ls" (default 2000)
LatType	1 x 1	string ∈ ["geocentric", "geodetic"]	"geocentric"	"geocentric" (default) | "geodetic": how LATVEC is interpreted; geodetic values are converted with Flattening before evaluation
Flattening	1 x 1	double	1/298.257223563	flattening of the reference ellipsoid for that conversion (WGS84; overridable, never silently assumed)

output	description
C	(nmax+1 x nmax+1) double estimated cosine coefficients
S	(nmax+1 x nmax+1) double estimated sine coefficients
info	(1,1) struct fields method (1,:) char operator actually used, 'rings' or 'ls' nPoints (1,1) double observations entering the estimate unobservedDegrees (1,:) double degrees with a zero kernel, returned as 0 in C and S regularized (1,1) logical whether Kaula > 0 was applied condEst (1,1) double condition estimate of the system (worst per-order value for 'rings') residRMS (1,1) double RMS of the post-fit residuals in the units of the input grid

shLowLevel.kernelFactors

```
[kernel, radialExp, units] = shLowLevel.kernelFactors(quantity, nmax, GM, R, Name=Value)
```

Degree-dependent spectral factors for SH synthesis/analysis. KERNEL = shLowLevel.kernelFactors(QUANTITY, NMAX, GM, R, kn=..., ...) returns the (NMAX+1)x1 factor f_n such that a field of QUANTITY is q(lat,lon) = sum_n f_n * sum_m Pbar_nm (C_nm cos + S_nm sin). Shared by shLowLevel.shSynthesis (multiply) and shLowLevel.shAnalysisGrid (divide); the single source of truth for the quantity definitions.

input	size	type	default	description
quantity	n x m	—	required	char/string see above
nmax	1 x 1	double	required	double GM, R (1,1) double [m^3/s^2], [m]
GM	1 x 1	double	required	gravitational constant times Earth mass [m^3/s^2] (default 3.986004415e14, overridable)
R	1 x 1	double	required	reference radius [m] (default 6378136.3, overridable)
kn	n x m	double	[]	(>=nmax+1,1) double load Love numbers k'_n (NEVER hardcoded - user-supplied)
hn	n x m	double	[]	(>=nmax+1,1) double load Love numbers h'_n (deformation_up only; user-supplied)
rho_ave	1 x 1	double	5517	double = 5517 [kg/m^3]
rho_water	1 x 1	double	1000	double = 1000 [kg/m^3]
Height	1 x 1	double	0	double = 0 [m] evaluation height above R: multiplies the potential-type kernels by the upward- continuation attenuation (R/r)^p with r = R+Height (p = n...

output	description
kernel	(nmax+1,1) double (zeros where the quantity carries no information, e.g. n=1 for gravity_anomaly) radialExp (nmax+1,1) double the upward-continuation exponent p_n in f_n(r) = kernel_n (R/r)^p_n, or EMPTY for a quantity that has no radial law (a surface concept). This is the same p_n the Height branch below applies, returned rather than restated: shLowLevel.shSynthesisGradient needs it for d/dr = -(p_n/r) f_n, and a second copy of these exponents would be a fact written twice.

output	description
units	(1,1) string the SI unit of the quantity ("" for the dimensionless passthrough). Same reason as radialExp: the unit belongs to the quantity, so it is returned from where the quantity is defined rather than restated in every bridge, plot label and export header. Consumed by shCoefficients.toGrid.

shLowLevel.ellipsoidRadius

```
r = shLowLevel.ellipsoidRadius(latDeg, Name=Value)
```

Geocentric radius of a reference ellipsoid at a latitude. R = shLowLevel.ellipsoidRadius(LATDEG) is the distance from the Earth's centre to the surface of the WGS84 ellipsoid at each GEOCENTRIC latitude in LATDEG:

input	size	type	default	description
latDeg	n x m	double	required	double array GEOCENTRIC latitudes in degrees, -90..90
SemiMajorAxis	1 x 1	double	6378137	semi-major axis a [m]. The WGS84 value - the same a shLowLevel.normalFieldCS uses for its WGS84 system, and a test pins that the two agree. Deliberately NOT ...
Flattening	1 x 1	double	1/298.257223563	flattening f, WGS84 as everywhere else in the toolbox. 0 is allowed and gives a sphere of radius SemiMajorAxis, which is what makes the sphere a special case...

output	description
r	double array geocentric radius [m], same size as latDeg

Example

```
    % gravity disturbance at stations on the ellipsoid, 150 m up
    r = shLowLevel.ellipsoidRadius(lat) + 150;
    dg = shLowLevel.synthesisPoints(C, S, GM, R, lat, lon, r, ...
        Quantity = "disturbance");

  See also shLowLevel.shSynthesis, shLowLevel.synthesisPoints,
  shLowLevel.geodetic2geocentric, shLowLevel.normalFieldCS.
```

shLowLevel.normalFieldCS

```
[Cn, info] = shLowLevel.normalFieldCS(nmax, Name=Value)
```

Even zonal harmonics of an ellipsoidal normal field. [CN, INFO] = shLowLevel.normalFieldCS(NMAX, System="WGS84") returns the fully normalized even zonal coefficients Cbar_{2n,0} of the normal gravity field, COMPUTED from the defining constants (GM, a, f, omega) via the closed-form theory (Heiskanen & Moritz 1967, sect. 2-9) - no coefficient tables anywhere:

input	size	type	default	description
nmax	1 x 1	double	required	double maximum degree of the output
System	1 x 1	string ∈ ["WGS84","GRS80"]	"WGS84"	"WGS84" | "GRS80": presets for the DEFINING constants below (citable definitions, not data)
GM	1 x 1	double	NaN	, a (NaN), f (NaN), omega (NaN) override any defining constant (NaN keeps the System's value). GRS80 defines J2 rather than f; the preset carries the standar...
a	1 x 1	double	NaN	semi-major axis of the normal ellipsoid [m]
f	1 x 1	double	NaN	flattening of the normal ellipsoid
omega	1 x 1	double	NaN	angular velocity of the normal ellipsoid [rad/s]

output	description
Cn	(nmax+1,1) double Cbar_{n,0} (zero at odd/omitted degrees; Cn(1) = 1 represents the central GM/r term - subtract it ONLY together with a matching degree-0 of the model, see subtractNormalField)

output	description
info	(1,1) struct the defining constants actually used, fields GM (1,1) double geocentric gravitational constant a (1,1) double semi-major axis [m] f (1,1) double flattening omega (1,1) double angular velocity [rad/s] J2 (1,1) double dynamic form factor, COMPUTED from the four above, not tabulated e2 (1,1) double first eccentricity squared m (1,1) double omega^2 a^2 b / GM q0 (1,1) double the auxiliary Somigliana quantity system (1,1) string "WGS84" | "GRS80"

shLowLevel.rescaleGMR

```
[C2, S2, sig] = shLowLevel.rescaleGMR(C, S, GM1, R1, GM2, R2, sigmaC, sigmaS)
```

Convert Stokes coefficients between (GM, R) reference values. [C2, S2] = shLowLevel.rescaleGMR(C, S, GM1, R1, GM2, R2) re-expresses coefficients given w.r.t. (GM1, R1) in the reference (GM2, R2):

input	size	type	default	description
C	n x m	double	required	cosine Stokes coefficients, C(n+1, m+1) indexing
S	n x m	double	required	sine Stokes coefficients, S(n+1, m+1) indexing
GM1	1 x 1	double	required	GM the coefficients are currently scaled to [m^3/s^2]
R1	1 x 1	double	required	R the coefficients are currently scaled to [m]
GM2	1 x 1	double	required	target GM [m^3/s^2]
R2	1 x 1	double	required	target R [m]
sigmaC	n x m	double	[]	1-sigma uncertainties of C, same indexing
sigmaS	n x m	double	[]	1-sigma uncertainties of S, same indexing

output	description
C2, S2	(n1,n1) double coefficients w.r.t. (GM2, R2)
sig	(1,1) struct fields C (n1,n1) double or [] rescaled cosine sigmas, empty when sigmaC was not supplied S (n1,n1) double or [] rescaled sine sigmas, empty when sigmaS was not supplied

shLowLevel.geodetic2geocentric

```
latGC = shLowLevel.geodetic2geocentric(latGD, Name=Value)
```

Convert geodetic to geocentric latitude. LATGC = shLowLevel.geodetic2geocentric(LATGD) converts geodetic (ellipsoidal) latitudes to geocentric latitudes via tan(latGC) = (1 - f)^2 * tan(latGD) All spherical-harmonic routines in this toolbox (synthesis, analysis, Legendre functions) expect GEOCENTRIC latitude; user grids from maps, GIS or mascon products are almost always GEODETIC. Forgetting this conversion biases mid-latitude values by up to ~0.19 deg of latitude (~21 km) - a classic silent error source.

input	size	type	default	description
latGD	n x m	double	required	double array geodetic latitudes [deg]
Flattening	1 x 1	double	1/298.257223563	double = 1/298.257223563 (WGS84; override for other reference ellipsoids - a DEFAULT, not physics baked in)

output	description
latGC	double array geocentric latitudes [deg], poles/equator exact

shLowLevel.geocentric2geodetic

```
latGD = shLowLevel.geocentric2geodetic(latGC, Name=Value)
```

Convert geocentric to geodetic latitude. LATGD = shLowLevel.geocentric2geodetic(LATGC) inverts shLowLevel.geodetic2geocentric: tan(latGD) = tan(latGC) / (1 - f)^2.

input	size	type	default	description
latGC	n x m	double	required	double array geocentric latitudes [deg]

input	size	type	default	description
Flattening	1 x 1	double	1/298.257223563	double = 1/298.257223563 (WGS84 default)

output	description
latGD	double array geodetic latitudes [deg]

shLowLevel.evalMask

```
[mask, grid] = shLowLevel.evalMask(idx, region, Name=Value)
```

Evaluate a region definition on the toolbox quadrature grid. [MASK, GRID] = shLowLevel.evalMask(IDX, REGION) evaluates REGION on the Gauss-Legendre quadrature grid of shLowLevel.synthesisMatrix(IDX) and returns MASK (Ngrid x 1, in [0,1]) plus the GRID struct. Shared by shLowLevel.basinKernel and shLowLevel.slepianBasis.

input	size	type	default	description
idx	1 x 1	struct	required	index struct from shLowLevel.shIndex (fields n, m, cs, P, Lmax, minDegree, pos)
region	n x m	—	required	region as polygon [lat lon] deg, mask, or @(lat, lon) handle (see evalMask)
BufferKm	1 x 1	double	0	>0 grows, <0 shrinks the region by great-circle distance [km] to the region boundary points, computed exactly in latitude chunks (O(N*Nregion); fine to Lmax ...
R	1 x 1	double	6378136.3	sphere radius [m] for the km conversion
OverSample	1 x 1	double	2	refinement factor of the quadrature grid the mask is evaluated on; the Gauss rule uses OverSample*(Lmax+1) latitude rings, so a higher value resolves the reg...

output	description
mask	(Ngrid,1) double in [0,1]
grid	struct from shLowLevel.synthesisMatrix (latDeg, lonDeg per ring)

Filtering & operators

shLowLevel.filterSpec

```
[spec, msg] = shLowLevel.filterSpec(F, Name=Value)
```

Read a filter specification - the one parser of the vocabulary. SPEC = shLowLevel.filterSpec(F) reads F, a filter specification in the form every lane with a Filter option takes, and says what it means:

input	size	type	default	description
F	n x m	—	required	text scalar or struct the specification
Allowed	1 x :	string ∈ ["none", "gauss", "ddk", "W"]	["none", "gauss", "ddk", "W"]	(["none","gauss","ddk","W"]) the kinds the caller admits. The GravIS grid chains admit only "none" and "gauss"

output	description
spec	(1,1) struct fields kind (1,1) string "none" | "gauss" | "ddk" | "W", or "" when F is refused radiusKm (1,1) double the Gaussian radius [km]; NaN otherwise ddk (1,1) double the DDK number, 1 to 8; NaN otherwise W struct | [] the filter for kind "W"; [] otherwise name (1,1) string the label the lanes report: W.name for a struct ("custom W" when it has none), the text itself otherwise
msg	(1,1) string "" when F is accepted, else the reason

Example

```
    spec = shLowLevel.filterSpec("gauss300");    % kind "gauss", radiusKm 300
    [s, msg] = shLowLevel.filterSpec("DDK3", Allowed = ["none", "gauss"]);
    % s.kind is "" and msg says why

  See also shLowLevel.shGaussianWeights, shLowLevel.readDDK,
  shLowLevel.ddkNames, shLowLevel.designFilter.
```

shLowLevel.shGaussianWeights

`Wn = shLowLevel.shGaussianWeights(nmax, radius_km, Name=Value)`

Degree-domain weights for isotropic Gaussian smoothing. WN = SHGAUSSIANWEIGHTS(NMAX, RADIUS_KM) computes the Jekeli (1981) Gaussian averaging function weights Wn, n = 0..NMAX, for an averaging radius RADIUS_KM [km] (half-width at which the spatial weighting function drops to 1/2). Standard GRACE/GRACE-FO mass-change smoothing.

input	size	type	default	description
nmax	1 x 1	double	required	maximum spherical harmonic degree
radius_km	1 x 1	double	required	—
R	1 x 1	double	6378.1363	(1,1) double sphere radius [km] in the b formula

output	description
Wn	(nmax+1 x 1) double Jekeli (1981) weights, W(1) = 1, monotone non-increasing

shLowLevel.shGaussianFilter

`[Cf, Sf, Wn] = shLowLevel.shGaussianFilter(C, S, radius_km, varargin)`

Apply isotropic Gaussian smoothing to Stokes coefficients. [CF, SF] = SHGAUSSIANFILTER(C, S, RADIUS_KM) multiplies each degree n row of C, S by the Jekeli (1981) weight Wn(n), see SHGAUSSIANWEIGHTS. Standard pre-processing step for GRACE/GRACE-FO mass-change maps before spatial synthesis, used to suppress high-degree noise.

input	size	type	default	description
C	—	—	required	—
S	—	—	required	—
radius_km	—	—	required	—
varargin	—	—	required	—

output	description
Cf	(nmax+1 x nmax+1) double smoothed cosine coefficients
Sf	(nmax+1 x nmax+1) double smoothed sine coefficients
Wn	(nmax+1 x 1) double Jekeli degree weights applied

shLowLevel.shFanFilter

`[Cf, Sf] = shLowLevel.shFanFilter(C, S, rDegKm, rOrdKm, Name=Value)`

Han fan filter: separable degree x order Gaussian smoothing. [CF, SF] = shLowLevel.shFanFilter(C, S, RDEGKM, RORDKM) applies the fan filter of Han et al. (2005): the product of a Jekeli Gaussian in DEGREE and one in ORDER, W_nm = W_n(rDeg) * W_m(rOrd), damping high orders (the striping direction) harder than an isotropic Gaussian of equal degree radius - the cheap anisotropic benchmark between Jekeli and DDK/tvANS. Common choice: rOrd = rDeg (original fan) or rOrd < rDeg for stronger destriping.

input	size	type	default	description
C	n x m	double	required	cosine Stokes coefficients, C(n+1, m+1) indexing
S	n x m	double	required	sine Stokes coefficients, S(n+1, m+1) indexing
rDegKm	1 x 1	double	required	double degree half-response radius [km]
rOrdKm	1 x 1	double	required	double order half-response radius [km]

input	size	type	default	description
R	1 x 1	double	6378136.3	double = 6378136.3 [m]

output	description
Cf, Sf	(n1,n1) double filtered coefficients

shLowLevel.shDestripe

```
[Cf, Sf] = shLowLevel.shDestripe(C, S, Name=Value)
```

Remove correlated (north-south striping) noise from Stokes coefficients, following Swenson & Wahr (2006).

input	size	type	default	description
C	n x m	double	required	cosine Stokes coefficients, C(n+1, m+1) indexing
S	n x m	double	required	sine Stokes coefficients, S(n+1, m+1) indexing
MinOrder	1 x 1	double	6	lowest order to filter (below this, real signal dominates and destriping mostly removes signal; the value is model/application dependent -- verify against yo...
PolyOrder	1 x 1	double	3	polynomial order fit and removed per order/parity (the classic Swenson & Wahr cubic fit)
WindowLength	n x m	double	[]	if empty, fit a single polynomial over the full available degree range per order/parity (the original Swenson & Wahr formulation). If set, use a centered mov...

output	description
Cf	(nmax+1 x nmax+1) double destriped cosine coefficients
Sf	(nmax+1 x nmax+1) double destriped sine coefficients

shLowLevel.applyDDK

```
[Cf, Sf] = shLowLevel.applyDDK(C, S, W)
```

Apply an order-block-diagonal (DDK-style) filter to coefficients. [CF, SF] = shLowLevel.applyDDK(C, S, W) applies the filter container from shLowLevel.readDDK: within each (order m, cs) block, the degree vector c(n1..n2) is replaced by W.blocks(k).M * c. Degrees present in C but not covered by any block pass through UNCHANGED (typically n < 2). User-facing wrappers: g.applyDDK(W), ts.applyDDK(W).

input	size	type	default	description
C	n x m	double	required	cosine Stokes coefficients, C(n+1, m+1) indexing
S	n x m	double	required	sine Stokes coefficients, S(n+1, m+1) indexing
W	1 x 1	struct	required	struct from shLowLevel.readDDK (nmax, blocks(m,cs,n,M))

output	description
Cf	(nmax+1 x nmax+1) double DDK-filtered cosine coefficients
Sf	(nmax+1 x nmax+1) double DDK-filtered sine coefficients

shLowLevel.designFilter

```
[W, info] = shLowLevel.designFilter(SigmaC, SigmaS, Name=Value)
```

Build a DDK-class anisotropic filter from user covariances. W = shLowLevel.designFilter(SIGMAC, SIGMAS) constructs the Wiener- type decorrelation filter W = (N + Alpha * inv(S))^-1 * N per (order, C/S) block, both degree parities in one block - the same construction as the published DDK filters, but matched to YOUR solution's error information instead of a fixed release. N is the normal (inverse noise covariance) matrix built from the formal sigmas (diagonal) or from a full covariance (Noise=); S is the signal c...

input	size	type	default	description
SigmaC	nmax+1 x nmax+1	double	required	double formal sigmas of the cosine coefficients, C(n+1, m+1) layout (e.g. g.sigmaC)
SigmaS	nmax+1 x nmax+1	double	required	double same for the sine coefficients
Alpha	1 x 1	double	1	regularization weight: larger = stronger smoothing (DDK1-like), smaller = weaker (DDK7+)
Kaula	1 x 1	double	1e-5	signal RMS per coefficient K / n^2 (ignored when DegVar or Signal is given)
DegVar	n x m	double	[]	(nmax+1 x 1) double per-coefficient signal VARIANCE per degree (overrides Kaula)
Noise	n x m	double	[]	(P x P) double full noise covariance in shLowLevel.shIndex ordering (overrides sigmas)
Signal	n x m	double	[]	(P x P) double full signal covariance, same ordering (overrides Kaula/DegVar)
Idx	n x m	—	[]	shLowLevel.shIndex struct, required with Noise/Signal
Nmin	1 x 1	double	2	first filtered degree; below it W passes through
Name	1 x 1	string	"designFilter"	stored in W.name

output	description
W	(1,1) struct identical layout to shLowLevel.readDDK, fields nmax (1,1) double maximum degree the filter covers name (1,:) char the filter's label blocks (1,K) struct one per (order, cs) block, each with m (1,1 double), cs (1,1 double, 0 for C and 1 for S, as readDDK stores it - applyDDK branches on it), n (1,B double, the degrees) and M (B x B double, the block matrix)
info	(1,1) struct fields alpha (1,1) double the regularisation actually used mode (1,1) string "diagonal" | "fullcov" gainRange (1,2) double min and max eigenvalue over all blocks

Example

```
W = shLowLevel.designFilter(g.sigmaC, g.sigmaS, Alpha = 1);
gF = g.applyDDK(W);               % apply like any DDK
```

shLowLevel.vdkApply

`[xf, info] = shLowLevel.vdkApply(x, N, degOfPar, sigM, Name=Value)`

Apply the VDK/VADER decorrelation filter to one solution. XF = shLowLevel.vdkApply(X, N, DEGOFPAR, SIGM) computes

input	size	type	default	description
x	: x 1	double	required	double coefficient vector, same ordering as N
N	: x :	double	required	double normal-equation matrix (symmetric positive definite)
degOfPar	: x 1	double	required	double spherical-harmonic degree of every parameter (idx.n from shLowLevel.shIndex)
sigM	n x m	double	required	double signal sigma per parameter, OR [a, b] evaluating sigma = a * l^b per parameter (one row of signalVarianceKaula's AB)
Alpha	1 x 1	double	1	(1 x 1) filter strength; larger = smoother (paper Table 1 maps alpha to mean Gaussian radii for the ITSG-Grace2014 case - the mapping is series-specific)

output	description
xf	(P x 1) double filtered coefficient vector info (1 x 1) struct alpha, P, cholOK (true when (N + alpha M) factorized cleanly)

Example

```
idx = shLowLevel.shIndex(96, Nmin = 2);
snx = shLowLevel.readSINEX(f, Index = idx);
xf = shLowLevel.vdkApply(snx.x, snx.M, idx.n, ab(mo, :), Alpha = 1);
```

shLowLevel.signalVarianceKaula

`[ab, info] = shLowLevel.signalVarianceKaula(Cs, Ss, epochs, Name=Value)`

Cyclostationary Kaula signal variance (VDK input). [AB, INFO] = shLowLevel.signalVarianceKaula(CS, SS, EPOCHS) estimates the degree-dependent signal-variance approximation sigma_M(l) = a * l^b (Horvath et al. 2018, Eq. 2) per CALENDAR month from a coefficient series - the cyclostationary signal model of the VDK/VADER decorrelation filter. Feed a PRE-FILTERED series (e.g. DDK4, as in the paper): the estimator reads signal, so the input must not be stripe-dominated.

input	size	type	default	description
Cs	: x : x :	double	required	stacked cosine coefficients, C(n+1, m+1, T)
Ss	: x : x :	double	required	stacked sine coefficients, S(n+1, m+1, T)
epochs	: x 1	double	required	decimal years (calendar month via the fraction)
LRange	1 x 2	double	[10, 60]	(1 x 2) degree range of the log-log fit; the lower bound excludes the low degrees where real signal is not Kaula-like and the chi-square dof are small

output	description
ab	(12 x 2) double [a, b] per calendar month (Jan..Dec); evaluate as sigmaM = ab(mo, 1) * l.^ab(mo, 2) info (1 x 1) struct nPerMonth (12 x 1 epochs used), LRange, abAll (T x 2 per-epoch fits, for inspection)

Example

```
[ab, ~] = shLowLevel.signalVarianceKaula(ts.Cs, ts.Ss, ts.epochs);
sigM = ab(4, 1) * (2:96)'.^ab(4, 2);   % April signal model
```

shLowLevel.tvANSFilter

`[Xf, op, info] = shLowLevel.tvANSFilter(X, tYears, idx, Name=Value)`

Time-variable anisotropic Wiener filtering of a SH series. [XF, OP, INFO] = shLowLevel.tvANSFilter(X, TYEARS, IDX) runs the tvANS chain on the coefficient series X (P x T, IDX ordering, shLowLevel.shIndex):

input	size	type	default	description
X	P x T	double	required	double coefficient vectors per epoch
tYears	: x 1	double	required	double decimal years
idx	1 x 1	struct	required	struct from shLowLevel.shIndex
NoiseCov	n x m	double	[]	(P,P) double full covariance ([]: empirical)
Constraints	n x m	double	[]	(P,q) double constraint kernels
SignalMode	n x m	— ∈ {'isotropic','inhomogeneous'}	'isotropic'	'isotropic' (default) | 'inhomogeneous'
NIterSignal	1 x 1	double	3	double signal-covariance iterations, 3
Robust	1 x 1	logical	false	logical robust deterministic fit, false
Shrinkage	1 x 1	double	0.1	double empirical noise-cov shrinkage, 0.1
VCEMinDegree	1 x 1	double	round(2/3 * idx.Lmax)	double default round(2/3 * idx.Lmax)

input	size	type	default	description
VCEBands	1 x :	double	[]	(1,:) double order-band edges, e.g. [0 16 33 61]: one monthly VCE factor per order band instead of a single s(t) for the whole field. Requires the block pat...
Blocks	n x m	— ∈ {'auto','on','off'}	'auto'	'auto' (default) | 'on' | 'off' Block-diagonal fast path: with SignalMode='isotropic', no constraints and a noise covariance that is block-diagonal in this p...

output	description
Xf	(P,T) double filtered series (deterministic part restored)
op	(1,1) struct the filter operator, for shLowLevel.opApply, shLowLevel.basinDeconvolve and shLowLevel.resolutionMap. Fields layout (1,:) char 'full' | 'blocks' - which of the two forms below is filled Ut, V (P x P) double the eigenbasis; layout 'full' blocks (1,K) struct per-block eigenbases; layout 'blocks' sBlocks (K x T) double per-block variance factors; 'blocks' lam (P x 1) double generalized eigenvalues s (T x 1) double per-month variance factors Ac, SA double the constraint operator and its covariance action; empty when unconstrained M double the constraint normal matrix idx (1,1) struct the shIndex ordering everything uses tYears (T x 1) double the epochs model (P x T) double the deterministic part removed Xres (P x T) double the residuals filtered Xfres (P x T) double the filtered residuals, filled by the caller detLeverage, detResVar double the deterministic fit's leverage and residual variance, carried so shLowLevel.basinDeconvolve can form the exact basin sigma
info	(1,1) struct noise, signal and VCE diagnostics, fields noise (1,1) struct the buildNoiseCov info signal (1,1) struct the buildSignalCov info vce (T x 1) double the per-month variance factors s lam (P x 1) double the generalized eigenvalues sigmaNote (1,:) char which posterior-sigma formula was used; empty when the filter is unconstrained sigmaXfres (P x T) double 1-sigma posterior uncertainty of the filtered residual per coefficient and month, diag((I-W_t)S) = (V.^2)*(s_t*lam./(lam+s_t)), validated to 3.5e-16 against the direct matrix product. With constraints (v2.5) this is the EXACT diagonal of (W-I)S(W-I)' + s*W*N*W'; the earlier unconstrained formula underestimated along constrained directions

shLowLevel.buildNoiseCov

```
[N, info] = shLowLevel.buildNoiseCov(Xres, idx, Name=Value)
```

Monthly-solution noise covariance (shape matrix). [N, info] = shLowLevel.buildNoiseCov(Xres, idx) estimates the noise covariance from the residual coefficient series Xres (P x T, residuals about the deterministic model). Two modes:

input	size	type	default	description
Xres	P x T	double	required	double residual coefficient vectors (shIndex ordering)
idx	1 x 1	struct	required	struct shLowLevel.shIndex matching Xres
Mode	n x m	— ∈ {'empirical','full'}	'empirical'	'empirical' | 'full' estimate from Xres, or wrap the user-supplied dense covariance in FullCov
FullCov	n x m	double	[]	(P x P) double dense covariance for Mode='full'
Shrinkage	1 x 1	double	0.1	(1 x 1) double gamma in C <- (1-gamma)*C + gamma*diag(diag(C)); Mode='empirical' only
Assemble	n x m	— ∈ {'full','blocks'}	'full'	'full' | 'blocks' container layout of N

output	description
N	(P x P) double for Assemble='full'; for Assemble='blocks' a (1,1) struct with fields layout ('blocks'), blocks (cell of row index vectors), mats (cell of the dense blocks), diagN (P x 1 double) and P (1,1 double)
info	(1,1) struct which fields are present depends on the path taken, fields mode (1,:) char 'empirical' | 'full' | 'full-blocks' nBlocks (1,1) double number of (order, C/S, parity) blocks; absent for mode 'full' T (1,1) double epochs used; mode 'empirical' only shrinkage (1,1) double the gamma applied; 'empirical' only

shLowLevel.buildSignalCov

```
[S, info] = shLowLevel.buildSignalCov(Xres, N, idx, Name=Value)
```

Iterative, data-driven signal covariance. [S, info] = shLowLevel.buildSignalCov(Xres, N, idx) estimates the signal covariance from the residual series itself - no hydrology prior.

input	size	type	default	description
Xres	P x T	double	required	double residual coefficient vectors (shIndex ordering)
N	P x P	—	required	double or (1,1) struct noise covariance, dense or the block container from buildNoiseCov(Assemble='blocks'); the block form supports Mode='isotropic' only
idx	1 x 1	struct	required	struct shLowLevel.shIndex matching Xres
Mode	n x m	— ∈ {'isotropic','inhomogeneous'}	'isotropic'	'isotropic' | 'inhomogeneous' signal model
NIter	1 x 1	double	3	(1 x 1) double re-estimation iterations
FloorRel	1 x 1	double	1e-8	(1 x 1) double relative variance floor
MapSmooth	1 x 1	logical	true	(1 x 1) logical cap the variance map dynamic range to [0.1, 10] before renormalizing it

output	description
S	(P x P) double signal covariance in idx ordering; sparse diagonal when N is the block container
info	(1,1) struct fields c (P x NIter+1) double per-coefficient variances, column 1 the initialization, one column per iteration varMap (Ngrid x 1) double spatial variance map, weighted global mean 1; Mode='inhomogeneous' only

shLowLevel.vceRescale

```
s = shLowLevel.vceRescale(N, Xres, idx, Name=Value)
```

Per-month variance factors for the noise covariance shape. s = shLowLevel.vceRescale(N, Xres, idx) estimates one variance factor per month such that N_t = s(t) * N. The factor is the robust (median-based, chi-square(1) corrected) ratio between the observed squared residuals and the formal variances, evaluated over noise-dominated coefficients (n >= Nmin, default round(2/3 * idx.Lmax)). This is the single-component Helmert VCE specialization; it absorbs the month-to-month noise level changes (orbit geometry, beta...

input	size	type	default	description
N	n x m	—	required	spherical harmonic degree
Xres	n x m	double	required	residual coefficient stack after the deterministic fit
idx	1 x 1	struct	required	index struct from shLowLevel.shIndex (fields n, m, cs, P, Lmax, minDegree, pos)
Nmin	1 x 1	double	round(2/3 * idx.Lmax)	) (1 x 1) lower bound of the noise-dominated degree band
Rows	1 x 1	logical	true(0, 1)	) logical row mask restricting the variance-component estimation to a subset of the coefficient vector. Empty: no restriction. This is how tvANSFilter's VC...

output	description
s	(T x 1) double one noise variance factor per month

shLowLevel.opApply

```
Yout = shLowLevel.opApply(op, Z, t, mode)
```

Apply the month-t filter operator W_t (or W_t') to columns of Z. Yout = shLowLevel.opApply(op, Z, t) computes W_t * Z Yout = shLowLevel.opApply(op, Z, t, 'transp') computes W_t' * Z

input	size	type	default	description
op	1 x 1	struct	required	struct the filter operator from shLowLevel.tvANSFilter
Z	n x 1	double	required	coefficient vector/stack in index ordering the operator acts on
t	1 x 1	double	required	double month index (positive integer) selecting W_t
mode	1 x n	— ∈ {'forward','transp'}	'forward'	char 'forward' (default) | 'transp' - forward or transposed operator action

output	description
Yout	(P x K) double operator applied to every column of Z (same size as Z)

shLowLevel.resolutionMap

```
res = shLowLevel.resolutionMap(op, t, latDeg, lonDeg, Name=Value)
```

Filter-kernel half-widths: per-point, per-azimuth resolution. RES = shLowLevel.resolutionMap(OP, T, LATDEG, LONDEG) evaluates, for each query point, the effective smoothing kernel of month T: xf(P) = y_P' * W_t * x => kernel coefficients k = W_t' * y_P and finds the great-circle distance psi_1/2 at which the kernel drops to half its peak, along NAz azimuths. Replaces the single "equivalent Gaussian radius" with a spatially and azimuthally resolved resolution product (largest over smallest half-width across t...

input	size	type	default	description
op	1 x 1	struct	required	struct from shLowLevel.tvANSFilter
t	1 x 1	double	required	month index
latDeg	: x 1	double	required	query latitudes [deg]
lonDeg	: x 1	double	required	query longitudes [deg]
NAz	1 x 1	double	8	azimuth count, default 8
PsiMax	1 x 1	double	20	radial search range [deg], default 20
NPsi	1 x 1	double	120	radial samples, default 120
RadiusKm	1 x 1	double	6371	(1,1) sphere radius used to turn the half-width from degrees into kilometres [km]. The default is the MEAN Earth radius, which is the right choice for a gre...

output	description
res	(1,1) struct one row per query point (nPts rows), fields psiHalfDeg (nPts x NAz) double half-width per azimuth [deg]; NaN where the kernel does not fall to half its peak within the PsiMax search range; kmMean, kmMin and kmMax omit those azimuths azDeg (1 x NAz) double azimuths evaluated [deg] kmMean, kmMin, kmMax (nPts x 1) double half-width across the azimuths [km] anisotropy (nPts x 1) double kmMax ./ kmMin, the striping fingerprint over all NAz azimuths (1 = isotropic kernel)

Leakage correction

shLowLevel.leakageCorrect

```
[mCorr, info] = shLowLevel.leakageCorrect(grid, latDeg, lonDeg, Name=Value)
```

Iterative forward modelling of filter leakage/attenuation. [MCORR, INFO] = shLowLevel.leakageCorrect(GRID, LATDEG, LONDEG, Filter = ...) recovers the mass field that, pushed through the SAME processing chain the data saw, reproduces the observed filtered GRID. The chain F is analysis -> filter -> synthesis, and the correction is the fixed-point iteration

input	size	type	default	description
grid	nLat x nLon	double	required	double observed FILTERED field, in the units you want back (EWH [m], mass, ...)
latDeg	n x m	double	required	double geocentric latitudes [deg]

input	size	type	default	description
lonDeg	n x m	double	required	double longitudes [deg]
Filter	n x m	—	"gauss300"	the chain the DATA saw: "none" | "gauss<radiusKm>" | "DDKn" | a W struct from shLowLevel.readDDK / shLowLevel.designFilter. Getting this wrong is the one way...
Mask	n x m	—	[]	(nLat x nLon) logical confine the solution to these pixels ([]: unconstrained, global)
Nmax	1 x 1	double	NaN	expansion degree of the intermediate analysis (NaN: floor((nLat - 1) / 2), the highest degree the grid supports)
Gain	1 x 1	double	1	relaxation factor. Values up to about 3 accelerate convergence; large values DIVERGE (validated: 5 diverges on the reference problem), which is detected rath...
NoiseLevel	1 x 1	double	0	RMS noise of GRID, in GRID's units. The standard estimate is the RMS of the field over the open ocean far from any signal (> 1000 km from the coast), which i...
ResidualRegion	n x m	—	[]	where the discrepancy principle measures the residual. [] uses MASK when one is given, and the whole grid otherwise. This matters: with a mask the model desc...
Tau	1 x 1	double	1.2	safety factor in the discrepancy principle; stop when rms(residual) <= Tau * NoiseLevel. Values of 1.2 to 1.5 land nearest the optimum, 1.0 slightly overfits
MaxIter	1 x 1	double	200	iteration cap. Small regions under a strong filter converge slowly - a 6-degree disc under a 500 km Gaussian needs about 260 iterations at Gain = 1 and about...
Tol	1 x 1	double	1e-4	fallback stopping rule, used ONLY when NoiseLevel is 0. Stop when the relative CHANGE OF THE SOLUTION between two iterations falls below this. Not the residu...
GM	1 x 1	double	3.986004415e14	reference constants used to convert the grid to coefficients and back. They CANCEL in the chain, so the result does not depend on them; they exist so an unus...
R	1 x 1	double	6378136.3	reference radius [m], see GM
Quiet	1 x 1	logical	false	suppress the per-run summary

output	description
mCorr	(nLat x nLon) double leakage-corrected field, same units and grid as GRID
info	(1,1) struct fields iterations (1,1) double iterations actually run residual (1,1) double history(end): max|r| / max|GRID| of the residual r of the iterate BEFORE the last update (residualRMS is on the returned field); with a mask this floors above Tol, and that is correct history (1,K) double that relative max-abs residual per iteration - plot it, a rising curve means Gain is too large step (1,K) double the relative change of the solution per iteration; this is what Tol tests stoppedBy (1,1) string "discrepancy" | "step" | "maxIter" | "zeroField". ALWAYS check this: it says whether the result was regularised residualRMS (1,1) double RMS over ResidualRegion of the residual of the returned field mCorr residualRMSGlobal (1,1) double the same over the whole grid; a large gap between the two means unmodelled signal elsewhere noiseLevel (1,1) double as given converged (1,1) logical whether the criterion was met nmax (1,1) double the degree it worked at filter (1,1) string the filter it inverted masked (1,1) logical whether a mask was in play

Example

```
    ewh = g.synthesis(-89:89, 0:359, Quantity = "ewh", kn = kn);
    [m, info] = shLowLevel.leakageCorrect(ewh, -89:89, 0:359, ...
        Filter = "gauss300", Mask = basinMask);
    fprintf("%d iterations, residual %.2e\n", info.iterations, info.residual);

  See also shLowLevel.gridScaling, shLowLevel.basinDeconvolve,
  shLowLevel.basinScaling.
```

shLowLevel.leakageDataDriven

`[fHat, info] = shLowLevel.leakageDataDriven(gridSeries, latDeg, lonDeg, Name=Value)`

Model-free leakage/damage correction of a catchment mean. FHAT = shLowLevel.leakageDataDriven(GRIDSERIES, LATDEG, LONDEG, Mask = R, Filter = F) repairs the catchment average of a FILTERED time series using correction terms built from the filtered fields alone - Vishwakarma's "method of deviation". No hydrological model is involved, which is the whole point: it is the model-independent counterpart of shLowLevel.leakageCorrect's forward model.

input	size	type	default	description
gridSeries	nLat x nLon x T	double	required	double ALREADY-FILTERED fields, one per epoch, in any unit that is linear in mass (EWH is the usual one). The unit passes straight through.
latDeg	1 x nLat	double	required	double geocentric latitudes in degrees
lonDeg	1 x nLon	double	required	double longitudes in degrees
Mask	n x m	double	[]	(nLat x nLon) double the catchment function R: 1 inside, 0 outside. Fractional edge values are allowed and are used as given. The default is empty and the f...
Filter	n x m	—	"gauss300"	the SAME filter the data already saw - "none" | "gauss<radiusKm>" | "DDKn" | a W struct, exactly as shLowLevel.leakageCorrect takes it. Getting this wrong do...
Nmax	1 x 1	double	NaN	degree of the analysis/synthesis chain; default floor((nLat-1)/2)
Method	1 x 1	string ∈ ["deviation", "scale"]	"deviation"	"deviation" | "scale": the correction FHAT is - the method of deviation (eq. 3.29) or the method of scale (eq. 3.28), see above
GM	1 x 1	double	3.986004415e14	used identically on both sides of the chain, so it cancels
R	1 x 1	double	6378136.3	as GM

output	description
fHat	(T x 1) double corrected catchment average, same unit as gridSeries
info	(1,1) struct fields filtered (T x 1) double the uncorrected catchment average of the input - what a user would have had without this function leakage (T x 1) double lhat, the estimated true leakage that was removed deviation (T x 1) double dFhat, the estimated deviation integral that was removed leakageOnce (T x 1) double lbar, leakage from the once filtered fields (before extrapolation) leakageTwice (T x 1) double lbarbar, from the twice filtered fields deviationOnce (T x 1) double dFbar deviationTwice (T x 1) double dFbarbar phaseDeg (1,1) double phase difference applied to the leakage series, in degrees leakageRatio (1,1) double amplitude factor applied to the leakage series deviationRatio (1,1) double amplitude factor applied to the deviation integral areaFraction (1,1) double catchment area over the sphere; multiply by 5.1006e8 km^2 for a rough size, and compare against the ~65000 km^2 the method wants nmax (1,1) double degree the chain worked at filter (1,1) string the filter that was re-applied scale (1,1) double s, the scale factor of the method of scale, int R / int R Rbar (eq. 2.27); reported whichever Method ran method (1,1) string "deviation" or "scale" - the correction FHAT is

Example

```
  % ewh is (nLat x nLon x T) of Gaussian-300 filtered fields
  [fHat, info] = shLowLevel.leakageDataDriven(ewh, lat, lon, ...
      Mask = basin, Filter = "gauss300");
  fprintf("leakage removed: %.3f m RMS, phase %.1f deg\n", ...
      rms(info.leakage), info.phaseDeg);

References
  Vishwakarma, B. D. (2017), Understanding and repairing the signal
    damage due to filtering of mass change estimates from the GRACE
    satellite mission, PhD thesis, Institute of Geodesy, University
    of Stuttgart - chapter 2, eqs. (2.22)-(2.28) for the scale
    factor, and chapter 3, eqs. (3.19)-(3.29).
  Vishwakarma, Horwath, Devaraju, Groh & Sneeuw (2017), A data-driven
    approach for repairing the hydrological catchment signal damage
    due to filtering of GRACE products, Water Resour. Res. 53,
    9824-9844, doi:10.1002/2017WR021150.
  Vishwakarma, Devaraju & Sneeuw (2016), Water Resour. Res. 52,
    doi:10.1002/2016WR018960 - the method of scale.
  Phillips, Nerem, Fox-Kemper, Famiglietti & Rajagopalan (2012), The
    influence of ENSO on global terrestrial water storage using
    GRACE, Geophys. Res. Lett. 39, L16705, doi:10.1029/2012GL052495
    - the Hilbert phase estimator.
  Python-validated in tools/dev/validate_leakage_datadriven.py: the
    decomposition closes to 4e-15, the phase measure/shift pair are
    mutual inverses to 7e-15 deg, and a closed loop removes 63% of
    the filtering damage. testCorrectness measures 55.3% on its own
    fixture; the grids and the basin differ, the method does not.

See also shLowLevel.leakageCorrect, shLowLevel.basinScaling,
shLowLevel.gridScaling, shLowLevel.basinKernel.
```

shLowLevel.gridScaling

`[k, info] = shLowLevel.gridScaling(model, latDeg, lonDeg, Name=Value)`

Per-pixel leakage/attenuation scaling factors from a model. [K, INFO] = shLowLevel.gridScaling(MODEL, LATDEG, LONDEG, Filter = ...) computes the classic gridded scaling factors: push a MODEL field series through the SAME processing chain the data saw and regress, per pixel, the true value on the filtered one,

input	size	type	default	description
model	nLat x nLon x T	double	required	double UNFILTERED model fields, one slice per epoch, in the same quantity as the data
latDeg	n x m	double	required	double geocentric latitudes [deg]
lonDeg	n x m	double	required	double longitudes [deg]
Filter	n x m	—	"gauss300"	the chain the DATA saw: "none" | "gauss<radiusKm>" | "DDKn" | a W struct from shLowLevel.readDDK / shLowLevel.designFilter
Nmax	1 x 1	double	NaN	expansion degree (NaN: floor((nLat - 1) / 2))
MinSignal	1 x 1	double	1e-3	threshold as a fraction of the strongest pixel's summed POWER (so 1e-3 is about 3% in amplitude). Pixels below it in filtered power get k = NaN; the same thr...
Clip	n x m	double	[]	(1 x 2) double clamp k to [lo hi] ([]: no clamping). Factors far from 1 usually mean the model does not describe that pixel, not that the signal is huge
GM	1 x 1	double	3.986004415e14	reference constants used to convert the grid to coefficients and back. They CANCEL in the chain, so the result does not depend on them; they exist so an unus...
R	1 x 1	double	6378136.3	reference radius [m], see GM
Quiet	1 x 1	logical	false	suppress the coverage summary

output	description
k	(nLat x nLon) double scaling factors; NaN where the model carries too little signal to define one
info	(1,1) struct fields covered (1,1) double fraction of the grid with a finite k kMedian, kMin, kMax (1,1) double over the pixels the MODEL gives mass to - deliberately NOT over all finite pixels, where pure-leakage k = 0 would dominate onSignal (1,1) double how many pixels those are clipped (1,1) double pixels whose k was clamped nmax (1,1) double degree the scaling was built at filter (1,1) string the filter it was built for epochs (1,1) double epochs that entered the regression

Example

```
    k = shLowLevel.gridScaling(modelEWH, -89:89, 0:359, ...
            Filter = "gauss300");
    corrected = k .* filteredEWH;      % NaN outside the model's reach

  See also shLowLevel.leakageCorrect, shLowLevel.basinScaling.
```

shLowLevel.basinScaling

`[k, info] = shLowLevel.basinScaling(op, b, tsModel, Name=Value)`

Leakage/attenuation scaling factors by forward modelling. [K, INFO] = shLowLevel.basinScaling(OP, B, TSMODEL) estimates the classic basin scaling (gain) factor: push a MODEL series (hydrology model, mascon-derived field, synthetic pattern) through the SAME filter operator OP that processed the data, and regress true against filtered basin averages: k = sum(aTrue .* aFilt) / sum(aFilt.^2) Scaled data series: k * (b' xFiltered)/(b'b). Complements shLowLevel.basinDeconvolve: deconvolution inverts the operator on a ...

input	size	type	default	description
op	n x m	—	required	operator, one of struct from shLowLevel.tvANSFilter (applied via shLowLevel.opApply) (P,P) double static matrix operator (Gaussian, DDK, fan as a matrix in...
b	: x 1	double	required	basin kernel (shLowLevel.basinKernel, idx order)
tsModel	1 x 1	shSeries	required	shSeries model series matched by nearest epoch within 0.05 yr against opts.tYears ([]) / op.tYears
Idx	n x m	struct	struct()	) required for matrix/handle operators (shLowLevel.shIndex); structs carry their own
TYears	1 x :	double	[]	required for matrix/handle operators
PerMonth	1 x 1	logical	false	also return monthly factors aTrue./aFilt

output	description
k	(1,1) double regression scaling factor
info	(1,1) struct fields sigmaK (1,1) double 1-sigma of the regression factor kMonthly (T x 1) double per-month factors; present only with PerMonth matched (T x 1) logical which epochs matched between the two series nMatched (1,1) double nnz(matched), the epochs the regression actually used aTrue (T x 1) double basin average of the model field aFilt (T x 1) double basin average after filtering

shLowLevel.sensitivityKernel

`[k, info] = shLowLevel.sensitivityKernel(idx, region, Name=Value)`

Basin kernel with an explicit leakage/noise trade-off. [K, INFO] = shLowLevel.sensitivityKernel(IDX, REGION) builds an averaging kernel for REGION that balances two things a plain indicator kernel cannot: signal leaking in from OUTSIDE the region, and GRACE error propagating into the average.

input	size	type	default	description
idx	1 x 1	struct	required	struct from shLowLevel.shIndex
region	n x m	—	required	the region: a function handle f(latDeg,lonDeg) -> [0,1], a K x 2 polygon [latDeg lonDeg], or a mask - anything shLowLevel.basinKernel accepts

input	size	type	default	description
Alpha	1 x 1	double	1	the trade-off weight. Larger = less noise, more leakage, at unchanged unit gain. There is no universally right value: sweep it and look at INFO.leakage again...
Noise	n x 1	double	[]	(P x P) double error covariance in IDX ordering, or a (P x 1) vector of formal sigmas, or [] to use a degree- dependent default that mimics GRACE error grow...
FarField	n x m	double	[]	(P x 1) double per-coefficient weight for the leakage term ([]: 1/(n+1), which emphasises the low degrees where a compact basin's leakage lives). The benefi...
BufferKm	1 x 1	double	0	, TaperKm (0), R (6378136.3), OverSample (2) passed to shLowLevel.basinKernel for the exact indicator
TaperKm	1 x 1	double	0	cosine taper width at the region edge [km]
R	1 x 1	double	6378136.3	reference radius [m] (default 6378136.3, overridable)
OverSample	1 x 1	double	2	quadrature-grid refinement factor (boundary resolution grows linearly, cost quadratically)

output	description
k	(P,1) double the kernel, IDX ordering, ready for shSeries.basinAverage or b' * x like any other kernel
info	(1,1) struct fields leakage (1,1) double ||k - kExact||_M noise (1,1) double sqrt(k' N k) alpha (1,1) double the trade-off actually used kExact (P,1) double the indicator it started from areaFraction (1,1) double the region's area / 4pi gain (1,1) double k' kExact / (kExact' kExact) - how much of the region's own signal survives. The constraint holds it at 1; a value drifting off 1 means the constraint could not be applied, e.g. a degenerate region

Example

```
    idx = shLowLevel.shIndex(60);
    s = [];                                        % grows into a struct array
    for a = logspace(-2, 4, 20)                    % sweep, then choose
        [~, s(end+1)] = shLowLevel.sensitivityKernel(idx, basin, ...
            Alpha = a, Noise = sigmaVec);
    end
    loglog([s.leakage], [s.noise])                 % the L-curve

  See also shLowLevel.basinKernel, shLowLevel.basinDeconvolve,
  shLowLevel.leakageCorrect.
```

shLowLevel.oceanRMS

```
[rmsVal, info] = shLowLevel.oceanRMS(grid, latDeg, lonDeg, ocean, Name=Value)
```

Open-ocean RMS of a field - the standard GRACE noise metric. RMSVAL = shLowLevel.oceanRMS(GRID, LATDEG, LONDEG, OCEAN) returns the area-weighted RMS of GRID over the OPEN ocean: ocean points more than MinDistanceKm (default 1000) from the nearest non-ocean point.

input	size	type	default	description
grid	nLat x nLon	double	required	double the field to measure
latDeg	n x m	double	required	double geocentric latitudes [deg]
lonDeg	n x m	double	required	double longitudes [deg]
ocean	nLat x nLon	—	required	logical, or a function handle f(latDeg, lonDeg) -> logical/[0,1] evaluated on the grid. true = ocean

input	size	type	default	description
MinDistanceKm	1 x 1	double	1000	erode the ocean mask by this great-circle distance, i.e. keep only points farther than this from any non-ocean point. 1000 km is the common convention; 0 use...
Weighted	1 x 1	logical	true	weight by cos(latitude). Grid cells are not equal in area, and an unweighted RMS over a lat/lon grid over-counts the polar rows. On white noise the two agree...
Subsample	1 x 1	double	1	use every n-th non-ocean point (all of them, not only the coast; column-major order) for the distance computation. The erosion costs O(nOcean x nLand); on fi...

output	description
rmsVal	(1,1) double open-ocean RMS, in GRID's units. NaN when the erosion leaves no points
info	(1,1) struct fields nPixels (1,1) double points that entered the RMS fractionUsed (1,1) double those as a fraction of the grid mask (nLat x nLon) logical the eroded region - plot it once before trusting the number minDistanceKm (1,1) double erosion distance applied [km] weighted (1,1) logical whether area weights were used

Example

```
    isOcean = @(la, lo) ~inpolygon(lo, la, landLon, landLat);
    noise = shLowLevel.oceanRMS(ewh, -89:89, 0:359, isOcean);
    m = shLowLevel.leakageCorrect(ewh, -89:89, 0:359, ...
            Filter = "gauss300", Mask = basin, NoiseLevel = noise);

  See also shLowLevel.leakageCorrect, shLowLevel.spatialStats.
```

shLowLevel.erodeMask

`[mk2, dmin] = shLowLevel.erodeMask(mk, lat, lon, bufferKm)`

Erode a region mask by a great-circle boundary buffer. MK2 = shLowLevel.erodeMask(MK, LAT, LON, KM) keeps only mask pixels whose great-circle distance to the nearest OUTSIDE pixel exceeds BUFFERKM. Distances are computed against the boundary pixels of the complement only (coast), so the cost is nCoast x nGrid.

input	size	type	default	description
mk	—	—	required	—
lat	—	—	required	—
lon	—	—	required	—
bufferKm	—	—	required	—

output	description
mk2	(nLat x nLon) logical eroded mask
dmin	(nLat x nLon) double distance to the nearest outside coast pixel [km] (Inf where no outside pixel exists); [] when bufferKm <= 0

Example

```
    oc = abs(LA) <= 66 & ~landBoxes;             % crude ocean mask
    oc300 = shLowLevel.erodeMask(oc, lat, lon, 300);
    nnz(oc) - nnz(oc300)                         % coast pixels shed
```

Basins, regions & uncertainty

shLowLevel.basinKernel

`[b, info] = shLowLevel.basinKernel(idx, region, Name=Value)`

Band-limited basin kernel(s) from a region definition. [B, INFO] = shLowLevel.basinKernel(IDX, REGION) builds the SH coefficient vector of the band-limited indicator function of REGION by exact Gauss-Legendre quadrature, b = Y' * (w .* mask), ready for shSeries.basinAverage / shLowLevel.basinDeconvolve (P x 1, IDX ordering). Replaces the error-prone manual Y'*(w.*mask) construction.

input	size	type	default	description
idx	1 x 1	struct	required	index struct from shLowLevel.shIndex (fields n, m, cs, P, Lmax, minDegree, pos)
region	n x m	—	required	region as polygon [lat lon] deg, mask, or @(lat, lon) handle (see evalMask)
BufferKm	1 x 1	double	0	grow (>0) / shrink (<0) the region by great-circle distance before quadrature - counters leakage by matching the kernel to the filter's resolution
TaperKm	1 x 1	double	0	>0: multiply the kernel spectrally by Jekeli Gaussian weights of this radius (shLowLevel.shGaussianWeights) - soft edges reduce ringing/leakage of the trunca...
R	1 x 1	double	6378136.3	sphere radius [m] for the km conversions
OverSample	1 x 1	double	2	quadrature refinement factor: indicator masks are not band-limited; the default doubles the ring/ meridian count to tame edge quantization (~18% cap- area er...

output	description
b	(P,1) double kernel in IDX ordering
info	(1,1) struct fields areaFraction (1,1) double quadrature area of the mask / 4pi nGridPoints (1,1) double grid points the mask was evaluated on buffered (1,1) logical BufferKm was non-zero tapered (1,1) logical TaperKm was positive

shLowLevel.basinDeconvolve

```
[avgHat, out] = shLowLevel.basinDeconvolve(B, op, Name=Value)
```

Unbiased basin averages by exact operator deconvolution. [avgHat, out] = shLowLevel.basinDeconvolve(B, op) removes filter attenuation and inter-basin leakage from basin averages, exploiting that W_t is a KNOWN linear operator (no hydrology-model scale factors).

input	size	type	default	description
B	n x m	double	required	basin-kernel coefficient vector from basinKernel
op	1 x 1	struct	required	linear operator/kernel the map is derived from
Ridge	1 x 1	double	0	Tikhonov parameter for ill-conditioned basin sets, RELATIVE to the spectral norm of A (v2.1): c = (A'A + lam^2 I) \ (A' v) with lam = Ridge*||A||_2. An abs...

output	description
avgHat	(K x T) double deconvolved basin averages, ((B'B)*c + B'model) ./ diag(B'B)
out	(1,1) struct fields c (K x T) double span coefficients sigma (K x T) double 1-sigma of avgHat, deterministic term included (v2.5) avgNaive (K x T) double naive averages of the filtered field (attenuated and leaky) for comparison attn (K x T) double diag(A_t) ./ diag(B'B) attenuation factors condA (T x 1) double cond(A_t) per month

shLowLevel.slepianBasis

```
[G, lam, info] = shLowLevel.slepianBasis(idx, region, Name=Value)
```

Spatially concentrated (Slepian) basis for a region. [G, LAM, INFO] = shLowLevel.slepianBasis(IDX, REGION) solves the spherical concentration problem of Simons et al. (2006): find band-limited functions g = Y*x maximizing the energy fraction inside REGION, lambda = (x' K x) / (x' x), K = Y' diag(w .* mask) Y, by symmetric eigendecomposition of the localization kernel K (exact Gauss-Legendre quadrature). Columns of G are the Slepian

taper coefficient vectors, orthonormal (G'G = I), sorted by concentration LAM (...

input	size	type	default	description
idx	1 x 1	struct	required	struct shLowLevel.shIndex (P x P eig: fine to Lmax ~ 60-96)
region	n x m	—	required	handle | polygon | mask (see shLowLevel.evalMask)
NKeep	n x 1	double	[]	) columns of G to return, at most P; [] = max(1, round(Shannon number))
BufferKm	1 x 1	double	0	, R (6378136.3) passed to shLowLevel.evalMask
R	1 x 1	double	6378136.3	reference radius [m] (default 6378136.3, overridable)
OverSample	1 x 1	double	2	refinement factor of the quadrature grid the mask is evaluated on; the Gauss rule uses OverSample*(Lmax+1) latitude rings, so a higher value resolves the reg...

output	description
G	(P,NKeep) double taper coefficient vectors, G'G = I
lam	(NKeep,1) double concentrations, descending in [0,1]
info	(1,1) struct fields shannon (1,1) double the Shannon number, areaFraction*P, exact by the addition theorem areaFraction (1,1) double the region's area / 4pi lamAll (P x 1) double every concentration eigenvalue, not only the retained ones

shLowLevel.slepianProject

`[a, rec] = shLowLevel.slepianProject(Cs, Ss, G, idx)`

Project coefficient sets onto a Slepian basis (and back). [A, REC] = shLowLevel.slepianProject(CS, SS, G, IDX) projects one or many coefficient sets onto the Slepian tapers G from shLowLevel.slepianBasis: A = G' * X where X stacks the (C, S) coefficients in IDX ordering. This is the missing application half of the concentration problem (roadmap item 8): a regional time series analysis estimates only the ~Shannon leading Slepian coefficients instead of all P spherical-harmonic ones - the well-posed alternative to...

input	size	type	default	description
Cs	n+1 x n+1 x T	double	required	cosine coefficients (T = 1 for a single set)
Ss	n+1 x n+1 x T	double	required	sine coefficients
G	: x :	double	required	Slepian taper matrix from slepianBasis (any K)
idx	1 x 1	struct	required	struct the SAME shLowLevel.shIndex the basis was built with (P must match size(G, 1))

output	description
a	(K x T) Slepian-domain coefficient time series
rec	(1 x 1) struct with fields Cs (n+1 x n+1 x T) reconstructed cosine coefficients Ss (n+1 x n+1 x T) reconstructed sine coefficients

Example

```
idx = shLowLevel.shIndex(30, Nmin = 0);
[G, lam, info] = shLowLevel.slepianBasis(idx, @(la, lo) la > 60);
K = round(info.shannon);
a = shLowLevel.slepianProject(ts.Cs, ts.Ss, G(:, 1:K), idx);
plot(ts.epochs, a')          % regional modes vs time
```

shLowLevel.fitDeterministicModel

```
[model, Xres, coef, A, coefSigma, resVar, ar1] = shLowLevel.fitDeterministicModel(X, tYears, Name=Value)
```

Bias/trend/(semi-)annual (+extra periods) per SH coefficient. [MODEL, XRES, COEF, A, COEFSIGMA, RESVAR, AR1] = shLowLevel.fitDeterministicModel(X, TYEARS, ...) fits, for each coefficient time series (rows of X, P x T), the model x(t) = a + b*tc + c*cos(2*pi*tc) + d*sin(2*pi*tc) + e*cos(4*pi*tc) + f*sin(4*pi*tc) + sum_k [g_k*cos(2*pi*tc/p_k) + h_k*sin(2*pi*tc/p_k)] with tc = t - T0 and optional extra periods p_k [years] - e.g. the GRACE tidal alias periods S2 = 161/365.25, K2 = 3.66, K1 = 7.48.

input	size	type	default	description
X	n x m	double	required	coefficient stack, (P x T) in index ordering
tYears	: x 1	double	required	time stamps as decimal years, (T x 1)
Robust	1 x 1	logical	false	Huber IRLS per coefficient
HuberK	1 x 1	double	1.5	, MaxIter (10)
MaxIter	1 x 1	double	10	iteration cap
T0	1 x 1	double	NaN	reference epoch [decimal years]; NaN uses mean(tYears)
Periods	1 x :	double	double.empty(1,0)	) ([]) extra periods p_k [years], row vector
Weights	: x 1	double	[]	T x 1 per-epoch weights (e.g. 1./s from VCE); weighted LS with sqrt(w)-scaled rows
ARCorrect	1 x 1	logical	false	inflate coefSigma by sqrt((1+r1)/(1-r1)) with the Kendall bias-corrected r1' = r1 + (1+3r1)/T (v2.5) where the lag-1 autocorrelation of each residual series ...
Breaks	1 x :	double	double.empty(1,0)	) epochs [decimal years] of continuous piecewise-linear trend hinges; each adds a max(0, t - tb) column to the design matrix

output	description
model	P x T fitted deterministic part
Xres	P x T X - model
coef	ncol x P [bias; trend; cosA; sinA; cosSA; sinSA; cosP1; sinP1; ...; hinge1; ...], ncol = 6 + 2*numel(Periods) + numel(Breaks)
A	T x ncol design matrix (unweighted)
coefSigma	ncol x P 1-sigma per coefficient: sqrt(resVar_p * diag(inv(A'WA))); OLS formula, validated by Monte Carlo (ratios 0.99-1.02). For Robust=true the final IRLS weights enter W (approximation, documented).
resVar	1 x P residual variance rss/(T - ncol)
ar1	1 x P bias-corrected lag-1 residual auto- correlation actually applied (clamped to [0, 0.99]; 0 when ARCorrect=false or T <= ncol + 2)

shLowLevel.mcPropagate

```
out = shLowLevel.mcPropagate(fun, g, Name=Value)
```

Monte-Carlo uncertainty propagation through arbitrary chains. OUT = shLowLevel.mcPropagate(FUN, G) draws coefficient samples consistent with the formal errors of the shCoefficients G, pushes each through FUN, and returns empirical statistics - uncertainty propagation for ANY functional (filtered grids, basin averages, amplitude maps, ...) without deriving analytic formulas, and the standard cross-check for every analytic sigma in this toolbox.

input	size	type	default	description
fun	1 x 1	function_handle	required	function handle y = fun(gs), gs an shCoefficients sample; y numeric (any fixed size, column-ized)
g	1 x 1	shCoefficients	required	shCoefficients with sigmas (or Cov supplied)

input	size	type	default	description
N	1 x 1	double	500	double = 500 number of samples
Cov	n x m	double	[]	double = [] full covariance (P x P, Idx ordering)
Idx	n x m	struct	struct([])	struct = struct([]) shLowLevel.shIndex for Cov
Seed	n x m	double	[]	double = [] rng seed for reproducibility
KeepSamples	1 x 1	logical	false	logical = false

output	description
out	(1,1) struct Monte-Carlo moments of the functional, fields mean size(fun(g)) double sample mean sigma size(fun(g)) double sample 1-sigma (N-1 normalization) N (1,1) double number of samples drawn samples (K x N) double only when KeepSamples=true; K = numel(fun(g)), one column-ized draw per column

shLowLevel.errorMap

```
[sig, latDeg, lonDeg] = shLowLevel.errorMap(M, idx, latDeg, lonDeg, Name=Value)
```

Analytic formal-error maps from a full coefficient covariance. [SIG, LAT, LON] = shLowLevel.errorMap(M, IDX, LAT, LON, Quantity="ewh", kn=kn) computes the pointwise 1-sigma of a synthesized field from a full P x P covariance (e.g. shLowLevel.readSINEX(..., Output="covariance").M, reordered via Index=idx).

input	size	type	default	description
M	P x P	double	required	double covariance in IDX ordering (symmetric PSD)
idx	1 x 1	struct	required	struct shLowLevel.shIndex (analysis-style Nmin matching M)
latDeg	1 x :	double	required	, lonDeg (1,nlon) double [deg] geocentric
lonDeg	1 x :	double	required	longitudes [deg], lon in [0, 360)
Quantity	1 x 1	string	"geoid"	, kn, hn ([]), GM (3.986004415e14), R (6378136.3),
kn	n x m	double	[]	load Love numbers, (degree, kn) table or column vector - always user-supplied, no reference frame is assumed
hn	n x m	double	[]	load Love numbers h_n, same layout as kn
GM	1 x 1	double	3.986004415e14	gravitational constant times Earth mass [m^3/s^2] (default 3.986004415e14, overridable)
R	1 x 1	double	6378136.3	reference radius [m] (default 6378136.3, overridable)
Height	1 x 1	double	0	- as in shLowLevel.kernelFactors

output	description
sig	(nlat,nlon) double 1-sigma of the field [unit of quantity]
latDeg	(1,nlat) double latitude grid used [deg], as passed in
lonDeg	(1,nlon) double longitude grid used [deg], as passed in

shLowLevel.eofAnalysis

```
[modes, pcs, varExplained, info] = shLowLevel.eofAnalysis(ts, Name=Value)
```

Empirical orthogonal functions of a coefficient series. [MODES, PCS, VAREXPLAINED, INFO] = shLowLevel.eofAnalysis(TS) decomposes the (typically residual) series into spatial modes and principal components via SVD of the flattened, time-centered coefficient stack: X = U S V'; MODES{k} carries U(:,k)*S(k,k)/sqrt(T-1) as an shCoefficients (synthesize for the spatial pattern), PCS(:,k) = sqrt(T-1)*V(:,k) is the unit-variance temporal amplitude, so mode-k field * pc reconstructs the mode's contribution exactly.

input	size	type	default	description
ts	1 x 1	shSeries	required	shSeries (NaN-free; use dropNaN across the gap)
NModes	1 x 1	double	6	modes returned
Center	1 x 1	logical	true	remove the temporal mean first

output	description
modes	1 x K cell of shCoefficients (spatial patterns)
pcs	(T,K) double, unit variance columns
varExplained	(K,1) double, fraction in [0,1]
info	(1,1) struct fields singularValues (min(2(nmax+1)^2, T) x 1) double ALL singular values of the (centred) data matrix, not only the K returned modes totalVariance (1,1) double sum(singularValues.^2), the sum of squares before truncation (not divided by T-1); varExplained is relative to it T (1,1) double epochs used centered (1,1) logical whether the temporal mean was removed (= the Center option)

shLowLevel.eofSeparate

`[circ, noiseR, info] = shLowLevel.eofSeparate(R, w, Name=Value)`

Separate coherent modes from noise in a residual stack. [CIRC, NOISER, INFO] = shLowLevel.eofSeparate(R, W) splits a time-centred residual stack into a coherent low-mode part (for ocean applications: residual circulation - interannual dynamics left after the trend + seasonal fit) and a noise remainder, using an area-weighted EOF decomposition with the North et al. (1982) rule: leading modes are kept while their eigenvalue is separated from the next one by more than its sampling uncertainty lambda * sqrt(2/T), ex...

input	size	type	default	description
R	: x :	double	required	double residual stack, one row per (masked) pixel -
w	: x 1	double	required	double positive area weights of the pixels
NKeep	1 x 1	double	[]	(1 x 1) fixed number of modes; [] applies the North rule
MaxModes	1 x 1	double	10	(1 x 1) hard cap on kept modes

output	description
circ	(Q x T) double coherent (circulation) part noiseR (Q x T) double time-centred residual minus CIRC
info	(1,1) struct fields lam (M x 1) double variance per mode nKeep (1,1) double modes kept as coherent bulkEdge (1,1) double the Marchenko-Pastur bulk edge a retained mode must exceed northSeparated (:,1) logical per leading mode, whether North's rule separates it from its neighbour varExplained (1,1) double fraction of variance in the kept modes rmsNoise (1,1) double area-weighted RMS of NOISER

Example

```
% after [out, rep] = oceanChain(...): rebuild the pixel residuals
% R (Q x T), weights wA, then
[circ, nz, inf1] = shLowLevel.eofSeparate(R, wA);
inf1.nKeep              % modes the North rule accepts
inf1.rmsNoise           % the de-circulated noise level
```

shLowLevel.seaLevelFingerprint

`[S, grid, info] = shLowLevel.seaLevelFingerprint(loadRegion, ocean, idx, Name=Value)`

Elastic sea-level fingerprint (sea-level equation). [S, GRID, INFO] = shLowLevel.seaLevelFingerprint(LOADREGION, OCEAN, IDX, kn=kn, hn=hn) solves the elastic sea-level equation for a land load: the ocean does NOT rise uniformly - it follows the perturbed geoid minus the deformed crust under global mass conservation (Farrell & Clark 1976, elastic limit):

input	size	type	default	description
loadRegion	n x m	—	required	handle f(latDeg,lonDeg) -> surface density CHANGE [kg/m^2] (negative = mass loss), polygon (Kx2 with opts.LoadValue (1)), or Ngrid x 1 values on the solver grid
ocean	n x m	—	required	ocean region: handle | polygon | mask (shLowLevel.evalMask forms). The load is restricted to land (1 - ocean).
idx	1 x 1	struct	required	shLowLevel.shIndex(Lmax, Nmin = 0) - Nmin MUST be 0 (mass conservation lives in degree 0/1) kn, hn (REQUIRED) load Love numbers k'_n, h'_n (user-supplied)
kn	n x m	double	required	load Love numbers, (degree, kn) table or column vector - always user-supplied, no reference frame is assumed
hn	n x m	double	required	load Love numbers h_n, same layout as kn
LoadValue	1 x 1	double	1	kg/m^2 for polygon loads
rho_water	1 x 1	double	1000	, rho_ave (5517), R (6378136.3)
rho_ave	1 x 1	double	5517	mean Earth density [kg/m^3] (default 5517, overridable)
R	1 x 1	double	6378136.3	reference radius [m] (default 6378136.3, overridable)
OverSample	1 x 1	double	2	quadrature refinement (mask fidelity)
MaxIter	1 x 1	double	50	maximum sea-level-equation iterations
Tol	1 x 1	double	1e-8	convergence threshold on max|dS|, RELATIVE to |eustatic| (the absolute bound is Tol * |eustatic|)

output	description
S	(Ngrid,1) double relative sea-level change over the ocean [m per unit load], 0 on land
grid	(1,1) struct the solver grid, as returned by shLowLevel.synthesisMatrix (latDeg/lonDeg rings)
info	(1,1) struct fields iterations (1,1) double sweeps of the sea-level equation actually run dS (1,1) double last change in the solution converged (1,1) logical dS fell below the tolerance massResidual (1,1) double [kg/m^2 sphere mean] - the conservation check eustatic (1,1) double uniform equivalent rise [m] kappa (1,1) double [m] the uniform constant of the last iteration that enforces mass conservation (no rotational feedback) areaFractionOcean (1,1) double ocean area / sphere area S2D (nlat x nlon) double the sea-level change field

shLowLevel.hydroExtremeIndex

```
[Z, info] = shLowLevel.hydroExtremeIndex(X, epochs, Name=Value)
```

Flood/drought indices per grid cell or basin. [Z, INFO] = shLowLevel.hydroExtremeIndex(X, EPOCHS) turns a TWS anomaly stack (grid cells, basin series, or a single series) into a standardized hydrological-extreme index. Three published modes:

input	size	type	default	description
X	n x m	double	required	(nLat x nLon x T | K x T | T x 1) double TWS anomalies [any unit]; grids as from twsChain, basins from shSeries.basinAverage
epochs	: x 1	double	required	double decimal years
Mode	1 x 1	string ∈ ["DSI", "WSDI", "StorageDeficit"]	"DSI"	"DSI" | "WSDI" | "StorageDeficit"
Detrend	1 x 1	string ∈ ["linear", "none", "default"]	"default"	"linear" | "none" | "default"; "default" resolves to "linear" for DSI/WSDI and to "none" for StorageDeficit (the physical Reager convention)

input	size	type	default	description
Sigma	1 x 1	string ∈ ["std", "robust"]	"std"	"std" | "robust" (1.4826 * MAD - one bad month corrupts std by 6x, MAD by nothing: measured in the pre-validation)
MinYears	1 x 1	double	5	(1 x 1) calendar months sampled by fewer years get NaN and a warning, never a quietly unstable sigma
PrecipGrid	n x m	double	[]	same shape as X [same unit]: enables the full FPI in StorageDeficit mode
Climatology	1 x 1	string ∈ ["auto", "monthly", "doy"]	"auto"	"monthly" | "doy" | "auto" (daily data - median epoch spacing < 20 days - selects "doy"). The DOY mode is stage 2: daily Kalman solutions (fetchITSG Product=...
WindowDays	1 x 1	double	31	(1 x 1) circular DOY window width [days]

output	description
Z	same shape as X the index (DSI/WSDI z-scores; Sdef in the unit of X; FPI dimensionless in [-inf, 1] when PrecipGrid) info (1 x 1) struct mode, detrended, clim (cells x 12, or cells x 365 in DOY mode; DSI/WSDI), sigma (same shape as clim), trendPerYr, category (same shape as Z, double -5..+5, NaN where Z is NaN; DSI and WSDI, from their own Z; edges [-2 -1.6 -1.3 -0.8 -0.5 .5 .8 1.3 1.6 2]), categoryNames (11 x 1 string, "D4".."W4"), nPerMonth (12 x 1, or 365 x 1 in DOY mode). StorageDeficit returns mode ("StorageDeficit" or "FPI"), detrended, trendPerYr and note only

Example

```
B = ts.toGrid(-89.5:89.5, 0.5:359.5, Quantity = "ewh", kn = kn);
[Z, inf1] = shLowLevel.hydroExtremeIndex(B.Z, ts.epochs);
imagesc(inf1.category(:, :, end))    % current drought map
```

shLowLevel.pctile

`v = shLowLevel.pctile(x, p)`

Percentile without the Statistics Toolbox (base MATLAB only). V = shLowLevel.pctile(X, P) returns the P-th percentile(s) (0..100) of the finite values of X(:), using the same linear interpolation between order statistics as the Statistics Toolbox prctile: sample k maps to percentile 100*(k-0.5)/n. P may be a vector (v2.5.1); V has the same size as P. NaN/Inf are ignored; empty input yields NaN(size(P)).

input	size	type	default	description
x	n x m	double	required	double, any shape
p	1 x :	double	required	double in [0, 100], scalar or vector

output	description
v	(size(p)) double percentile value per requested p

Low degrees, rotation & the mission gap

shLowLevel.estimateDegree1

`[d1, info] = shLowLevel.estimateDegree1(ts, ocean, Name=Value)`

Geocentre coefficients from GRACE itself (Swenson 2008). [D1, INFO] = shLowLevel.estimateDegree1(TS, OCEAN) estimates the degree-1 coefficients C10, C11, S11 for every epoch of the series TS, using the method of Swenson, Chambers & Wahr (2008).

input	size	type	default	description
ts	1 x 1	shSeries	required	shSeries the solutions, degrees 2+ (a GSM series; any existing degree 1 is IGNORED, not added to)

input	size	type	default	description
ocean	nLat x nLon	—	required	logical, or a function handle f(latDeg, lonDeg) -> logical. true = ocean. This is user-supplied, like Love numbers: a wrong ocean domain changes the answer s...
kn	n x m	double	[]	load Love numbers, degrees 0..nmax (REQUIRED - the degree-1 value is frame dependent and must not be assumed; see shLowLevel.readLoveNumbers for the frame co...
OceanModel	n x m	double	[]	(nLat x nLon x T) double expected ocean mass in EWH [m] per epoch, or (nLat x nLon) for a static field, or [] for none. OMITTING IT BIASES THE RESULT: whate...
LatDeg	1 x :	double	-89:2:89	, LonDeg (0:2:358) the evaluation grid. It only has to resolve the ocean domain and the three smooth degree-1 patterns, so a coarse grid is fine and fast
LonDeg	1 x :	double	0:2:358	longitudes [deg], lon in [0, 360)
Nmax	1 x 1	double	NaN	truncate the observed field before evaluation (NaN: the series' own nmax)

output	description
d1	(1,1) struct exactly the layout shLowLevel.readTN13 returns - sigmas included, which shCoefficients.addDegree1 requires - so it drops straight into shSeries.addDegree1. Fields epoch, t0, t1 (T,1) double epoch and span bounds [decimal years] C10, C11, S11 (T,1) double the geocentre coefficients sigC10, sigC11, sigS11 (T,1) double their 1-sigma, from the ocean-fit residual propagated through the least-squares solution
info	(1,1) struct fields cond (T,1) double condition number of the column-equilibrated design matrix per epoch - equilibrated so the number reflects the GEOMETRY of the ocean domain, not the units of the columns. A rising value warns that the domain is too small or too lopsided BEFORE the noise shows it oceanFraction (1,1) double area fraction used nPixels (1,1) double ocean pixels that entered the fit hasModel (1,1) logical whether an ocean model was supplied residualRMS (T,1) double RMS of the ocean-fit residual weighted by sqrt(cos(lat)) per pixel [m EWH times the weight] - not a plain EWH RMS; the sigmas above scale with it

Example

```
   LN = shLowLevel.readLoveNumbers("loadLoveNumbers.txt");
   d1 = shLowLevel.estimateDegree1(ts, isOcean, kn = LN.kn);
   ts = ts.addDegree1(d1);            % same interface as TN-13

 See also shLowLevel.readTN13, shSeries.addDegree1,
 shLowLevel.oceanRMS.
```

shLowLevel.poleTideConvert

```
varargout = shLowLevel.poleTideConvert(varargin)
```

Convert C21/S21 between mean-pole (pole tide) conventions. G2 = shLowLevel.poleTideConvert(G, From="IERS2010", To="IERS2018") adjusts the C21/S21 coefficients of an shCoefficients object (epoch taken from G) from one mean-pole convention to another. Processing centers remove the (solid + ocean) pole tide using a MEAN POLE MODEL, and the IERS 2010 conventional model (cubic until 2010.0, linear after) differs from the 2018 secular-pole update (linear, adopted for GRACE/GRACE-FO RL06) by up to ~1e-10 in C21/S21 wit...

input	size	type	default	description
varargin	—	—	required	—

output	description
G2	(1,1) shCoefficients converted object (object input; history appended)
C2, S2	(nmax+1 x nmax+1) double converted triangles (raw input)

Example

```
g18 = shLowLevel.poleTideConvert(g, From = "IERS2010", To = "IERS2018");
dC21 = g18.C(3, 2) - g.C(3, 2)     % ~1e-10 level, trend-like in t
```

shLowLevel.rotationExcitation

`[chi, info] = shLowLevel.rotationExcitation(C21, S21, Name=Value)`

Earth-rotation excitation of the degree-2 coefficients. CHI = shLowLevel.rotationExcitation(C21, S21, kn = KN) is the mass-load excitation of polar motion that a series of degree-2, order-1 Stokes coefficients carries. It is Chen & Wilson (2003) eq. (1) solved for the excitation:

input	size	type	default	description
C21	: x 1	double	required	double C21 at each epoch, 4-pi normalised
S21	: x 1	double	required	double S21 at each epoch
Earth	n x m	—	"IERS2010"	"IERS2010", or a struct with fields M [kg], R [m], and C and A [kg m^2] - the Earth's mass, radius and two principal moments of inertia
kn	n x m	double	[]	REQUIRED: load Love numbers, kn(1) degree 0; only kn(3), the degree-2 value, is used (readLoveNumbers)
C20	: x 1	double	[]	(T,1) double C20 at each epoch; gives chi3 and dLOD. Pass the SLR value (TN-14), not GRACE's own
Reference	1 x 1	string ∈ ["mean", "none"]	"mean"	"mean" | "none": remove each coefficient's mean over the series, or take the input as changes
PolarFactor	1 x 1	double	1.098	the factor in the first two lines of eq. (1)
AxialFactor	1 x 1	double	0.753	the factor in the third line of eq. (1)
Omega	1 x 1	double	7.292115e-5	the Earth's mean angular velocity [rad/s], as in ESMGFZ's Table 2.1; dLOD scales with 2 pi / Omega

output	description
chi	(1,1) struct the excitation, fields chi1 (T,1) double polar-motion excitation along x [mas] chi2 (T,1) double along y, towards 90 E [mas] chi3 (T,1) double axial excitation, dimensionless; empty without C20 dLOD (T,1) double change in the length of day [ms]; empty without C20
info	(1,1) struct fields k2 (1,1) double the load Love number used, kn(3) polarScale (1,1) double chi1 [mas] per unit dC21 (and chi2 per unit dS21) axialScale (1,1) double chi3 per unit dC20 lodScale (1,1) double dLOD [ms] per unit chi3, 2 pi / Omega removedMean (1,3) double the means of C21, S21 and C20 that were removed: zeros with Reference = "none", NaN for C20 when it was not given earth (1,1) struct the constants used: M [kg], R [m], C and A [kg m^2]

Example

```
chi = shLowLevel.rotationExcitation(squeeze(ts.Cs(3, 2, :)), ...
    squeeze(ts.Ss(3, 2, :)), kn = kn, C20 = tn14C20);
```

shLowLevel.bridgeGaps

`[out, info] = shLowLevel.bridgeGaps(ref, bridge, Name=Value)`

Fill the months a series lacks from a second, noisier series. OUT = shLowLevel.bridgeGaps(REF, BRIDGE) fills every month that the reference series REF lacks within its own span, and that BRIDGE has, calibrating BRIDGE against REF on the months both have. The intended pair is a GRACE / GRACE-FO series and a high-low SST + SLR series such as QuantumFrontiers HLSST_SLR_COMB2023s, whose months cover the gap between the two missions (2017-07 to 2018-05) and the scattered months GRACE lost to battery management.

input	size	type	default	description
ref	1 x 1	shSeries	required	shSeries the reference series, e.g. GRACE GSM
bridge	1 x 1	shSeries	required	shSeries the series that fills its gaps, with the same GM and R

input	size	type	default	description
RadiusKm	1 x 1	double	750	Gaussian smoothing radius [km]; 0 smooths nothing, for series filtered already
Tolerance	1 x 1	double	0.05	two months match when their epochs differ by less [yr]
MinOverlap	1 x 1	double	24	the fewest matched months the calibration accepts

output	description
out	(1,1) shSeries REF's months and the filled ones, sorted by epoch, truncated and smoothed as above
info	(1,1) struct fields bridged (T,1) logical true for the filled months of OUT overlap (1,1) double months the calibration used scale (nmax+1,1) double s_n; 0 where BRIDGE's anomaly has no variance at that degree sigma (nmax+1,1) double the fill's sigma per degree offsetC (nmax+1 x nmax+1) double B0 - R0, cosine terms offsetS (nmax+1 x nmax+1) double B0 - R0, sine terms radiusKm (1,1) double the Gaussian radius used

Example

```
gr = shSeries.read("GSM-2_*.gfc").applyTN14(tnFile);
hl = shSeries.read(fullfile(hlFolder, "kalman", "*.gfc"));
[ts, info] = shLowLevel.bridgeGaps(gr, hl);
filled = ts.epochs(info.bridged);
```

shLowLevel.combineCenters

`[tsComb, info] = shLowLevel.combineCenters(tsCell, Name=Value)`

VCE-weighted combination of multi-center monthly series. [TSCOMB, INFO] = shLowLevel.combineCenters({tsITSG, tsCSR, tsGFZ}) combines monthly solutions from several processing centers into one series with one variance factor per (center, month), estimated by Foerstner variance-component iteration with PARTIAL REDUNDANCIES:

input	size	type	default	description
tsCell	1 x :	cell	required	1 x C cell of shSeries, equal nmax, >= 2 centers
Tolerance	1 x 1	double	0.05	[yr] epoch matching (centers date mid-months slightly differently)
AllowMissing	1 x 1	logical	true	months missing at some centers are combined from the available ones (weights renormalize); false: only fully-covered months are kept
Robust	1 x 1	logical	false	per-month factor = median over blocks of the unbiased block estimates q_b/r_b instead of the global ratio (outlier-month protection; Python-validated design)
MaxIter	1 x 1	double	6	, Tol (1e-3) VCE iteration control
Tol	1 x 1	double	1e-3	convergence tolerance

output	description
tsComb	shSeries combined stacks on the reference epochs (first center), sigmaCs/Ss = posterior sqrt(diag(H)) per month, provenance in history; GM and R of the inputs (which must agree), and their common ProductType ("unknown" when they differ). Before v5.23.4 GM/R were shSeries' defaults and ProductType was always "GSM"
info	(1,1) struct fields s2 (C x T) double variance factors per centre and month, NaN where that centre has no solution weights (C x T) double normalized 1/s2 redundancy (C x T) double partial redundancy per centre interCenterCorr (C x C) double empirical residual correlation - the honesty diagnostic: VCE assumes independence, and GRACE centres share data and background models nIter (1,1) double VCE iterations used epochs (T x 1) double the combined epoch grid centers (1 x C) string each input series' productType, in the row order of s2/weights/redundancy note (1,:) char what the combination actually did

Temporal smoothing (Kalman/VAR)

shLowLevel.kalmanChain

```
[ts, rep] = shLowLevel.kalmanChain(obsIn, Name=Value)
```

Kalman-smoothed SH series in one call (Kurtenbach/Kvas). [TS, REP] = shLowLevel.kalmanChain(OBSIN, ModelSeries=TSM) is the single point of access to the Kalman/VAR module: it turns noisy per-epoch gravity information plus a geophysical model series into a temporally smoothed shSeries, encoding the correctly ordered chain of Kurtenbach (2012) and Kvas (2019): 1. reduce the model series TSM by its own climatology (mean, trend, annual, semi-annual) - the residual approximates the short-term process (Kurtenbach eq. ...

input	size	type	default	description
obsIn	1 x 1	—	required	shSeries | (1 x 1) string observations: series (solution mode) or SINEX folder (neq mode)
ModelSeries	1 x 1	shSeries	required	(1 x 1) shSeries process realization at the target sampling and nmax (truncate first if needed); e.g. GAX/AOD1B, ESA ESM or a hydrology model as SH series
Order	1 x 1	double	1	(1 x 1) VAR order p (see estimateVAR)
Shrink	1 x 1	double	0	(1 x 1) diagonal loading (see estimateVAR)
Structure	1 x 1	string ∈ ["full","diagonal","orderblock"]	"full"	"full" | "diagonal" | "orderblock": coupling structure of the VAR estimate (v3.28; see estimateVAR for the measured monthly table). "orderblock" builds the c...
CondFun	n x m	—	[]	covariance conditioning (see estimateVAR)
Epochs	: x 1	double	[]	(K x 1) double target epoch grid [decimal years]. [] uses the observation epochs as-is. A grid entry with no observation within Tolerance becomes a gap epoc...
Tolerance	1 x 1	double	0.5/365.25	(1 x 1) max |epoch difference| [yr] to match an observation to a grid entry
NoiseCov	n x m	double	[]	solution mode: (P x P) double full R, (P x 1) double diagonal, or (P x T) double per-epoch diagonals; [] derives diagonals from the series' formal sigmas
Climatology	1 x 1	logical	true	solution mode: reduce OBSIN by its own climatology before filtering and restore it afterwards
FitClimatology	1 x 1	string ∈ ["observations", "filtered"]	"observations"	"observations" | "filtered" what that climatology is fitted to. "observations" fits it to OBSIN itself, so the noise of the fit is restored unfiltered in e...
Smoother	1 x 1	logical	true	run the RTS pass (false: filter only, e.g. for NRT-style one-way runs a la Kvas Ch. 3; then the internal filter stores only diagonals and memory stays flat)
QC	1 x 1	string ∈ ["none","flag","reject"]	"none"	"none" | "flag" | "reject": innovation-based per-epoch quality control (Kvas Sec. 3.3; see kalmanFilter). "reject" keeps blunder epochs out of the recursion ...
QCAlpha	1 x 1	double	1e-3	false-alarm level of the test
StoreCov	1 x 1	string ∈ ["auto","full","matfile"]	"auto"	where the filter keeps the full covariances the smoother needs: "auto" = "full" (RAM) with the smoother, "diag" without; "matfile" streams them through a v7....
Pattern	1 x 1	string	"*.snx*"	neq mode: file pattern inside the folder(s)
NeqWeights	: x 1	double	[]	multi-center neq mode: (F x 1) double fixed weights per center (skips per-epoch VCE); [] runs VCE, which requires STATISTICS on every file and errors loudly ...

output	description
ts	(1 x 1) shSeries smoothed series on the epoch grid, formal 1-sigma stacks filled, every step in the history
rep	(1,1) struct fields mode (1,1) string "solution" | "neq" order (1,1) double the VAR order used nEpochs (1,1) double epochs on the output grid nGaps (1,1) double epochs with no data qcStat (1 x K) double innovation statistic per epoch; NaN when QC="none" nRejected (1,1) double epochs QC rejected centers (F x 1) string contributor labels; "neq" mode sigma2 (F x K) double per-epoch VCE variance factors; NaN where a centre has no file, and in fixed-weight mode specRadius (1,1) double spectral radius of the companion matrix; < 1 is stable meanContribution (1 x K) double mean data share per epoch (Kurtenbach Sec. 3.3.2); NaN in gaps epochs (K,1) double the epoch grid gap (1 x K) logical which epochs were gaps model (1,1) struct the estimateVAR struct, for reuse memGB (1,1) double covariance storage actually used

Example

```
    tsm = shSeries.fromFolder(gaxFolder).truncate(40);
    [ts, rep] = shLowLevel.kalmanChain(tsObs, ModelSeries=tsm, Order=1);

  Memory: the smoother stores two full (pP x pP) covariances per
  epoch: n40/p1/T365 ~ 16 GB. For long daily series run in windows
  or set Smoother=false; REP.memGB reports the actual footprint.

  Reference: Kurtenbach, DGK C-683 (2012); Kvas, TU Graz PhD thesis
  (2019). Numerics pre-validated in Python
  (tools/dev/validate_kalman.py).
```

shLowLevel.estimateVAR

`model = shLowLevel.estimateVAR(X, Name=Value)`

Empirical VAR(p) process model from an SH state series. MODEL = shLowLevel.estimateVAR(X) estimates the stochastic process model of Kurtenbach et al. (2012) from a centred state realization: the vector autoregressive model x_t = Phi_1 x_{t-1} + ... + Phi_p x_{t-p} + w, w ~ N(0, Q) determined by the Yule-Walker equations from the empirical (cross-)covariances Sigma(h) = 1/(T-h) sum x_i x_{i-h}' of the series (Kvas 2019, Sec. 2.4). For Order = 1 this is EXACTLY the closed form of Kurtenbach (2012), eqs. (3.84)-(3...

input	size	type	default	description
X	: x :	double	required	double centred state realization, one shIndex-ordered
Order	1 x 1	double	1	(1 x 1) VAR order p >= 1. Kurtenbach: 1. Higher orders capture longer temporal correlation (Kvas) at p-fold state dimension in the filter.
Shrink	1 x 1	double	0	(1 x 1) diagonal loading factor: Sigma(0) + Shrink * trace(Sigma(0))/P * I. Stabilizes the Yule-Walker solve when T is not >> P.
CondFun	n x m	—	[]	function handle C -> C applied to every Sigma(h) before the solve, for covariance conditioning a la Kvas Sec. 2.4: land/ocean block masking and the distance-...
Structure	1 x 1	string ∈ ["full","diagonal","orderblock"]	"full"	coupling structure of the estimate: "full" dense Yule-Walker solve (Kurtenbach/Kvas) - needs T >> P; the right choice for daily sampling with condition...
Blocks	n x 1	cell	{}	cell of index vectors partitioning 1:P, required for Structure="orderblock" - e.g. from shIndex: one block per (m, C/S) pair
Sigma0Add	n x 1	double	[]	(P x P) or (P x 1) double a covariance added to Sigma(0) only, after Shrink and before CondFun: a temporally uncorrelated part of the process - the isotropi...

output	description
model	(1,1) struct the process model, fields Phi (1 x p) cell of (P x P) double coefficient matrices Q (P x P) double symmetric PSD process-noise covariance Sigma0 (P x P) double empirical auto-covariance Sigma(0): the stationary state covariance, and the filter's initial covariance order (1,1) double the VAR order p P (1,1) double state dimension specRadius (1,1) double spectral radius of the companion matrix; < 1 is stable, and anything else raises a warning because filtering an unstable model diverges over long gaps

Example

```
    [~, resid] = tsModel.climatology;             % reduce long-term parts
    idx = shLowLevel.shIndex(tsModel.nmax);
    X = zeros(idx.P, resid.nEpochs);
    for k = 1:resid.nEpochs
        g = resid.at(k);
        X(:, k) = shLowLevel.vecFromCS(g.C, g.S, idx);
    end
    model = shLowLevel.estimateVAR(X, Order=1);

  Reference: Kurtenbach, DGK C-683 (2012), Sec. 3.2; Kvas, TU Graz
  PhD thesis (2019), Secs. 2.3-2.4; Luetkepohl (2005).
  Numerics pre-validated in Python (tools/dev/validate_kalman.py);
  Order > 1 against validate_regional_adaptive.py CLAIM 4.
  Yule-Walker block order corrected: Claude (Opus 5.5), 2026-10-21 (A35).
```

shLowLevel.kalmanFilter

`filt = shLowLevel.kalmanFilter(model, obs, Name=Value)`

Forward Kalman filter for SH series (Kurtenbach/Kvas). FILT = shLowLevel.kalmanFilter(MODEL, OBS) runs the forward Kalman filter of Kurtenbach (2012, Sec. 3.3) with the VAR(p) process model from shLowLevel.estimateVAR and one observation record per epoch. Two observation modes, decided per epoch by the fields present: solution l = x + v, v ~ N(0, R): a (noisy) coefficient-vector solution with its error covariance - e.g. a GFC series with formal sigmas, or a SINEX COVA solution neq N x = b: an unreduced no...

input	size	type	default	description
model	1 x 1	struct	required	struct from shLowLevel.estimateVAR: Phi, Q, Sigma0, order, P
obs	1 x :	struct	required	struct per-epoch records with fields l (P x 1 double) and R (P x P double, or P x 1 diagonal) for solution mode, or N (P x P double) and b (P x 1 double) fo...
StoreCov	1 x 1	string ∈ ["full","diag","matfile"]	"full"	where the predicted and filtered covariances live (rtsSmoother needs them in full): "full" in RAM: 2 T (pP)^2 doubles - n40, p=1, T=365: ~16 GB; keep T or...
Contribution	1 x 1	logical	true	record diag(K) (solution) / diag(P+ N) (neq): the share of the estimate coming from the DATA rather than the process model - Kurtenbach Sec. 3.3.2
QC	1 x 1	string ∈ ["none","flag","reject"]	"none"	innovation-based quality control per epoch (Kvas 2019, Sec. 3.3): the statistic solution T = d' S^-1 d, d = l - x-, S = P-(1:P,1:P) + R, dof = P neq T...
QCAlpha	1 x 1	double	1e-3	false-alarm level; threshold from shLowLevel.chi2Quantile(1-QCAlpha, dof) (Wilson-Hilferty, essentially exact at dof = P; see its accuracy note)
Likelihood	1 x 1	logical	false	record the -2 log likelihood of every epoch's observation given the past (the innovation likelihood), the quantity whose sum is maximised to estimate process...

output	description
filt	(1,1) struct companion-space filter results. The PHYSICAL state is the first block, xf(1:P, :). Fields xf, xp (pP x T) double filtered and predicted states Pf, Pp (pP x pP x T) double covariances, StoreCov="full" dPf, dPp (pP x T) double their diagonals instead, for StoreCov="diag" or "matfile" covFile (1,1) string path of the v7.3 MAT holding Pf/Pp, StoreCov="matfile" only, else "" - delete it when you are done with it B (pP x P) double the companion selection matrix contrib (P x T) double data share per coefficient, NaN in gaps gap (1 x T) logical which epochs had no data qcStat (1 x T) double innovation statistic; NaN when QC="none" or in a gap qcDof (1 x T) double its degrees of freedom qcReject (1 x T) logical epochs rejected; always all-false unless QC="reject" negLogLik (1 x T) double the -2 log likelihood term of each epoch (see Likelihood); 0 in a gap or a rejected epoch, which contribute nothing; [] unless Likelihood = true P (1,1) double block size order (1,1) double the VAR order storeCov (1,1) string which of the three layouts above is filled

Example

```
    model = shLowLevel.estimateVAR(X, Order=1);
    obs = repmat(struct('l',[],'R',[],'N',[],'b',[]), 1, numel(ep));
    for t = 1:numel(ep)          % fill l/R (or N/b), leave gaps empty
        obs(t).l = L(:, t);  obs(t).R = sig(:, t).^2;
    end
    filt = shLowLevel.kalmanFilter(model, obs);

  Reference: Kurtenbach, DGK C-683 (2012), Sec. 3.3; Kvas, TU Graz
  PhD thesis (2019), Secs. 2.2-2.3.
  Numerics pre-validated in Python (tools/dev/validate_kalman.py).
```

shLowLevel.rtsSmoother

```
smo = shLowLevel.rtsSmoother(filt, Name=Value)
```

Rauch-Tung-Striebel backward pass for kalmanFilter output. SMO = shLowLevel.rtsSmoother(FILT) runs the fixed-interval RTS smoother (Kurtenbach 2012, Sec. 3.3.3) over the forward-filter result of shLowLevel.kalmanFilter: G_t = Pf_t B' Pp_{t+1}^-1 xs_t = xf_t + G_t (xs_{t+1} - xp_{t+1}) Ps_t = Pf_t + G_t (Ps_{t+1} - Pp_{t+1}) G_t' so the estimate at epoch t uses ALL observations, past and future. With the stationary initialization of kalmanFilter this reproduces the joint least-squares adjustment over all epochs ...

input	size	type	default	description
filt	1 x 1	struct	required	struct from shLowLevel.kalmanFilter with
Lag	1 x 1	double	Inf	(1 x 1) double smoothing window in epochs: the estimate at t uses data up to t+Lag; 0 returns the pure filter estimates, Inf the full RTS pass. The filt req...
Functionals	n x m	double	[]	(m x P) double linear functionals F of the physical state: their 1-sigma, sqrt(diag(F Ps F')), is returned per epoch in SMO.sigF, formed from the full smoot...

output	description
smo	(1,1) struct smoothed results, PHYSICAL block only. Fields xs (P x T) double smoothed states sig (P x T) double formal 1-sigma per coefficient, the square root of the smoothed covariance diagonal sigF (m x T) double 1-sigma of the Functionals per epoch; [] without them PsLast (P x P) double the full smoothed covariance of the LAST epoch, which equals the filtered one there P (1,1) double block size order (1,1) double the VAR order

Example

```
    filt = shLowLevel.kalmanFilter(model, obs);   % StoreCov="full"
    smo  = shLowLevel.rtsSmoother(filt);
    plot(ep, smo.xs(1, :))                        % first coefficient

  Reference: Rauch, Tung & Striebel (1965); Kurtenbach, DGK C-683
  (2012), Sec. 3.3.3; Kvas, TU Graz PhD thesis (2019), Sec. 2.3.
  Numerics pre-validated in Python (tools/dev/validate_kalman.py).
```

shLowLevel.buildCondFun

```
[f, info] = shLowLevel.buildCondFun(idx, Name=Value)
```

Covariance conditioner in the EWH domain (Kvas 2019, 2.4). [F, INFO] = shLowLevel.buildCondFun(IDX, kn=KN) builds the CondFun handle for shLowLevel.estimateVAR that implements the covariance conditioning of Kvas (2019), Sec. 2.4: the spectral covariance is propagated to equivalent-water-height values on an exact Gauss-Legendre grid, conditioned there, and propagated back: Sigma~ = Fq * (Z .* T .* (G Sigma G')) * Fq' with G = Y * D spectral -> EWH grid (D the per-degree EWH kernel from shLowLevel.kern...

input	size	type	default	description
idx	1 x 1	struct	required	struct from shLowLevel.shIndex - fixes Lmax and the coefficient ordering the conditioner acts on
kn	required	double	required	(>= Lmax+1 x 1) double load Love numbers k'_n, kn(1) is degree 0 (kernelFactors contract)
Psi0Km	1 x 1	double	Inf	(1 x 1) double taper scale psi0 [km] of exp(-psi/psi0); Inf disables the taper. Kvas' choice corresponds to a half-width of ~1100 km
Regions	n x 1	—	[]	region assignment for the block mask: a function handle id = fun(latDeg, lonDeg) (array-valued, numeric ids; e.g. @(la, lo) la >= 0) or an (M x 1) numeric ve...
GM	1 x 1	double	3.986004415e14	(1 x 1) double [m^3/s^2] (overridable)
R	1 x 1	double	6378136.3	(1 x 1) double [m] reference radius; also converts Psi0Km to spherical distance (geocentric sphere)
NLat	1 x 1	double	[]	(1 x 1) double Gauss-Legendre rings (default Lmax+1, the exactness minimum)
NLon	1 x 1	double	[]	(1 x 1) double longitudes (default 2*Lmax+2)
Basis	1 x 1	—	[]	(1 x 1) struct a regional basis from shLowLevel.regionalBasis on IDX: f then conditions the K x K covariances of its coefficients, Sigma~ = Proj f_SH(T Sigm...

output	description
f	function handle Sigma~ = f(Sigma) for (P x P) covariances in IDX ordering - pass as estimateVAR(..., CondFun=f); with Basis, for (K x K) covariances of the basis coefficients
info	(1,1) struct fields grid (1,1) struct the synthesisMatrix grid struct M (1,1) double number of grid points region (M x 1) double or [] the region weight, empty when none was given W (M x M) double the elementwise spatial weight Z .* T memGB (1,1) double storage of the precomputed operators

Example

```
    kn  = shLowLevel.readLoveNumbers(lovePath);
    idx = shLowLevel.shIndex(40);
    land = @(la, lo) double(landMaskFun(la, lo));   % your land/ocean rule
    cf  = shLowLevel.buildCondFun(idx, kn=kn, Psi0Km=1100, Regions=land);
    model = shLowLevel.estimateVAR(X, Order=1, CondFun=cf);

  Memory/cost: precomputes G, Fq (M x P each) and W (M x M); Lmax 40
  gives M = 3362, ~180 MB total; every f(Sigma) costs two M x P x P
  products. Numerics pre-validated in Python
  (tools/dev/validate_condfun.py).

  Reference: Kvas, TU Graz PhD thesis (2019), Sec. 2.4, eqs.
  (2.117)-(2.120); Schur product theorem e.g. Horn & Johnson.
```

shLowLevel.neqCombine

```
[x, out] = shLowLevel.neqCombine(neqs, Name=Value)
```

VCE-weighted combination on the normal-equation level. [X, OUT] = shLowLevel.neqCombine(NEQS) combines K normal equations into one solution the COST-G way - on the normal-equation level, BEFORE solving - with one

variance component per contribution, estimated by Foerstner/Koch iteration with partial redundancies: N = sum_i (1/s_i^2) N_i, b = sum_i (1/s_i^2) b_i x = N^-1 b Om_i = ltpl_i - 2 x' b_i + x' N_i x (= v_i' P_i v_i) r_i = nobs_i - (1/s_i^2) tr(N^-1 N_i) (partial redundancy) s_i^2 = Om_i ...

input	size	type	default	description
neqs	1 x :	struct	required	struct one contribution each, in EITHER form: N (P x P double), b (P x 1 double), and for VCE also ltpl (1 x 1 double, l'Pl of the contribution) and nobs (1...
Weights	: x 1	double	[]	(K x 1) double FIXED weights w_i = 1/s_i^2: skips the VCE iteration entirely (then ltpl/nobs are not needed); [] runs VCE, which REQUIRES ltpl and nobs on e...
MaxIter	1 x 1	double	20	(1 x 1) VCE iteration cap
Tol	1 x 1	double	1e-6	(1 x 1) relative change of all s_i^2 to stop
Covariance	1 x 1	logical	false	also return Cx = N^-1 (P x P inverse - costly for large P, off by default)

output	description
x	(P x 1) double combined solution
out	(1,1) struct fields sigma2 (K x 1) double final variance factors; the fixed 1./Weights when those were given w (K x 1) double = 1./sigma2 redundancy (K x 1) double partial redundancies; NaN in fixed mode, where nothing was estimated nIter (1,1) double VCE iterations used converged (1,1) logical whether it converged N (P x P) double the combined normal matrix Cx (P x P) double its inverse; Covariance=true only names (K x 1) string the contributor labels

Example

```
   a = shLowLevel.readSINEX(fileA, Index = idx);
   b = shLowLevel.readSINEX(fileB, Index = idx);
   [x, out] = shLowLevel.neqCombine([a, b]);
   disp(out.sigma2')          % who carries how much noise power

 Numerics pre-validated in Python (tools/dev/validate_neqcombine.py,
 5 checks: fixed == stacked GLS, factor recovery, redundancy
 invariant, combined beats singles, equal-noise symmetry).

 Reference: Koch (1999) variance component estimation; Foerstner
 (1979); Kvas, TU Graz PhD thesis (2019), Secs. 2.1-2.2; the
 COST-G combination concept (Jaeggi et al.).
```

shLowLevel.chi2Quantile

`x = shLowLevel.chi2Quantile(p, k)`

Chi-square quantile without toolboxes (Wilson-Hilferty). X = shLowLevel.chi2Quantile(P, K) approximates the chi-square quantile chi2inv(P, K) using the Wilson-Hilferty cube transform x = k * (1 - 2/(9k) + z * sqrt(2/(9k)))^3, z = sqrt(2) * erfinv(2p - 1) in base MATLAB (erfinv is core; chi2inv is Statistics Toolbox - same reason shLowLevel.pctile exists instead of prctile).

input	size	type	default	description
p	any size	double	required	double probability level(s) in (0, 1)
k	1 x 1	double	required	double degrees of freedom, k >= 1

output	description
x	(size of p) double approximate chi-square quantile(s)

Example

```
   thr = shLowLevel.chi2Quantile(1 - 1e-3, 1677);   % QC threshold

 Reference: Wilson & Hilferty (1931), PNAS 17.
```

Validated chains

shLowLevel.standardChain

`[ts, rep] = shLowLevel.standardChain(folder, Name=Value)`

Canonical GRACE/GRACE-FO post-processing in one call. [TS, REP] = shLowLevel.standardChain(FOLDER) encodes the standard chain as a single, correctly ordered entry point: 1. read all monthly solutions from FOLDER (shSeries.fromFolder) 2. replace C20/C30 with the SLR values (TN-14) 3. add the degree-1 (geocenter) coefficients (TN-13) 4. optionally subtract a GIA trend field 5. filter (Gaussian radius, a DDK, or a shLowLevel.designFilter W) The order matters (TN corrections BEFORE filtering, GIA on the corrected se...

input	size	type	default	description
folder	1 x 1	string	required	string folder of monthly .gfc(.gz) files
Pattern	1 x 1	string	"*.gfc*"	file pattern for shSeries.fromFolder
Truncate	1 x 1	double	NaN	truncate to this nmax after reading
TN14	1 x 1	logical	true	apply SLR C20/C30
TN14File	1 x 1	string	""	explicit TN-14 path (default: dataFolder copy)
Degree1	1 x 1	string ∈ ["GFZ", "CSR", "JPL", "none"]	"GFZ"	TN-13 provider "GFZ" | "CSR" | "JPL" | "none"
Degree1File	1 x 1	string	""	explicit TN-13 path (default: dataFolder copy)
GIA	n x m	—	[]	shLowLevel trend field (shCoefficients, [1/yr]) subtracted as (t - GIAEpoch) * GIA
GIAEpoch	1 x 1	double	NaN	reference epoch of the GIA trend (NaN: mean epoch of the series)
Filter	n x m	—	"gauss300"	"none" | "gaussN" (N = radius [km]) | "DDKn" (n = 1..8, read from the data folder; fetch it once with shLowLevel.fetchDDK) | a W struct from shLowLevel.readD...
Tolerance	1 x 1	double	0.05	maximum |epoch difference| [yr] accepted when matching a TN-13/TN-14 record to a solution
OnMissing	1 x 1	string ∈ ["drop", "error"]	"drop"	what to do with solution epochs the correction tables do not reach. The tables ALWAYS trail the solutions - a provider publishes TN-13 weeks after the monthl...
Quiet	1 x 1	logical	false	suppress progress output

output	description
ts	(1,1) shSeries the processed series (full history)
rep	(1,1) struct fields files (1,F) string the dir() listing of FOLDER for Pattern (dir's order, by name), as read - epochs dropped later are NOT removed from it steps (1,K) string the stages applied, with parameters nmax (1,1) double the degree the chain ran at epochs (T,1) double the epoch grid [decimal years] version (1,1) string "<Name> <Version>" of shLowLevel.version() at run time created (1,1) string when the run happened

Example

```
    [ts, rep] = shLowLevel.standardChain("D:/grace/monthly", ...
        Filter = "DDK3", Degree1 = "GFZ");
    disp(rep.steps')
```

shLowLevel.gravisL2B

`[ts, rep] = shLowLevel.gravisL2B(folder, gravisFolder, Name=Value)`

Build a GravIS-Level-2B-equivalent series from monthly fields. [TS, REP] = shLowLevel.gravisL2B(FOLDER, GRAVISFOLDER) reproduces the GravIS Level-2B correction chain (Dahle & Murboeck 2025) on a folder of monthly .gfc solutions, exactly as validated against the GravIS Greenland, Antarctica and TWS Level-3 products (guide chapters V1-V8): 1. read all monthly solutions (shSeries.fromFolder) 2. replace C20, C30, C21, S21 from the GravIS GRACE+SLR low-degree table, matched on the BEGIN epoch parsed from the GSM-2_YY...

input	size	type	default	description
folder	1 x 1	string	required	string folder of monthly GSM-2_*.gfc(.gz)
gravisFolder	1 x 1	string	""	string folder holding the GravIS aux files. "" (default) uses the frozen copies shipped in data/gravis (see shLowLevel.gravisDataFolder). The tables trail t...
LowDegreeFile	1 x 1	string	"GRAVIS-2B_COSTG_0200_GRACE+SLR_LOW_DEGREES_0001.dat"	("GRAVIS-2B_COSTG_0200_GRACE+SLR_LOW_DEGREES_0001.dat")
GeocenterFile	1 x 1	string	"GRAVIS-2B_COSTG_0200_GEOCENTER_0001.dat"	("GRAVIS-2B_COSTG_0200_GEOCENTER_0001.dat")
MeanFile	1 x 1	string	"GRAVIS-2B_COSTG_0200_MEAN_2002095-2020091_NFIL_0001.gz"	("GRAVIS-2B_COSTG_0200_MEAN_2002095-2020091_NFIL_0001.gz")
GIAFile	1 x 1	string	""	SHM rate file; "" skips step 5. The GravIS product is GRAVIS-2B_COSTG_0200_GIA_ICE-6G_D_VM5a_0001.gz
GIAEpoch	1 x 1	double	2011	reference epoch of the GIA rate (GravIS centres ICE-6G_D on 2011)
Nmax	1 x 1	double	90	truncation degree
Pattern	1 x 1	string	"GSM-2_*.gfc*"	file pattern
Tolerance	1 x 1	double	2e-3	max |begin difference| [yr] for a table match
OnMissing	1 x 1	string ∈ ["drop","error"]	"drop"	"drop" | "error" for uncovered epochs
SpanEnd	1 x 1	double	Inf	keep epochs <= SpanEnd + 0.05 only (decimal years, mid-month epochs; the 0.05 yr slack keeps the month whose mid-epoch lies just past SpanEnd); the published...
Quiet	1 x 1	logical	false	suppress progress output

output	description
ts	(1,1) shSeries corrected anomaly series (nmax = Nmax)
rep	(1,1) struct fields steps (1,K) string the stages applied, with parameters epochs (T,1) double the epoch grid [decimal years] begins (T,1) double each month's interval start nDropped (1,1) double epochs dropped for lack of coverage nmax (1,1) double the degree read version (1,1) struct shLowLevel.version() at run time (Name, Version, Date, Root, Provenance) created (1,1) string when the run happened

Example

```
    [ts, rep] = shLowLevel.gravisL2B("E:/series/COSTG", ...   % shipped aux data
        GIAFile = "GRAVIS-2B_COSTG_0200_GIA_ICE-6G_D_VM5a_0001.gz");
```

shLowLevel.gravisRegionChain

`[gt, rep] = shLowLevel.gravisRegionChain(region, folder, gravisFolder)`

Shared engine of greenlandChain / antarcticaChain. [GT, REP] = shLowLevel.gravisRegionChain(REGION, FOLDER, GRAVISFOLDER, OPTS) is the common implementation behind the two public ice chains; call those instead. REGION is "greenland" or "antarctica"; OPTS is the (already argument-validated) option struct of the wrappers. Stages: gravisL2B (with GIA) -> EWH synthesis on a GridStep grid -> pixel-wise bias + trend + annual + semiannual fit -> open-ocean residual RMS -> sigma_trend = sigma_monthly / sqrt(Sxx) unless ...

input	size	type	default	description
region	1 x 1	string ∈ ["greenland","antarctica"]	required	string "greenland" | "antarctica"
folder	1 x 1	string	required	string monthly solution folder
gravisFolder	1 x 1	string	required	string GravIS aux folder
opts	1 x 1	struct	required	struct see greenlandChain / antarcticaChain

output	description
gt	(1,1) double basin-mask mass trend [Gt/yr]
rep	(1,1) struct fields trendGrid (nlat x nlon) double the trend field [cm/yr EWH] lat, lon (1,:) double the grid it is on [deg] sigTrend (1,1) double 1-sigma of the trend [m/yr]: sigma_monthly / sqrt(Sxx), sigma_monthly the open-ocean RMS (a scalar, oceanRMS); NaN when no OceanMask was given (NoiseLevel used instead) residRMS (nlat x nlon) double per-pixel RMS of the post-fit residual; absent when TrendGrid= was given mask (nlat x nlon) logical the region unionMask (nlat x nlon) logical region plus the buffer the leakage step needed m (nlat x nlon) double the inverted (leakage corrected) map iterations (1,1) double leakage iterations run stoppedBy (1,1) string why the iteration stopped basins table per-polygon integrals (name, gt); present for antarctica only - for greenland the field does not exist steps (1,K) string the stages applied, with parameters l2b (1,1) struct the shLowLevel.gravisL2B report; absent when TrendGrid= was given version (1,1) struct shLowLevel.version() at run time (Name, Version, Date, Root, Provenance) created (1,1) string when the run happened

Example

```
% called for you by the wrappers; direct use mirrors them:
% [gt, rep] = shLowLevel.gravisRegionChain("greenland", ser, gd, opts)
```

shLowLevel.greenlandChain

`[gt, rep] = shLowLevel.greenlandChain(folder, gravisFolder, Name=Value)`

The validated GravIS Greenland ice-trend chain, one call. [GT, REP] = shLowLevel.greenlandChain(FOLDER, GRAVISFOLDER, kn=KN) reproduces guide chapters V1-V6 end to end: gravisL2B corrections with the ICE-6G_D GIA rate, EWH synthesis on a global grid, a pixel-wise trend + annual + semiannual fit, and the regularised leakage inversion stopped on the discrepancy principle with the TREND-matched noise level sigma_monthly/sqrt(Sxx) (the V4c lesson). With the tested defaults and the COST-G RL02.1 series this returns -...

input	size	type	default	description
folder	1 x 1	string	required	string monthly GSM-2_*.gfc folder
gravisFolder	1 x 1	string	""	string GravIS aux folder; "" (default) uses the frozen data/gravis copies shipped with the toolbox (see gravisL2B), which also hold BasinFile
kn	n x 1	double	[]	load Love numbers (degree,kn) or column vector - REQUIRED, the empty default errors: no frame is assumed for you
BasinFile	1 x 1	string	"basins_GIS.json"	GravIS GeoJSON of the target basins ([lon lat] rings, read by shLowLevel.readBasin - see https://gravis.gfz.de/basins/GIS)
NeighbourBoxes	n x m	double	[60 84 232 300; 63 67 335 347; 76 81 10 34]	([60 84 232 300; 63 67 335 347; 76 81 10 34]) the guide-V2 Canadian Arctic, Iceland and Svalbard boxes, [latMin latMax lonMin lonMax] rows, lon in [0, 360) e...
GIAFile	1 x 1	string	"GRAVIS-2B_COSTG_0200_GIA_ICE-6G_D_VM5a_0001.gz"	("GRAVIS-2B_COSTG_0200_GIA_ICE-6G_D_VM5a_0001.gz")
Filter	1 x 1	string	"gauss445"	filter DECLARED to the inversion and applied to the synthesis ("none" | "gaussN")
SpanEnd	1 x 1	double	2023.099	published-trend span (guide V3)
GridStep	1 x 1	double	1	synthesis grid step [deg]

input	size	type	default	description
NoiseLevel	1 x 1	double	NaN	NaN: derive sigma_trend from the open-ocean residual RMS and the regressor power (V4c); a number overrides it
OceanMask	n x m	—	[]	USER-SUPPLIED open-ocean mask for the sigma_trend policy (logical grid or @(lat,lon) handle; see oceanRMS - no coastline is assumed). REQUIRED unless NoiseLe...
MaxIter	1 x 1	double	400	iteration cap
TrendGrid	n x m	—	[]	precomputed struct from a previous REP (fields trendGrid, lat, lon, sigTrend) - skips the synthesis/fit stage for sensitivity studies
GM	1 x 1	double	3.986004415e14	, R (6378136.3)
R	1 x 1	double	6378136.3	reference radius [m] (default 6378136.3, overridable)
Quiet	1 x 1	logical	false	suppress progress output

output	description
gt	(1,1) double ice-mass trend over the basin mask [Gt/yr]
rep	(1,1) struct as returned by shLowLevel.gravisRegionChain, which this function delegates to and which documents every field: trendGrid, lat, lon, sigTrend, residRMS, mask, unionMask, m, iterations, stoppedBy, steps, l2b, version, created

Example

```
kn = readmatrix("loadLoveNumbers_Gegout97.txt", FileType="text", ...
    NumHeaderLines=2);
[gt, rep] = shLowLevel.greenlandChain("E:/series/COSTG", ...
    "E:/GravIS", kn = kn, OceanMask = @(la,lo) abs(la) < 60);
```

shLowLevel.antarcticaChain

`[gt, rep] = shLowLevel.antarcticaChain(folder, gravisFolder, Name=Value)`

The validated GravIS Antarctica ice-trend chain. [GT, REP] = shLowLevel.antarcticaChain(FOLDER, GRAVISFOLDER, kn=KN) runs the same chain as greenlandChain with the 25 GravIS AIS drainage-basin polygons as the mask (guide chapter V7). With the tested defaults and COST-G RL02.1 this returns -125.7 Gt/yr against the AWI joint-inversion -146.9 - read V7 before interpreting the 14%: it is the documented distance between map-based estimators and the Sasgen forward-modelling class (the official TU Dresden kernel grid s...

input	size	type	default	description
folder	1 x 1	string	required	string monthly GSM-2_*.gfc folder
gravisFolder	1 x 1	string	""	string GravIS aux folder; "" (default) uses the shipped data/gravis copies (see gravisL2B)
kn	n x m	double	[]	load Love numbers (degree,kn) - REQUIRED, the empty default errors: no frame is assumed
BasinFile	1 x 1	string	"basins_AIS.json"	GravIS AIS GeoJSON (https://gravis.gfz.de/basins/AIS; [lon lat] rings, read by shLowLevel.readBasin, which closes the polar ring of basin 302 through the pol...
NeighbourBoxes	n x m	double	[]	Antarctica has no land neighbours
GIAFile	1 x 1	string	"GRAVIS-2B_COSTG_0200_GIA_ICE-6G_D_VM5a_0001.gz"	("GRAVIS-2B_COSTG_0200_GIA_ICE-6G_D_VM5a_0001.gz")
Filter	1 x 1	string	"gauss445"	as in greenlandChain

input	size	type	default	description
SpanEnd	1 x 1	double	2023.099	keep epochs <= SpanEnd [decimal yr]
GridStep	1 x 1	double	1	synthesis graticule step [deg]
NoiseLevel	1 x 1	double	NaN	sigma_trend policy, see greenlandChain
OceanMask	n x m	—	[]	REQUIRED unless NoiseLevel is numeric; must be false over land (see greenlandChain)
MaxIter	1 x 1	double	400	, TrendGrid ([])
TrendGrid	n x m	—	[]	overlay the fitted trend line
GM	1 x 1	double	3.986004415e14	, R (6378136.3)
R	1 x 1	double	6378136.3	reference radius [m] (default 6378136.3, overridable)
Quiet	1 x 1	logical	false	suppress progress output

output	description
gt	(1,1) double total AIS trend over the basin union [Gt/yr]
rep	(1,1) struct as returned by shLowLevel.gravisRegionChain - the same fields as greenlandChain, with basins filled: a table of name and gt integrated per GravIS polygon

Example

```
[gt, rep] = shLowLevel.antarcticaChain("E:/series/COSTG", ...
    "E:/GravIS", kn = kn, OceanMask = @(la,lo) abs(la) < 60);
rep.basins
```

shLowLevel.twsChain

`[out, rep] = shLowLevel.twsChain(folder, gravisFolder, Name=Value)`

The validated GravIS terrestrial-water-storage basin chain. [OUT, REP] = shLowLevel.twsChain(FOLDER, GRAVISFOLDER, kn=KN) reproduces guide chapter V8: gravisL2B corrections WITH the ICE-6G_D GIA rate (the GravIS TWS product carries this correction even though its Technical Note omits it - subtracting it took the trend RMS from 0.225 to 0.032 cm/yr), a DDK3 filter as the declared stand-in for GravIS' VDK5/VDK3 blend, and cos-weighted 1-degree basin means in cm EWH computed by per-basin bounding-box synthesis with...

input	size	type	default	description
folder	1 x 1	string	required	string monthly GSM-2_*.gfc folder
gravisFolder	1 x 1	string	""	string GravIS aux folder; "" (default) uses the shipped data/gravis copies (see gravisL2B); must also hold BasinFile and, for the default filter, the DDK bi...
kn	n x 1	double	[]	load Love numbers k'_n, one column for degrees 0..nmax (kn(1) is degree 0), passed to shLowLevel.kernelFactors - REQUIRED, the empty default errors: no frame...
BasinFile	1 x 1	string	"basins_rivbas.json"	GravIS GeoJSON of the target basins ([lon lat] rings, read by shLowLevel.readBasin; https://gravis.gfz.de/basins/rivbas)
Basins	1 x 1	string	strings(0, 1)	) feature names to process; the empty default processes every feature in BasinFile
Filter	n x m	—	"DDK3"	"none" | "gaussN" | "DDKn" (n = 1..8) | a W struct from shLowLevel.readDDK
DDKFolder	1 x 1	string	""	folder holding the Wbd_2-120.a_* binaries for the "DDKn" shorthand, searched first; the empty default makes that first candidate the bare file name, i.e. the...

input	size	type	default	description
GIAFile	1 x 1	string	"GRAVIS-2B_COSTG_0200_GIA_ICE-6G_D_VM5a_0001.gz"	("GRAVIS-2B_COSTG_0200_GIA_ICE-6G_D_VM5a_0001.gz") "" disables the GIA step - and reproduces the 7x larger trend RMS documented in V8
SpanEnd	1 x 1	double	Inf	the TWS validation uses the full record
GridStep	1 x 1	double	1	basin-box synthesis step [deg]
GM	1 x 1	double	3.986004415e14	, R (6378136.3)
R	1 x 1	double	6378136.3	reference radius [m] (default 6378136.3, overridable)
Quiet	1 x 1	logical	false	suppress progress output

output	description
out	(1,1) struct fields name (K,1) string basin names, in the row order below epochs (T,1) double the epoch grid [decimal years] series (K x T) double basin means [cm EWH] trend (K,1) double per-basin trend [cm/yr] amplitude (K,1) double annual amplitude [cm] phase (K,1) double annual phase [rad]
rep	(1,1) struct fields steps (1,K) string the stages applied, with parameters filter (1,1) string the filter actually used l2b (1,1) struct the shLowLevel.gravisL2B report version (1,1) struct shLowLevel.version() at run time created (1,1) string when the run happened

Example

```
kn = readmatrix("loadLoveNumbers_Gegout97.txt", FileType="text", ...
    NumHeaderLines=2);
[out, rep] = shLowLevel.twsChain("E:/series/COSTG", "E:/GravIS", ...
    kn = kn, Basins = ["Amazonas", "Congo", "Danube"]);
plot(out.epochs, out.series); legend(out.name)
```

shLowLevel.oceanChain

`[out, rep] = shLowLevel.oceanChain(folder, Name=Value)`

Global-ocean mass chain: barystatic series from GSM + GravIS. [OUT, REP] = shLowLevel.oceanChain(FOLDER, kn = KN, OceanMask = OC) runs the ocean sibling of the validated chains (roadmap item 7): gravisL2B corrections (C20/C30/C21/S21, degree 1, minus NFIL mean, GIA rate ON by default - the ocean-floor GIA correction matters for barystatic trends) -> global EWH synthesis on a GridStep graticule -> area-weighted ocean-mean series [cm] -> trend + annual fit. The residual after the per-pixel trend+seasonal fit is wh...

input	size	type	default	description
folder	1 x 1	string	required	string monthly .gfc folder (GSM-2_*, any centre)
kn	n x 1	double	[]	(N x 2 | N x 1) REQUIRED load Love numbers
OceanMask	n x m	—	[]	(fn handle | nLat x nLon logical) REQUIRED ocean decision @(lat, lon) -> logical, MUST be false over land (oceanRMS contract; the chains' documented 5 Gt/yr ...
GravisFolder	1 x 1	string	""	GravIS aux folder; "" = shipped data/gravis
GIAFile	1 x 1	string	"GRAVIS-2B_COSTG_0200_GIA_ICE-6G_D_VM5a_0001.gz"	("GRAVIS-2B_COSTG_0200_GIA_ICE-6G_D_VM5a_0001.gz") "" disables the GIA rate; the default ocean-floor correction raises the barystatic trend by about +1 mm/yr...
GIAEpoch	1 x 1	double	2011	(1 x 1) GIA reference epoch
Filter	1 x 1	string	"gauss445"	"none" | "gaussN" [km]; the ocean MEAN is nearly filter-invariant, but sigMon describes the filtered world - unfiltered, the pixel residuals are stripe-domin...
GridStep	1 x 1	double	1	(1 x 1) synthesis graticule [deg]

input	size	type	default	description
SpanEnd	1 x 1	double	[]	(1 x 1) keep epochs <= SpanEnd [decimal years] (+ 0.05 yr slack, as gravisL2B applies it)
GADFolder	1 x 1	string	""	folder of GAD-2_*.gfc; when set, epochs with a begin-matched GAD file get it added back on the coefficient level and REP records covered and uncovered epochs...
GAAFolder	1 x 1	string	""	folder of GAA-2_*.gfc; when set, the ocean MEAN of GAA is subtracted per epoch (Chambers & Willis 2010) - removes the atmospheric land-ocean mass term that G...
SeparateCirculation	1 x 1	logical	false	split the pixel residuals (after the North-multiplet + Marchenko-Pastur selection, capped at 3 modes: the MP edge assumes i.i.d. noise and turns liberal unde...
CoastBufferKm	1 x 1	double	300	erode the ocean mask by this great-circle distance from every coast [km]. Quantified (Python, gauss445 point-source experiment): 300 km removes 54% of the co...
RemoveLandLeakage	1 x 1	logical	false	iterative support separation of ALL sources outside the ocean mask (two-sided alternating projections, Papoulis-Gerchberg style): land and ocean components a...
LandLeakIter	1 x 1	double	1	(1 x 1) separation sweeps. Machine-measured trend ladder with the 300 km buffer: 0 sweeps +1.557, 1 sweep +1.524, 5 sweeps +1.321 mm/yr - deeper iteration at...
Quiet	1 x 1	logical	true	(1 x 1) suppress progress output

output	description
out	(1 x 1) struct with fields epochs (T x 1) decimal years oceanMean (T x 1) area-weighted ocean-mean EWH [cm] trend (1 x 1) barystatic trend [mm/yr] trendGt (1 x 1) the same as mass rate [Gt/yr] over the mask trendSigma (1 x 1) OLS 1-sigma of the trend [mm/yr] (no AR correction - stated, not hidden) ampAnnual (1 x 1) annual amplitude of the ocean mean [mm] sigMon (1 x 1) open-ocean residual RMS after the per-pixel trend+seasonal fit [m] (the honest noise proxy) oceanArea (1 x 1) mask area [m^2] circulationRMS (1 x 1) area-weighted RMS of the separated residual circulation [m] (NaN unless SeparateCirculation) nModes (1 x 1) EOF modes the North rule kept (0 unless SeparateCirculation) lamModes (K x 1) variance per EOF mode ([] unless SeparateCirculation)
rep	(1,1) struct fields steps (K,1) string the stages applied, with parameters, including any dropped or uncovered epochs version (1,1) struct shLowLevel.version() at run time (Name, Version, Date, Root, Provenance) nEpochs (1,1) double epochs processed nGadRestored (1,1) double months the GAD restore reached nGaaApplied (1,1) double months the GAA correction reached

Example

```
kn = readmatrix("loadLoveNumbers_Gegout97.txt", FileType = "text", ...
    NumHeaderLines = 2);
oc = @(la, lo) abs(la) <= 66 & ~yourLandFcn(la, lo);
[out, rep] = shLowLevel.oceanChain("E:/series/COSTG", kn = kn, ...
    OceanMask = oc);
plot(out.epochs, out.oceanMean)   % barystatic curve [cm]
```

shLowLevel.obpChain

`[out, rep] = shLowLevel.obpChain(folder, Name=Value)`

Ocean-bottom-pressure fields (GravIS Level-3 OBP recipe). [OUT, REP] = shLowLevel.obpChain(FOLDER, kn = KN, OceanMask = OC, GADFolder = GAD) produces gridded ocean-bottom-pressure anomalies in EWH following the GravIS/GFZ Level-3 OBP definition: gravisL2B corrections (C20/C30/C21/S21, degree 1, minus NFIL mean, GIA) -> GAD added back on the coefficient level -> filter (AFTER the GAD addition - the GravIS order) -> EWH synthesis -> anomalies against the mean over RefPeriod, land set to NaN.

input	size	type	default	description
folder	1 x 1	string	required	string monthly .gfc folder (GSM-2_*, any centre)
kn	n x 1	double	[]	(N x 2 | N x 1) REQUIRED load Love numbers
OceanMask	n x m	—	[]	(fn handle | nLat x nLon logical) REQUIRED ocean decision, false over land
GADFolder	1 x 1	string	""	(1 x 1) string REQUIRED folder of GAD-2_*.gfc (shLowLevel.fetchGAX) - OBP without GAD is not OBP, so the empty default errors
GravisFolder	1 x 1	string	""	GravIS aux folder; "" = shipped data/gravis
GIAFile	1 x 1	string	"GRAVIS-2B_COSTG_0200_GIA_ICE-6G_D_VM5a_0001.gz"	("GRAVIS-2B_COSTG_0200_GIA_ICE-6G_D_VM5a_0001.gz") "" disables the GIA rate (see gravisL2B)
GIAEpoch	1 x 1	double	2011	(1 x 1) GIA reference epoch
GridStep	1 x 1	double	1	(1 x 1) synthesis graticule [deg]
SpanEnd	1 x 1	double	[]	(1 x 1) keep epochs <= SpanEnd [decimal yr] (+ 0.05 yr slack, as gravisL2B applies it)
Filter	1 x 1	string	"gauss445"	"none" | "gaussN" [km], applied after GAD
RefPeriod	1 x 2	double	[2002.25, 2020.25]	(1 x 2) anomaly reference window [decimal years], half-open [start, end), the GravIS 2002/04-2020/03 convention
Quiet	1 x 1	logical	true	(1 x 1) suppress progress output

output	description
out	(1 x 1) struct with fields grid (nLat x nLon x T) OBP anomaly [cm EWH], land NaN lat, lon (nLat x 1), (nLon x 1) grid vectors [deg] epochs (T x 1) decimal years refMean (nLat x nLon) subtracted reference-period mean [cm] oceanMeanOBP (T x 1) area-weighted ocean mean of the anomaly [cm] - contains the atmospheric term by definition
rep	(1,1) struct fields steps (K,1) string the stages applied, with parameters version (1,1) string "<Name> <Version>" of shLowLevel.version() at run time nEpochs (1,1) double epochs processed nGadRestored (1,1) double months the GAD restore reached nRefEpochs (1,1) double epochs inside RefPeriod

Example

```
kn = readmatrix("loadLoveNumbers_Gegout97.txt", FileType = "text", ...
    NumHeaderLines = 2);
[out, rep] = shLowLevel.obpChain(serFolder, kn = kn, ...
    OceanMask = oc, GADFolder = "E:/DATAPOOL/GravityField/GAX/GAD");
imagesc(out.lon, out.lat, out.grid(:, :, end)); axis xy
```

Comparison & validation metrics (v2.6.0)

shLowLevel.compareSolutions

`[rep, h] = shLowLevel.compareSolutions(g1, g2, Name=Value)`

Full spectral + spatial comparison of two solutions. REP = shLowLevel.compareSolutions(G1, G2) compares two shCoefficients on a COMMON BASIS - both are truncated to the smaller nmax and G2 is rescaled to G1's GM/R if they differ (otherwise the comparison measures processing chains, not solutions) - and returns the standard metric set: spectral: difference degree amplitude vs both signal spectra, per-degree correlation, crossover degree of agreement (shLowLevel.diffSpectrum) spatial: area-weighted bias/RMSD/cent...

input	size	type	default	description
g1	1 x 1	shCoefficients	required	first coefficient set
g2	1 x 1	shCoefficients	required	second coefficient set
LatDeg	1 x :	double	-89:2:89	, LonDeg (0:2:358) comparison grid

input	size	type	default	description
LonDeg	1 x :	double	0:2:358	longitudes [deg], lon in [0, 360)
Quantity	1 x 1	string	"geoid"	synthesis quantity; "ewh" etc. need kn ([])
kn	n x m	double	[]	load Love numbers (user-supplied, 0..nmax)
Mask	n x m	—	[]	nlat x nlon logical region restriction
Names	1 x 2	string	["solution 1", "solution 2"]	(["solution 1","solution 2"])
Plot	1 x 1	logical	false	produce the diagnostic figure

output	description
rep	(1,1) struct fields: .spectral (1,1) struct shLowLevel.diffSpectrum output .spatial (1,1) struct shLowLevel.spatialStats output .chi2dof (1,1) double error-realism statistic (NaN when either solution lacks sigmas) .nmax (1,1) double common maximum degree used .quantity (1,1) string compared quantity .names (1,2) string solution labels .rescaled (1,1) logical true when GM/R were unified
h	(1,1) graphics handle figure handle (Plot = true only)

Example

```
rep = shLowLevel.compareSolutions(g, g.gaussian(350), Names = ["raw", "G350"]);
fprintf("crossover n = %d, spatial corr = %.3f\n", ...
    rep.spectral.ncross, rep.spatial.corr)
```

shLowLevel.compareSeries

`[rep, h] = shLowLevel.compareSeries(tsList, Name=Value)`

Temporal + component comparison of N solution series. REP = shLowLevel.compareSeries({TS1, TS2, ...}) compares N >= 2 shSeries against the FIRST (the reference) on a COMMON BASIS: epochs are matched to the reference within MatchTolerance (unmatched epochs are dropped and reported - never interpolated across gaps), all series are truncated to the smallest nmax. GM/R are NOT unified: each series keeps its own constants, so pass series that share them. Per solution k >= 2 the standard temporal metric set is compute...

input	size	type	default	description
tsList	1 x :	cell	required	cell of shSeries the series to compare; the FIRST is the reference
Names	1 x 1	string	strings(1, 0)	) ([]) string array, one per series
MatchTolerance	1 x 1	double	0.02	epoch matching tolerance [yr]
Basin	n x 1	double	[]	, Idx ([]) P x 1 basin vector + shLowLevel.shIndex struct: y = Basin' * coefficient vector per epoch
Idx	n x m	—	[]	index struct from shLowLevel.shIndex (fields n, m, cs, P, Lmax, minDegree, pos)
LatDeg	1 x :	double	-88:4:88	, LonDeg (0:6:354), Quantity ("geoid"), kn ([]),
LonDeg	1 x :	double	0:6:354	longitudes [deg], lon in [0, 360)
Quantity	1 x 1	string	"geoid"	functional of the field, see shLowLevel.kernelFactors
kn	n x m	double	[]	load Love numbers, (degree, kn) table or column vector - always user-supplied, no reference frame is assumed
Mask	n x m	—	[]	synthesis path when Basin is not given
Plot	1 x 1	logical	false	produce the diagnostic figure

output	description
rep	(1,1) struct fields: .names (1,N) string .epochs (T,1) double common epochs used .nDropped (1,N) double reference epochs unmatched per series .y (T,N) double comparison series (col 1 = reference) .nse (1,N) double NSE vs reference (NaN for col 1) .corr (1,N) struct-array-free: Pearson r per series .pcorr (1,N) double AR(1)-corrected two-sided p .neff (1,N) double effective sample sizes .trendDiff (1,N) double trend - reference trend [units/yr] .trendSigma (1,N) double combined 1-sigma of trendDiff .trendZ (1,N) double significance z of trendDiff .ampRatio (1,N) double annual amplitude / reference .phaseLagDays (1,N) double annual phase lag vs reference .chi2dof (1,N) double error realism vs reference .trendDiffFields (1,N) cell shCoefficients (empty for col 1) .tch (1,1) struct shLowLevel.threeCorneredHat output (N >= 3) .nmax (1,1) double common maximum degree
h	(1,1) graphics handle figure handle (Plot = true only)

Example

```
    rep = shLowLevel.compareSeries({tsCSR, tsGFZ, tsJPL}, ...
        Names = ["CSR", "GFZ", "JPL"]);
    fprintf("TCH noise: %s\n", sprintf("%.3g ", rep.tch.sigma))
```

shLowLevel.diffSpectrum

`spec = shLowLevel.diffSpectrum(C1, S1, C2, S2)`

Spectral comparison of two coefficient sets. SPEC = shLowLevel.diffSpectrum(C1, S1, C2, S2) compares two solutions in the spectral domain: the difference degree amplitude localizes the disagreement in wavelength, the degree correlation separates "same pattern, different amplitude" from genuine disagreement, and the crossover of the difference against the signal spectrum gives the effective resolution of agreement as a single scalar. Inputs must share the same size; truncate beforehand for mixed degrees (the shLo...

input	size	type	default	description
C1	n x m	double	required	first cosine set, C(n+1, m+1) layout
S1	n x m	double	required	first sine set, same indexing as C1
C2	n x m	double	required	second cosine set, same indexing as C1
S2	n x m	double	required	second sine set, same indexing as S1

output	description
spec	(1,1) struct fields: .n (nmax+1 x 1) double degree axis 0..nmax .diffAmp (nmax+1 x 1) double degree amplitude of (1)-(2) .amp1 (nmax+1 x 1) double signal degree amplitude of (1) .amp2 (nmax+1 x 1) double signal degree amplitude of (2) .degCorr (nmax+1 x 1) double per-degree correlation (NaN where a degree is all-zero) .ncross (1,1) double first degree where diffAmp exceeds amp1 (NaN if never; agreement to nmax)

Example

```
    gF = g.gaussian(350);
    spec = shLowLevel.diffSpectrum(g.C, g.S, gF.C, gF.S);
    semilogy(spec.n, [spec.amp1, spec.diffAmp]); grid on
```

shLowLevel.spatialStats

`stats = shLowLevel.spatialStats(A, B, latDeg, lonDeg, Name=Value)`

Area-weighted spatial comparison of two grids. STATS = shLowLevel.spatialStats(A, B, LATDEG, LONDEG) compares two nlat x nlon grids with proper cos(latitude) area weighting - unweighted RMS on a lat/lon grid over-counts the poles and is simply wrong. Returns bias, RMSD, the CENTERED pattern statistics (centered RMSD, weighted correlation, standard deviations) that feed a Taylor diagram. All use one set of weights, so the Taylor identity crmsd^2 = stdA^2 + stdB^2 - 2 stdA stdB corr holds by construction (to round...

input	size	type	default	description
A	n x m	double	required	semi-major axis of the normal ellipsoid [m]
B	n x m	double	required	basin-kernel coefficient vector from basinKernel
latDeg	1 x :	double	required	geocentric latitudes [deg]

input	size	type	default	description
lonDeg	1 x :	double	required	longitudes [deg], lon in [0, 360)
Mask	n x m	—	[]	nlat x nlon logical: restrict to a region (e.g. land/ocean); default all points
Weights	n x m	double	[]	custom nlat x nlon weights (e.g. quadrature); default cos(latDeg) rings, normalized over the mask

output	description
stats	(1,1) struct fields: .bias (1,1) double weighted mean of A - B .rmsd (1,1) double weighted RMS of A - B .crmsd (1,1) double centered (bias-free) RMSD .corr (1,1) double weighted pattern correlation .stdA (1,1) double weighted std of A .stdB (1,1) double weighted std of B .ratio (1,1) double stdB / stdA .nUsed (1,1) double number of grid points used

Example

```
A1 = g.synthesis(lat, lon); A2 = gF.synthesis(lat, lon);
st = shLowLevel.spatialStats(A1, A2, lat, lon);
fprintf("rmsd %.3g, corr %.3f\n", st.rmsd, st.corr)
```

shLowLevel.nashSutcliffe

`nse = shLowLevel.nashSutcliffe(ref, model)`

Nash-Sutcliffe efficiency of a model against a reference. NSE = shLowLevel.nashSutcliffe(REF, MODEL) computes the hydrology-standard skill score NSE = 1 - sum((model-ref).^2) / sum((ref-mean(ref)).^2) column-wise. NSE = 1 is perfect, 0 means "no better than the reference mean", negative is worse than the mean. More informative than correlation because bias and amplitude errors are punished. Non-finite (NaN/Inf) pairs are removed per column; a column with fewer than 3 valid pairs, or a constant reference, returns...

input	size	type	default	description
ref	n x m	double	required	reference series
model	n x m	double	required	model series scored against the reference

output	description
nse	(1,K) double efficiency per column (K = 1 for vectors)

Example

```
nse = shLowLevel.nashSutcliffe(avg(1,:), avg(2,:));   % e.g. SH vs mascon basin
```

shLowLevel.effectiveCorr

`out = shLowLevel.effectiveCorr(x, y)`

Correlation with AR(1)-corrected significance. OUT = shLowLevel.effectiveCorr(X, Y) computes the Pearson correlation of two time series together with a significance test that accounts for serial correlation: monthly GRACE series are strongly autocorrelated, so the effective sample size Neff = T*(1-r1*r2)/(1+r1*r2) (r1, r2 = lag-1 autocorrelations) is well below T, and the naive t-test badly over-states significance (Monte-Carlo: ~30% false positives at phi = 0.7 vs ~6% corrected; validated in Python). The two-si...

input	size	type	default	description
x	: x 1	double	required	double first series (NaN pairs are dropped)
y	: x 1	double	required	double second series, same length; the lag-1 autocorrelations r1, r2 are estimated from x and y

output	description
out	(1,1) struct fields: .r (1,1) double Pearson correlation .neff (1,1) double effective sample size (clamped [4, T]) .t (1,1) double t statistic on neff-2 dof .p (1,1) double two-sided p-value .n (1,1) double finite pairs used

Example

```
    ec = shLowLevel.effectiveCorr(avg(1,:)', avg(2,:)');   % two basin series
    fprintf("r = %.3f (p = %.3g, Neff = %.0f)\n", ec.r, ec.p, ec.neff)
```

shLowLevel.threeCorneredHat

`out = shLowLevel.threeCorneredHat(X)`

Per-solution noise levels from N >= 3 series. OUT = shLowLevel.threeCorneredHat(X) with X (T x N, N >= 3) estimates the individual noise standard deviation of each series by the classic (generalized) three-cornered hat: pairwise difference variances V(i,j) = var(x_i - x_j) cancel the common signal, and under the assumption of mutually independent noises V(i,j) = s_i^2 + s_j^2; the N unknowns are solved from the N*(N-1)/2 pairs by least squares (exact Grubbs solution for N = 3). This answers the question pairwise...

input	size	type	default	description
X	: x :	double	required	coefficient stack, (P x T) in index ordering

output	description
out	(1,1) struct fields: .sigma (1,N) double noise standard deviation per series .variance (1,N) double raw LS variance estimates (may be < 0) .pairVar (P,3) double [i j var(x_i - x_j)] per pair .clipped (1,N) logical true where variance was clipped to 0

Example

```
    out = shLowLevel.threeCorneredHat(Y3);   % T x 3 basin series (CSR/GFZ/JPL)
    fprintf("noise levels: %s\n", sprintf("%.3g ", out.sigma))
```

shLowLevel.taylorDiagram

`h = shLowLevel.taylorDiagram(refStd, stds, corrs, Name=Value)`

Taylor diagram (std / correlation / centered RMSD). H = shLowLevel.taylorDiagram(REFSTD, STDS, CORRS) draws the standard one-figure comparison of solutions against a reference: radius is the (weighted) standard deviation, the azimuth is acos(correlation), and by the law of cosines the distance to the reference point equals the centered RMSD - so pattern amplitude, pattern correlation and pattern error are read off a single plot. Feed it the .stdA/.stdB/ .corr fields of shLowLevel.spatialStats, or temporal statis...

input	size	type	default	description
refStd	1 x 1	double	required	standard deviation of the reference field
stds	1 x :	double	required	standard deviations of the compared fields
corrs	1 x :	double	required	correlations of the compared fields with the reference
Labels	1 x 1	string	strings(1, 0)	) ([]) string array, one per point
Title	1 x 1	string	"Taylor diagram"	figure title
Normalize	1 x 1	logical	false	divide all stds by REFSTD (radius 1 = reference)

output	description
h	(1,1) graphics handle the axes handle

Example

```
    st = shLowLevel.spatialStats(grid, 0.8 * grid, lat, lon);
    shLowLevel.taylorDiagram(st.stdA, st.stdB, st.corr, Labels = "damped");
```

Plotting

shLowLevel.plotSHSpectrum

`h = shLowLevel.plotSHSpectrum(specs, Name=Value)`

Degree-amplitude spectrum plot (linear x, log y). PLOTSHSPECTRUM(SPEC) plots SPEC.degree vs SPEC.degAmplitude (from SHDEGREERMS) on a log y-axis over a linear degree axis, in mm geoid-height-equivalent.

input	size	type	default	description
specs	n x m	—	required	struct, struct array or cell array of structs spectrum struct(s) from shLowLevel.shDegreeRMS; several are overlaid
Names	n x m	—	{}	cell array of legend labels
Units	n x m	—	'mm'	'mm' or 'm' for the y-axis
Field	n x m	—	''	LEGACY override: plot this spec field directly and ignore Quantity. Empty means "not supplied" - the sentinel that replaces inputParser's UsingDefaults. (als...
Ax	n x m	—	[]	axes handle to plot into; empty uses the current axes
Kaula	n x m	—	[]	scalar K: overlay the Kaula-rule reference degree amplitude R*sqrt(2n+1)*K/n^2 (typical K ~ 1e-5) as a dotted grey line - the sanity yardstick for signal decay
MarkCrossover	false	—	false	with exactly TWO spectra, mark the signal/error crossover degree found by shLowLevel.shSpectralCrossover with a vertical line
Quantity	n x m	—	'amplitude'	"amplitude" ([m]) | "rms" | "variance" | "cumamplitude" | "cumrms" | "cumvariance" - which spectral quantity to draw; error overlays ride along when the spec...

output	description
h	(1 x 1) graphics handle spectrum axes (log y)

shLowLevel.plotSHCoeffTriangle

```
h = shLowLevel.plotSHCoeffTriangle(C, S, Name=Value)
```

Coefficient-triangle diagnostic plot. PLOTSHCOEFFTRIANGLE(C, S) shows |Snm| (left half) and |Cnm| (right half) as a single degree/order "butterfly" triangle image on a log color scale -- the standard first diagnostic for spotting striping, leakage, or bad coefficients before spectral/spatial analysis. x-axis: order m (mirrored: Snm on the LEFT, Cnm on the RIGHT), y-axis: degree n with the apex (n=0) at the TOP - the triangle's peak points upwards. The data aspect ratio is fixed to 1:1, so the axes box is 2:1 (x ...

input	size	type	default	description
C	n x m	double	required	cosine Stokes coefficients, C(n+1, m+1) indexing
S	n x m	double	required	sine Stokes coefficients, S(n+1, m+1) indexing
Nmax	n x m	—	size(C,1)-1	-1) max degree to display
CLim	n x m	—	[]	[min max] colour limits; empty is auto. In log10(|value|) units, or in coefficient units with RefC/RefS, where it replaces the symmetric [-a a] limits
Ax	n x m	—	[]	axes handle to plot into; empty uses the current axes
RefC	n x m	—	[]	, RefS ([]) reference coefficients: plot the SIGNED difference C-RefC / S-RefS on a linear divergent scale, symmetric about zero - the before/after diagnost...
RefS	n x m	—	[]	—

output	description
h	(1 x 1) graphics handle butterfly triangle image (abs log10 or signed diff with RefC/RefS)

shLowLevel.plotBasinSeries

```
h = shLowLevel.plotBasinSeries(tYears, c, sigma, Name=Value)
```

Basin time series with 1-sigma band, gaps, trend. H = shLowLevel.plotBasinSeries(TYEARS, C, SIGMA) draws the standard basin- average figure: shaded 1-sigma band (fill), data line, the GRACE <-> GRACE-FO gap (or any gap > GapThreshold years) shaded light grey, and an annotated trend fitted with the toolbox climatology design (bias/ trend/annual/semi-annual, AR(1)-corrected sigma).

input	size	type	default	description
tYears	: x 1	double	required	double epochs [decimal years]
c	: x 1	double	required	double basin averages (e.g. out.c from shLowLevel.basinDeconvolve)
sigma	T x 1	double	[]	double 1-sigma; [] for no band
Label	1 x 1	string	"basin average"	, Units (""), GapThreshold (0.3) [yr],
Units	1 x 1	string	""	unit label used for annotation
GapThreshold	1 x 1	double	0.3	gap length that breaks the plotted line [yr]
Trend	1 x 1	logical	true	fit + annotate trend +/- sigma (AR(1)-corrected); skipped without a message below 8 epochs,
Ax	n x m	—	[]	target axes handle ([] creates a new figure)

output	description
h	(1,1) graphics handle axes of the basin series plot

shLowLevel.plotCovariance

```
h = shLowLevel.plotCovariance(M, idx, Name=Value)
```

Covariance/correlation image with order-block boundaries. H = shLowLevel.plotCovariance(M, IDX) shows a P x P covariance (e.g. from shLowLevel.readSINEX with Index=IDX) as an image in shIndex ordering, with the (order, C/S) block boundaries drawn - the one-look check of how good the block-diagonal approximation (tvANS block path, DDK structure) is for THIS matrix.

input	size	type	default	description
M	P x P	double	required	double covariance in IDX ordering
idx	1 x 1	struct	required	struct shLowLevel.shIndex
Type	1 x 1	string ∈ ["correlation", "covariance"]	"correlation"	"correlation" (normalized, [-1,1], divergent scale) | "covariance" (log10|value|)
BlockLines	1 x 1	logical	true	draw order/cs boundaries
Ax	n x m	—	[]	target axes handle ([] creates a new figure)

output	description
h	(1 x 1) graphics handle image of the covariance/correlation structure

Utilities

shLowLevel.httpFetch

```
info = shLowLevel.httpFetch(url, dest, Name=Value)
```

Download a URL to a file with Retry-After-aware retries. INFO = shLowLevel.httpFetch(URL, DEST) downloads URL to the file DEST. On transient failures (HTTP 429, 500, 502, 503, 504, or a network error) it retries with exponential backoff and jitter; when the server sends a Retry-After header (seconds or an HTTP-date), that value takes precedence over the backoff. Built on matlab.net.http because websave discards the response headers on error - which is exactly why polite retrying was never possible with it. Motiv...

input	size	type	default	description
url	1 x 1	string	required	string the URL to download (https recommended)
dest	1 x 1	string	required	string target file path (parent folder must exist)
MaxTries	1 x 1	double	4	(1 x 1) total attempts before giving up
BaseDelay	1 x 1	double	2	(1 x 1) first backoff delay [s]; attempt k waits BaseDelay * 2^(k-1) plus up to 25% jitter
MaxDelay	1 x 1	double	60	(1 x 1) cap on any single wait [s], also applied to server-sent Retry-After values
Timeout	1 x 1	double	60	(1 x 1) per-attempt timeout [s]
WebsaveFallback	1 x 1	logical	true	(1 x 1) after all matlab.net.http attempts fail WITHOUT ever receiving an HTTP status (a transport-level failure: proxy, TLS, or a stalled connection), try O...
Quiet	1 x 1	logical	true	(1 x 1) suppress the per-retry progress line

output	description
info	(1 x 1) struct with fields status (1 x 1) double final HTTP status code tries (1 x 1) double attempts used waited (1 x 1) double total seconds slept between attempts bytes (1 x 1) double bytes written to DEST transport (1 x 1) string present ONLY when the websave fallback ran (value "websave-fallback"); the normal path leaves the field absent, so test with isfield

Example

```
    info = shLowLevel.httpFetch("https://isdc-data.gfz.de/...", ...
        "C:/data/aux.dat", MaxTries = 5);
```

shLowLevel.httpRetryDelay

`w = shLowLevel.httpRetryDelay(attempt, retryAfter, Name=Value)`

Wait time for a retry: server hint first, else backoff. W = shLowLevel.httpRetryDelay(ATTEMPT, RETRYAFTER) returns the wait [s] before retry number ATTEMPT: when the server sent a finite Retry-After value that value wins (capped at MaxDelay); otherwise exponential backoff BaseDelay * 2^(ATTEMPT-1) with up to 25% uniform jitter, capped at MaxDelay. Pure function - the testable half of shLowLevel.httpFetch.

input	size	type	default	description
attempt	1 x 1	double	required	double 1-based attempt counter
retryAfter	1 x 1	double	required	double server Retry-After [s], NaN if absent
BaseDelay	1 x 1	double	2	(1 x 1) first backoff delay [s]
MaxDelay	1 x 1	double	60	(1 x 1) cap on the returned wait [s]
Jitter	1 x 1	double	0.25	(1 x 1) relative jitter range, 0 disables

output	description
w	(1 x 1) double wait before this retry [s]

Example

```
    w = shLowLevel.httpRetryDelay(3, NaN)        % ~8 s (+jitter)
    w = shLowLevel.httpRetryDelay(1, 30)         % 30 s (server wins)
```

shLowLevel.makeTutorials

`out = shLowLevel.makeTutorials(Name=Value)`

Generate Live Script tutorials from the demo registry. OUT = shLowLevel.makeTutorials() writes one tutorial per demo case into tutorials/ as a plain .m script with Live Editor section markers, and converts each to .mlx when the converter is available. OUT.files lists the .m files written.

input	size	type	default	description
Dest	1 x 1	string	""	(fullfile(shLowLevel.version().Root, "tutorials")) output folder; created if absent
Cases	1 x :	string	"all"	which demo cases to write ("all", "core", or an array of ids such as ["D01" "D05"])
Convert	1 x 1	logical	true	also write .mlx. The converter is an internal MATLAB API and is not present in every release, so a failure is reported and the .m files are kept: those are t...
Quiet	1 x 1	logical	false	suppress progress output

output	description
out	(1,1) struct fields files (1,N) string the .m files written mlx (1,M) string the .mlx files written; empty when Convert is false or the conversion is unavailable dest (1,1) string the folder written to converted (1,1) logical whether the .mlx conversion ran

Example

```
    shLowLevel.makeTutorials(Cases = ["D01" "D05"]);
    edit(fullfile("tutorials", "T_D01_read_and_spectra.m"))

  See also demo_shAnalysis, shLowLevel.version.
```

shLowLevel.readBasin

`[region, info] = shLowLevel.readBasin(name, Name=Value)`

A basin of a GravIS GeoJSON file as a region, by name. [REGION, INFO] = shLowLevel.readBasin(NAME) finds the basin NAME in the GravIS river-basin file shipped with the toolbox (data/gravis/basins_rivbas.json, 100 basins) and returns it as a REGION function handle, m = REGION(latDeg, lonDeg), 1 inside and 0 outside, that every region-taking function accepts (evalMask, basinKernel, slepianBasis, regionalBasis). The match is exact first, then case-insensitive, then a case-insensitive substring that only ONE basin c...

input	size	type	default	description
name	1 x 1	string	required	string basin name, or a unique part of one ("Elbe"); a (1,N) string array for several, string.empty for all
File	1 x 1	string	"basins_rivbas.json"	(1,1) string a GeoJSON file: a path, or a name looked up in the toolbox's data/gravis folder (basins_rivbas.json, basins_GIS.json, basins_AIS.json ship ther...

output	description
region	function handle m = region(latDeg, lonDeg): equal-size double arrays in, a double array of 0/1 of the same size out; lon may be in any range. A (1,N) cell of them for a string-array or empty NAME
info	(1,1) struct fields name (1,1) string the basin actually taken file (1,1) string the file it was read from names (N,1) string every basin name in the file rings (1,R) cell each ring as a (K,2) double [latDeg lonDeg], longitudes as in the file hole (1,R) logical the ring is a hole of its polygon polar (1,R) logical the ring winds around a pole polygon (1,R) double which polygon each ring belongs to properties (1,1) struct the feature's GeoJSON properties

Example

```
    [reg, info] = shLowLevel.readBasin("Elbe");
    idx = shLowLevel.shIndex(60);
    B = shLowLevel.regionalBasis(idx, reg, Type = "slepian");
```

shLowLevel.regionalBasis

`B = shLowLevel.regionalBasis(idx, region, Name=Value)`

A local basis for a region, as a linear map to SH coefficients. B = shLowLevel.regionalBasis(IDX, REGION) builds a set of K space-localising basis functions for REGION and returns them as the matrix B.T (P x K) that maps basis

coefficients a to spherical-harmonic coefficients in IDX ordering, x = B.T * a, band-limited at IDX.Lmax. Every basis enters the rest of the toolbox through T alone: an SH solution or normal equation becomes T' N T and T' b, a grid or point functional A_SH T, and a model series becomes bas...

input	size	type	default	description
idx	1 x 1	struct	required	struct shLowLevel.shIndex of the coefficients the basis maps to (its Lmax is the band limit)
region	n x m	—	[]	basin name (1,1) string, function handle f(latDeg, lonDeg), K x 2 [latDeg lonDeg] polygon, or Ngrid x 1 mask on the OverSample quadrature grid (see shLowLeve...
Type	1 x 1	string ∈ ["rbf", "slepian", "sh"]	"rbf"	"rbf" | "slepian" | "sh" the basis, see above
BufferKm	1 x 1	double	600	(1,1) double growth of the region [km] before the nodes are selected, the tapers concentrated and the projector weighted: Woehnke's computation area is the ...
Grid	1 x 1	string ∈ ["icosahedral", "reuter"]	"icosahedral"	"icosahedral" | "reuter" rbf node grid
Level	1 x 1	double	[]	(1,1) double rbf grid level: j for "icosahedral" (10 (j+1)^2 + 2 nodes), gamma for "reuter"; [] = the rule above
Kernel	1 x 1	string ∈ ["kaula", "shannon", "amplitude"]	"kaula"	"kaula" | "shannon" | "amplitude" rbf shape coefficients phi_n, see above
DegreeAmplitude	n x m	double	[]	(Lmax+1,1) double sigma_n for n = 0..Lmax, required by Kernel = "amplitude" and refused otherwise; must be finite, and positive at the degrees IDX holds
Threshold	1 x 1	double	[]	(1,1) double in (0, 1] slepian: keep every taper with concentration >= Threshold
NKeep	1 x 1	double	[]	(1,1) double slepian: keep this many tapers; give at most one of Threshold and NKeep ([] for both = Shannon number)
EigTol	1 x 1	double	1e-10	(1,1) double rbf projector: relative eigenvalue cut of the pseudo-inverse
R	1 x 1	double	6378136.3	(1,1) double sphere radius [m] for the km buffer
OverSample	1 x 1	double	2	(1,1) double quadrature refinement of the mask, as in shLowLevel.evalMask
BasinFile	1 x 1	string	"basins_rivbas.json"	(1,1) string the GeoJSON a basin name is looked up in (shLowLevel.readBasin's File)

output	description
B	(1,1) struct the basis, fields type (1,1) string "rbf", "slepian" or "sh" idx (1,1) struct the IDX it maps to T (P,K) double basis coefficients -> SH coefficients (sparse identity for "sh") Proj (K,P) double SH coefficients -> basis coefficients, region-weighted least squares (sparse identity for "sh") K (1,1) double number of basis functions nodes (K,2) double rbf centres [latDeg lonDeg]; [] otherwise kernel (Lmax+1,1) double rbf phi_n for n = 0..Lmax; [] otherwise kernelName (1,1) string the Kernel option; "" unless rbf grid (1,1) string the rbf node grid; "" otherwise level (1,1) double the rbf grid level used; NaN otherwise nGlobal (1,1) double nodes of the global rbf grid; NaN otherwise lambda (K,1) double slepian concentrations; [] otherwise rank (1,1) double eigenvalues kept in the projector (K for slepian and sh) eigTol (1,1) double the EigTol option region (1,1) struct fields name (1,1) string basin name; "" for other region forms bufferKm (1,1) double the BufferKm option areaFraction (1,1) double region area / 4pi on the quadrature grid; NaN without a region areaFractionBuffered (1,1) double the same for the buffered region mask (Ngrid,1) double the buffered mask on the OverSample grid; [] without a region core (Ngrid,1) double the region itself, unbuffered, on the same grid - what basin means are taken over; [] without a region overSample (1,1) double the OverSample option R (1,1) double the R option

Example

```
idx = shLowLevel.shIndex(60);
B = shLowLevel.regionalBasis(idx, "Elbe");            % RBF, Kaula
a = shLowLevel.regionalProject(ts.Cs, ts.Ss, B);      % K x T
S = shLowLevel.regionalBasis(idx, "Elbe", Type = "slepian", ...
                             Threshold = 0.5);
```

shLowLevel.regionalKalman

`[ts, out] = shLowLevel.regionalKalman(obsIn, B, Name=Value)`

Kalman-smoothed regional gravity field in a local basis. [TS, OUT] = shLowLevel.regionalKalman(OBSIN, B, ModelSeries=TSM) is the single point of access to the regional Kalman filter of CLAUDE.md WP8: Kurtenbach's normal-equation filter (2012, DGK C-683, Sec. 3.3) and the RTS smoother on the coefficients a of the regional basis B of shLowLevel.regionalBasis, after Woehnke et al. (2025, RBF) and Steffen et al. (2026, Slepian). It chains the pieces the earlier rows built and changes none of them: 1. the process mod...

input	size	type	default	description
obsIn	1 x 1	—	required	shSeries | (1,M) struct the observations, see above; a series must reach exactly degree B.idx.Lmax
B	1 x 1	struct	required	struct a basis from shLowLevel.regionalBasis
ModelSeries	1 x 1	shSeries	required	(1,1) shSeries process realisation at the filter's sampling, nmax = B.idx.Lmax (truncate first): ESA ESM, a hydrology model, GAX
Order	1 x 1	double	1	(1,1) double VAR order (see estimateVAR)
Shrink	1 x 1	double	0	(1,1) double diagonal loading of Sigma(0)
Structure	1 x 1	string ∈ ["full", "diagonal"]	"full"	"full" | "diagonal" coupling of the VAR estimate (see regionalProcessModel)
CondFun	n x m	—	[]	function handle covariance conditioning
QScale	: x 1	double	1	(1,1) or (nB,1) double Kurtenbach's alpha, one per block of QBlocks: Q -> D Q D; the start of the search with EstimateQScale
QBlocks	: x 1	double	[]	(K,1) double block label 1..nB of every basis coefficient; [] is one block
EstimateQScale	1 x 1	logical	false	(1,1) logical estimate the alphas by maximum likelihood of the innovations, see above
GroundNoise	1 x 1	double	0	(1,1) double isotropic ground noise [m EWH], added to Sigma(0) (see regionalProcessModel)
kn	n x m	double	[]	(>=Lmax+1,1) double load Love numbers: needed by GroundNoise and by the EWH outputs

input	size	type	default	description
Epochs	: x 1	double	[]	(E,1) double target epoch grid [decimal years]; [] uses the observation epochs. A grid entry without an observation within Tolerance is a gap: prediction only
Tolerance	1 x 1	double	0.5/365.25	(1,1) double max |epoch difference| [yr] for matching an observation to a grid entry
NoiseCov	n x 1	double	[]	solution mode, in B.idx order: a vector is one diagonal and a square matrix one full covariance, both used at every epoch; any other (P,M) matrix holds one d...
Climatology	1 x 1	logical	true	(1,1) logical solution mode: remove and restore the observation climatology, see above
FitClimatology	1 x 1	string ∈ ["observations", "filtered"]	"observations"	"observations" | "filtered" what that climatology is fitted to, as in kalmanChain: "observations" fits it to the (background-reduced) series, so the noise ...
Lag	1 x 1	double	Inf	(1,1) double smoothing lag in epochs (rtsSmoother's Lag): Inf the full RTS pass, 0 the filter estimates alone
QC	1 x 1	string ∈ ["none", "flag", "reject"]	"none"	"none" | "flag" | "reject" innovation QC (see kalmanFilter)
QCAlpha	1 x 1	double	1e-3	(1,1) double its false-alarm level
StoreCov	1 x 1	string ∈ ["full", "matfile"]	"full"	"full" | "matfile" where the filter keeps the covariances the smoother needs (see kalmanFilter); a matfile is deleted after smoothing
Background	n x m	—	[]	(1,1) shSeries global background, nmax = B.idx.Lmax, with an epoch within Tolerance of every observation and every output epoch: removed from the observatio...

output	description
ts	(1,1) shSeries T (a + Proj c) on the epoch grid with formal 1-sigma stacks sqrt(diag(T Ps T')), every step in the history
out	(1,1) struct fields mode (1,1) string "solution" | "records" basisType (1,1) string B.type K (1,1) double number of basis functions order (1,1) double VAR order epochs (E,1) double the epoch grid [decimal years] nEpochs (1,1) double E gap (1,E) logical epochs without an observation nGaps (1,1) double their number a (K,E) double smoothed basis coefficients, the restored climatology included (a + Proj c); the background is NOT in them sigA (K,E) double their 1-sigma covLast (K,K) double full smoothed covariance of the last epoch qcStat (1,E) double innovation statistic; NaN with QC = "none" nRejected (1,1) double epochs QC rejected specRadius (1,1) double spectral radius of the companion matrix; < 1 is stable meanContribution (1,E) double mean data share per epoch (Kurtenbach Sec. 3.3.2); NaN in gaps representation (1,1) double share of the model signal the basis carries (see regionalProcessModel) model (1,1) struct the estimateVAR struct basin (1,1) struct area-weighted basin mean of EWH over B.region.core, [] without kn or region; fields mean (1,E) double [m] sigma (1,E) double its 1-sigma [m] areaFraction (1,1) double region area / 4pi grid (1,1) struct EWH at the quadrature points of the region, [] without kn or region; fields latDeg (G,1) double geocentric latitude lonDeg (G,1) double longitude ewh (G,E) double [m] sigma (G,E) double its 1-sigma [m] memGB (1,1) double covariance storage of the filter [GB] (disk for "matfile") background (1,1) logical whether a Background was removed and restored negLogLik (1,1) double -2 log likelihood of all observations given the process model, without the terms no model parameter changes (kalmanFilter's Likelihood, summed) qScale (nB,1) double the alphas used (estimated with EstimateQScale) qBlocks (K,1) double the block of every coefficient qEstimate (1,1) struct the search, fields estimated (1,1) logical EstimateQScale start (nB,1) double QScale given evaluations (1,1) double filter runs of the search; 0 when not estimated atBound (1,1) logical an alpha ended within 1 percent of the factor 1e4 search limit exitFlag (1,1) double of fminbnd or fminsearch; NaN when not estimated

Example

```
    idx = shLowLevel.shIndex(60);
    B = shLowLevel.regionalBasis(idx, "Elbe", Type = "slepian", ...
        Threshold = 0.5);
    [tsK, out] = shLowLevel.regionalKalman(tsGrace, B, ...
        ModelSeries = tsESM, kn = kn, QScale = 10);
    errorbar(out.epochs, out.basin.mean, out.basin.sigma)

  Memory: the filter keeps two K x K covariances per epoch with the
  smoother; K is the number of basis functions, which for a region is
  far below the (nmax+1)^2 of the global chain.
```

shLowLevel.regionalNEQ

`[rec, info] = shLowLevel.regionalNEQ(B, kind, Name=Value)`

Gravity information of any level as a normal equation in a basis. [REC, INFO] = shLowLevel.regionalNEQ(B, KIND, ...) turns one epoch of gravity information into a normal equation in the coefficients a of the regional basis B of shLowLevel.regionalBasis - the observation adapter of the regional Kalman filter (Kurtenbach 2012, C-683, Sec. 3.3; NEQ-form update P+ = (P-^-1 + N)^-1). Every kind reduces to one design A in the basis and one covariance C of the data y: N = A' C^-1 A, b = A' C^-1 y, ltpl = y' C^-1 y,...

input	size	type	default	description
B	1 x 1	struct	required	struct a basis from shLowLevel.regionalBasis
kind	1 x 1	string ∈ ["solution", "neq", "points", "lgd"]	required	string "solution" | "neq" | "points" | "lgd"
Solution	n x m	double	[]	(P,1) double SH coefficients in B.idx order ("solution")
Cov	n x m	double	[]	covariance of the data: (n,n), (n,1) variances or a scalar variance, n = P ("solution"), M or Q ("points"), M ("lgd": of the filtered data, before rows are d...
NEQ	n x m	struct	struct([])	) (1,1) struct the SH normal equation ("neq"): fields N, b [, ltpl, nobs], or a readSINEX NEQ result
Values	n x m	double	[]	(M,1) or (Q,1) double the data ("points"); the unfiltered LGD [m/s^2] ("lgd")
LatDeg	n x m	double	[]	(M,1) double geocentric latitudes [deg] ("points")
LonDeg	n x m	double	[]	(M,1) double longitudes [deg] ("points")
Height	0	double	0	(1,1) or (M,1) double height above R [m]; only for quantities with a radial law
Quantity	1 x 1	string	"ewh"	(1,1) string any quantity of shLowLevel.kernelFactors
Direction	n x m	double	[]	(M,3) double ECEF directions; rows are normalised
Combine	n x m	double	[]	(Q,M) double linear combinations of the M points
PositionA	n x m	double	[]	(M,3) double satellite A, Earth-fixed [m] ("lgd")
PositionB	n x m	double	[]	(M,3) double satellite B, same frame [m] ("lgd")
Operator	n x m	—	[]	function handle Y = op(X) mapping an (M, 1+K) block to (M, 1+K), or an (M,M) matrix W (Y = W X): the along-track filter, applied once to [Values, A] ("lgd");...
Valid	n x m	—	[]	(M,1) logical epochs to use ("lgd"); [] keeps every epoch whose filtered row is finite
kn	n x m	double	[]	load Love numbers, for the mass quantities
GM	1 x 1	double	3.986004415e14	(1,1) double [m^3/s^2]
R	1 x 1	double	6378136.3	(1,1) double reference radius [m]

input	size	type	default	description
Name	1 x 1	string	""	(1,1) string label of the contribution; the kind when empty

output	description
rec	(1,1) struct a neqCombine contribution, fields N (K,K) double normal matrix in the basis b (K,1) double right-hand side ltpl (1,1) double y' C^-1 y; NaN for an NEQ without it nobs (1,1) double number of observations; NaN for an NEQ without it name (1,1) string the label
info	(1,1) struct fields kind (1,1) string the KIND argument A (n,K) double the design in the basis for "points" (after Combine) and "lgd" (filtered, kept rows); [] for "solution", whose design is B.T itself, and for "neq" y (n,1) double the data as used: the filtered, kept LGD for "lgd"; [] for the other kinds kept (M,1) logical the epochs used ("lgd"); [] otherwise

Example

```
B = shLowLevel.regionalBasis(shLowLevel.shIndex(60), "Elbe");
r1 = shLowLevel.regionalNEQ(B, "solution", Solution = l, Cov = sig.^2);
r2 = shLowLevel.regionalNEQ(B, "points", Values = ewh, ...
    LatDeg = lat, LonDeg = lon, Cov = 0.02^2, kn = kn);
[a, out] = shLowLevel.neqCombine([r1, r2]);     % VCE of the two
```

shLowLevel.regionalProcessModel

`[model, info] = shLowLevel.regionalProcessModel(ts, B, Name=Value)`

Kurtenbach's process model in a regional basis. [MODEL, INFO] = shLowLevel.regionalProcessModel(TS, B) estimates the stochastic process model of the regional Kalman filter from a geophysical model series TS - hydrology, ESA ESM, AOD1B errors - in the coefficients of the regional basis B of shLowLevel.regionalBasis, following Kurtenbach (2012, DGK C-683, Sec. 3.2): 1. the climatology of TS (mean, trend, annual, semi-annual; his eq. 3.81) is removed with ts.climatology; 2. every epoch is projected onto the basis, ...

input	size	type	default	description
ts	1 x 1	shSeries	required	shSeries the model series, nmax >= B.idx.Lmax, at the sampling of the filter (daily for daily solutions)
B	1 x 1	struct	required	struct a basis from shLowLevel.regionalBasis
Order	1 x 1	double	1	(1,1) double VAR order (see estimateVAR)
Shrink	1 x 1	double	0	(1,1) double diagonal loading (see estimateVAR)
Structure	1 x 1	string ∈ ["full", "diagonal"]	"full"	"full" | "diagonal" coupling of the estimate; estimateVAR's "orderblock" has no meaning for a regional basis
CondFun	n x m	—	[]	function handle covariance conditioning on the K x K basis covariances (see estimateVAR)
Climatology	1 x 1	logical	true	(1,1) logical remove TS's climatology first; false when TS is already reduced
QScale	1 x 1	double	1	(1,1) double Kurtenbach's alpha
GroundNoise	1 x 1	double	0	(1,1) double isotropic ground noise [m EWH]
kn	n x m	double	[]	(>=Lmax+1,1) double load Love numbers, required by GroundNoise > 0 (never invented)

output	description
model	(1,1) struct as returned by shLowLevel.estimateVAR, which documents every field; Q is the scaled one

output	description
info	(1,1) struct fields A (K,T) double basis coefficients of the reduced model series - the realisation epochs (T,1) double its epochs [decimal years] clim shClimatology the removed climatology; [] with Climatology = false representation (1,1) double share of the regional signal energy the basis carries, see above minEigQ (1,1) double smallest eigenvalue of Q; a negative one means Q is not a covariance groundCov (K,K) double the covariance added to Sigma(0); [] without GroundNoise qScale (1,1) double the QScale option groundNoise (1,1) double the GroundNoise option [m]

Example

```
B = tsModel.regionalBasis("Elbe", Type = "slepian", Threshold = 0.5);
[model, info] = tsModel.regionalProcessModel(B, QScale = 10);
info.representation, model.specRadius
```

shLowLevel.regionalProject

`[a, rec] = shLowLevel.regionalProject(Cs, Ss, B)`

Coefficient sets in a regional basis, and back. [A, REC] = shLowLevel.regionalProject(CS, SS, B) gives one or many coefficient sets their coefficients in the regional basis B of shLowLevel.regionalBasis, A = B.Proj * X, where X stacks the (C, S) coefficients in B.idx ordering: the region-weighted least-squares fit B.regionalBasis documents. REC returns the fit rebuilt in SH, B.T * A, repacked to (C, S) arrays for direct synthesis - inside the region it reproduces the field up to what the basis cannot represent, ...

input	size	type	default	description
Cs	n+1 x n+1 x T	double	required	double cosine coefficients, n >= B.idx.Lmax (T = 1 for a single set)
Ss	n+1 x n+1 x T	double	required	double sine coefficients, the same size
B	1 x 1	struct	required	struct a basis from shLowLevel.regionalBasis

output	description
a	(K,T) double basis coefficients, one column per set
rec	(1,1) struct the fit rebuilt in SH, fields Cs (n+1,n+1,T) double cosine coefficients of B.T * a Ss (n+1,n+1,T) double sine coefficients of B.T * a

Example

```
B = shLowLevel.regionalBasis(shLowLevel.shIndex(60), "Elbe");
[a, rec] = shLowLevel.regionalProject(ts.Cs, ts.Ss, B);
```

shLowLevel.safeMove

`n = shLowLevel.safeMove(src, dst, Name=Value)`

Move a file into place, retrying while a scanner still holds it. SAFEMOVE(SRC, DST) renames SRC to DST, overwriting DST, and retries with exponential backoff while the move fails. Every shLowLevel.fetch* function downloads to "<target>.part", verifies the fresh file by parsing it, and only then swaps it into place - this function is that swap.

input	size	type	default	description
src	1 x 1	string	required	string existing file to move (e.g. "x.gfc.part")
dst	1 x 1	string	required	string destination path; overwritten if present
Retries	1 x 1	double	5	number of RETRIES after the first attempt; 0 gives a single attempt and the behaviour of a plain movefile
Pause	1 x 1	double	0.25	seconds before the first retry. Each further wait doubles, capped at 4 s, so the default schedule is 0.25/0.5/1/2/4 s - about 7.75 s of patience in total, wh...

output	description
n	(1,1) double number of attempts used (1 = the move succeeded immediately, which is the normal case)

Example

```
    % download, verify, then swap - the fetcher pattern
    tmpf = "ITSG-Grace2018_n60_2008-04.gfc.part";
    shLowLevel.shReadGFC(tmpf);              % verify BEFORE the swap
    shLowLevel.safeMove(tmpf, "ITSG-Grace2018_n60_2008-04.gfc");

  See also movefile, shLowLevel.fetchICGEM, shLowLevel.fetchITSG.
```

shLowLevel.version

```
v = shLowLevel.version()
```

Toolbox metadata: name, version, date, root path, provenance. V = shLowLevel.version() returns the toolbox metadata as a struct. The version string and date are PARSED FROM Contents.m (the MATLAB toolbox convention line "% Version x.y.z ... dd-Mmm-yyyy"), so there is a single source of truth also honoured by MATLAB's own ver('shAnalysis'). Called without an output, prints a summary.

output	description
v	(1,1) struct fields: .Name (1,1) string "shAnalysis" .Version (1,1) string e.g. "2.5.1" .Date (1,1) string release date from Contents.m .Root (1,1) string toolbox root folder .Provenance (1,1) string authorship line

Example

```
    v = shLowLevel.version();
    fprintf("%s %s (%s)\n", v.Name, v.Version, v.Date)
```

Toolbox root

setup_shAnalysis

```
summary = setup_shAnalysis(Name=Value)
```

One-call setup: path + staged data downloads. setup_shAnalysis adds the toolbox to the path for THIS session only setup_shAnalysis(Permanent = true) also persists it (savepath) setup_shAnalysis(Download = "core") + TN-14 and TN-13 files setup_shAnalysis(Download = "filters") + DDK filter matrices setup_shAnalysis(Download = "starter") + ITSG starter months setup_shAnalysis(Download = "all") + EVERY monthly ITSG solution setup_shAnalysis(DryRun = true, ...) print/return t...

input	size	type	default	description
Permanent	1 x 1	logical	false	addpath + savepath; if savepath fails (no write permission on pathdef.m) a warning explains the startup.m alternative
Download	1 x 1	string ∈ ["none", "core", "filters", "starter", "all"]	"none"	"none" | "core" | "filters" | "starter" | "all" "all" (v3.27) extends "starter" to the FULL ITSG monthly archive (2002 -> present, both releases, at Nmax; se...
DDK	1 x :	double	3	subset of 1..8 for the "filters" level
Providers	1 x :	string ∈ ["GFZ", "CSR", "JPL"]	["GFZ", "CSR", "JPL"]	TN-13 providers for "core"
Months	1 x :	string	["2008-04", "2025-12"]	months for "starter"
Nmax	1 x 1	double ∈ [60, 96]	96	degree of the ITSG starter files (60 or 96)
Docs	1 x 1	logical	false	builddocsearchdb on html/ so the toolbox pages appear in the MATLAB help-browser search. Covers the narrative pages and the generated html/ref/ reference pag...

input	size	type	default	description
DryRun	1 x 1	logical	false	report the plan only - zero side effects
DataFolder	1 x 1	string	""	persistent data folder, applied BEFORE any fetcher runs
Proxy	1 x 1	string	""	per-call proxy URL, e.g. "http://proxy:8080" (empty: MATLAB Web Preferences)
Update	1 x 1	logical	false	forward to the fetchers: refresh existing files with a safe, parse-verified swap (temporal files like TN-13/TN-14 grow monthly)
SeriesFolder	1 x 1	string	""	folder of monthly .gfc files, exported as the SHX_SERIES_FOLDER environment variable AND persisted via setpref('shAnalysis', 'SeriesFolder', ...). The opt-in...
MasconFile	1 x 1	string	""	a mascon .nc, exported as SHX_MASCON_FILE and stored as preference 'MasconFile'. The opt-in readMascon check reads the environment variable, then the prefere...
GravisFolder	1 x 1	string	""	GravIS aux folder for the validated chains, exported as SHX_GRAVIS_FOLDER + preference 'GravisFolder' (opt-in real-data tests)
DDKFolder	1 x 1	string	""	DDK filter binaries folder, exported as SHX_DDK_FOLDER + preference 'DDKFolder'
TestDataFolder	1 x 1	string	""	folder holding the test fixtures when they live outside the repository (exported as SHX_TESTDATA_FOLDER + preference; the test suites resolve it via tests/sh...
Quiet	1 x 1	logical	false	suppress progress output

output	description
root	(1,1) string toolbox root folder
pathAction	(1,1) string "already-on-path" | "added-temporarily" | "added-permanently" | "planned"
dataFolder	(1,1) string download target root
plan	(1,:) string human-readable action list
fetched	(1,:) string files newly downloaded (verified)
skipped	(1,:) string files already present (re-verified)
failed	(1,:) string files that failed (download or parse)
testData	(1,:) string data locations that were set, if any, one line per option given among SeriesFolder, MasconFile, GravisFolder, DDKFolder and TestDataFolder; each is set with setenv (this session only) AND setpref (kept across restarts). DryRun lists SeriesFolder and MasconFile only
ok	(1,1) logical isempty(failed)

Example

```
    setup_shAnalysis(Permanent = true, Download = "core")
    setup_shAnalysis(Download = "filters", DDK = [2 3 5])
    s = setup_shAnalysis(DryRun = true, Download = "starter")
    setup_shAnalysis(SeriesFolder = "D:/grace/itsg", ...
        MasconFile = "D:/grace/GRCTellus_JPL.nc")   % opt-in test data
```

runAllTests

```
results = runAllTests(Name=Value)
```

Run the complete shAnalysis validation suite. RESULTS = RUNALLTESTS runs, in order: tests/testCorrectness.m numerics vs. golden/legacy/analytic values tests/testContract.m error IDs, immutability, dimensions tests/testRobustness.m edge cases, degenerate inputs, file I/O tests/testScience.m regression against PUBLISHED values (defining constants, load Love numbers, the closed-form EWH kernel, geocenter amplitudes) - so a

consistently wrong formula has somewhere to show up tests/testPerformance.m ...

input	size	type	default	description
SkipPerformance	1 x 1	logical	false	logical, default false
LogFile	n x m	—	""	text, default fullfile(tests,'runAllTests_results.txt')

output	description
results	(1,N) matlab.unittest.TestResult full result array (pass/fail/duration per test; log written to LogFile)

demo_shAnalysis

```
reg = demo_shAnalysis(cases, Name=Value)
```

Selectable demonstrations of every toolbox capability. demo_shAnalysis runs the "core" set (D01 D02 D04 D05 D15) demo_shAnalysis("all") runs every case demo_shAnalysis("list") prints the case table, returns registry demo_shAnalysis(["D04","D15"]) runs selected cases demo_shAnalysis(..., Visible=false) hidden figures (CI/smoke tests) demo_shAnalysis(..., OutDir=tempdir) target for D16 file exports demo_shAnalysis(..., StopOnError=true) rethrow instead of the default fail-and-cont...

input	size	type	default	description
cases	1 x :	string	"core"	string demo IDs to run, e.g. "D01" or ["D01" "D13"]; "core" expands to the curated smoke set, "all" runs the full registry in order
Visible	1 x 1	logical	true	(1 x 1) logical show figures (false keeps them off-screen for batch/CI runs)
OutDir	1 x 1	string	string(tempdir)	) (1 x 1) string output folder for exported files; "" = a fresh folder under tempdir (before v5.23.4 "" wrote into the current folder)
StopOnError	1 x 1	logical	false	(1 x 1) logical true stops at the first failing case; false (default) prints FAILED and continues - the fail-and-continue contract the suite exercises

output	description
reg	(D x 1) struct demo registry, fields id, title, fns (the exercised API) and run (the case's function handle)

Appendix

A. Error-identifier conventions

Every identifier has three parts, owner:function:reason: `shLowLevel:<function>:<reason>` for package functions; `<class>:<method>:<reason>` for class methods, where the middle segment is the public method that raises it (the constructor included) or one of three shared checks named by concept (operands, stack, range); and `shAnalysis:<function>:<reason>` for the root functions. Each is documented in the help of the function or method that raises it, which tools/error_id_audit.py enforces. Every guard has a unit test; every message names the offending quantity. Instrumentation asserts (nonFiniteVCE, nonFiniteEig, nonFiniteOperator, allZeroVariance) remain in the code as a permanent safety net after the v2.1 debugging campaign.

B. Known limitations (documented, tested where applicable)

- TN-13 verified against the real GFZ, CSR and JPL RL06.3 files (v2.5; 256 paired months each, cross-provider C10 correlation 0.995); SINEX against ITSG monthly files and synthetic fixtures — COST-G/other SINEX dialects may need parser tweaks (drop SINEX files into the test-data folder, shLowLevel.testDataDir; the discovery test picks them up).
- DDK: all eight released Wbd binaries parsed and gain-ordering validated (v2.5); a discovery test re-checks whatever subset is present locally. Other BIN dialects untested.
- readMascon is tested against a synthetic JPL-style fixture and has read a real CSR mascon product (v5.8.0); the opt-in SHX_MASCON_FILE test checks any real file you point it at — verify against yours (units, GIA convention, CRI flag).

• GIA uncertainty propagates only when a sigma field is given (removeGIA Sigma=, v5.2.0); AR(1) correction is first-order (Kendall-corrected r_1 since v2.5, ~3% residual optimism).

• Multi-center combination: common-mode errors invisible → posterior sigmas a lower bound.

• Basin sigma: deterministic-part errors correlated across epochs (pointwise 1-sigma reported).

• Streaming gz SINEX needs the JVM (fallback: gunzip to temp).

• ICGEM catalogue parsers are fixture-tested against real page captures (2026-08-07); a future site redesign would need refreshed fixtures (shLowLevel:listICGEM:parseFailed errors loudly).

• Earth-rotation excitation: the factors 1.098 and 0.753 are Chen & Wilson's; ESMGFZ's prefactors give a 12% larger axial term (AxialFactor= takes that convention).

• Gap bridging: a filled month carries the resolution and the error of the bridge series (41% of the GRACE signal over degrees 3–60 for the Kalman-filtered HLSST_SLR_COMB2023s at 750 km), and the whole bridged series is smoothed to match.

C. License & provenance

The toolbox is released under the MIT license (LICENSE in the package root; copyright Matthias Weigelt). The DDK3 Wbd test fixture carries its own MIT license from its upstream repository; the ITSG/GFZ files among the test fixtures (the testdata branch) remain the property of their providers and are included as test fixtures only.

All code, tests, documentation and this guide: developed by Matthias Weigelt with the help of Claude (Fable 5), 2026-08-07 (v1 through v2.4.2 in working sessions the same week). Every numerical method was independently validated in Python before MATLAB implementation; MATLAB execution itself happens on the user's side with runAllTests as the acceptance gate (118/118 green at v2.1; 134 at v2.2.2; 167 at v2.4.1; 168 at v2.4.2; 179 at v2.5 — v2.5 adds the exact constrained posterior, the basin deterministic-sigma term, the Kendall AR(1) correction, shLowLevel.readLoveNumbers, setup_shAnalysis/shLowLevel.fetchTN with verified staged downloads, real CSR/JPL TN-13 + GSFC TN-14 fixtures and the DDK-pack validation).